The Ideas Page: Agnipath revision must be judged by what it does to institution it was meant to reform 13

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CLAIMS BY CIVIL SERVICES CANDIDATES

Parent income not sole factor: SC on creamy layer in OBC

Bench reaffirms March ruling, says shall not affect seniority of any person or entail re-opening of selections already made

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, November 6

THE SUPREME Court on Friday reaffirmed its March 11 judgment which held that the creamy layer status of Other Backward Classes (OBCs) cannot be decided solely on the basis of parental income.

The Centre had sought "clarifications and appropriate directions" from the Supreme Court on the applicability of its March 11 judgment on the consideration of claims by OBC candidates who were selected in the Civil Services Examinations (CSE).

The matter traces its origin to a Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) letter of October 14, 2004, clarifying an Official Memorandum (OM) of September 1993 on the creamy layer criterion for OBCs. The 1993 OM had excluded income from salary and agricultural sources from the income/wealth test used to determine creamy layer status. The 2004 clarification said the salary income of employees in public sector undertakings (PSUs) and the private sector would be a criterion.

The 2004 clarification was not implemented effectively until 2014. It began to be applied rigorously from the CSE-2015 (corresponding to the 2016 batch). Since then, around 100 OBC candidates who cleared the CSE have found their claims being rejected by the DoPT on the creamy layer ground. Most of them are parties in different petitions

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Delhi sees worst pre-Diwali air in 8 years, GRAP-III imposed in NCR



Water sprinklers being used to curb air pollution in New Delhi, Friday. The Commission for Air Quality Management invoked Stage-III of the Graded Response Action Plan in NCR as the Capital's average Air Quality Index rose to 382 (Very Poor). AP

MORE REPORTS, PAGE 4

Vehicle restrictions, hybrid mode until Class 5, work-from-home norms kick in

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 6

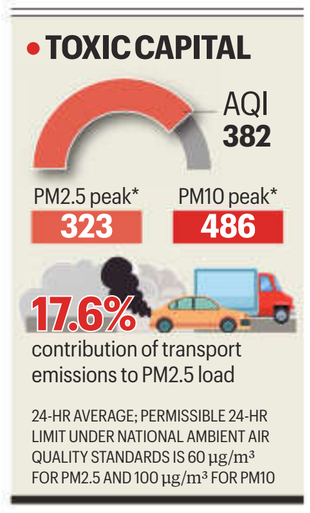
AIR QUALITY in Delhi plunged to near-severe levels on Friday as the 24-hour average air quality index (AQI) hit 382, the worst pre-Diwali air quality crisis in eight years.

Data from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) showed PM 2.5 concentrations peaking around 280 µg/m³ in the 30-45 hours leading up to Diwali — the highest pre-festival particulate baseline recorded since 2019.

Previous years have typically seen fine particulate levels drop to 50-150 µg/m³ during this window.

As pollution levels rose sharply, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) invoked Stage-III of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) across the entire

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In first, 50% WFH rule enforced in Gurugram pvt offices, two law firms get notice

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, November 6

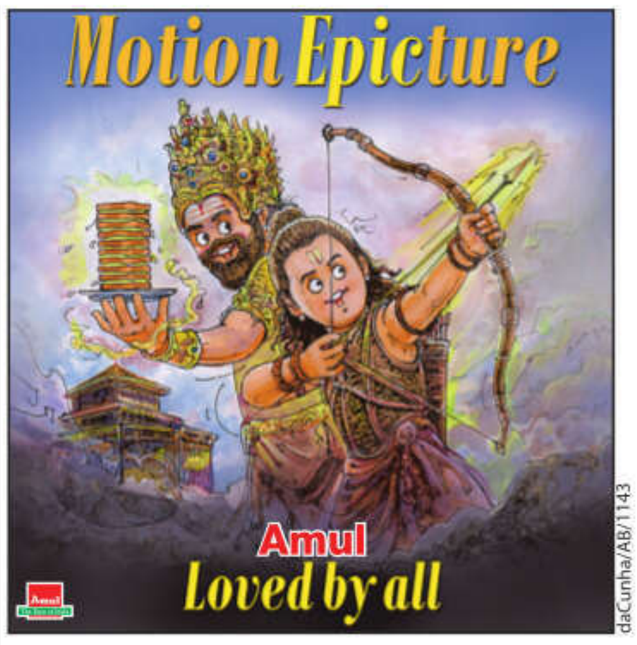
IN AN unprecedented action, the Gurugram district administration has served show-cause notices on several private commercial establishments in the city for alleged "violation of the directions restricting physical attendance of employees to 50%" to reduce regional air pollution.

Among the establishments to whom the notices have been issued are at least two prominent corporate law firms with offices on Golf Course Road (GCR).

The mandatory 50 per cent work-from-home (WFH) order was issued by the Deputy Commissioner of Gurugram on November 3 following directions of the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM).

The show-cause notices, which have been accessed by *The Indian Express*, were issued

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Amid global AI meltdown, stocks jump 9% in a week, best run in 6 years

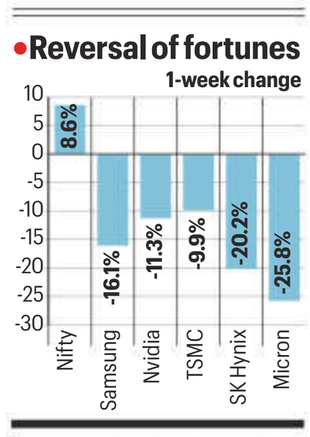
FIIs bring $4.6 bn this week, $1.1 bn on Friday alone

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, November 6

THE STOCK market gained another 2% on Friday and extended its winning run to the seventh session on its way to posting a 9% rise in one week — its best in six years — amid a global artificial intelligence-led driven meltdown that extended from the US to Japan.

While some of these markets are on the verge of entering bear territory, Indian markets look rejuvenated after a disappointing year — the Nifty is now down only 2% in the past one year and is at an eight-month high, while the Sensex is at a nine-month high — as foreign investors have come rushing in recent days. As a result, the rupee has also

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



NOTE: AS PER SHARE PRICES AT 6:30 PM IST, NOV 6; SOURCE: BLOOMBERG

Path clear for '25 batch, about 100 candidates whose OBC certificates were rejected since '16

Shyamlal Yadav
New Delhi, November 6

IF THE Central government follows Friday's Supreme Court ruling, it could pave the way for service allocation and training and induction of the 2025 batch of 958 candidates selected in the Civil Services Examination (CSE) and of 148 candidates selected in the Indian Forest Service Examination.

The decision could also enable nearly 100 OBC candidates to enter various civil services in accordance with their merit in the respective examinations.

Their caste certificates had been rejected over the years since 2016 on the ground that they belonged to the creamy layer, resulting in the rejection of their CSE selections.

A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and R Mahadevan said there was "no convincing or reasonable justification" for deferring the implementation of its March 11 judgment. While the court had originally given the Centre six months to implement the verdict retrospectively, the government approached it on August 24, citing

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Vehicles major cause of pollution, it's a free-for-all in Delhi, says top court

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, November 6

SAYING THAT vehicular pollution is a major contributor to the deteriorating air quality in Delhi-NCR, the Supreme Court on Friday asked why it is taking place despite all the measures put in place by the government so far. It expressed concern over the "bumper-to-bumper traffic" in the Capital, noting that it's a "free-for-all".

To address the other issue of stubble burning, the court said farmers should be provided economic incentives and practical alternatives. It said crop residue (*parali*) can be procured by procurement agencies, and the rates notified beforehand.

The bench, comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE EDITORIAL PAGE
A SCIENCE-BASED PLAN, NOT JUST GRAP, IS NEEDED TO TACKLE AIR POLLUTION P 12

EXPRESS AADA

'I am not against delimitation... but it has to be scrutinised'
KERALA CM
V D SATHEESAN
PAGES 20, 21

THE BIG PICTURE



LAWRENCE'S BOYS
PAGE 11

Happening today

- **NEW ZEALAND** is set for one of its closest polls in history after a campaign dominated by high cost of living and an economy hit by the war in West Asia.
- **VICE PRESIDENT** C P Radhakrishnan will visit Ayodhya for the Deepotsav, which will showcase the city's history and the Ram temple movement.

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



EXPRESS special

8 calls between Delhi, Washington in May-June: US lobbying firm

Divya A
New Delhi, November 6

IN ITS latest filings under the US's Foreign Agents Registration Act (FARA), American lobbying firm SHW Partners LLC, helmed by President Donald Trump's aide Jason Miller, has listed eight phone calls arranged between senior White House officials and the Indian government in May-June this year to discuss "India-US relations" as part of its "political activities".

India signed Miller's firm in April 2025, and the lobbying contract was renewed for another year in April this year. However, on June 23, the contract was terminated after Miller joined the Trump administration as a "special government employee".

The FARA requires "agents of foreign principals" who are engaged in political activities to make periodic public disclosure of their relationship, activities and financial compensation.

According to SHW Partners LLC, in May, ahead of Secretary of State Marco Rubio's visit to India, phone calls were arranged between the Indian side

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

AFTER SUPREME COURT SUGGESTION

EC re-opens window for electors left out of draft rolls in 7 States/ UT

Those marked absent, shifted, duplicate, dead can submit enumeration forms again

Damini Nath
New Delhi, November 6

JUST OVER a week after the Supreme Court gave the suggestion, the Election Commission on Friday re-opened the window for submitting enumeration forms for those electors who were left out of the draft electoral rolls in seven States/ Union Territory after being marked "absent, shifted, dead or duplicate" in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

Writing to the Chief Electoral Officers of Delhi, Maharashtra,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

- **4.51 crore deleted**

Delhi	47.56 lakh
Maharashtra	2.06 crore
Haryana	33.83 lakh
Andhra Pradesh	44.89 lakh
Jharkhand	43.61 lakh
Telangana	73.39 lakh
Nagaland	1.57 lakh

• WITH 50 LITRES OF ISOTONIC LIME WATER PREPARED ON DEMANDING DAYS, EVEN HYDRATION IS NOW METICULOUSLY PLANNED

Curries out, salads in: Colour-coded diet to prepare men's hockey team for Olympics

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, November 6

THE TEA break is out, and so are the heavy curries and generous helpings of rice.

The familiar post-meal sluggishness is now a thing of the past as the Indian men's hockey team has acquired a taste for the salad bar. Hummus, avocado, grilled meats, hung-curd desserts and an assortment of milkshakes are also on the menu. Even hydration is now meticulously planned, with players told when and how much to drink, and 50 litres of isotonic lime water prepared on particularly demanding training days.

PAGE 1 anchor

For a team that has spent the last decade transforming itself physically, tactically and technically, the latest change is happening at the dining table.

After winning the Asian Games gold last month and the Asian Champions Trophy Thursday, India are now turning their attention to the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, where they will chase a third successive Olympic medal.

The journey from a team that struggled to match the physical demands of elite hockey to one that can compete with the best has involved several interventions. Nutrition is the latest, and perhaps one of the last missing pieces, according to coach Craig Fulton.

"I don't think we have done it (diet) properly (in the past)," Fulton tells *The Indian Express*. "I think everyone now has bought into what the nutritional benefits are. It's not a magic wand. It's just the consistency of doing it not just at SAI (during the training camp) but also at home."

Since May, nutritionist Mihira Khopkar has been working with the team, introducing a structured fuelling programme that is as much about changing habits as changing menus. The idea is to ensure that the work done on the training pitch is not undone during meal time.

"Your grit, your determination, pieces like training, recovery can help you, of course. But if you don't put the right fuel in, how fast can you go? How far can you go?" says Khopkar, who was the Indian contingent's nutritionist at the Paris Olympics. "Nutrition is like a silent intervention but an extremely powerful intervention."

The first change was to bring the kitchen into the team's training programme. At the Sports Authority of India's (SAI) Bengaluru centre, the food was already good, Khopkar says, but it wasn't customised to the demands of the players' training schedules. Now, every Sunday, she shares a weekly menu with the chef, matching the food to the intensity of the sessions ahead.

The team's training days are colour-coded. Red is the highest-load day, usually involving match-like situations. Orange is a relatively lighter day, while green days are reserved for sessions such as penalty-corner practice and gym work. The plates follow the same colour scheme, with carbohydrate intake increasing alongside the training load.

A green plate is high in protein and lower in carbohydrates. It comes with raw, steamed and stir-fried vegetables, hummus, avocado or guacamole, nuts and seeds. Protein options range from grilled chicken and fish to lamb chops and prawns. The cooking is deliberately uncomplicated, with little oil, basic seasoning,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

- **MORE CARBS FOR HEAVY TRAINING LOAD**



RED (LUNCH / DINNER)
Carbs: 100-150 gm; Protein: 40 gm
Heavy workload days; along with salad and protein, there is additional rice, dal and other carbs

ORANGE (LUNCH / DINNER)
Carbs: 50-100 gm; Protein: 40 gm
Moderate workload days; plate is balanced accordingly, with a little more pasta and potatoes

GREEN (LUNCH / DINNER)
Carbs: 50-60 gm; Protein: 40-50 gm
Relatively light training day; meal includes raw, steamed/ stir-fried vegetables, hummus, nuts, seeds

Gurugram 50% WFH

on November 5 by the Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM), Badshahpur, after surprise on-site inspections.

According to the notices, the inspectors discovered that physical attendance at the offices of both law firms – Trilegal and JSA Advocates & Solicitors, which have their offices on the same premises in Gurugram's Sector 42 – exceeded the cap set under the anti-pollution directives.

The Indian Express reached out to both firms for their comments, but did not get a response till the time of going to print.

According to the notices, the inspectors found "approximately 87" and "approximately 160" employees at the two offices, whose "total staff strength" were 117 and 262 respectively.

Thus, the number of employees in both offices was "in excess of the permissible limit of 50%, thereby indicating non-compliance with the...directions" issued by the administration, the notices said.

The SDM's office directed the managements of both law firms to submit written explanations along with supporting documents within 24 hours. The required submissions include actual staff strength, biometric and attendance records for the day of inspection, roster schedules, and details of personnel permitted to work remotely.

The orders warned that failure to furnish a satisfactory response within the stipulated window would invite proceedings under Section 14 of the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021 (CAQM Act).

Gurugram Deputy Commissioner Uttam Singh had directed on November 3 that all private establishments must restrict physical staff presence to 50 per cent between November 5 and November 20.

"Directions issued by the CAQM to mitigate air pollution must be followed in letter and spirit," Deputy Commissioner Singh said on Friday. "Teams across all subdivisions are monitoring institutions and private units, and notices will continue to be issued to any violators."

Sources in the district administration said this is the first time that corporate offices across the district have been issued show-cause notices for violating anti-pollution work-from-home rules.

Officials said teams are carrying out surprise inspections based on public complaints flagging non-compliant workplaces on social media, where employees and residents have been tagging the Deputy Commissioner.

GRAP-III

National Capital Region (NCR) with immediate effect. The notification followed an emergency review by the CAQM Sub-Committee on GRAP on Friday evening.

The Sub-Committee noted that unfavourable weather conditions was leading to poor dispersion of pollutants, and warned that forecasts pointed to air quality deteriorating further into the 'Severe' category over the coming days. Officials evaluated pollution trends together with meteorological projections from the India Meteorological Department (IMD) and the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune.

Under GRAP Stage-III, private BS-III petrol and BS-IV diesel four-wheelers cannot ply in Delhi and in the high-density NCR districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Ghaziabad, Gautam Buddh Nagar, and Sonipat.

Primary schools across Delhi-NCR have been directed to mandatorily switch to hybrid learning mode for children up to Class V. NCR states and the central government may also move up to 50% of office staff to remote work to curb commuter traffic, according to the Commission's order.

The deterioration is not confined to Delhi. High fine particulate levels (PM 2.5 and PM 10) triggered severe spikes across the region, led by Panchgaon (AQI 426), Gajraula (407), Ballabhgarh (397), and Gurugram (368). Greater Noida (316) and Noida (303) recorded 'Very Poor' air.

A combination of weather conditions and the timing of Diwali this year is contributing to the deterioration. Stagnant winds, coupled with a sharp drop in weekend temperatures — forecast between 14 and 16 degrees Celsius by the IMD — could also trigger a temperature inversion.

Normally, warm air near the surface rises and carries pollutants up into the atmosphere. However, during inversion, a layer of cold air settles near the ground under a blanket of warmer upper air. This acts like a physical lid over the city, trapping heavy baseline emissions, farm fumes, and Diwali smoke near the surface.

When Diwali is in October, warmer temperatures alongside reduced seasonal stubble burning aid in dissipating firecracker emissions. Over the past decade, Diwali has come in early-to-mid November in only 2020 and 2023. In 2017, 2022, 2024, and 2025, Diwali mostly fell between mid- and late October.

Even before the festival-related emissions add to the pollution load over the weekend, NCR cities are dealing with substantial baseline emissions.

According to the IITM's Decision Support System, transport emissions in the city Friday was the biggest contributor to PM 2.5 at 17.6%. This was followed by smoke from farm fires at 7.9%. Neighbouring regions including Jhajjar contributed 6.8%.

A total of 6,226 farm fires have been reported in the northern states including Punjab, Haryana, UP, Rajasthan, and MP so far this season. Haryana's cumulative count between September 15 and November 6 has shrunk to 89 fires — down from 888 in 2024 and 2,576 in 2023 — while UP has halved its count to 479. In Punjab, detections fell to 3,144, down from 3,284 last year, and a peak of 58,489 in 2020. But key hotspots remain active, with Punjab logging 357 fires Friday.

Central India has emerged as a major source of farm fires. Satellite data maintained by IARI show the geographic baseline has flipped, with MP and Rajasthan recording cumulative seasonal totals of 1,220 and 1,097 fires respectively, including 197 active fires on Friday alone.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Creamy layer in OBC

before the Supreme Court and various High Courts.

The Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT) and the High Courts of Madras, Delhi and Kerala have ruled in their favour. The March 11 judgement came on the Centre's petition challenging the decisions of various High Courts granting relief to these OBC candidates.

The Centre had urged the court to "clarify/ direct that the judgment...shall not apply retrospectively so as to reopen completed selections, appointments, service allocations, cadre allocations, seniority positions or admissions" already made and to permit "a reasonable period of two years to undertake the exercise of establishing equivalence of posts".

Disposing of the Centre's plea, a bench of Justices P S Narasimha and R Mahadevan on Friday said there was "no convincing or reasonable justification" for deferring implementation of the order. The SC had given the Centre six months for implementation of its judgment. It extended the deadline by eight weeks on Friday.

The bench clarified that its order was only applicable to the parties before the court. "The grant of such benefit shall not, by itself, operate to the detriment of the seniority of any other person or entail the reopening of selections or appointments already concluded. In this regard, it is relevant to note that by its letter dated December 20, 2016, the DoPT had clarified that the selections pursuant to the Civil Services Examination, 2016, were subject to the outcome of the appeals pending before this court," the bench said.

Advocate Shashank Ratnoo, counsel for the candidates, said: "It's a big victory for OBCs. A decade-long battle for successful OBC candidates of CSE against the injustice has come to an end."

On the Civil Services Examination, 2025, the court said: "Since the process of allocation (of services) remains pending and there is no convincing or reasonable justification for deferring the implementation of the judgment dated 11.03.2026, the creamy layer principle, as interpreted in the said judgment, shall govern the allocation of services to OBC candidates selected through the CSE 2025."

Affirming the HCs' views, the SC had asked the Centre "to create such supernumerary posts, as required, to accommodate the candidates."

On Friday, it clarified that its judgment "cannot be construed as directing a general revision of service allocations or seniority across successive recruitment years, nor does it confer individual relief upon persons who were not parties to the original proceedings". "We find no observation or direction requiring the Union Government to revisit appointments already made, revise the seniority of any person, or undertake any selection, appointment or service allocation exercise afresh," it said.

It said the Centre's applications "appear to proceed on the erroneous assumption that the benefit of the judgment operates retrospectively, with effect from the dates of selection and appointment of the respondent candidates, and that the...government is required to undertake a corresponding exercise within six months. Such an interpretation is not borne out by the judgment. This Court did not direct the retrospective revision or reconsideration of selections, appointments, seniority or service allocations already concluded. The six-month period stipulated...was...for implementation of the directions in relation to the respondent candidates and intervenors and cannot be construed as requiring a general exercise."

It clarified that "although the interpretation laid down... constitutes a binding precedent under Article 141 of the Constitution and attracts the doctrine of *stare decisis*", the relief was on the facts of the case and determined only the rights of those who were party to it. "A distinction must be drawn between the adjudication of individual claims and the application of the legal principle declared while deciding those claims," it said.

"The ratio laid down in the judgment shall not, by itself, furnish a ground for reopening selections or appointments already concluded... The claims of persons asserting that they are similarly placed, whose cases are pending before any Court, Tribunal or other competent forum or authority, may be considered on their own merits" on the basis of the 1993 OM and the 2004 Letter, it said.

"All selections, appointments and allotments... made subsequent to the judgment dated 11.03.2026, insofar as they concern the implementation of reservation and the exclusion of the creamy layer, shall be governed by the 1993 OM, as interpreted by this Court," it said.

"The government remains at liberty to formulate its policy concerning reservation and the creamy layer criteria, in accordance with the Constitution and the principles laid down by this Court," it said, adding that it "is not inclined to prescribe any timeline for establishing equivalence between posts or consulting stakeholders in the formulation of the creamy layer policy, as these matters fall within the domain of the executive and the legislature."

The SC said it "was also conscious of the interdependent nature of recruitment and promotion arrangements... Reopening a concluded selected process... may prejudice numerous other persons and disrupt successive stages of service administration. The retrospective application of the principle may also unsettle promotions already granted and disturb the seniority of employees."

2025 batch

difficulties in doing so. On Friday, the court granted the Centre an additional two months.

The bench said its March 11 judgment had held that the respondent candidates "fall within the non-creamy layer of the OBC category and are entitled to the benefit of reservation together with consequential placement and allotment of posts in the selection processes in which they participated."

This means that salary or income alone cannot be used to determine creamy-layer status in the case of candidates whose parents work in PSUs, private-sector establishments, schools and other institutions. The status and category of the posts held by their parents must also be taken into account in accordance with the 1993 government order.

The 1993 order had excluded salary and agriculture income from the income wealth test deciding the creamy layer. In 2004, however, the government included the salary income of PSU and private sector employees, following which petitions were filed before the Supreme Court.

The Court ruled that excluding the children of such OBC parents working in PSUs and the private sector from reservation benefits solely on the basis of their salary income and not considering the category of posts - Group A or B, or Group C or D - would amount to "hostile discrimination".

The Indian Express had first reported on August 24 the Centre's move to seek relief from the Supreme Court. In October, it reported that the Foundation Course and service allocation of CSE-2025 candidates had been put on hold for the first time in the history of the Civil Services Examination.

The 2004 clarification of the Department of Personnel and Training provided that where equivalence between posts in the private or public sector and government posts had not been evaluated, creamy-layer status would be determined by assessing parental salary income separately from income from other sources. This formula was not implemented during the Congress-led UPA regime but began to be applied in 2016, two years after the BJP came to power.

The creamy-layer concept, introduced by the Supreme Court in the landmark Indra Sawhney case to ensure that reservation benefits reach the genuinely backward sections among OBCs, has long been the subject of debate over how social status and income should be assessed across different forms of employment.

The income ceiling for those not in government service, set at Rs 1 lakh per annum in 1993, was revised in 2004, 2008 and 2013. In 2017, it was raised to Rs 8 lakh per annum. It has remained at this level since then. The last meeting to consider revising the ceiling was held in July 2020, but no revision has followed.

The creamy-layer criteria cover persons occupying constitutional posts; Group A/ Class I officers of the All India Services and Central and state services (either of parents direct recruitee or by promotion before age of 40); Group B/Class II officers of the Centre and states (both parents); employees of PSUs of similar ranks; officers of the armed forces (above Lt Colonel); professionals and those engaged in trade and industry; property owners; and those covered by the income/ wealth test.

While equivalence between posts in some central PSUs and government positions was settled in 2017, the question remains unresolved for the private sector, universities, educational institutions and various state government organisations. Employees in these sectors were consequently being classified as creamy layer on the basis of their parental income.

SC on pollution

Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing a suo motu case examining the regulatory framework governing air pollution. "I hope you all are enjoying the weather in Delhi," the CJI said as soon as the bench took up the matter.

"A major cause of the pollution is vehicular pollution. Look at the roads in Delhi, look at the roads connecting Delhi to the NCR... the kind of bumper-to-bumper traffic... that's the major cause," the CJI said. "People may have their own justification, because if they have to go out, they don't have public transport system which can facilitate them. Unfortunately, we are lacking in that," he said.

Briefed about the immediate, intermediate and long-term measures being taken to check air pollution, the CJI said: "Despite all these measures, why is vehicular pollution taking place? It is only because of the overflowing of the vehicles itself, irrespective of the quality of fuel you use, whether it's petrol or diesel based..."

Senior Advocate Aparajitha Singh, the amicus curiae in the matter, said Delhi has the maximum number of vehicles.

"In Delhi, it's a free-for-all," the CJI said. Pointing out that vehicles registered in other states come to the Capital, he said: "You cannot, on mere entry, monitor what kind of fuel is being used, what is the condition of that vehicle. So, you don't have any mechanism. Maybe they come only for two hours, but whatever damage is done is done."

"We have made multifarious efforts to control these polluting vehicles. Pollution certificates are now geo-tagged. Without pollution certificates, fuel is not being given," Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the CAQM, said.

Senior Advocate Sanjiv Sen, appearing for the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), said "it's just this one month that this problem occurs".

But the CJI didn't agree. "Rest of the year also, it is not that you have less vehicles," he said.

The CJI said that solutions like curbing vehicles or infrastructure works were "tried and failed" methods.

Referring to steps taken under the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP), Bhati said: "I wouldn't say that there has been a complete failure of these measures. They have allowed pollution levels to remain in some sustainable (limits)".

"Our point is it (AQI level) is already touching 400," the CJI said.

"Every human activity will cause pollution....so how much to stop? And Delhi invites this talent, people... from across the country. Then festive times add on to it. Then little bit of stubble burning that flows in this direction, there also the winds play a bigger role," Bhati said.

Amicus Singh said that as per the CAQM status report, "on November 5, the contribution of stubble burning is 14 per cent. Stubble burning is one of the problems. Because Delhi is already polluted and with stubble burning, it tips over. So the entire focus on stubble burning is a little problematic."

The CJI said the burning period was almost over. "Stubble burning in any case is reducing," he said. Adding that it may fluctuate for a few days, he said: "Maybe, it is slightly higher on November 8, then with the passage of time... Because these are the days when the farmers will go for sowing wheat crop normally in place of paddy."

"There was a suggestion that with regard to the stubble, and the potential commercial usage...that some policy would be formulated by the ministry concerned to acquire the stubble at a particular rate from the farmers," Justice Bagchi said.

Bhati said significant measures have already been taken as policy interventions.

The CJI said crop residue can be procured by procurement agencies, and the rates notified in advance. "... kind of an education among farmers is required... when they find that it is incentivised or is beneficial for them, they will retain, they will not burn," he said.

Curries out, salads in

garlic and herbs. The heavy curries and generous masalas have disappeared.

"We kept some rice and tortillas and some noodles for them to make whatever they want. Every day they can have whatever they want. But the ingredients are clean," Khopkar says. "There are no curries, there is nothing heavy."

Orange days bring a little more pasta and potatoes, while red days have additional rice, dal and other carbohydrate options.

Khopkar studied the players' tracking data from Catapult, the monitoring device, to calculate their energy expenditure across the three types of training days before working out their calorie requirements.

Even the vegetarian options have received an upgrade. With only three vegetarians in the squad that travelled for the European tour and the World Cup, the challenge was to provide alternatives to the familiar paneer-heavy diet. There is grilled paneer, yes, but also a dessert made with hung curd and mango. On some days, a milkshake gets an extra dose of skimmed milk powder, taking its protein content to around 10 grams per glass.

"Not every day you can do paneer," Khopkar says. "So it's either grilled paneer, or if they don't feel like having it, then they do the shake. And they have the yogurt."

Eating right, Khopkar believes, is as much about keeping players available as improving their performance. "A healthy player means that you have reduced risk of injuries. It means that your immunity is fine. You have reduced risk of sickness. So that means that you have more playing days, more training days," she says.

The hydration programme follows the same principle of matching intake to training demands. On red days, the kitchen prepares around 50 litres of isotonic lime water. Morning recovery drinks could be watermelon or pineapple juice, while the evening menu rotates among milkshakes prepared with mango and dates, dry fruits, banana and chocolate, and avocado. There is no added sugar.

The emphasis is on more than just preventing cramps or fatigue. Dehydration can also affect concentration and decision-making — crucial in a sport where players have to process information in fractions of a second.

"If you are losing a lot of sweat and your heart rate is increasing, you get tired earlier in the day, which you don't want," Khopkar explains. "If you are dehydrated, with more than two per cent loss of water as body weight, automatically there are not enough fluids coming to the brain. So, your decision-making skills start blacking out."

Vice-captain Hardik Singh says the sessions with Khopkar made him realise he needed to add more protein to what was previously a carbohydrate-heavy diet. "Since we run a lot, we need carbs. But for me, carbs were overfuelling. So, I needed to eat more protein and then consume carbs," Singh says. "These small details can help you win and take you further."

Stocks jump 9%

strengthened markedly, closing at 93.91 per dollar on Friday, up 2.7% in the last month.

Foreign investors bought $1.1 billion worth shares on a net basis on Friday — their largest single-day purchase in nearly six years — taking the total for the week to $4.6 billion. This marks a big departure from what has prevailed for the better part of three years: from January 2024 to October this year, foreign investors have dumped $50 billion worth of Indian shares.

The Sensex added 1,718.01 points to close 2.2% higher on Friday at 81,028.02, while the Nifty 50 ended 493.75 points, or 2%, higher at 25,030.35, crossing the psychologically-crucial 25,000-mark for the first time since February. Most sectors were in the green, with banking, financial services, and pharmaceuticals being the top gainers.

In an interaction with *The Indian Express*, Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran said, AI is not the only story that will determine the optimism or the continued increase in the financial asset prices in the Indian stock market. "It is also true that in the last few days, the oil price came down quite significantly. Brent was trading at near $115 per barrel. Now it came down to $94. Of course, today it is $98 as we speak. Also, the Indian 10-year bond yield approaching 7.5 has also rallied to 7.2%. So all these factors played their part as well. But the most dominant influence was India's status as a non-AI play is definitely weighing positively on the Indian market sentiment and also drawing in FII investors in the near term."

"...the AI frenzy has sucked capital into a narrow sector and a few, selected economies. Returns, at least for a while, have been stunning. But, given recent jitters, it's worth to widen the perspective again. That's where India comes in, bypassed by much of global capital in recent quarters," said HSBC economists led by Frederic Neumann, Chief Asia Economist and Co-head Global Research Asia, on Friday.

In the US, shares of key AI companies have been hammered in recent days, with the likes of chipmaker Micron down 26% since October 30, while Nvidia has fallen 11%. On Thursday, the tech-heavy Nasdaq Composite fell 5.5% — the biggest single-day fall in 19 months — as a resounding win for the Democrats in the US midterm elections deepened fears of tighter AI regulations and potential roadblocks to construction of crucial data centres.

Asian markets on Friday took cues from Thursday's overnight selloff on Wall Street, with South Korea's Kospi, Taiwan's Taiex, and Japan's Nikkei 225 indices dropping 5-6%. In South Korea, chipmakers SK Hynix and Samsung have plunged 20% and 16%, respectively, since October 30.

"The initial relief following the Democratic sweep of (the US) Congress has faded sharply amid concerns over tighter scrutiny of AI infrastructure investment," noted analysts at MUFG Bank on Friday.

According to Tanvi Kanchan, Associate Director at Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers, global investors are "reallocating within emerging markets". "For most of this year, North Asia's AI-heavy markets pulled money away from India, which was seen as having little exposure to the AI trade. Now that trade is unwinding sharply. So yes, part of this is an anti-AI play. Indian IT services companies are being treated as a relative safe haven, since they sell enterprise services rather than the AI hardware and data centres now in question."

A knock-on effect of the Democrats taking control of the US Congress has been hopes of an end to the war in West Asia, which should help cool global energy prices. This is a key consideration for India, as it imports a vast majority of its energy needs. "AI or no AI, India's macro could look a lot better with lower oil prices," said analysts at Kotak Institutional Equities.

On Thursday, the price of India's crude oil basket had fallen to $94.52 per barrel, down sharply from October's average of $119.91 per barrel.

Eight calls

and senior White House officials including Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, Deputy NSA Michael Needham and Under Secretary for Terrorism and Financial Intelligence Gene Lange.

In June, after Rubio's visit, there were calls between the Indian side and US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, Assistant to the President for Policy Walker Barrett, and Director of White House Office of Communications Steven Cheung.

The company, in its filings, has also listed two "embassy events" with Rubio on May 23 and 24. Rubio was in India from May 23 to May 26, during which he attended the America @250 events hosted by the US Embassy.

Miller, too, was in New Delhi at the time.

The contract, signed by the Indian Embassy in Washington with Miller, involved a monthly payout of $150,000. The scope of work included "strategic counsel, tactical planning and government relations assistance on policy matters before the US government, the US Congress, state governments, academic institutions, think tanks, and other relevant stakeholders," as per the documents.

Following Trump's re-election, the Indian Embassy hired two major lobbying firms helmed by those seen as part of the President's inner circle. The other firm was Mercury Public Affairs, signed at a monthly retainership of $75,000, with Bryan Lanza, communications director for Trump's transition team, in its core team. Susie Wiles, now Trump's Chief of Staff, was also a registered lobbyist with the firm until late 2024.

In its filings, Mercury has listed a post on X by Trump, greeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi on becoming India's longest serving Prime Minister in June this year, among other things.

Draft rolls

Haryana, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand, Telangana and Nagaland — all States/ UT where the final SIR electoral roll is yet to be published — the EC said: "...the Commission has decided that electors who were issued enumeration forms but whose names could not be included in the draft electoral roll on account of being marked as ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Dead and Duplicate) shall be provided one more opportunity to get their names included in the final electoral roll."

While the EC letter did not mention any deadlines for the submission of enumeration forms, sources said the forms would be accepted during the ongoing claims and objections period in each state.

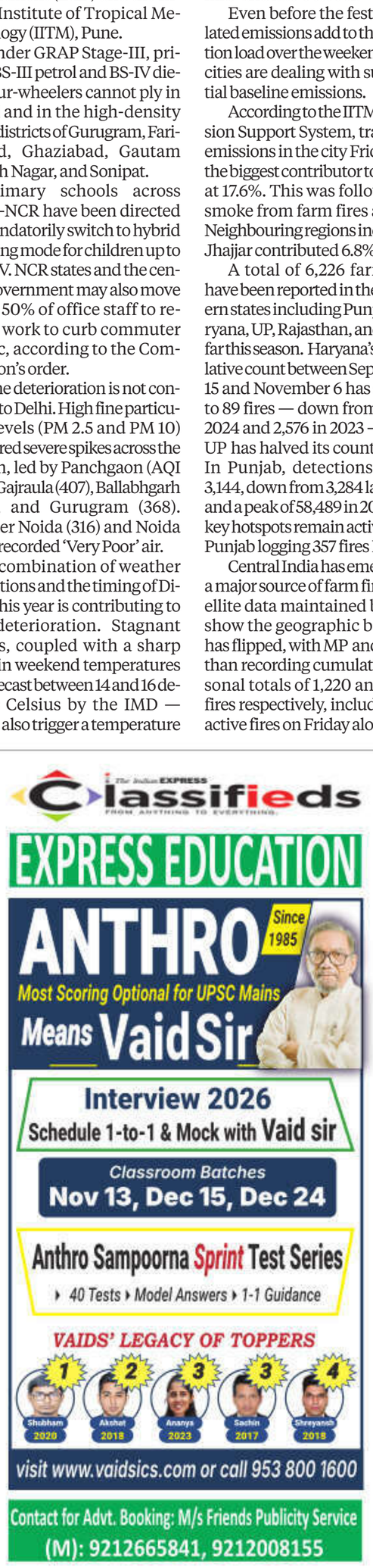
During a hearing on October 28, the Supreme Court had asked the EC to consider allowing those who could not submit their enumeration forms in time during the SIR to do so now.

As per the EC's SIR procedure, all registered electors were required to submit enumeration forms within a one-month enumeration phase, and those who did not do so within the deadline were not included in the draft rolls. These electors, 4.51 crore in total in these seven States/ UT, were removed from the rolls when the drafts were published earlier this year.

While these electors were encouraged to submit Form 6, which is the statutory form for new electors, the EC has now said: "All such electors shall be provided one more opportunity to submit their duly filled enumeration forms during the ongoing SIR to the concerned ERO/AERO corresponding to their current ordinary residence."

The EC said the ASDD lists, published during the enumeration phase of the SIR earlier this year, would once again be put up on the noticeboards of the respective polling stations, panchayat bhawans, urban local body offices and BDO offices. They would also be published on the CEO's website in readable PDF format, it said. The Booth Level Officers of the ECI were instructed to work with the Booth Level Agents of political parties to make contact with all electors through house-to-house visits.

Since these electors had been deleted from the draft rolls, the EC said if they are now added back, they would be "re-assigned" the same EPIC numbers they had prior to the SIR. "An elector who has already submitted Form-6 for fresh enrolment during SIR, need not submit the enumeration form with statement afresh," it said.



Excluded in SIR draft roll? Here's how to get back on the list

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, November 6



Ground workers carrying out SIR-related work in Delhi. FILE

ELECTORS LEFT out of Special Intensive Revision (SIR) draft in Delhi, Maharashtra, Haryana, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Telangana — after being marked absent, shifted, dead or duplicate — are set to get another chance, the Election Commission of India (ECI) announced Friday. This comes over a week after the Supreme Court suggested such a move.

In Delhi, nearly 47.5 lakh electors were excluded from the draft roll published on August 31 after being categorised as ASDDO (Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate and Others). Of the 1.45 crore electors in the initial roll, those left out will now be able to apply for inclusion through a special process without going through the regular fresh enrolment procedure.

Electors excluded after being marked in the ASDD category do not need to submit Form 6 (for fresh enrolment) or Form 8 (for change of residence). Instead, they have to submit an enumeration form, along with a declaration explaining their circumstances.

Those who have already submitted Form 6 during the revision period do not need to submit another form.

Partially filled enumeration forms will be generated afresh and can be accessed online through the ECI website or ECINET app by entering EPIC number. The missing details will have to be filled in. Any adult member of the household can fill it on the elector's behalf, as per officials.

Electors will also be required to trace their own, a parent's or a close relative's name in the 2002 electoral roll, the last time an SIR was conducted in Delhi. Those who voted in Delhi before 2002 can search the roll on the Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi's website. Those who moved to Delhi after 2002 can check the electoral roll of their previous state on voters.eci.gov.in. If their own name is not available, they can provide details of a parent or close relative.

If the address remains unchanged, an elector should submit the enumeration form along with a signed declaration in Annexure-B. Both can be submitted physically to the Booth Level Officer (BLO), Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) or Assistant Electoral Registration Officer (AERO), either by the elector or a family member. Submission through ECINET using e-sign is also permitted.

Those who have moved within Delhi must submit the enumeration form with Annexure-C. For homeless electors without residence documents, a BLO's field verification report will serve as proof. The application must be submitted to the ERO/AERO of the new Assembly constituency.

BLOs, in coordination with Booth Level Agents and RWAs, will conduct door-to-door visits and phone inquiries. For assistance, one can use 'Book a call with BLO' facility on ECI website or ECINET app.

Over 1,000 posts vacant in govt hospitals, HC says recruit early

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 6

EXPRESS exclusive

IN A bid to fill over 1,000 vacant posts of general duty medical officers (GDMO) and non-teaching staff (NTS) across Delhi government hospitals, the Delhi High Court has directed the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) to begin recruitment without waiting for the regular annual cycle, "as an exceptional case".

The direction, issued by division bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and Manmeet Pritam Singh Arora on October 30 – it was made public on November 3 – came while hearing a 2017 suo motu public interest litigation (PIL) instituted to monitor facilities in Delhi hospitals.

The Delhi government, in a status report submitted to the HC on October 29, had admitted that over one-third (645) of its sanctioned posts (1,785) for GDMO and over 40% of its sanctioned posts (926) for NTS are vacant.

The recruiting agency for both these posts is UPSC, which, as per policy, accepts requisitions for filling the vacant posts from January to March every year.

The government told HC that while it had sent the requisition to UPSC for recruitment to 654 GDMO and 417 NTS posts, UPSC had raised some observations, and that it will resubmit the requisition between January and March 2027.

The government attributed the vacancies to a shortage of eligible candidates, non-joining of selected candidates and resignations after appointment. It also said UPSC often recommended fewer candidates than the number of vacancies reported.

"It is pertinent to mention that the number of candidates recommended/forwarded by UPSC against the vacancies requisitioned by the department is often considerably lower than the number of vacancies reported," the report noted.

According to it, during the last recruitment cycle, against 279 NTS vacancies, UPSC forwarded only 154 dossiers. Further, against 234 GDMO and 279 NTS posts, only 161 doctors and 82 non-teaching staff joined the Delhi Health department.

The HC directed the government to send revised requisitions for the vacant posts to UPSC in two weeks. "The UPSC, as an exceptional case, shall commence the process of recruitment without waiting for the annual cycle of submission in January to March, 2027."

It also directed UPSC to file a status report on whether it has received the said requisition and whether the process of recruitment has been initiated or not by December 17, the next date of hearing.

Meanwhile, 804 of the 4,462 posts sanctioned for paramedical staff remain vacant in government hospitals. The recruitment to these posts are made through the Delhi Subordinate Services Selection Board. Paramedical staff vacancy also includes radiographers, senior radiographers, and tech officer in radiology — the combined vacancies currently stand at 122.

In the interim, the HC directed the medical superintendents or medical directors of individual hospitals to take steps to engage contractual employees for these three positions within two months.The HC also noted a shortage of radiologists in the government hospitals. The government's report shows machines lying unused or only partly used in at least 9 of its 38 hospitals owing to lack of qualified personnel, including specialists in radiology departments.

With the government earlier suggesting that radiology-related tests can be outsourced to the private sector — with it funding the cost — the HC asked medical superintendents and directors of the 38 hospitals to hold a joint meeting and suggest steps to ensure availability of equipment or staff.

It also asked the Health Secretary to assess the expenditure on outsourced MRI, ultrasound and other scans, and examine whether contractual salaries could be increased to attract more candidates.

• Equipment unused due to vacancies in radiology department

Hospital	Equipment lying unused	Why
Dr BR Sur Hospital	USG Machine	**No radiologist**
Chacha Nehru Bal Chikitsalaya	2 USG machines (partially used)	Radiologist available only **3 days a week** on diverted capacity from GTB Hospital; none applied for recruitment call
Chaudhary Brahm Prakash Ayurvedic Charak Sansthan	USG Machine	**No radiologist**
SDDMASC	2 USG	**No radiologist**
Acharya Shree Bhikshu Hospital	1 USG	Medical officer specialised in radiology available **3 days a week**
Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital	1 functional USG Machine	**No radiologist,** ultrasonographynot being conducted for general patients. But USG being conducted on gynaec patients. **4 posts** of senior residents and one specialist in radiology department are vacant.
Guru Govind Singh Government Hospital	4 USGs under condemnation	**No regular radiologist**, a radiologist medical officer deployed on rotational basis for 3 days a week
Aruna Asaf Ali Hospital	1 functional USG	**No radiologist**
DDU Hospital	1 CT scan and 4 USG machines	Of the 42 radiographer posts, **13 vacant**, including both posts of radiodiagnosis specialists

*SOURCE: DELHI GOVERNMENT'S REPORT BEFORE DELHI HC

Can't disconnect power without notice, HC tells NDMC on Race Course Masjid

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 6

REFERRING TO the disconnection of water and electricity to Race Course Masjid, the Delhi High Court Friday remarked that utilities cannot be disconnected without notice, when the mosque is a notified property under the relevant statutes.

Justice Subramonium Prasad, addressing the New Delhi Municipal Council, remarked, "You cannot disconnect electricity without notice." The judge's remarks came while the court was hearing a fresh plea filed by the mosque's imam, appealing against a single-bench order that refused to restore utilities.

The division bench issued notice, seeking responses to be filed by the NDMC and Delhi Waqf Board within two weeks. The court will hear the matter next on December 14.

The mosque is located inside the Race Course Club, which occupies around 53 acres near the Prime Minister's residence at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg. A petition in court has raised apprehensions that the mosque, a Waqf-notified property and a Grade II heritage structure notified in 2009, will be demolished due to the Centre's ongoing reclamation of land parcels in the surrounding area.

On October 29, the Centre, through its Land and Development Office (L&DO), had told the Delhi HC that it will decide on a representation by the Delhi Waqf Board in four weeks and won't take any coercive action against the mosque until then.

Advocate M Sufian Siddiqui, representing the imam, Md Haroon, argued before the bench of Justices Prasad and Renu Bhatnagar on Friday that while the Centre is relying on a Delhi HC judgment that had paved the way for removal of alleged encroachers in three jhuggi clusters opposite the PM's house, the mosque was never party to the litigation.

The NDMC as well as the Centre have relied on the court's verdict in a separate set of litigations, where the court had paved the way for eviction of 700-odd families from the slum dwellings in August.

Siddiqui also pointed out that electricity and water connections to the mosque were disconnected "without following procedures under relevant statutes and regulations".

Challenging the single-judge's order of October 15, which refused to restore electricity and water connections that were disconnected on October 7, Siddiqui also pointed out that "at least a reply was called for (by the single judge's court) from the respondents to show... on what basis electricity and water was disconnected".

The appeal stated that the sole issue that was to be adjudicated upon by the court was "whether NDMC possessed lawful authority to disconnect and continue withholding the existing electricity and water supply to a functioning mosque and occupied hujra", which remained unexamined.

It also contended that the single judge's verdict "consequently rests upon a foundational misconception of Waqf law, selective consideration of the record, and an erroneous enlargement of the earlier demolition directions".

'Attack on dignity of a woman': HC orders takedown of CM's AI videos

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 6

DIRECTING TAKEDOWN of AI-generated videos featuring Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta posted from social media handles of the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), the Delhi High Court on Friday observed that the posts were "not only defamatory and offensive but also attack the dignity of a woman, having constitutional authority".

CM Gupta had moved the HC against AAP and others, including social media intermediaries X Corp and Meta platforms, seeking permanent injunction against several AI-generated videos featuring her as a liquor vendor as well as a deepfake video showing her, along with Deputy CM Parvesh Sahib Singh, pouring liquor and ice-cubes.

Seeking the takedown of the images, videos and posters published from AAP's official and verified accounts, Gupta submitted that all the "offending" material, put on public domain, depict a sitting CM "as liquor vendor, hawker and delivery agent and as head of non-existing 'Har Har Rekha or Ghar Ghar Theka Yojana'".. She also submitted that some of the content was "highly stigmatic, disgraceful and defamatory" that showed her serving drinks "amidst a brawl and in the backdrop of romantic soundtrack".

Justice Manoj Jain, ruling that she has a preliminary case in her favour, "particularly keeping in mind the fact that these contents travel at a lightning speed through social media platform", ordered takedown of six such posts.

The court issued summons to the defendants, including AAP, while observing that the videos and the posts in question "have clearly breached the dividing line as the contents are not only defamatory and offensive but also attack the dignity of a woman having constitutional authority".

Noting that featuring Gupta in the videos "has evident potential to tarnish her personal dignity and moral character, not only as a Chief Minister but as a woman also", the court observed that "the offensive portrayal of Chief Minister, ... hurting her very dignity can be...said to be in the realm of permissible political satire".

Takedown request against rights groups by impostor: X

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 6

A REQUEST to take down the X accounts of digital rights organisations Internet Freedom Foundation (IFF) and SFLC.in (Software FreedomLaw Center), purportedly sent by the Delhi Police, was actually made by an impostor, X Corp has told the Delhi High Court following its internal probe.

On November 3, X Corp had communicated to the IFF that it had received "requests from the Delhi Police". The purported "illegal content report" was made by someone claiming to be "Hargobinder Singh Dhaliwal, Special Commissioner of Police (Crime), Delhi Police", who reported IFF's content as violating Indian law on grounds of "safety/security, defamation, and other".

Senior advocate Akhil Sibal, along with advocates Abhik Chimni and Pranjal Abrol, appearing for IFF and SFLC.in, told the HC that it had written to the Delhi Police to clarify the veracity of the takedown requests, but received no response. "Accusation is defamation, defamation is non-cognisable offence, how can Delhi Police send (a request for takedown on grounds of defamation)?" Sibal argued.

X Corp, through its counsel Ankit Parhar, clarified to Justice Amit Mahajan on Friday, "We have done our investigation, it turns out that it was somebody playing imposter, somebody impersonating Delhi Police ... We have not taken any action (against IFF and SFLC.in)... We have done an internal investigation and it turns out these notices are not by Delhi Police, it is an illegal notice. We filed a complaint with the Delhi Police to investigate and find this imposter."

Delhi Police, through central government standing counsel Ashish Dixit, also clarified that it has not sent such requests.

Recording X Corp's submission, Justice Mahajan disposed of the two pleas.

In their pleas, SFLC.in and IFF said they received legal notices on October 29 purportedly issued on behalf of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS).

The pleas said the notices were signed by an unidentified authorised signatory, calling upon the two to stop "publicly opposing" directions of the Government of India under the Information Technology Act, 2000, and to stop documenting restricted content. They also objected to SFLC.in's 'Free Speech Tracker' which documents instances of digital censorship.

On November 1, the two again got an email purportedly on behalf of the RSS along similar lines. The same evening, both organisations received a communication from X Corp that it had received a request from the Indian Police of certain posts on their X accounts violating the law.

On November 3, X Corp again communicated that it had received requests from the Delhi Police, sharing with the organisations the specific 'illegal content report'.

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Program Coordinator, DACE

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INSTITUTIONAL PLOTS SCHEME

Sl. No.	Plot No.	Sector	Area (PSQM)	Plot Use	Total Reserve Price (In ₹)
1	NH-1	CHI-3	1,270.00	Nursing Home	5,62,00,040/-
2	NH-1A	CHI-3	1,500.00	Nursing Home	6,63,78,000/-
3	NH-1B	CHI-3	1,500.00	Nursing Home	6,63,78,000/-
4	NH-1C	CHI-3	3,537.75	Nursing Home	16,02,81,302/-
5	NH-1	CHI-4	677.00	Nursing Home	2,99,58,604/-
6	5A	Knowledge Park-5	23,062.00	Higher Secondary School	66,39,08,856/-
7	5B	Knowledge Park-5	17,667.80	Higher Secondary School	54,83,90,844/-
8	12C	Knowledge Park-5	6,200.00	Higher Secondary School	18,58,82,200/-
9	HS-01	XU-II	5,628.00	Higher Secondary School	16,20,07,608/-
10	HS-38A	Omicron-I	12,000.00	Hospital	32,56,56,000/-

Note: In above rate GST not included, GST shall be payable extra.
Plots clear from all encumbrances | Allotment will be made on "as is where is basis" | Plot readt for Procession
Brochure download and Registration Starts 12.11.2026 | 3:00 PM
Registration End Date 02.12.2026 | 5:00 PM
Last Date of EMD, Processing Fee Deposit 04.12.2026 | 5:00 PM
Last Date of Final Submission of Document 07.12.2026 | 5:00 PM
E-Auction Date & Time to be Notified Separately
For corrigendum/addendum, please refer to website www.greaternoidaauthority.in
Don't miss the opportunity, please visit One Map Greater Noida for plots location deails.
Greater Noida Industrial Development Authority
Plot No. 01, Knowledge Park-04, Greater Noida-201308, Distt.-Gautam Budh Nagar, (U.P.)
Helpline Center No.: 0120-2336046, 2336047, 2336048, 2336049
Ph.: 0120-2336030-33 | E-mail: authority@gnida.in | Website: www.greaternoidaauthority.in
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DELHI DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
V. No. 5/2026/PB-I
VACANCY NOTICE
DDA intends to fill up following posts on deputation basis from eligible and willing officers belonging to Central Government/ State Government or Organizations dealing with public works or town planning.

Sl. No.	Name of Post	No. of Vacancies*	Level in the Pay Matrix as per 7th CPC
1.	Chief Engineer (Civil)	04*	Level-14

*No. of posts are tentative and can be increased or decreased, as per the requirement of DDA, without prior notice.
The initial tenure of deputation period will be for 03 years extendable up to 05 years on year to year basis, which may, however, be terminated at any time before completion of period/ extended period at the discretion of DDA.
For complete details regarding eligibility criteria, terms and conditions etc., kindly visit DDA's website www.dda.gov.in/personnel/advertisement
Last date for submission of applications is 15.12.2026.
(Sonika Singh)
Commissioner (Pers.)
Visit DDA's website-www.dda.gov.in or dial Toll Free No. 1800110332
Follow us on: @ddaofficial @official_dda @official_dda_

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ADMISSION OPEN
MBBS Management seats
in Government Medical College
Option Entry Available From
6th November to 9th November, 2026
Interested candidates should apply through KEA Website : kea.kar.nic.in

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For details visit : Karnataka Examinations Authority

DELHI'S AIR QUALITY INDEX SET TO TURN 'SEVERE'

Blind spots in pollution monitoring as GRAP-III kicks in

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 6

JUST TWO days before Diwali celebrations kick off in full swing in Delhi-NCR, several of the Capital's key air-quality monitoring stations went blank, the Central Pollution Control Board's (CPCB) official data revealed.

Across the Capital, as fireworks were burst in parts of the city by Friday night, around a dozen monitoring stations recorded gaps in particulate pollution data, according to an analysis by *The Indian Express*.

The data gaps come at a time when the air quality in the city remained in the 'Very Poor' category for the fifth consecutive day with the 24-hour average AQI settling at 382. The AQI is expected to worsen to 'Severe' category over the weekend. The Commission for Air Quality Management in the NCR and Adjoining Areas imposed stage three emergency measures in Delhi-NCR under the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) to prevent further deterioration of the situation.

WHAT DATA ANALYSIS REVEALS

IN PM2.5 µg/m³

WORST PM2.5 HOTSPOTS ON FRIDAY: IN PM2.5 µg/m³

Punjabi Bagh	350
Jahangirpuri	340
Rohini	336
DTU	316
Vivek Vihar	311
R K Puram	310

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)



TRUCK-MOUNTED WATER SPRINKLERS DEPLOYED NEAR INDIA GATE ON FRIDAY. ANI



Major changes between Nov 1 and 6

- PM2.5 increased nearly **70%**, rising from 133.6 to 226.6
- PM10 increased by **53%**
- Stations with daily average PM2.5 above 250 rose from zero to 25
- Stations with daily average PM10 above 250 increased from 27 to 56
- 144 hourly PM2.5 readings and 282 hourly PM10 readings were missing across the 59 monitoring stations

SOURCE: CPCB

Skywatch

Forecast: November 7, 2026
Mainly clear sky.
MAX: 28-30
0.5°C below normal
MIN: 15-17
1.7°C above normal

AQI Tracker

Najafgarh	Rohini
Severe	Severe
AQI: 422	AQI: 438
Anand Vihar	Vivek Vihar
Poor	Severe
AQI: 291	AQI: 423

11 stations hit

From Nehru Nagar to Burari Crossing, at least 11 monitoring stations were affected in all on Friday, including Vasundhara Enclave and Nangloi, which were among the monitoring stations inaugurated just last month. The disruptions led to 22 blind spots in hourly PM2.5 tracking and 27 missing PM10 hourly readings.

Of these, seven had both pollutants missing and four others reported gaps in only one. Three major monitoring stations suffered complete data outages across all 24 air-quality and meteorological parameters, including PM2.5, PM10, NO, NO2, NOx, ammonia, sulphur dioxide, carbon monoxide, ozone, temperature and wind speed. While IIT Delhi went blank for nearly two hours from 11 am to 1 pm; Nangloi lost four hours of data from noon to 4 pm; and NSIT Dwarka faced blackout for four hours during the peak evening period from 5 pm to 9 pm Friday. On the other hand, Shadipur missed six PM2.5 readings while Indian Institute Of Technology Delhi failed to record six PM10 data points.

Blackouts through the week

The blackouts have extended through the week leading up to Diwali. For instance, stationwise data maintained by the Centre and state pollution control board revealed ITO's PM10 monitor remained completely non-functional for 86 consecutive hours, from midnight on November 1 to 2 pm on November 4 before finally sputtering back to life. The pattern was broader — 144 missing PM2.5 readings and 282 missing PM10 readings across the Capital's 59 monitoring stations through the week.

Not only individual pollutants, complete outage on all monitored parameters were also common during this period. NSIT Dwarka recorded the highest number of such hourly data gaps, with 27 hours of missing data, followed by Nangloi with 23 hours. Sonia Vihar recorded 10 such hours, IIT Delhi seven, while Najafgarh and Burari Crossing logged two and one hours, respectively.

A senior scientist at Delhi Pollution Control Committee explained: "Under standard operating protocol, the central server in DPCC is configured to automatically trigger an operational alert whenever a CAQM Station fails to transmit telemetry for three consecutive hours..." The nodal officers are alerted to trace whether the outage stems from server concerns, power interruptions, sensor or instrument choking, or any calibration errors.

Missing hourly readings are a cause of concern, and as per official protocols by DPCC, treated as a priority. This is because CPCB's National AQI methodology requires a minimum of 16 hours of readings for each of at least three pollutants, one of which must be PM2.5 or PM10, to calculate a station's daily AQI.

If a station fails to meet this requirement, its overall AQI is treated as having insufficient data, even if readings for some pollutants are available. This can leave localised pollution levels unrepresented in the station-wise daily AQI assessment.

GROUND report

'Work has stopped, labourers left': Inside Delhi's drive to stop construction

Alok Singh
New Delhi, November 6

AROUND 2 PM on Thursday, a white Swift Dzire stopped outside a construction site in East Delhi's Laxmi Nagar. Three officials wearing masks stepped out.

They were greeted by a blue hoarding with a handwritten message "*Kaam band hai* (Work has stopped)" hanging at the entrance. The team entered the premises and found construction material covered with green netting, and a few plastic cement sacks that had been left open.

Noticing them, the MCD official asked a security guard, who lived there with his family, "*Yeh khula kyun hai?* (Why has this been left open?)". The guard immediately covered the sacks with the net.

He said no construction work had been taking place here since November 1. "*Koi labour ab nahi hai, sab chali gayi. Pata nahi kab aayenge aur malik kab bulayega* (There are no workers now; they have all left. I don't know when they will return or when the owner will call them back)," he said.

The officials were part of a joint enforcement team tasked with inspecting construction sites in Gandhi Nagar and adjoining areas.

"Today, we have to cover parts of Laxmi Nagar and Geeta Colony," said a Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) official, who was an assistant sub-inspector-rank officer.

Citing historically observed peak pollution levels in November, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) in Delhi and adjoining areas ordered a 15-day ban on dust-generating demolition and outdoor construction activities across the region from November 5.

Meanwhile, as part of the Delhi government's winter action plan, which came into effect on November 1, outdoor construction activities and dust-generating demolition work have been prohibited, except for essential public infrastructure projects, till January 31.

To track on-ground compliance, joint enforcement teams have been constituted by the government to inspect construction and demolition (C&D) sites, issue on-the-spot fines and track illegal dumping of construction waste.



Under the Delhi government's winter action plan, outdoor construction activities have been prohibited. ALOK SINGH

Across Delhi, fines exceeding Rs 1.5 crore were imposed over five days for violations including driving without a valid Pollution Under Control Certificate and flouting the construction ban.

In the East district alone, which is divided into three subdivisions — Vishwas Nagar, Gandhi Nagar and Patparganj — challans amounting to Rs 6 lakh had been issued till November 5 for violations of the C&D activity ban. These included two government construction sites in Patparganj.

What has stopped — and what hasn't

Before the Laxmi Nagar site, the team had stopped at a suspected construction site in Geeta Colony. It was a three-storey commercial building on the main road. They found the site locked.

One of the team members, a junior engineer from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC), checked whether anti-dust measures — a green net and steel sheets at least 10 metres high — were in place to cover the site.

The MCD official inspected the area around the premises to check for construction waste but found none.

The team went to a garment shop on the ground floor, where the shopkeeper said no work had been carried out at the site for the past two days.

The DPCC official said the team identified sites for inspection based on complaints received through the government app and directions from senior officials.

"Today, we were assigned sites based on the directions of our seniors, as the number of complaints has come down compared to earlier," the official said.

Returning to sites where work was halted

Officials next walked into a lane in East End Enclave, also in Laxmi Nagar, where construction had been underway at a house before the ban came into force. Work had since stopped, and the entire premises was enclosed with blue sheets and green netting.

The team then visited another site in the vicinity. Two men inside the premises opened the door. On seeing the Civil Defence official in a khaki uniform, one of them said, "*Sir, kaam band hai, dekh lijiye, koi labour nahi hai* (Sir, the work has stopped. You can check; there are no workers here)".

Construction material had been stored inside the premises and covered.

"We visited this site on October 30 and instructed the contractor to stop work before October 31. We have come back today to check whether the instructions have been followed," the MCD official said.

"In this area, most construction sites are smaller than 500 square metres. Initially, many were flouting the norms, but things have now improved. You can see that the workers have left," the official added.

The MCD official said the team had issued four challans during the first three days of inspections.

These included one of Rs 20,000 for dumping construction and demolition waste into a drain outside a premises in Preet Vihar. "We also issued a court challan for burning wood at a construction site," the official said.

"Since yesterday, however, we have not found any violations. People have become more aware," the MCD official said.

The officials went on to inspect five more sites during the day but found no violations at any of them. Their shift ended at 10 pm.

15K kg of illegal crackers seized; over 70 FIRs in Delhi-NCR

Pragynesh & Abhimanyu Hazarika
New Delhi, November 6

IN THE run-up to Diwali, Delhi-NCR saw a crackdown against sale of firecrackers at unlicensed units with at least 35 FIRs filed in the Capital and 41 cases registered in neighbouring Gurugram, as per officials. In Noida, officers said they remain vigilant. However, the number of cases filed is not significant.

Key seizures in Delhi

In Delhi, at least 15,000 kg of illegal firecrackers were seized by the city police between October 1 and November 6, said sources.

At least 35 FIRs were registered across Delhi under the Explosive Act of 1884, and relevant BNS sections. One of the biggest seizures took place in Shalimar Bagh on October 24 when around 2,375 kgs of firecrackers were seized from a godown in Haiderpur village, which also included green crackers.



A policeman pours water on crackers at Pataudi Road, Gurugram. EXPRESS

- Another large consignment was seized in Outer North Delhi with a total of 2,101 kg seized on October 2. Officers said that 1,350 kg of firecrackers were seized from two vehicles going to transport them. The arrested men led the police to a godown near the Jeet farmhouse in Alipur, where another 751 kg of firecrackers were recovered.
- Another key case, officers underlined, was reported from the North District where 10 FIRS were registered across Lahori Gate, Burari, Kotwali, Bara Hindu Rao and Subzi Mandi with a total of 1,074 kg of firecrackers seized, said officers.
- The Delhi Police's Crime Branch recovered 2,270 kg of "illegal firecrackers" from over 87 packages from two vehicles near Alipur. The packages were allegedly procured from Punjab for supply in the national capital.

Raids in Gurugram

In Gurugram, administrative teams registered over 41 FIRs across multiple sub-divisions and seized several quintals of crackers that flouted green certification norms or were sold outside designated zones.

- In Farrukhnagar, SDM Dinesh Kumar sealed two shops selling firecrackers outside prescribed standards, booked the owners, and confiscated 25 kilograms of stock. In Sohna, Sub-Divisional Magistrate Akhilesh Yadav oversaw inspections that led to two FIRs and the seizure of another 25 kg of crackers.
- Along Pataudi Road, SDM Hitendra Kumar intercepted over 100 kg of banned firecrackers being sold outside designated spots, destroying the entire haul on-site by soaking it in water, said officers.
- In Sector 56, SDM Sanjeev Singla led raids in the local market against unlicensed vendors, resulting in three FIRs.
- In parallel operations, Gurugram Police stepped up enforcement under the Explosives Act, deploying 53 special squads, in coordination with specialised Crime Branch units.
- As per Gurugram Police spokesperson ASI Sandeep Kumar, 36 cases were registered on November 5 alone, resulting in 23 individuals being arrested or joined into investigations.

Meanwhile, in Noida, a senior police officer said that the officers remain vigilant. But no major cases have been filed.

According to police, around 24 kg of illegal fire crackers were seized and an FIR was registered under the jurisdiction of Sector-39 police station on Thursday.

DDA opens bookings for 445 flats in Delhi, prices start at Rs 43L

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, November 6

WITH PRICES starting at Rs 43.36 lakh, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) is opening bookings for 445 middle-income group (MIG) flats across Narela, Loknayakpuram and Jahangirpuri from Friday.

These flats are under the DDA's new scheme, Khushhaal Parivaar Yojana 2026.

The largest share is located in Narela, in Pockets 1B and 1C, and Sectors A1-A4. These flats have a plinth area of around 114 square metres and are priced between Rs 67.03 lakh and Rs 67.41 lakh after a 25% discount. The prices exclude GST and maintenance charges.

At Loknayakpuram's Pocket E, 132 flats with areas ranging from around 134 to 140 square metres are available. These are priced between Rs 1.14 crore and Rs 1.19 crore. In Jahangirpuri, 17 flats with areas ranging from 64 to nearly 100 square metres are on offer, with prices ranging from Rs 43.36 lakh to Rs 1.14 crore.

As per the DDA, registration and booking will be conducted through the authority's Awaas Portal from Friday. Applicants will have to pay a one-time, non-refundable registration fee of Rs 2,500. Those who have already registered on the portal need not register again. The flats will be available for inspection by prospective buyers.

The launch comes amid a rise in DDA's housing sales this financial year.

Between April and October, the authority sold 9,332 flats, against 5,198 during the corresponding period last year — an increase of nearly 80%. Sales across MIG, low-income group (LIG) and high-income group (HIG) categories during the first seven months of the current financial year have also surpassed the total sales recorded in each category during the entirety of 2025-26.

The DDA sold 5,171 LIG, 1,704 MIG and 820 HIG flats between April and October, compared with 3,547, 1,580 and 404, respectively, in the previous financial year.

Narela, recently renamed Vindhyachal, accounted for over 90% of the DDA's housing sales this year, according to officials. The authority has attributed the increased demand to improved connectivity and infrastructure projects.

Mobile shop, car showroom, garment unit: Capital sees 3 blazes in one day; no casualty

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 6

THREE FIRES broke out at commercial establishments in different parts of Delhi on Friday with the most serious incident reported at Karol Bagh's Gaffar Market where a blaze at a mobile accessories shop spread through a four-storey building prompting the deployment of 22 fire tenders, police said.

Two other fires were reported at a Kia showroom near Saket Metro station and a garment lace shop in New Azadpur, officers said, adding that no casualties were reported in any of the incidents.

At the Gaffar Market, the fire broke out at Puri Plaza in Chain Wali Gali around 1:28 am on Friday. Police suspect the fire originated on the ground floor, where mobile batteries were stored, before spreading to the upper floors.

Overheating or overcharging of batteries is being considered a possible cause though the exact reason will be established after an investigation, police said.

Around 22 fire tenders, three ambulances and two PCR vehicles were deployed to contain the fire. The fire caused extensive property damage, police said.





The incident sites at the Kia showroom in Saidulajab; (right) Karol Bagh's Gaffar Market. PRAVEEN KHANNA

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) and the Electrical Inspector will submit reports to determine the cause, officers said. A forensic team will examine the premises for other combustible materials, while police will seek a structural safety assessment from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD). The MCD said the building at Karol Bagh had an approved building plan dating back to 2005.

The old, occupied property comprises a basement, ground floor and three upper floors. MCD said it had received no recent complaints regarding fire hazards, battery storage or electrical wiring. It added that the building was protected from punitive action under the Delhi Special Provisions laws.

The incident prompted the Chamber of Trade and Industry (CTI) to seek round-the-clock deployment of fire tenders, and firefighting teams at 20 major markets until Bhai Dooj on November 11. In a letter to Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the traders' body sought that one lane in each market be kept clear for emergency vehicles.

The CTI proposed a Rs 100-crore 'Traders' Fire Disaster Fund', seeking assistance of up to Rs 5 lakh or interest-free loans for small traders affected by fires.

Meanwhile, in South Delhi, a fire broke out at a Kia showroom near Saket Metro station around 3.45 pm. According to the DCP, South District, 12-15 people stranded on the rooftop were rescued, while four others were evacuated from the rear of the building.

Two women suffered minor injuries due to smoke inhalation and were hospitalised. Their condition was stable. Five fire tenders and six ambulances were deployed. Six vehicles were also reportedly affected in the blaze, police said.

Another fire was also reported at a garment lace shop in Shanti Mohalla, New Azadpur, around 8: 40 am.

Sixteen fire tenders were rushed to the spot, and the blaze was brought under control by afternoon. Azadpur Market head Abhay Jain said a short circuit was suspected to have caused the fire.

The shop was closed at the time, and no one was inside, police said.

3 held, flagged illegal construction: Police on building collapse

Pragynesh
New Delhi, November 6

A DAY after two labourers died after an under-construction building collapsed in Old Delhi's Chawri Bazaar, three contractors were arrested on Friday. Police said labourers had warned the contractors that the building was not capable of bearing the load of any additional floor.

Police said Siraj, Tajuddin, and Furkan, were nabbed from Faridabad's Dauj. All three, residents of Chawri Bazaar, had fled after the incident.

Neighbours said the owners were two brothers — Ayub and Barkat. "The building was being built by Barkat. The contract was given to Siraj, who transferred it to Furkan," said a neighbour.

Police had earlier told the Municipal Corporation of Delhi that the building was being constructed illegally. "You are requested to inform agencies concerned for necessary action ... Necessary police assistance will be provided...," a letter by Hauz Qazi SHO dated June 15 read.

An officer said the collapse prima facie appeared to have been caused by the contractors beginning work just seven days after laying the slab for the third floor. Ideally, work should not resume for at least 15 days after a slab is laid.



The building collapse in Chawri Bazaar killed two labourers. FILE

The deceased were identified as Kishori (40), and Sanjeet (45). The injured were Sahdev Chaudhary (25), and Firoz (37), also labourers. Police said four to five labourers could still be trapped under the debris.

A relative of Kishori, Sulekha Devi, said he was planning on going to Bihar for Diwali. "He has four children waiting for him. Who will take care of them?"

According to a relative, Sanjeet had been living in Railway Colony since June. "He has a son aged 3 and daughter aged 2. He was the only earning member of his family.

'Deeply sinister': Rahul slams minister for his voter ID-linked welfare payments statement

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, November 6



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi

LINKING UNION Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh's remarks about replacing Aadhaar with voter IDs and biometrics for welfare payments to the SIR exercise, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi Friday said the statement revealed "a deeply sinister plot". What the Panchayati Raj Minister said goes beyond just "vote chori", Gandhi said. "This is theft of rights."

Gandhi's remarks drew a sharp reaction from Rajiv Ranjan Singh, alias Lalan Singh, who said the Congress leader has "mastered the art of distorting facts."

Earlier in the day, Gandhi shared on X a video of Singh making the statement, and said the minister announced that eligibility for government schemes will no longer be determined by Aadhaar, but by one's Voter ID. "This is a deeply sinister plot." the Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha wrote in his post in Hindi. "Take a moment to understand it."

"Millions of names are being struck off the electoral rolls—and if this is not stopped, many more will be removed. Whose names are being targeted? Primarily those who are angry with the BJP," Gandhi added.

"The electoral roll should be managed by an impartial Election Commission; instead, it is in the hands of Gyanesh Kumar—an official of the Modi government—who has been caught, with evidence, colluding with BJP to steal votes," he alleged.

The plan is to curate an electoral roll that ensures a permanent majority for the BJP, he said. "And now, this very list will determine whether or not you receive the benefits of government schemes."

"If you decide to oppose the BJP, your name will be selectively removed from the list. No name—no vote. No vote—no rights. Before you know it, you will become an 'invisible' citizen in a hijacked democracy—a system where the people do not choose the government, rather, the government chooses its people," he said, adding, "Today, it concerns Panchayati Raj schemes. Tomorrow, rations? Pensions? MNREGA? Housing? Scholarships? Reservations?"

"A poor person's pension cannot be held hostage to their Voter Id. This is not just the theft of votes—it is the theft of your rights. We will not let this happen," he said.

Reacting sharply to Gandhi's remarks, Singh accused him of "distorting facts". "The government is committed to ensuring that benefits reach the genuine beneficiaries directly, leaving no scope for middlemen to misuse the system."

"The Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana (PM VGSY) aims to provide essential training and guidance to every eligible Panchayat representative and individuals associated with a Panchayat. Under this scheme, the identity of the trainees will be verified using their EPIC number and biometric-based Aadhaar authentication," he said in a video message on X.

Addressing the National Workshop on People's Plan Campaign 2026-27 on October 30 , Singh had said, "I would like to add the Aadhaar card will no longer serve as basis for making payments to beneficiaries. Instead, payments to beneficiaries will be processed using their biometrics and their voter ID (EPIC) number)," he said, without elaborating on the schemes for which the EPIC number will be used.

30% ethanol blend in petrol: Karnataka govt accuses OMCs of exceeding limit

Blending governed by prescribed specifications and quality-control protocols: OMCs

Express News Service
Bengaluru, New Delhi, November 6



A signboard with information about E20 ethanol fuel in Delhi. FILE

THE CONGRESS-RULED Karnataka has accused Central public sector oil companies Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL) and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) of using ethanol blends in petrol exceeding the prescribed 20 per cent limit, potentially harming vehicles.

The allegations have been rejected by the Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs), who also raised questions on the sampling and testing methodology used by the Karnataka government.

Karnataka Food and Civil Supplies Minister Rizwan Arshad told a press conference Friday that independent studies of fuel samples at a private laboratory had revealed "31.2% ethanol blending in IOCL and 30.5% in HPCL, exceeding 20%."

The minister said the state had tested 63 petrol samples across the state through the Karnataka Legal Metrology Department and found four of every five samples contained over 20 per cent ethanol blending — which oil firms did not disclose.

"We demand transparency from the Union Government, strict action against over-blending, compensation for affected consumers and mandatory disclosure of ethanol content at fuel stations. Consumers deserve quality fuel and transparency for every rupee paid," he said.

Deputy CM Dr G Parameshwara said that the findings reveal a danger to the fuel efficiency of vehicles in the state.

"Even the Centre has acknowledged that E20 can reduce fuel efficiency in certain vehicles. What happens when the ethanol content goes beyond 30%? Who will bear the additional fuel costs and the risk to vehicle performance? Why should ordinary motorists pay the price for such failures?" the deputy CM asked on social media regarding the findings.

"At a time when Karnataka's farmers are already suffering from severe drought, the Centre is restricting an important market for sugarcane-based ethanol while allowing petrol to be sold with ethanol levels far beyond the prescribed limit. Where is the promised benefit to farmers? Where is the protection for motorists? Is this not deceiving both farmers and consumers?" Parameshwara asked.

The samples from 63 petrol pumps were initially sent to the IOCL and BPCL laboratories, but they did not provide reports on the extent of ethanol content in the fuel. The state then approached private labs accredited by the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL) and those certified by ISO.

The minister referred to reports obtained from the Shriram Research Institute to substantiate claims of higher ethanol blending in some of the pumps.

OMCs reject claims

Three public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) — IOCL, BPCL and HPCL — rejected the allegations, saying E20 petrol supplied across India conforms to Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) specifications, and questioned the sampling and testing procedures used by Karnataka authorities. They sought independent testing of the samples as per the prescribed methodology in the presence of their representatives.

In a joint statement, the OMCs said the inspection by the Karnataka government was conducted in absence of their representatives, and that they were not provided with the retained samples, complete laboratory reports or technical details needed to verify the findings.

They also questioned the testing methodology, arguing that the certificates cited by Karnataka do not establish compliance with prescribed BIS testing standards.

"In view of the concerns raised, the three OMCs have asked the Karnataka government to share complete sampling records, outlet-wise laboratory reports and test methodology details. They have also sought access to counterpart samples for independent testing at an authorised laboratory using the prescribed referee method, in the presence of state government and OMC representatives," they said.

The OMCs also cited a joint quality-monitoring exercise with the Centre for High Technology, in which all 893 samples tested across 27 states and UTs, including 56 from Karnataka, met the prescribed ethanol range of 19-21%. The Karnataka samples recorded an average ethanol content of 19.3%.

"These results demonstrate that ethanol blending at OMC retail outlets is monitored and controlled within the prescribed specifications. The findings are inconsistent with the substantially higher ethanol levels reported in the Karnataka press release and reinforce the need for a transparent, technically sound and jointly verifiable testing exercise," the OMCs said.

CM: Karnataka to get woman minister before next session

Press Trust of India
Bengaluru, November 6

KARNATAKA CHIEF Minister D K Shivakumar said Friday a woman would be inducted into the state Cabinet before the next session of the state legislature.

Speaking at an interaction with beneficiaries of Congress government's 'Gruha Lakshmi' scheme, he urged them to exercise caution in financial transactions and warned them against falling prey to exorbitant interest rates and chit fund schemes.

"All these days, Laxmi Hebbalkar (Congress MLA) has taken the lead in addressing your concerns. She served for three years (as Women and Child Development Minister). Let's see, in the future, a woman minister will be appointed before the next Assembly session," Shivakumar said. "Whomever the high command nominates will be appointed as the Minister to look into your issues."

The CM, however, did not specify whether he was referring to the state legislature's winter session, scheduled to be held in early December.

सार्वजनिक सूचना

समृद्धि होम्स योजना में **ई.डब्ल्यू.एस.** भवनों का **लॉटरी ड्रॉ** दिनांक **18.11.2026** तथा **एल.आई.जी.** भवनों का **लॉटरी ड्रॉ** दिनांक **20.11.2026** को **प्रातः 11:00** बजे शासन द्वारा निर्धारित समिति के समक्ष हिन्दी भवन लोहिया नगर, गाजियाबाद में किया जायेगा। लॉटरी ड्रॉ से पूर्व आवेदक निजी विकासकर्ता के कार्यालय में आपत्ति एवं आवश्यक संशोधन हेतु **07.11.2026 से 10.11.2026** तक आवेदन कर सकते हैं। निर्धारित अवधि के उपरान्त किसी भी आपत्ति पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा। समस्त पात्र आवेदक लॉटरी ड्रॉ के समय स्वयं उपस्थित रह सकते हैं।

निजी विकासकर्ता
मैसर्स उप्पल धड्डा हाईटेक डेवलपर्स प्रा.लि. (वेव सिटी)
योजना–समृद्धि होम्स

M-1-27/22/2019-Museum-I

Government of India
Ministry of Culture

Applications are invited for appointment to the post of Director General in the Pay Band-4 (Rs. 37400-67000/-) plus Grade Pay Rs. 10000/- [Pre-revised scale of Pay of 6th CPC] [Revised as Pay Matrix level 14, Rs. 144200-218200 of 7th CPC), General Central Service, Group 'A' Gazetted, Non- Ministerial in National Gallery of Modern Art, New Delhi a Sub-Ordinate Office under Ministry of Culture, Government of India, on promotion or deputation (Including Short Term Contract) or on contract basis. The details regarding eligibility conditions, educational qualifications and experience, application form, Recruitment Rules, date of receipt of applications etc. attached to the post are available on the website of this Ministry at **https://culture.gov.in** & **www.ngmaindia.gov.in**

CBC-09110/11/0005/2627 **Under Secretary**

PUBLIC NOTICE
ATTENTION

Restriction on Entry/Plying of Vehicles in Delhi

1. Vehicles Registered Outside Delhi

- Every year, from 1 November to 31 January, Other State registered BS-IV and below vehicles will not be allowed to ply in Delhi.

2. Commercial Goods Vehicles & Buses Registered Outside Delhi

- With effect from **1 November 2026, commercial goods vehicles (LGV/MGV/HGV)** and **buses which are BS-IV and below** will not be permitted to enter Delhi. This also includes buses operating under **All India Tourist Permit and other service regimes**.

Exemptions: The above restrictions shall not apply on BS-VI, CNG, LNG, Electric, emergency/sovereign-duty vehicles and vehicles registered in Delhi.

Note 1: Violation shall attract action as per law.

Note 2: GRAP restrictions shall also apply, as and when enforced.

Sd/-
Transport Department
Government of NCT of Delhi

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0259/26-27





Jharkhand HC quashes state govt decision to cancel JSSC-CGL exam

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, November 6

THE JHARKHAND High Court on Friday quashed the state government's decision to cancel the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination, calling the move that came after a prolonged students' protest as "unfair" and "unjust".

The high court's decision is expected to bring relief to around 2,300 candidates who had already been selected through the examination before the notification for its cancellation was issued.

Noting that an examination could not be cancelled merely because of protests, the court, though, allowed the investigation into the alleged irregularities to continue.



The JSSC-CGL exam was among 22 recruitment exams cancelled by the state government on August 18, after weeks of student protests over alleged irregularities in the recruitment process. FILE

Justice Deepak Roshan delivered the verdict.

Advocate Arpan Ekka, the counsel for the petitioners, told *The Indian Express* that the court had set aside the notification through which the state government had cancelled the appointments made in 2024. "The candidates will continue in their jobs. The investigation into the alleged irregularities will continue," he said.

Observing that the state government had taken the decision to cancel the examination following a stir by candidates and student organisations, the high court said an examination could not be scrapped merely because of protests.

The court also observed that candidates allegedly involved in irregularities could be identified and action could be taken against them individually. The alleged involvement of some candidates does not warrant cancellation of the entire examination and recruitment process, it said.

The court further found that the state government's counter-affidavit did not provide a clear and convincing justification for cancelling the examination. It observed that the decision appeared to have been taken in haste and that the government had failed to establish sufficient grounds for scrapping the examination and appointments.

The JSSC-CGL examination was among the 22 recruitment examinations cancelled by the Jharkhand government through a notification issued on August 18, following weeks of student protests over alleged irregularities in the recruitment process.

Earlier, on August 20, the High Court had stayed the government's decision to cancel appointments made through the 11th to 13th Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) examinations.

The matter of CGL examination, however, was taken up separately as it involved an earlier court proceeding and an FIR registered in connection with alleged irregularities.

Shah seeks BJP hat-trick in Uttarakhand, targets 65 of 70 seats in Assembly elections

Express News Service
Dehradun, November 6

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Friday urged BJP workers to conduct door-to-door outreach in Uttarakhand to ensure the party scores a "hat-trick" in the state by winning 65 of the 70 Assembly seats in polls next year.

"Uttarakhand will be the first milestone in the (country's) journey towards a developed India," Shah said at an event organised here to mark the state's 26th Foundation Day. He also inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for 62 development projects, totalling Rs 1,475.31 crore.

He dismissed Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's "vote bachao" campaign as a "ghuspathiya bachao" rally, and called for the removal of "infiltrators" from the electoral rolls and the country. "The BJP aims to make Uttarakhand a secure and prosperous state, and to transform the 'Devbhoomi' into the cultural capital of the country," Shah said. "When the Congress comes to power, they advocate for a Muslim university."

Highlighting that the BJP won 57 seats in 2017 and 47 in 2022, he called on the party workers to achieve the target of "crossing 65 seats" this time. The "voice of Uttarakhand" should reach Rahul Gandhi, he said. "Rahul ji, your attempts at tourism in the state will not help, as thousands of BJP workers are continuously working to solve problems of locals across the state."



Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami during the President's Colour presentation ceremony for the state police personnel in Dehradun on Friday. PTI

He further claimed the tourism sector in Uttarakhand has witnessed a 380 per cent growth. He said the government is turning focus to move Uttarakhand from a "money-order economy" to an "industrial economy".

Referring to the 2016 surgical strikes, 2019 airstrikes, and 2025 Operation Sindoor, Shah stated that the Modi government has strengthened the security at borders. He also highlighted development projects worth Rs 270 crore being implemented in 51 border villages under the 'Vibrant Village' programme. "We have also worked to ensure that migration stops."

Dhami, who addressed the rally before Shah, said "some individuals" question EVMs and the electoral process when they lose an election. The people of the state will no longer be tricked by the Congress party's misleading narratives, he said. Dhami also questioned the Congress party over "insult" to NSA Ajit Doval, who is from Uttarakhand.

He was referring to Gandhi's remarks before INDIA bloc's anti-CEC rally that PM Modi, Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, CEC Gyanesh Kumar and NSA Ajit Doval are "villains of this story".

Dhami also asked why Congress leaders were not speaking against their ally and SP chief Akhilesh Yadav who allegedly characterised the people of Uttarakhand as "infiltrators".

The CM further claimed that his government has sent over 100 members of the "exam-cheating mafia" to jail and has provided government jobs to more than 35,000 youths, with exams conducted without any instance of cheating or corruption.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



Service Matters

AS HE made his way to the stage to launch the annual Digital Life Certificate campaign for Central government pensioners on Friday, Minister of State Dr Jitendra Singh was reminded of his own service record. Officials had planned for a "live" DLC generation for Singh, who was a government medical college professor before joining politics. Singh waved off the offer, saying he did not want the matter brought up. Then, he joked, it would be brought to light that he had taken voluntary retirement. The minister said he would complete the formalities later.

The Go-ahead

AHEAD OF Diwali, the Centre has given its nod to the Tamil Nadu government to impose stock limits on two key pulses — tur and urad — widely used in dishes such as dosa and sambar. The Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution has conveyed its approval to the state government, it is learnt. The move is aimed at curbing hoarding and checking further rise in prices of these essential commodities during the festive season, when demand typically picks up. The decision is also expected to provide some relief to the state government amid concerns over rising commodity prices.

Diya Dig

UNION LABOUR Minister Mansukh Mandaviya added his diyas to the ongoing campaign by BJP ministers and supporters, stating "*Modi Kahin Nahi Jayenge*". In a video he post on X, Mandaviya wished Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge — whose remark on the Prime Minister triggered the BJP response — a happy Diwali as he stood on a lawn near diyas spelling out "*Modiji Kahin Nahi Jayenge*".

Citizenship by Dec 31 for eligible: Suvendu on CAA

Aranghata: West Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari Friday promised to complete the process of granting citizenship to all eligible applicants under the CAA by December 31. He said around 2.5 lakh applications were pending in Nadia and North 24 Parganas. **PTI**

EXPRESS special

Why Owaisi is gunning for Akhilesh, eyeing alliance with Mayawati

BJP sees AIMIM's outreach to BSP for UP elections as a 'positive signal'

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, November 6

IN THE wake of the Samajwadi Party's rejection of its proposal to join the Opposition INDIA bloc for the upcoming Uttar Pradesh Assembly polls, the Asaduddin Owaisi-led AIMIM has intensified its campaign in the state, especially in the constituencies held by the SP.

The AIMIM is exploring the possibility of an alliance with the Mayawati-led Bahujan Samaj Party or Nagina MP Chandra Shekhar Aazad-led Aazad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) for the February 2027 polls. Kickstarting the AIMIM's campaign from a rally at Matera in Bahraich district on June 14, Owaisi has since addressed eight more public meetings across the state, including in Kairana, Suar, Didarganj, Bhinga, Kanpur Cantonment, Moradabad Rural, Saharanpur Dehat and Najibabad.

At all these rallies, Owaisi has kept his guns trained on SP president Akhilesh Yadav, accusing him of taking Muslims for granted. His next rally is scheduled in Meerut city on November 14. Other AIMIM leaders including its UP chief Shaukat Ali, have separately addressed public meetings in Laharpur, Nizamabad, Phoolpur Pawai and Kaiserganj in recent weeks.

All these 14 Muslim-dominated seats were bagged by the SP in the 2022 Assembly polls when the party had won 111 of the state's 403 seats as against the BJP's 255. Nine of the 14 SP MLAs are Muslims. The SP's junior ally in UP, Congress, had then contested the polls separately, winning just two seats.



AIMIM president Asaduddin Owaisi kickstarted poll campaign from a rally at Matera in Bahraich district on June 14. X/@AIMIMOFFICIAL

Owaisi has also deployed party MLA from Telangana's Nampally, Majid Hussain, in UP for canvassing. For the 2027 polls, the AIMIM has announced candidates in three seats — Shaukat Ali from Matera, Engineer Irfan from Kairana (Shamli district), and Daddan Khan from Bhinga (Shrawasti district).

Ally? 'BSP or ASP (KR)'

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Shaukat Ali said the party has been preparing to contest 100 seats in the UP polls. "We want an alliance with the BSP to make a social coalition of 'Bhim (Dalits) and Meem (Muslims)'. This is the natural alliance. AIMIM has approached BSP, and a response is awaited."

Dalits and Muslims account for 21% and 19% of UP's population, respectively. There are 84 Assembly seats reserved for the Scheduled Castes across the state, with Muslims holding significant influence in the western and eastern regions.

Accusing both the SP and the BJP of "exploiting" the Muslim community for political gains, Ali said: "The SP shows Muslims fear of BJP to get their votes. And BJP shows fear of Muslims to get votes of Hindus."

Sources in the AIMIM said the party was also looking for an alignment with the Aazad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram).

In the 2025 Bihar polls, the AIMIM had tied up with the ASP (KR) and Swami Prasad Maurya's Apni Janata Party. The AIMIM won 5 of 28 seats it contested, securing 15.24% votes in these seats. In the 2022 UP polls, the AIMIM had formed a "third front", called Bhagidari Parivartan Morcha, along with the Jan Adhikar Party led by ex-minister Babu Singh Kushwaha and the Bhartiya Mukti Morcha headed by Waman Meshram. This coalition drew a blank, with the AIMIM securing just 2% votes.

AIMIM vs SP

On AIMIM focusing its canvassing in SP-held seats, Shaukat Ali said: "The Muslim-dominated seats are our turf but SP contests there. We wanted an alliance with SP but its leaders declined our proposal."

The ruling BJP is seeing the AIMIM's outreach to the BSP for an alliance as a "positive signal". "If AIMIM and BSP forge an alliance, Muslim votes may split. In that case, SP will become weaker, putting the BJP-led NDA in a more comfortable position," said a senior UP BJP leader.

Addressing a public meeting at Kairana in Shamli district on October 26, Owaisi said Akhilesh should rename his party the "Samajwadi Yadav Parivar", accusing him of picking "safe seats" dominated by Muslims-Yadavs for his family members. The AIMIM chief said Muslims were once elected as the MPs from the Azamgarh, Badaun and Firozabad Lok Sabha seats, but Akhilesh's family members are MPs from there now. "Akhilesh and his Yadav family want Abdul (Muslim voter) to gift the MP and MLA seats to their children," he claimed.

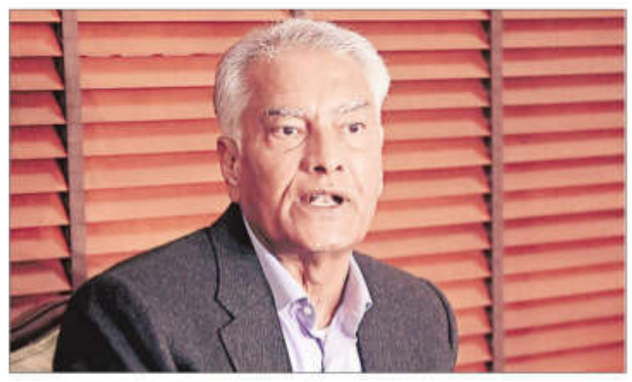
The AIMIM chief has also targeted Akhilesh over the 2013 Muzaffarnagar riots when he was the chief minister, alleging that the SP supremo and his 47 Muslim MLAs had failed to prevent the violence and protect Muslims. He alleged that Akhilesh was then attending an event featuring the Bollywood stars in his ancestral village Saifai.

"Those who are claiming that Bhaiyya (Akhilesh)'s government is coming soon...I am telling them that the next government will be of Abdul. Abdul will become leader, MLA and raise voices of the poor and oppressed in the UP Assembly," he said.

At another rally held at Suar in Rampur — jailed SP heavyweight Azam Khan's stronghold — on October 18, Owaisi expressed concern over Azam's plight, claiming that "*Bhaiyya*" (Akhilesh) would stage a road blockade in Lucknow if a Yadav of Saifai is sent to jail for six months because "*mera Yadav, Yadav hai*". "And if Abdul is in jail, *Bhaiyya* will ask him not to worry and vote for him after release," he charged.

'Punjab on edge, BJP-Akali approach for Hindu-Sikh amity is need of the hour'

WITH THE BJP weighing its alliance options for the Punjab Assembly elections due in February 2027, senior party leader **Sunil Jakhar**, 72, says any such alignment must be guided by the state's interests. In an interview with **Manraj Grewal Sharma**, Jakhar, the former state BJP chief, warns that the weakening of the panthic establishment has created space for radical elements, accusing the AAP government of presiding over the criminalisation of politics. Excerpts:



EXPRESS interview | SUNIL JAKHAR, SENIOR BJP LEADER

How far have BJP's alliance talks with Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) progressed?

Nothing is done till it is done. The decision will be taken at the highest level of the party. But the fundamental consideration has to be what is in Punjab's interest.

Punjab is once again witnessing attempts to revive sentiments reminiscent of the dark days of terrorism. Certain political establishments are trying to divide society and shatter communal amity. Punjab's ethos does not permit this. Any decision must be guided by the need to preserve peace and harmony.

Have you, other state BJP leaders conveyed to party's high command that an alliance would benefit it?

I have been a strong votary of this from day one, even before the 2024 Lok Sabha polls. Punjab's communal amity is fundamental to it. As the Gurus taught us, *Manas ki jaat sabhe eke pehchanbo*. Every community must feel secure.

The Sikh community, being in majority in the state, must feel that its interests, anxieties and aspirations are being addressed. Punjab needs a credible panthic establishment that can articulate Sikh concerns. It acts as a safety valve. When that establishment weakens, radical elements occupy the space.

How do you explain the rise of Akali Dal (Waris Punjab De)?

The traditional institutions have lost credibility. When the SGPC president goes to submit a memorandum and the SDM does not even step out of his office, it tells you how far things have deteriorated. Earlier, such representatives would be received with dignity by the Chief Minister or Chief Secretary.

When people lose faith in mainstream institutions, they turn to those who claim to represent their anxieties. Punjab is walking a very thin line. The BJP-Akali alliance in 1997-98 was not merely an electoral arrangement. It was a conscious effort to preserve Hindu-Sikh amity at a time when forces were trying to divide society. A similar broad-minded approach is required today.

Is BJP's renewed focus on the 1984 anti-Sikh violence reopening old wounds?

The point is not to reopen wounds but to remind people why Punjab must never return to those days. The violence of 1984 hurt the entire state. Subsequently, massacres took place in Punjab, and thousands were killed, many of them Hindus. Punjab's basic ethos was hurt.

We must look beyond political considerations and freebies. Punjab will remain long after all of us are gone. Its future cannot be sacrificed for petty political interests. What worries me is the similarity between the political circumstances then and now. The militancy years followed a tussle between two Congress leaders, one the CM and the other the home minister. That political rivalry cost Punjab dearly. Today, we see similar clashes of authority and political one-upmanship. Can we trust this leadership not to sacrifice Punjab to settle scores?

Why do you accuse the AAP and the Congress of encouraging radicalism?

There is a competition to establish who is more radical. Congress leaders are talking about only one issue, while ignoring the larger concerns of Punjab. If they are so committed to that ideology, why don't they make that person (Waris Punjab De chief Amritpal Singh) their CM face? I am against the ideology, not an individual. Anyone talking about secessionist movements and breaking India cannot be defended on grounds of sentiment. India first, Punjab first.

The AAP government has played a large role in creating the circumstances in which these elements have risen. The Congress is following suit. Neither is doing Punjab any good.

Is the AAP government under pressure on the ground? Can it sustain its welfare guarantees?

This does not even require much application of mind. The Congress has already said the freebies will continue. But where is the money?... These promises cannot be sustained indefinitely through loans...

Will you contest Assembly polls? Do you see yourself as a CM face of your party?

I have no illusions that I am the remedy for Punjab. Sunil is not important. Peace in Punjab is important. Punjab needs someone who can rise above petty politics and take everybody along. I have always believed Captain Amarinder Singh had that ability.

As for me, I am part of an organisation and will abide by the party's decision. There are enough people with clarity of thought and intent who can take care of Punjab. Punjab needs handholding now. It deserves far better than what is being offered to it. Bringing the state back on track will be a long haul, but it has to begin somewhere. The time is now.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

National Conference dissident MLAs meet Farooq Abdullah, party chief rules out split

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, November 6

AT LEAST 10 National Conference MLAs who have been part of a dissident group met with party president Farooq Abdullah at his Gupkar Road residence Friday.

Since the Cabinet reshuffle earlier this month, some party MLAs have raised concerns about the lack of Cabinet representation and the position of Chief Minister Omar Abdullah's adviser, Nasir Aslam Wani, in the government.

After the two-hour meeting, Farooq and Omar stepped out along with all the dissident MLAs. "We have spoken; they have raised some concerns and they are genuine. We have heard them all and considered the concerns they raised. We will address some of them now and some in due course," said Farooq, the party president.



J&K National Conference chief Farooq Abdullah addresses the media in Srinagar on Friday. PTI

The former J&K CM also dismissed concerns of internal divisions. "The news being spread about our party members being scattered is baseless. We are together as a party and the people who think that this party can be broken. This has not happened before and it will not happen in the future," Farooq said.

The NC president underscored that the party's "struggle for restoration of statehood and Article 370 and 35A would continue. God willing, we will achieve this."

The Omar Cabinet has room for only nine members, including the CM. While alliance partner Congress has chosen to stay out of the Cabinet, J&K remains a Union Territory and the NC has struggled to accommodate members from its large pool of 41 elected leaders.

The leaders who met Farooq include Abdul Majeed Larmi, who first expressed discontent over the Cabinet expansion and his exclusion; Tangmarg MLA Farooq Shah; senior party leader and Eidgah MLA Mubarak Gul; former MP and Pampore MLA Hasnain Masoodi; Gurez legislator Nazir Gurezi; Poonch MLA Aijaz Jan; Budhal MLA Javed Iqbal Choudhary; Khan Sahib MLA Saifuddin Bhat; Lolab MLA Qaisar Jamsheed Lone; Karnah MLA Javed Mirchal; Uri MLA Sajjad Shafi; Rajpora MLA Ghulam Mohiddin Mir; and Bijbehara MLA Bashir Veeri.

After the meeting, Gurezi said, "We always bring our issues to the party leadership. A few days ago, we got together for a discussion and over social media it was hyped and it was said that a separate faction was going to split from the NC. No separate faction or party has emerged."

Acknowledging there were some issues that had been put forth and discussed with the Abdullahs, Gurezi said, "They have given us their assurance that whether it is political issues or others, some will be resolved immediately, and some others will be addressed gradually."

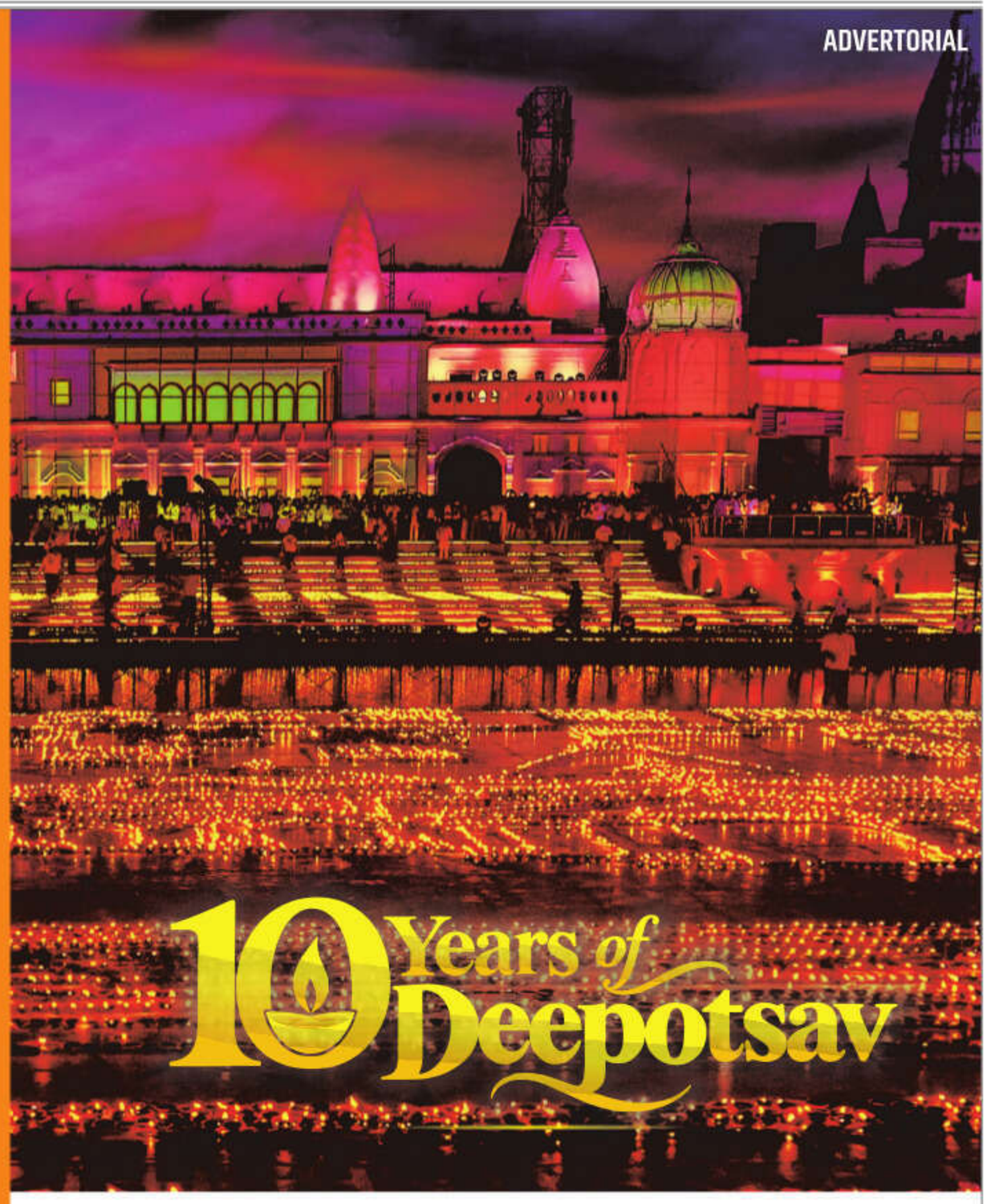
Veeri said the legislators held a "comprehensive discussion with Dr Abdullah" and expressed hope that all matters of concern would be resolved soon. "This is in the best interest of the party and the people of J&K," he said.

ADVERTORIAL

Ayodhya's Deepotsav 2026

A DIVINE SPECTACLE OF LIGHT, HERITAGE & TECHNOLOGY

Ayodhya's Deepotsav-2026 is set to unfold in a spectacular new avatar, bringing together faith, tradition and cutting-edge technology. The grand saga of Shri Ram's return to Ayodhya will come alive through an enthralling performance by over 100 artists, complemented by immersive 3D visuals, projection mapping with more than 30 lakh diyas illuminating the sacred city and a spectacular laser show. A floating stage at Ram Ki Paidi and mobile-based Augmented Reality (AR) experiences will add to the festivities. The five-day celebration aims to reconnect the younger generation with India's rich cultural heritage while positioning Ayodhya as a premier destination on the global tourism map.



Ayodhya to Relive Shri Ram's Grand Return in a 28-Minute Spectacle

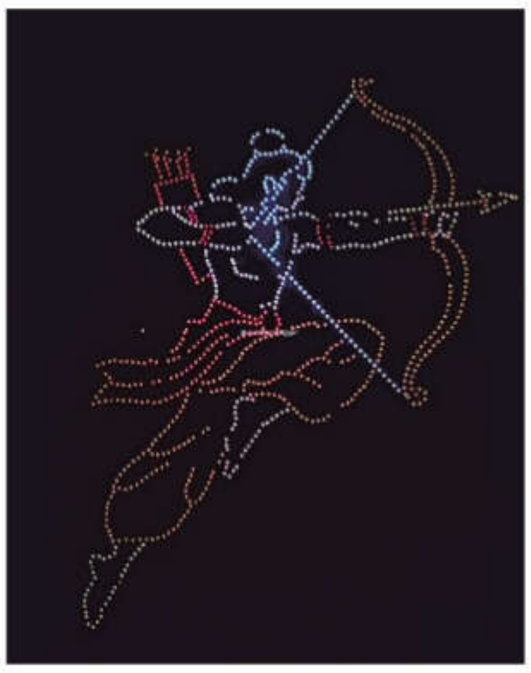
- **100+ Artists, One Epic Ramayana:** Folk and classical performers bring the Ramayana alive through captivating dance, music, theatre and voice-overs.
- **28 Minutes of Visual Grandeur:** A spectacular fusion of projection mapping, laser technology, aerial acts and live performances creates an immersive experience.



- **20-Minute Ramayana Extravaganza:** Stunning projections recreate iconic episodes from the Ramayana, culminating in Shri Ram's triumphant return to Ayodhya.
- **8-Minute Laser & Light Spectacle:** Mesmerising lights, music and powerful voice-overs recreate the magic of Diwali and Shri Ram's homecoming.
- **Ram Ki Paidi Transforms into a Floating Theatre:** A magnificent water-based stage, cinematic 2D-3D visuals, dynamic props and aerial performances add a spectacular new dimension to Deepotsav.

Five Days of Spectacle: A Fusion of Heritage and Innovation

- **Five Days of Festive Spectacle (Nov 5-9):** A grand multimedia projection and laser show will illuminate Ayodhya with a captivating visual experience.
- **November 7: Special Showcase:** The main presentation will be held before Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, followed by three public shows.
- **November 8: Four Grand Shows:** Four spectacular presentations will add to the festive fervour of Diwali.
- **November 9: Drone Show Finale:** An exclusive grand drone show for Ayodhya residents will bring the five-day celebrations to a spectacular close.



Ramayana Goes Digital

Deepotsav Reimagianed for Gen Z



- **Five Ramayana Episodes in 3D:** Five iconic moments from Shri Ram's life will come alive on visitors' mobile screens through stunning 3D visuals.
- **AR Brings Ramayana to Life:** Augmented Reality will superimpose captivating Ramayana scenes onto visitors' real-world surroundings.
- **Dedicated Mobile App:** A specially designed iOS and Android app will unlock this unique digital experience.
- **Geo-Fenced Digital Experience:** The feature will be activated exclusively within the designated Ram Ki Paidi area.
- **Capture, Share & Celebrate:** Visitors can capture immersive 3D moments and share their digital Deepotsav experience across social media.

Tradition Meets Technology: Deepotsav Woos Gen Z and Global Tourists

- **Tradition Meets Technology:** Earthen lamps, dazzling lights, lasers and digital effects unite to create a breathtaking festive spectacle.
- **A Fresh Spectacle Every Year:** New music, animations and creative storytelling bring a vibrant, contemporary touch to Deepotsav.
- **Ramayana Goes Digital:** 3D visuals, Augmented Reality (AR) and projection mapping make the epic come alive for Gen Z.
- **Ayodhya on the Global Tourism Map:** A unique fusion of faith, heritage and cutting-edge technology promises an unforgettable experience for visitors from across the world.

A Spectacular Floating Stage to Transform Ram Ki Paidi

- **A Grand Stage on Water:** A magnificent floating stage at Ram Ki Paidi will be the showstopper of Deepotsav.
- **100+ Artists, One Epic Spectacle:** Folk and classical performers will bring the Ramayana alive through mesmerising acts.
- **Live Action, Dynamic Visuals:** Moving props, innovative stagecraft and live performances will create an immersive theatrical experience.
- **World-Class Viewing Experience:** Advanced sound systems and outdoor LED walls will offer spectacular viewing for thousands.
- **Safety First, Always:** Stringent safety measures will ensure secure stage construction, technical installations and seamless event management.





SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



CONSTABLE NARAYAN SINGH 86 BN BSF 25.08.1970 – 07.11.1995

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Narayan Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Srinagar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CONSTABLE PRAKASH CHANDRA SHIAL 94 BN BSF 21.05.1987 – 07.11.2023

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Prakash Chandra Shial on his Balidan Diwas. On 06th Nov 2023, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast, triggered by Naxals in area of COB Bande, Chhattisgarh and later succumbed to his injuries at Shree Narayana hospital, Raipur on 07th Nov 2023.



HC VIJAYANAND 161 BN BSF 07.10.1956 – 07.11.1997



CT/DVR V S MISHRA 161 BN BSF 06.04.1962 – 07.11.1997



CT/DVR FAQUIRDDIN KHAN 161 BN BSF 12.02.1969 – 07.11.1997



CT BHOOP SINGH 161 BN BSF 01.01.1974 – 07.11.1997



CT BABU GEORGE 161 BN BSF 28.05.1970 – 07.11.1997



CT SHEIK MASTAN BASA 161 BN BSF 24.11.1969 – 07.11.1997



CT BHIM SINGH 161 BN BSF 20.12.1970 – 07.11.1997

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constable Vijayanand, Constables/Drivers V S Mishra, Faquirddin Khan and Constables Bhoop Singh, Babu George, Sheik Mastan Basa, Bhim Singh on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Rashiyabari area, Tripura and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Naik Radio Operator Birbal Pater 2 Signal BN 1-8-1966 To 7-11-1994

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Naik Radio Operator Birbal Pater of 2 Signal Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a fierce encounter with insurgents during an operation in Imphal, Manipur, on 7 November 1994. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Juneja Haji 134 BN 1-5-1971 To 7-11-2001

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Juneja Haji of 134 Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a fierce encounter with Maoists during an operation at dist. Lohardaga, Jharkhand, on 7 November 2001. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

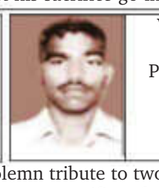


Veer Balidani Head Constable Sadan Basumatary 26 Bn 3-12-1969 To 7-11-2010

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Sadan Basumatary of 26 Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in an IED blast while valiantly in dist. Bokaro, Jharkhand, on 7 November 2010. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Mahesh Kumar Barhadiya 130 Bn 12-1-1976 To 7-11-2013



Veer Balidani Constable Pradeep Ghana 130 Bn 6-7-1988 To 7-11-2013

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to two valiant troopers of 130 Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining fatal injuries in a cowardly attack by a militant in dist. Pulwama, Jammu & Kashmir, on 7 November 2013. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Kamta Prasad 151 Bn 10-8-1989 To 7-11-2019

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Kamta Prasad of 151 Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering an attack by Maoists in Pamed, dist. Bijapur, Chhattisgarh, on 6 November 2019. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

11-yr-old girl raped, killed in UP's Barabanki

Barabanki: An 11-year-old girl was allegedly abducted, raped and murdered in Barabanki district of Uttar Pradesh. Her body was recovered from a well on Friday, police said. The accused, Uttam Kumar Singh, was nabbed after an encounter in which he received a gunshot wound, SP Ravina Tyagi said. PTI

NORTHERN RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Ref : Tender Notice No. 16/2026-2027 dated 27.05.2026 Sr. no. 06

(i). Tender No. 15235293Á due on 10.11.2026

In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 10.11.2026 to 01.12.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3904/26

म.प्र. राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम मर्या.

पर्यटन भवन, भदभदा रोड, भोपाल-462003

फोन : +91-755-4027100, 2774340, 42, Web. : www.mpstdc.com

क्रमांक 530/यांत्रिकी/पविनि/26 दिनांक : 06.11.2026

NIT/SYSTEM No. 368/2026_STDC_548362_1

Bids are invited from reputed Architects/Architectural firms for **"RFP for architectural consultancy services for the action plan and outline related to the development of Shri Ramchandra path Gaman at MP 4th Call"**

Terms and Conditions can be downloaded from website **https://mptenders.gov.in.** For any other information contact Mr. Amit Kumar Tiwari (Executive Engineer) Rewa Division, Mob. No. 9039435029 or e-mail at **amitkumarlivelong@gmail.com** Last date and time for Online Tender Purchase is **19.11.2026 Time 05:00 PM**

M.P. Madhyam/129015/2026 **EXECUTIVE ENGINEER**

SIKKA PORTS & TERMINALS LIMITED

Registered Office: Admin Building, MTF Area, Village Sikka, Taluka & District Jamnagar - 361140, Gujarat, India.
Phone : 022-35557700 • Email: debenture.investors@sptl.co.in • Website: www.sptl.co.in
CIN: U45102GJ1997PLC031906

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER 2026

(Rs. in crore, except per share data and ratios)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30 Sept' 26 Unaudited	Quarter Ended 30 Sept' 25 Unaudited	Year Ended 31 Mar' 26 Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	1,478.42	1,358.04	5,331.12
2	Net Profit before Exceptional Item and Tax	563.90	985.55	1,360.15
3	Net Profit before Tax (after Exceptional Item)	563.90	3,261.85	6,774.45
4	Net Profit after Tax	343.11	2,897.41	5,734.22
5	Total Comprehensive Income/ (Loss) [Comprising Profit (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income/ (Loss) (OCI) (after tax)]	(540.64)	2,298.12	6,145.29
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	2,475.00	2,475.00	2,475.00
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)			29,944.92
8	Securities Premium Account	17,967.47	17,967.47	17,967.47
9	Net worth	31,229.17	27,404.96	29,846.23
10	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	12,635.21	23,995.30	19,608.76
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	47.00	47.00	47.00
12	Outstanding Non-Cumulative Optionally Convertible Preference Shares	-	3,500.00	-
13	Debt Equity Ratio	0.39	0.81	0.60
14	Earnings per Equity Share for the period/ year of face value of Re. 1 each :- - Basic and Diluted (in Rupees) After Exceptional Item	0.14	1.17	2.32
	- Basic and Diluted (in Rupees) Before Exceptional Item	0.14	0.25	0.13
15	Capital Redemption Reserve	3,500.00	-	3,500.00
16	Debenture Redemption Reserve	400.00	1,316.80	1,316.80
17	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	2.96	3.18	0.56
18	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	3.33	3.36	1.82

Notes:

1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended 30th September 2026 filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 52 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended 30th September 2026 are available on the website of BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and can be accessed on the Company's website (www.sptl.co.in).

2 For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and can be accessed on the Company's website (www.sptl.co.in).

3 The Audit Committee has reviewed, and the Board of Directors has approved the above results and its release at their respective meetings held on 6th November 2026. The statutory auditors of the Company have carried out a Limited Review of the aforesaid results.

For Sikka Ports & Terminals Limited
Sd/-
Sanjeev Dandekar
Chairman
DIN : 00022797

Place: Mumbai
Date : 6th November 2026

SC settles interstate energy dispute; Himachal to get 11,973 MU electricity arrears

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, November 6

BRINGING THE curtain down on a decades-old interstate energy dispute over the payment of dues arising from Bhakra Beas Management Board (BBMB) projects since 1966, the Supreme Court Friday directed Punjab and Haryana to give Himachal Pradesh 11,973 million units (MU) of electricity arrears in the next 20 years.

A bench comprising CJI Surya Kant, Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana accepted the Centre's cashless proposal to settle the liability in energy arrears in favour of Himachal Pradesh. It also rejected the objections raised by Punjab.

"The energy arrears due to the plaintiff-state, as computed by the Union of India, shall be taken at 13,066 MU. The same shall be supplied by the states of Punjab and Haryana at the rate of 653 MU per annum over 20 lean seasons, being the period from October to March, in the inter se ratio of 58:42 for the Bhakra-Nangal Project and 60:40 for the Beas Projects," the bench said. It said Himachal Pradesh would pay the charges determined by the Bhakra Beas Management Board for the year in which each tranche of energy is received.

The bench said Himachal Pradesh's liability toward its 7.19% share of the capital cost of the Bhakra-Nangal and Beas Projects, representing the un-reimbursed share of loan servicing undertaken by Punjab and Haryana since 1966-67, would be assessed at Rs 420.77 crore, comprising Rs 249.23 crore and Rs 171.55 crore attributable to Punjab and Haryana respectively.

It also said the capital-cost liability would be adjusted against a corresponding portion of the energy arrears due to Himachal Pradesh. For this purpose, the energy shall be valued at the rate of Rs 3.85 per unit, resulting in an adjustment of approximately 1,093 MU against the capital-cost liability.

"Upon giving effect to the aforesaid adjustment, the balance energy arrears payable to the Plaintiff-State shall stand at approximately 11,973 MU. This balance shall be supplied by Punjab and Haryana at the rate of approximately 598 MU per annum over 20 lean seasons..." the top court held.

The bench clarified that the settlement shall be implemented on a cashless basis, with the capital-cost liability being adjusted against the energy arrears in the manner set out above, and with the remaining energy being supplied in accordance with the said schedule.

It also took note of non-compliance with a decree by Punjab and Haryana issued by the SC in 2011. "As a matter of abundant concern, we must express in no uncertain terms to all the concerned stakeholders that the directions issued by this court are binding and are required to be acted upon without reservation. The expectation of a decree, having remained pending for several decades, cannot be rendered fruitless by reason of the unwillingness or recalcitrance of a judgment debtor," the top court stated.

It also appreciated the efforts of Attorney General R Venkataramani for facilitating attempts at mediation between the parties and formulating a framework to bring this long-standing dispute to a conclusion.

"It is particularly unfortunate that a dispute which has remained pending for several decades continues to be prolonged, requiring further judicial time and attention... We trust that all concerned parties will extend their cooperation and ensure that the directions issued by this court are implemented in their true letter and spirit," the bench underscored.

Bengaluru cabbie held for killing wife, six members of her family

Atiya Firdos
Bengaluru, November 6

A 52-YEAR-OLD cab driver from Bengaluru has been arrested for allegedly murdering his wife and six members of her family over 15-20 days and dumping their bodies at multiple locations in Karnataka, police said Friday.

Police are probing possible motives, including property disputes, marital discord and the accused's suspicion about his wife's character.

The accused, identified as Indushekar alias Shekhar, a resident of Rajajinagar, allegedly lured his wife's family members to his house individually before killing them. The victims were identified as his wife Sunitha (40), her mother Roopavati (65), her brothers Shivakumar (30) and Shankar (44), their wives Divya (30) and Nalini (29), and Shivakumar's seven-year-old son Puneeth.

Police have recovered only Puneeth's body so far — near the foothills of Nandi Hills in Chikkaballapur district — and are searching for the remaining six. Investigators said the accused has given contradictory statements about the locations where he allegedly dumped the bodies.

Bengaluru Police Commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh told reporters on Friday that the case came to light after the mother of one of the victims lodged a missing-person complaint at Srirampura police station on November 3. Following this, police began questioning the accused.

"Considering the extent of the crime, we suspect there could be more to the killings. We are investigating all the angles. The accused's statements about the locations, circumstances and manner of the murders are being verified and cannot be treated as established facts at this stage..." Singh said.

Searches are continuing at several locations based on the accused's statements and information provided by his 13-year-old nephew, the son of victims Shankar and Nalini. The boy was found in the accused's car and reportedly told investigators that he had accompanied his uncle and witnessed him disposing of bodies stuffed in gunny bags at isolated locations. He recalled seeing the accused dump four such bags.

Investigators said the accused intended to kill the boy as well, but the minor was rescued after police traced the accused on Wednesday night. Police are also questioning the accused's 17-year-old daughter.

A murder case was registered at Rajajinagar police station on Thursday, and Shekhar has been taken into custody. Police have also seized the car used to transport the bodies.

KGMU sets up disciplinary panel after claims of 'forced conversion'

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, November 6

LUCKNOW'S KING George's Medical University (KGMU) has set up a six-member disciplinary committee, headed by the Vice-Chancellor, to examine a police report alleging that some university employees were harassed and, in some cases, pressured by colleagues and senior staff to convert.

KGMU spokesperson Dr KK Singh said the Uttar Pradesh Police's Special Task Force's report was tabled during the executive council meeting, where it was examined along with representations submitted by others. After detailed deliberations, the council decided to constitute the committee to examine the allegations and submit its findings.

The committee will include the university registrar as member-secretary. The remaining four members will be nominated, including two retired senior government officials, with preference given to former Indian Police Service (IPS) officers.

The STF had launched an inquiry following claims about alleged religious conversion and "love jihad" that emerged last year. The Lucknow Police had in January arrested Rameezuddin alias Rameez Malik, a junior resident in the university's Department of Pathology, and a medical intern in two separate cases.

Rameezuddin, who was arrested in Lucknow on January 9, faces allegations of sexually exploiting and trying to convert two women. The intern faces allegations of sexually exploiting a nursing student on the false promise of marriage.

According to the report, the STF inquiry was initiated following a complaint by a man who identified himself as president of the "UP Youth Association" and sought a probe into alleged religious conversions and what he described as "love jihad" cases on the university campus.

In its inquiry report, submitted to the state government in August, the STF is learnt to have flagged alleged instances of misconduct, including physical and mental harassment of female junior residents, nursing staff and a contractual employee by male nursing staff, doctors and a head of department belonging to the minority community.

The report has learnt to have identified alleged instances of harassment across four departments of KGMU.

CENTRUM HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

peoplehome

A Subsidiary of Whoever Services Private Limited

All loans are processed and sanctioned by Centrum Housing Finance Limited ("CHFL")

Registered Office :
Unit No.301, Third Floor, Harbhajan Commercial Premises Co-operative Society Ltd., CST Road, Opp. BPCL Petrol Pump, Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai - 400098.
CIN: U65922MH2016PLC273826

NOTICE OF SALE THROUGH PRIVATE TREATY

Pursuant to taking possession of the secured asset mentioned hereunder by the Authorized Officer of Centrum Housing Finance Limited. under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 for the recovery of amount due from borrower/s, offers are invited by the undersigned in sealed covers for purchase of immovable property, as described hereunder, which is in the physical possession, on 'As Is Where Is Basis', 'As Is What Is Basis', Particulars of which are given below:-

Sr. No.	Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower (s)/ Guarantor(s) / Loan Account No/ Branch	Total Outstanding as on date	Description of the Immovable property	Reserve Price (RP)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) 10%
1	**Raj Kumar (Borrower) Raj Kumari (Co-Borrower) MTCAG23014423**	**Rs. 914898/- (Rupees Nine lakh Fourteen Thousand Eight Hundred Ninety Eight Only) as on 11-Apr-2025.**	In the rights, piece and parcel of immovable property bearing House No. 67/423, adm. 54.74 sqmts., Shanti Nagar (Sati Nagar), Asfabad, Distt.- Firozabad-283203, Uttar Pradesh. **Boundaries:-** East :- H/o Omprakash West :- 16' wide Road North :-H/o Mahendra singh South :- H/o Chhaviram	**Rs. 6,00,000/- (Rupees Six lakhs Only)**	**Rs.60,000/- (Rupees Sixty thousand Only)**

STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002

1.The Auction is being held on **"AS IS WHERE IS" AND "AS IS WHAT IS"** basis 2. The detailed terms and conditions of the auction sale are incorporated in the prescribed tender form, available at the above mentioned Branch office **3.** Date of Opening of the Bid/Offer Auction Date for Property is **25/11/2026** at the above mentioned Branch Office address at **11:00 AM. to 2:00 PM** by the Authorised Officer. **4.** The purchaser shall bear the applicable stamp duties/additional stamp duty/transfer charges, fee etc. and also all the statutory dues, taxes, rates assessment, Govt & Semi Govt. taxes, TDS and other charges, fees etc. in respect of the auctioned property. The possession of the Mortgage Property mentioned above is with the CHFL, who will hand over peaceful possession to the successful bidder on compliance of above. The intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the Encumbrances Title of property & also inspect & satisfy themselves. **5.** All other expenses for getting the properties transferred on their name and statutory dues, if any shall be borne by the successful purchaser. 6. The Highest bidder shall be subject to approval of Centrum Housing Finance Limited. Authorised Officer shall Reserve the right to accept all any of the offer /Bid so received without assign any reason whatsoever. His decision shall be final and binding. **7.**The Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) are hereby given **15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002** to pay the sum mentioned as above before the date of Auction failing which the immovable property will be auctioned and balance, if any, will be recovered with interest and costs. If the Borrower pays the amount due to Centrum Housing Finance Limited, in full, before the date of sale, auction is liable to be set aside. **For further details, contact the Authorised Officer, at the above mentioned Office address Contact Person - Varun Kumar Shukla-9958641200**

Place : FIROZABAD / Date : 07.11.2026 **Sd/-, Authorised Officer For Centrum Housing**

समाहरणालय, बाँका

(मद्य निषेध शाखा)

वाहन नीलामी हेतु अति अल्पकालीन आम सूचना

(बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं अधिनियम 2016 एवं संशोधित अधिनियम 2018 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत् राजसात् किये गये वाहनों की अल्पकालीन सार्वजनिक नीलामी सूचना)

एतद् द्वारा सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बाँका जिलान्तर्गत विभिन्न थाना काण्डों/उत्पाद वादों में राजसात किये गये वाहनों को बिहार मद्य निशेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत् विभिन्न अधिहरण वादों में अधिहरण न्यायालय अनुमंडल दण्डाधिकारी, बाँका, भूमि सुधार उपसमाहर्त्ता, बाँका, अपर समाहर्त्ता–सह–मद्यनिषेध दण्डाधिकारी, बाँका, जिला प्रंचायती राज पदाधिकारी–सह–मद्यनिशेध दण्डाधिकारी, बाँका एवं जिला परिवहन पदाधिकारी–सह–मद्यनिशेध दण्डाधिकारी, बाँका द्वारा राजसात् किये वाहनो कि सार्वजनिक नीलामी जो जहाँ है जैसे है के रुप में **11.00 बजे पूर्वाह्न में अधीक्षक मद्यनिशेध, महेशाडीह, बाँका के कार्यालय वेश्म में निम्न प्रकार से की जायेगी।**

वाहन नीलामी की तिथिनये SOP (विभागीय पत्रांक–809, दिनांक–03.02.2026) के आधार पर।		आवेदन प्राप्त की अंतिम तिथि	आवेदन प्राप्त करने का स्थान
दसवीं नीलामी की तिथि	25.11.2026	23.11.2026	कार्यालय अधीक्षक मद्यनिषेध बाँका
दसवीं नीलामी से शेष बचे वाहनों की ग्यारहवीं नीलामी की तिथि	12.12.2026	10.12.2026	
ग्यारहवीं नीलामी से शेष बचे वाहनों की बारहवीं नीलामी की तिथि	22.12.2026	19.12.2026	

नोटः– (1) विभागीय पत्रांक–809, दिनांक–03.02.2026 के आलोक में तीन बार नीलामी होने के पश्चात शेष बचे वाहनों की नीलामी "AS IS WHERE IS BASIS" पर किया जायेगा एवं AS IS WHERE IS BASIS पर प्रत्येक नीलामी में वाहनों के मूल्य को 10% कम करते हुए तब तक नीलामी की जायेगी, जब तक वाहन नीलाम न हो जाये।

(2) निम्नांकित वाहन के स्वामियों को भी सूचित किया जाता है कि यदि वे निम्नांकित वाहनों के लिये अपील/रिवीजन/प्रपत्र IV दायर किये हों तो इसकी सूचना साक्ष्य सहित नीलामी की तिथि के पूर्व नीलामी समिति को उपलब्ध करा देंगे।

(3) उक्त वाहन से संबंधित वाहन स्वामी यदि इच्छुक हैं तो नीलामी में भाग ले सकते हैं।

क्र0 सं0	न्यायालय, बांका का ज्ञापांक/दिनांक	उत्पाद थाना/थाना नाम/कांड सं0	वाहन का प्रकार	पंजीयन सं0/चेचिस सं0/इंजन सं0	MVI द्वारा मूल्यांकित राशि (रूपया में)	SOP के आलोक में नौवीं नीलामी की राशि	SOP के आलोक में दसवीं नीलामी की राशि	अग्रधन की राशि (20%)	SOP के आलोक में ग्यारहवीं नीलामी की राशि	अग्रधन की राशि (20%)	SOP के आलोक में बारहवीं नीलामी की राशि	अग्रधन की राशि (20%)	वाहन स्वामी का नाम व पता	वाहन निर्माण का वर्श (मॉडल)	वाहन की भौतिक उपस्थिति	नीलामी समय बीमाकृत मूल्य (वाहन की बीमाकृत मूल्य)	वाहन जहाँ पर है
1	2	3	4	5	6		8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
01	15/R 11.09.24	धनकुण्ड 131/23	कार	DL12CA1049 CHE-MA1YA2 KJNA2K16689 ENG-KJA4K35027	175000	74403	66963	13393	60267	12054	54241	10849	नाम–सतीष पे0–रतन सिह, सा0–जनता बिहार 3/12 मकन्दपुर (EXTNPARTI) थाना दो जिला–दिल्ली, पिन नं0–110042	2010			धनकुण्ड

नीलामी की विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से भी प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

समाहर्त्ता, बाँका

PR- 015054 (Excise) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Office of the Executive Engineer
P.W.D. (Maintenance) Division No. 2 Bhopal
Tender Notice

NIT 22 of 2026-27 **Bhopal, Date 04/11/2026**

Online Tender for mentioned below are being invited. The Tender have been uploaded on the e-Procurement system of Public Works Department on the Portal **www.mptenders.gov.in** Tender details are as below:-

S. No	Tender No.	Name of work	Call No.	Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. in Lack)
1	2	3	4	5
1	2025_PWDRB_547961_1	Construction of Helipad Ground Road, Bhopal Length-0.70 K.M (Two lane), Renewal and Improvement of Habibganj to Barkheda Church Road, (two lane/four lane) Bhopal For Army Day Parade (Length=5.25K.M.) and Sawantika Petrol Pump to Govindpura Haat Bazar Road, Bhopal Length-1.00 K.M (Two lane)	First	423.60
2	2025_PWDRB_547963_1	Renewal and Improvment of road from Savantika petrol pump to Hema School Length-1.30Km, Anna Nagar to DRM (Kasturba Hospital) Road, (Four lane/ two lane) Bhopal For Army Day Parade Length= 1.8K.M. and Improvement and Furnishing of Mahatma Gandhi Junction to Raisen Road, (Four lane) Bhopal For Army Day Parade Length=2.0 K.M.	First	408.51
3	2025_PWDRB_547964_1	Renewal and Improvment of the road from Subhash Nagar Vishram Ghat ground to Raisen Road.Length-1.50 Km and Carrier college to ITI Road, (four lane) Bhopal For Army Day Parade (Length =2.4K.M.)	First	323.33
4	2025_PWDRB_547965_1	Renewal and Improvement of road of Gurudwara Junction to Raisen Road, (Four lane) & Development of Parkings Bhopal for Army Day Parade Length =3.2 K.M., Helipads and helipad approach roads and Construction of Pathways for spectators Army Pared Ground Area, Kalibadi Road, Bhopal Length = 0.37K.M. and Construction of Jamuri Maidan to Piplani B Sector-Khajuri Road, Bhopal Length-1.60 K.M (Two lane)	First	487.95

The document can only be purchased online from the above website after making online payment. The last date & time for Purchesh and Submition of document on line is **13/11/2026** up to 17:30 PM. Detailed NIT and other details can be viewed on the above mentioned portal. Amendments to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not in news paper.

Sd/- **Executive Engineer**
P.W.D. (Maint.) Division No. 2, Bhopal

G-21185/26

TENDER NOTICE

AFFWA (L), 27 ED, AF Prahaladpur invites tenders for operation of a Confectionery Shop. Minimum monthly licence fee is ₹ 9,500/-.

Last date for submission of tender forms is 15 Nov 2026 and opening of tender is 16 Nov 2026 at 1100 hrs.

First preference will be given to AFFWA members, Ex-Servicemen and War Widows.

For tender forms and details, contact Manager, AFFWA (L) at 9701878301

U.P.POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD

Invites e-auction bids for **SALE OF SCRAP** at 400 KV Substation Manth District- Mathura On Date:- 18.11.2026 ● E-auction to be done on 'as is where is' basis in separate lots through M/s M.S.T.C. ● **Sites of Scrap:-** ❖Village Maduaka, Electricity 400 KV Substation Manth Bajna, Mathura-281201 ● **Details of E-auction:-** ❖Auction catalogue, terms and conditions available on **www.mstcecommerce.com** ❖All auction related information and corrigendum, if any, shall only be uploaded on the above website. ● **Contact Details of Concerned Officers:-**❖ ee400kvmanth@upptcl.org/ Mobile No. 9808264282 Sd/-(Hopendra Kumar) Executive Engineer E 400 KV S/S Div. Manth Mathura पत्रांक: 332/वि400 के०वी० उ० खं० (मां०) / मथुरा / विज्ञापन दिनांक:- 05/11/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SONIPAT	SUPPLYING, INSTALLATION, TESTING, AND COMMISSIONING (SITC) OF AUTOMATIC WATER MIST SPRAY SYSTEMS (MIST RINGS ON EXISTING/ERECTED PILLARS AND ROUNDABOUT SYSTEMS FOR AIRBONE DUST SUPPRESSION IN MC SONIPAT + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 13.11.2026	97,31,197/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01302261100 xenhortmcs@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50854/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	PROVIDING AND LAYING OF 1.5 MM THICK HDPE LINER BED (LAYER-WISE, WITH ANCHOR TRENCH, LEACHATE COLLECTION PIPES, PERIPHERAL LEACHATE DRAIN AND RCC LEACHATE TANK) FOR FRESH WASTE WINDROWS ON 4 ACRE LAND AT DESIGNATED MSW PROCESSING SITE OF WEST ZONE. + 1 WORKS	04.11.2026 14.11.2026	3,95,20,944/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01293411649 memandeep188@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50850/HRY

CBSE Class 10 & 12 board exams to begin on Feb 16

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, November 6

THE CENTRAL Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) on Friday released the date sheet for the Class 10 and 12 board examinations, which will begin on February 16, 2027. CBSE has released the exam schedule 101 days in advance this year to help students prepare for the boards as well as future entrance examinations.

As per CBSE, more than 26.5 lakh students have registered for Class 10 and over 19.8 lakh for Class 12. They will appear in 83 subjects in Class 10 and 121 subjects in Class 12. All examinations will commence at 10.30 am. "... Date sheets are prepared based on the data submitted in the List of Candidates (LOC) by the schools. As the LOC submission process has been completed and the Board now possesses the final data regarding subject combinations opted by students, CBSE has finalised the date sheets," the board said in a statement.

The board said it had factored in over 40,000 subject combinations to ensure that exams for two subjects opted for by the same student do not clash, and had provided adequate gaps between subjects commonly taken together in both classes. The tentative schedules of major entrance exams for Class 12 students were also taken into account.

"Every effort has been made to complete the Board Examinations well before the commencement of such entrance examinations...," CBSE said.

The schedule also takes into account the number of candidates at individual examination centres on a given day and has been designed to minimise teachers' prolonged absence from schools during evaluation, CBSE said.

The board said the early release would give students sufficient time to reduce examination-related anxiety, and help schools undertake academic planning and support measures for board classes.

"It would also help students, parents and teachers plan their engagements and travel during the summer vacation in accordance with the examination and evaluation schedules," it said.

JHARKHAND: FIVE WOMEN, 11-MONTH-OLD BABY AMONG DEAD

Truck runs over seven helping man pull scooter out of ditch

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, November 6

SEVEN PEOPLE, including an infant, were killed after a speeding truck ran over a group that had gathered on a road to help a scooterist in Jharkhand's Khunti district on Thursday night.

The accident took place around 9.30 pm on Thursday. According to Khunti Superintendent of Police Rishabh Garg, a scooter slipped into a roadside ditch in the village. The scooterist was from the same village and asked residents for help to pull the two-wheeler out of the ditch.

"Several women from the village came to help; some children accompanied them. They were standing on the road when a speeding heavy truck ran over the group," the senior police officer said, adding that the truck was possibly coming from the Ramgarh-Hazaribagh side.

He said the truck may have been speeding and lost control while taking a turn. Visuals from the spot showed that the 16-wheeler crashed into a tree after the accident.



People gather at the accident site along the Karra-Torpa main road in Khunti on Friday. ANI

The victims have been identified as 11-month-old Saurabh Nayak, his mother Anjali Kumari, Pako Devi, Jayanti Devi, Manhu Devi, Golu Kumar and Tuti Kumari. Five-year-old Khushbu Kumari was seriously injured in the accident and is undergoing treatment at Khunti Sadar Hospital.

The truck driver left the vehicle and fled the spot after the accident, and has switched off his mobile phone, Garg said.

Police teams are trying to track him down and contact his family to ensure his surrender.

Chief Minister Hemant Soren expressed grief over the deaths.

"My heartfelt condolences to the bereaved families who have lost their loved ones. May Marang Buru grant peace to the souls of the deceased and give strength to their families to bear this loss. I wish a speedy recovery to those injured and undergoing treatment," he wrote on X.

President Droupadi Murmu described the tragedy as "extremely heartbreaking". "I express my deepest condolences to the bereaved families. I pray for the swift recovery of those injured in this accident," the Rashtrapati Bhavan said in a post on X.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi too extended his condolences to the victims' families. "Deeply pained by the loss of lives in a mishap in Khunti, Jharkhand. I extend my condolences to those who have lost their loved ones. Praying for the speedy recovery of the injured," the Prime Minister's Office posted on X.



Police personnel lathicharge protesters on the premises of Danapur Sub-Divisional Hospital, following a clash with families of the three criminals in Patna on Friday. ANI

3 wanted men killed in encounter in Patna

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, November 6

THREE MEN wanted in connection with a shooting that left one person dead and another injured were killed in a police encounter in Bihar's Sherpur village on Friday.

Police said they received confidential information that some criminals with previous records had gathered in Sherpur and could be planning a major crime. Acting on the input, a joint team of the Bihar STF and Patna Police conducted a raid.

According to police, the team came under fire as soon as it reached the spot. "One bullet passed after grazing the uniform of the Maner station house officer," an officer said, adding that other members of the team were also targeted.

The police claimed they retaliated in "self-defence", injuring the three. "They were rushed to hospital, where doctors declared them dead," the officer said. The deceased have been identified as Jai Prakash Rai, a resident of Tarachak in Danapur; Bablu Yadav, from Vastu Bihar Krishi Farm under Shahpur police station; and Raja Sharma alias Suraj Kumar, a resident of Gangahara, also under Shahpur police station.

According to police, all three were wanted in a case registered on October 19 in connection with a shooting in Byapur village a day earlier.

The FIR said, Pintu Kumar, the survivor, told police that a group of men arrived at his residence around 9.30 pm and opened fire. He alleged that Ajay Singh fired twice at Sanjeet Kumar, who later died.

One bullet hit the survivor in the back, while Jaiveer Kumar and Dalveer Kumar fired five to six rounds at him, hitting both his legs. Pintu further alleged that Vijay Kumar and Dhananjay Singh threatened to shoot his entire family if he approached the police.

He also alleged that Ajay Singh had demanded Rs 10 lakh from Sanjeet, who had already paid Rs 1 lakh.

Police said Rajesh Ranjan alias Rajesh Mukhiya, the alleged main conspirator, had been arrested earlier and sent to judicial custody.

Saharanpur court sentences 2 cops to 20 yrs for gangrape of woman in 2015

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, November 6

AFTER WAITING over a decade for justice, a 45-year-old woman watched on Friday as two police personnel were sentenced to 20 years in prison by a court in Saharanpur for gangraping her in 2015, when she had approached them seeking help after her husband was arrested.

Earlier on Thursday, the court held retired Circle Officer Brijmohan Yadav and inspector Vedpal Singh guilty under sections of gang rape and criminal intimidation following which the two, who were out on bail, were taken into custody.

"I have finally got justice after 11 and a half years, and I am satisfied," the survivor said after the verdict.

Her husband said that in 2015, police had falsely implicated him in an attempted murder case. "The court has since acquitted me in that case," he said.

The case involved four accused, according to the complaint. The survivor's lawyer, Rajeev Tomar, said, "Proceedings against the third accused, Pankaj Dhama, were separated after he submitted documents stating that he was not mentally stable. The case against him is pending in court. The identity of the fourth accused could not be ascertained."

Defence counsel, Radhey Shyam said they would file an appeal against the judgment. He added that Vedpal Singh is posted in Mathura.

Doctor 'lured, robbed' by Malayalam actors; rape case adds a twist

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, November 6

TWO EMERGING actors in the Malayalam film industry have been arrested in Kochi for allegedly assaulting and robbing a doctor after luring him to a flat on the pretext of an emergency medical call. The case took a twist on Friday, however, when police registered a rape case against the doctor following a complaint by a relative of one of the arrested actors.

The arrested accused are actors Athulya Chandra (32) and Bibin Perumbally (43), and the latter's driver, K B Vishnu (31), who has eight criminal cases against him, police said.

Kochi city police arrested the trio on Thursday following a complaint by the 41-year-old doctor, who works at a leading multi-speciality hospital in the city. They were booked for wrongful confinement, assault, criminal intimidation and robbery.

Police sources said the full picture was yet to emerge, as the two cases were connected. "Preliminary evidence suggests that this was not a robbery but a calculated extortion attempt, in which the doctor was allegedly lured before being assaulted and stripped of his valuables. We are searching for nine others involved in the assault, which was allegedly planned by Athulya," an officer said.

According to police, the incident took place on the night of November 2, when Athulya called the doctor, claiming that one of her close relatives needed urgent medical attention.

"The doctor, who was familiar with actor Athulya, rushed to an apartment used to accommodate members of the film industry. On reaching the flat, he was tied to a chair, threatened and assaulted by the trio. They also robbed him of digital devices worth Rs 3.25 lakh," police said, quoting the FIR.

The doctor lodged a complaint two days later, saying he had been afraid of the gang, which had allegedly threatened him with dire consequences if he disclosed the incident. The three accused have been remanded in judicial custody.

Police sources said Athulya allegedly plotted the crime because she knew that her relative was close to the doctor. She allegedly intended to extort money from him through blackmail and had also accessed digital evidence that could serve as proof of their relationship.

The case took another turn on Friday when Athulya's relative, a woman in her early 50s, approached the police alleging that the doctor had sexually assaulted her in a hotel room last month. The doctor is yet to be arrested.

Athulya, according to police, is also a law graduate who practised at the Kerala High Court under a prominent criminal lawyer. She made her Malayalam film debut with the 2019 Mammootty-starrer *Ganagandharvan*, directed by Ramesh Pisharody, who is now a Congress legislator. She subsequently appeared in Tamil and Telugu films.

Her breakthrough came with the 2025 Malayalam film *Dies Irae*, in which she played Tessa.

Surat diamond polisher goes 'missing' in Russia, kin say he was working with the army

Kamal Saiyed
Surat, November 6

A DIAMOND polisher from Surat has been "missing" in Russia for almost four-and-a-half months now. The matter came to light on Thursday, when Ramnik Sakhwala's family approached the Surat police.

The strains that the Russia-Ukraine war put on the diamond industry supply chain impacted the smaller units in Surat the most. Ramnik worked in one of those, and his employer had slashed his modest salary of Rs 35,000 by more than half, members of the family said. Ramnik's son Hemil was 16, and is still in school.

So when his close friend Pankaj Jiwani, also a diamond polisher in Surat, landed a job in Russia, Ramnik decided to tag along. They landed in Moscow on June 13, 2025. The two friends rented a room, where they stayed for more than a month. Ramnik's brother Mahesh said Ramnik had first tried to get a job in the diamond industry in Russia, which is the world's largest producer of diamonds both by volume and production value. "But he had no references...," Mahesh said.

Ramnik got himself a job in a mall in Moscow, his wife, Sheetal, told *The Indian Express*.

According to the family, things started to go wrong in March this year, when the 40-year-old diamond polisher lost his job at the mall.

"One day in mid-April, when he was returning home after searching for a job, he was arrested by the Russian police," Sheetal said. According to Sheetal, the police gave Ramnik two options — he could either work for six months in the Russian Army, or he could go to jail. Ramnik chose the first option.



Ramnik Sakhwala with wife Sheetal and son Hemil

"During my last conversation with Ramnik on June 24, he told me he was working as a member of the support staff supplying food to Russian army soldiers on the front. He told me that the commander of his team was a Sri Lankan named Arjun. Ramnik gave me Arjun's phone number, and told me that he himself would be out of network coverage area for about 15-20 days," Sheetal said.

Since the beginning of the Russia-Ukraine war in February 2022, dozens of media reports have said foreign nationals, including Indians, have been lured or tricked into participating in the fighting.

In early October this year, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said that it believed 259 Indian nationals had been recruited into the Russian armed forces, 139 of whom had ultimately returned to India.

Sheetal said that police had found Ramnik's visa to have been "genuine".

After a while, even Arjun had stopped taking her calls, Sheetal said. "During our last conversation, Arjun said that Ramnik had been transferred to some other place. But we have not been in touch with him for more than four months," she said.

"We have emailed the Russian Consulate General in Mumbai, the Indian Embassy in Moscow, and the Ministry of External Affairs and the Prime Minister's Office... So far, we have not received any reply," said Sheetal, who has started sewing garments to make ends meet and pay her son's school fees.

Pankaj, who is in Indonesia now, said, "Both of us looked forward to a bright future in Russia, but I was forced to return because the weather there did not suit me at all."

SC bins Tejpal's plea to suspend sentence in 2013 rape case

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 6

THE SUPREME Court on Friday rejected former *Tehelka* editor Tarun Tejpal's plea to suspend his sentence in the 2013 rape case, where he was sentenced to 10 years' imprisonment for raping a woman journalist inside the elevator of a Goa hotel.

"We are concerned with the suspension of sentence alone... On a prima facie view, we are not inclined to suspend the sentence," a bench of Justices M M Sundresh and P B Varale said dismissing his application.

Appearing for Tejpal, Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal said the charge was that while he was assaulting the survivor inside the elevator, he kept its buttons pressed to ensure that the doors did not open. "The whole story is false... During that two minutes nine seconds, the lift door opened two times at the ground floor. Her case was that it did not open and had it opened, she would have run out," Sibal said, adding that CCTV recordings that showed this were destroyed.

The high court had not dealt with this aspect, he said, adding that the investigating officer had not seized the visuals.

Sibal pointed out that a defence witness who had seen the survivor emerge from the lift had testified that she appeared to be smiling, grinning and looking excited.

Senior Advocate Siddharth Agarwal, also for Tejpal, said he was on bail throughout the period of trial but never misused the liberty.

Opposing the prayer for suspending sentence, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state of Goa, said that about 1.30 am that night, Tejpal had sent a message to her. "Imagine a person sending the message to a girl of daughter's age. What does that message implicate?..." Mehta highlighted the apology Tejpal emailed to the survivor after she complained to *Tehelka*'s then editor, Shoma Chaudhary, and contended it rendered all his arguments on the lift door opening irrelevant.

Sibal said it was Chaudhary who drafted the email. To this, Mehta said that Tejpal had sent it directly to the survivor.

AFTER AUTHOR PERUMAL MURUGAN FLAGS FACTUAL INACCURACIES IN BOOKS IN THE LIBRARY IN COIMBATORE, CM VIJAY PINS BLAME ON DMK

Tamil Nadu 'library scam': Perumal Murugan's questions spark Vijay-DMK war

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, November 6

A BOOK of classical Tamil verse presented as a poet and philosopher. Another poet acquires a royal identity. A writer who spent nearly 15 years studying Tamil literature and 30 years teaching it opens a library book and discovers, to his astonishment, how much he apparently did not know.

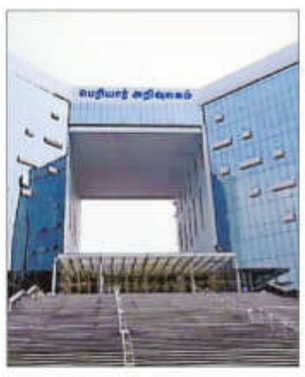
These are among the encounters Tamil novelist Perumal Murugan describes in an essay alleging serious irregularities in book purchases for Periyar Arivulagam, a new public library in Coimbatore inaugurated by Chief Minister Joseph Vijay on October 16.

His account has drawn a sharply worded political response accusing the previous DMK government — under which the library was conceived — of corruption. Both demand attention to public money, though their emphases differ. Murugan examines the books while the response directs its attack at the DMK.

Built across seven acres at a cost of nearly Rs 300 crore, the seven-storey library was equipped with facilities comparable to those at the Anna Centenary Memorial Library in Chennai and the Kalaignar Centenary Memorial Library in Madurai, according to Murugan. A statue of Periyar stands at its entrance.

The opening had already generated arguments over political credit. Murugan wrote that Vijay had not acknowledged it as a DMK project, even in passing. Former CM M K Stalin visited on November 4 and was felicitated that evening by the Dravidar Kazhagam.

Inside, Murugan found another controversy. On the fourth floor, he counted nearly 1,800 Tamil books from the Agalvilakku Publishing House, a publisher unfamiliar to him despite four decades in the literary world. Nearly all were hardbound. "Perhaps the scope of my reading and my pursuit of knowledge are that limited," he wrote.





Periyar Arivulagam in Coimbatore; (right) Perumal Murugan

A shelf full of questions

One 300-page volume, "Naladiyar: A Guide to Life", by Surya Balu, cost Rs 1,445. Other publishers, he said, charge Rs 350 for books of that length. The price suggested considerable labour and rare knowledge. Opening the book produced a different impression.

"Naladiyar, an important poet and philosophical sage of Tamil," its opening declared, according to the passage Murugan reproduced. Naladiyar, he explained, is a collection of 404-line verses by unnamed Jain ascetics. The book nevertheless described this supposed individual's songs, poems, and insights into human existence.

"Reading this made my head spin," Murugan wrote. A second volume, "Madurai Kanchi: A Literary Journey", by Dev Nilan, was also 300 pages long and priced at Rs 1,395. It attributed the work to "Madurai Koozhathi Peruvazhuthi", first describing him as a poet and later as a victorious king skilled at managing war's social and economic consequences. Murugan identified the author of "Madurai Kanchi" as Mangudi Maruthanar, a poet, not a king. "Who on earth is this Koozhathi Peruvazhuthi?" he asked.

The surprises continued into modern literature. A book called "Bharathiyar Stories," attributed to Manisha Saravanan, presented a story called "The Face of Achievement" as Bharathiyar's work. Murugan questioned both that attribution and the passage's awkward language, calling on Bharathi researchers to establish whether the story was his.

In another volume, "The History Keeladi Tells," he reported finding a photograph of a large Nandi presented as a sculpture discovered there. A book titled "Tamil Nadu: An Overview" identified "Muthuvelu Subbiah Iyer" as the state's first Chief Minister in 1947 and introduced "M K Ramasamy" as a subsequent political leader.

Murugan's mock astonishment accompanied a broader allegation: that publishers had been created specifically to supply the library, using underdeveloped Artificial Intelligence to produce books under fictitious authors' names.

He also alleged that the ISBNs were false, saying online searches returned no matching numbers. The books supplied an email address but no mobile number, he wrote. More than 100 books from Phoenix Publishing House were on the shelves, he said, while hundreds of boxes apparently remained unpacked.

Vijay targets DMK

The political response came from Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay who praised Murugan for exposing the alleged procurement corruption. It also said the novelist had served on a committee recommending modern literature and criticism for new libraries, constituted under a government order dated November 5, 2025, during the DMK administration.

Vijay's statement accused the DMK leadership of recommending substandard books while boasting of the care taken in developing the library.

"The DMK has committed corruption in a slightly different way, turning Coimbatore's Periyar Arivalayam itself into a world of corruption," said CM Vijay.

Murugan's requested first step was immediate and physical: remove the books from the shelves. He called for action against everyone involved and an inquiry committee to place the facts of the alleged fraud before the public. And his essay reminded everyone that there were books yet to be opened.

KANHAIYA MURDER

HC upholds UAPA charges against eight accused

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, November 6

THE RAJASTHAN High Court has upheld framing of charges under the UAPA against eight accused in the 2022 murder of Udaipur tailor Kanhaiya Lal, dismissing appeals where they had challenged the trial court's order.

A Division Bench of Chief Justice Sanjay K Agrawal and Justice Sameer Jain, in a judgment delivered on November 5, held the objections raised by the accused regarding the recovered videos, the absence of specific words or expressions affecting public tranquility, and their alleged lack of membership in any unlawful organisation could not, by themselves, be considered sufficient grounds for discharging them without examining the entire prosecution material.

The Bench said the conspiracy allegations and circumstances surrounding the incident had to be considered together and "the absence of direct evidence of conspiracy, by itself, cannot be decisive, as such an agreement may be inferred from the cumulative effect of the circumstances."

AMID SIANG PROTESTS

Govt gives in-principle forest nod to 1,000-MW project on Siyom

Panel also directs review of Kamala project on Subansiri which involves proposed felling of nearly 24 lakh trees

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, November 6

AMID SEVERE protests against the 11,200-MW Siang Upper project in Arunachal Pradesh, the Forest Advisory Committee (FAC) of the Union Environment Ministry has recommended an in-principle forest clearance for the 1,000-MW Naying Hydroelectric Project on Siyom river, a major tributary of the Siang river.

The FAC's recommendation for the North Eastern Electric Power Corporation Ltd (NEEPCO) project was made during its October 23 meeting, as per official minutes of the meeting.

The Naying project is proposed to be built as a run-of-the-river project in the Shi Yomi and Siang districts, both bordering China. The estimated project cost is Rs 10,369 crore, as per submissions by the NEEPCO, the project proponent.

It will entail construction of a concrete gravity dam 138 metres high from the deepest foundation level, and an underground powerhouse complex connected through a 7.08-km-long headrace tunnel. A headrace tunnel carries water from a dam or reservoir to a hydroelectric power station to generate electricity.

The dam will be near Pabuying and Yapik villages.

The Naying Hydroelectric Project is one among at least four hydroelectric projects planned in the Siang River Basin. The Upper Siang multipurpose project is the biggest one, while Lower Siang has a capacity of 2,700 MW. The Tato-II project, with a proposed capacity of 700 MW, on Siyom River was approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs in August 2025.

Meanwhile, the FAC directed a "comprehensive assessment" of the 1,720-MW Kamala Hydroelectric Project, which was also taken up for appraisal, after it noted that the proposed project on the Kamla River in Arunachal Pradesh involves extensive submergence, affects a substantial number of trees and raises significant ecological and socio-economic concerns.

Around 24 lakh trees are proposed to be felled for the Kamala hydel project planned on Kamala, a right-bank tributary of the Subansiri River. The FAC formed a sub-committee to examine the project's implications on forest submergence, wildlife, and directed it to propose ways to reduce forest loss.

The Naying project's in-principle forest clearance recommendation was for diverting 470.8 hectares of unclassed forest land for non-forest use, in an area which was categorised as "high conservation value zone" by the FAC. "The project will affect approximately 1,04,036 trees comprising 48,282 trees above 60 cm girth and 55,754 below 60 cm girth," FAC noted in the minutes of its meeting.

While recommending in-principle forest clearance, the FAC specified that the compensatory afforestation, which has been proposed on double the area – 942 hectares - must happen on contiguous area. It also noted that as per the cumulative impact assessment and carrying capacity study of the Siang basin, it was recommended to alter the design parameters by lowering full reservoir level, to maintain a minimum 1-km free-flowing river stretch between Tato-II and Naying.

Siyom originates from the snow-clad Pari mountains range, where elevation varies between 4,472 and 5,044 metres, as per the project's catchment area treatment plan.

The river flows northwest to southwest with sharp flow turns in west to east direction and joins Siang on the right bank. Twelve villages and 408 project affected families have been identified by the social impact assessment report.

The in-principle forest clearance approval to the Naying Hydroelectric Project comes amid rising tensions in Arunachal Pradesh's Siang belt, as *The Indian Express* had reported earlier, with sections of the indigenous Adi community, youth leaders and riverbank residents objecting to the proposed Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP).

According to locals, the project threatens them economically and socially, and also impinges upon the sentimental and cultural heritage attached to their ancestral land. Even as the government goes ahead with the pre-feasibility survey (PFR), apprehensions have only grown.

The state government maintains that the SUMP is essential to counter China's proposed upstream dam and is a national security issue.

'Didn't apply mind...': High Court quashes Kaziranga activist's NSA detention

Shinjini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 6



Land rights activist Pranab Doley

THE GAUHATI High Court on Friday quashed land rights activist Pranab Doley's detention under the National Security Act (NSA), which was invoked against him for protesting a proposed luxury hotel project near the Kaziranga National Park. He was released from custody after over 115 days.

In its judgment, the HC bench of Justice Kalyan Rai Surana and Justice Susmita Phukan Khaund noted, "The detaining authority (Assam government) has not applied its mind as to whether or not the ordinary laws of the country were insufficient to deal with the activities of the petitioner (Doley)."

Doley, 40, is the convener of the Greater Kaziranga Land and Human Rights Committee and has been vocal about the potential impact of the project and the displacement of indigenous villagers for years now.

While quashing the detention order, the HC said that it was based on "stale criminal cases," as Doley had already been acquitted in nine of the 13 cases the state government had relied on. "Only three proceedings were live and one is at evidence stage," it added. "As the petitioner is found to have been detained on strength of stale cases, including those wherein he has been discharged and acquitted, the only inference that can be drawn under facts of this case is that the sponsoring authority and the detaining authority, by issuing detention order, has adopted a short cut to detain the petitioner instead," the judgment read.

On the detention order mentioning Doley's foreign visits, the court said the state government had "not given details of anti-India activity" by him.

"Repetitive foreign visit, by itself, is not an act which would warrant preventive detention of a person and curtail his fundamental right to visit a country of his choice," the HC said.

The judgment read, "Moreover, along with the grounds of detention, except for a vague allegation regarding foreign visits and suspicious foreign exchange receipts, the detaining authority has not furnished to the petitioner any materials showing how his foreign visits and receipt of foreign exchange amounts to activities that is prejudicial to the interest of the State, its security and integrity, or has affected public order."

The court noted while there were allegations of Doley's involvement in "road blockades and damages to public properties," no details of the said offences had been provided. "Thus, the allegations against the petitioner is vague and bereft of material particulars." Speaking to *The Indian Express*, senior advocate Santanu Borthakur, who was representing Doley, said the state government's failure to provide relevant detention documents to Doley was another ground laid out by the HC to quash the detention order.

After his arrest on July 12 by Golaghat Police, Doley was granted bail by a local court on July 29. The state government invoked NSA against him a day later, stating his activities were "prejudicial to maintenance of public order as well as security of the state."

Jharkhand tribal activist dies by suicide on FB live

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, November 6

AN TRIBAL activist from Jharkhand died by suicide during a Facebook livestream where she could be heard speaking about her grievances and talking to the area police station inspector over the phone, in Ranchi on Friday.

Nisha Bhagat, aged around 38, was vocal about tribal religion and rights. During her livestream, which lasted for around 10 minutes, she appeared distressed and described herself as being alone and fighting for the community single-handedly. She also said that the system had failed her in her fight against land mafia.

Bhagat was vocal against conversion of tribals and supported the demand for the delisting of tribals who have converted to Christianity or Islam from the Scheduled Tribes list.

While the exact reason behind the extreme step could not be ascertained yet, Bhagat appeared angered by online trolling and the word "dalal" (broker) used against her. In the video, she said that she had no connection with anyone and was not associated with any particular group. However, in the video, she expressed disappointment with the RSS and the BJP, saying that despite expecting their support, they had never stood by her.

During the livestream, she called up the inspector of Pithoria police station and told him that she was live on Facebook and would take her life. She also questioned why the robbery case at her house had not been solved and why those allegedly harassing her had not been identified or apprehended.

After she informed the inspector that she was live on social media, he reportedly disconnected the call. Some time later, police reached the spot and rushed Bhagat to RIMS hospital, where she was declared dead.

The BJP has stepped up its criticism of the state government and police following the death of Bhagat. BJP state president Aditya Sahu raised serious questions over the role of Pithoria police station and the state government, demanding immediate action and the arrest of the police personnel found responsible in the matter.

Leader of Opposition Babulal Marandi expressed deep sorrow over the death and held Chief Minister Hemant Soren responsible, alleging that the state government had no control over crime and was protecting land brokers and mafias.

Marandi alleged that Bhagat was driven to suicide due to a lack of administrative support despite repeatedly raising her concerns. He said that she had informed the police about her situation during her livestream shortly before her death, but no action was taken.

He demanded the arrest of the police officers concerned and those whose names Bhagat mentioned in the video. He also called for a CBI investigation into the entire matter.

Ranchi Rural SP Gaurav Goswami told The Indian Express that Bhagat was live on Facebook for around 10 minutes and had also called several people, including her parents, before her death. He said the police were investigating the circumstances surrounding the incident and were also checking whether she had filed any complaints or cases at Pithoria police station. The SP said the incident took place around 12.30 pm. He said the police would be in a position to comment further on the case after the post-mortem examination.

The Indian Express also tried to contact the Pithoria police station in-charge but could not reach him for comment.

Bhagat's death has triggered grief among members of the Adivasi community as well as social organisations.

Set to be euthanised, Keralam elephant to get specialised treatment at Vantara

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, November 6

SOME TIME back, an 18-month-old elephant calf, found abandoned in the forests of Keralam last year, was recommended for euthanasia.

Suffering from a severe bone disease, the calf, Maya's condition had worsened after a fall earlier this year, leaving its caretakers with little hope for its recovery.

Now, it is all set to get a new lease of life with the Keralam Forest Department on Friday airlifting the calf on a chartered flight to Vantara in Gujarat for specialised treatment.

Keralam Chief Wildlife Warden Dr P Pugazhendi told the media that Vantara, the wildlife conservation, rescue and rehabilitation centre in Gujarat's Jamnagar, founded by Anant Ambani, would bear the entire cost of the calf's treatment.

Dr Pugazhendi said Maya was suffering from a "serious bone disease".

Osteopenia is a condition in which mineral density of bones is lower than normal, making them weaker and less dense than healthy bones.



Caretakers tend to Maya, a sick elephant calf from Kodanad Abhayaranyam, inside a special container before being airlifted to Vantara in Jamnagar for specialised treatment on Friday. PTI

"A health monitoring committee had recommended euthanasia for the calf as doctors had lost hope. But before going for any irreversible step, we discussed the matter with experts in other states and later with those in Vantara. They have recommended an at least six-month-long treatment plan for the calf. Expert veterinary doctors there have already prepared a treatment protocol," he said.

After being rescued last year, Maya was being sheltered and nursed at Abhayaranyam — a sanctuary for orphaned and abandoned wild animals in Ernakulam district of Keralam.

The calf, weighing around 120 kg, was loaded into an animal ambulance at Abhayaranyam from where it was taken to the Kochi airport on Friday. From here, it was shifted to a special chartered flight, accompanied by its mahout and a veterinary surgeon, to Gujarat.

The newborn was found abandoned at Malayatoor forest division in Ernakulam in April 2025. In July this year, the calf, which was already weak, had a fall that left it indisposed and unable to stand.

According to a press release issued by Vantara, Maya will receive "round-the-clock monitoring, pain management, advanced diagnostics, hydraulic lifting support and hydrotherapy where appropriate."

It said, "Kerala remains in charge of her care, and Vantara will facilitate her return to Abhayaranyam once treatment is complete."

Said the Chief Wildlife Warden, "We hope our calf will return to Keralam healthy."

SC issues contempt notice to office-bearers of KPCC for online post targeting CJI

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 6

UNDERLINING THAT "the independence of the judiciary is not a matter of political convenience", the Supreme Court on Friday issued a contempt show-cause notice against all Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) office-bearers over a now-deleted social media post targeting Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi said court judgments are always open to criticism but freedom of expression cannot become a shield for intimidation or interference with the administration of justice. The SC was hearing a petition filed by Advocate Vineet Jindal seeking suo motu contempt of court proceedings in connection with the October 12 viral social media post.

"The present matter concerns certain remarks directed against the Hon'ble CJI attributed to the social media account of a political organisation. The Constitution is supreme..." said the bench.

It underscored the supremacy of the judiciary's independence saying it is not a matter of political convenience. "It is a constitutional guarantee owed to the Republic..."

The bench said no person can be allowed to pollute the stream of justice, however high their position, "Judicial restraint must never be mistaken for institutional weakness. Any attempt to undermine the authority of the Court requires to be dealt with iron hand".

"... we consider it appropriate to examine whether the material warrants exercise of this Court's jurisdiction under Article 129 of the Constitution of India (which empowers the SC to punish for contempt)."

The court directed that notice be issued not only to the KPCC president, but to all its office-bearers

Appearing for the respondents, Senior Advocate Ramesh Babu said the post "was uploaded without the approval or consent of the office bearers".

"Unconditionally, we are tendering an apology...On the same day it came to the notice of the Committee, it was taken down..." Babu said.

TCS case: AIMIM's Imtiaz Jaleel named accused

Express News Service
Mumbai, November 6

IN A fresh development in the Nashik TCS sexual harassment and alleged religious conversion case, the Nashik police have named All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM) leader and former MP Imtiaz Jaleel as an accused in the existing FIR for allegedly sheltering Nida Khan, one of the accused in the case, while she was absconding.

The development follows the questioning of AIMIM corporator Matin Patel, who was earlier booked for allegedly helping Khan evade arrest by providing her accommodation in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar.

According to police sources, investigators found evidence pointing towards Jaleel's alleged involvement during Patel's questioning. The Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the case has also informed the court about Jaleel's alleged role in the case.



AIMIM leader and former MP Imtiaz Jaleel

The investigation is understood to have included the examination of audio recordings recovered from Patel's mobile phone. Jaleel's voice samples have also been obtained for verification, according to reports.

The police action comes nearly six months after *The Indian Express* reported that Jaleel's name had figured in the chargesheet. The chargesheet mentioned that Patel had repeatedly made references to the AIMIM leader when investigators questioned him about Khan's whereabouts.

Jaleel was, however, not named as an accused at that stage.

Police arrested Khan from Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar on May 7. It was then alleged that Patel had provided shelter to her and her family despite knowing that her anticipatory bail application had been rejected by a Nashik court.

The case came to light following complaints by employees of the TCS unit in Nashik, alleging sexual harassment, intimidation and attempts at religious conversion by their colleagues. The Nashik police had then registered nine FIRs in connection with the allegations and constituted an SIT to investigate them.

Jaleel had earlier denied allegations of his involvement in helping Khan evade arrest. He couldn't be contacted for a comment.

● ALIGARH MUSLIM UNIVERSITY VOTED FOR ITS STUDENTS' UNION ON NOVEMBER 5 — AFTER A GAP OF 8 YEARS

'I was contesting to win': AMU gets first woman V-P of students' union in 40 yrs

Sukrita Baruah
New Delhi, November 6

NASHRA NAIM was very clear that she was contesting in the Aligarh Muslim University (AMU) Students' Union election — an institution that has been revived after eight years — to win.

Those around her might have had their doubts because most cannot remember when a woman had last been elected to a chair position in the students' union. But she has now carved her own place in AMU's history, by being elected vice-president — the first woman to be elected to one of the top posts of president, vice-president, or secretary in at least four decades.

AMU voted for its students' union on November 5 after a gap of eight years, and the results were announced on Friday. It had been suspended by the administration since 2019, citing campus violence, indiscipline, and law and order. This election came after 19 days of intense protests by students led by an MA student on hunger strike, after which the administration agreed to restore the union.

Significantly, this was soon followed by similar protests at Jamia Millia Islamia in Delhi, where students' union elections had not been held in two decades, after which the administration there also agreed to hold elections.

The dramatic circumstances around these elections have been heightened by Naim's historic win. While she has been elected vice-president, Noman Ashraf has been elected president and Mohammad Hamdan has been elected honorary secretary.

Elections also took place for 10 Cabinet Member positions, and women candidates won five of these positions.

"A particularly encouraging feature of this year's elections was the significant participation and representation of women. Nashra Naim secured the post of vice-president, while five woman candidates were elected to the 10-member AMUSU Cabinet. Two women, Amina Faizan and Ilma Mashroof, were also elected as student representatives to the AMU Court. The Women's College Students' Union further witnessed the election of its new office-bearers and eight cabinet members, reflecting the active engagement of women students in campus democracy," a statement issued by the AMU read.

A long association

Naim, an LLB student from Uttar Pradesh's Gorakhpur, has a long association with the university: She had done her higher secondary schooling in the Women's College, a constituent college of AMU, and her father is an alumnus of the university.



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

'Everything is political... and it's very important to keep politics alive': Nashra Naim, an LLB student from UP's Gorakhpur

She said her father was a little unsure when she first said she wanted to contest in the election. "At first, I had said that I wanted to contest for president. But my father knows the university very well, and said it would be very difficult for me because he thought that the campus is not likely to accept a woman president immediately after the union has been restored. I considered this because I am contesting to win, and so I decided to aim for vice-president. But my family has been very supportive through it all," she said.

According to Naim, the two focus areas of her campaign were the need to update an old and outdated academic curriculum and the restrictions on "third spaces", where students can meet and talk and discuss ideas on campus, such as the main library canteen closing earlier than it used to.

Naim, who played an active part in the protests, said she believes that it is "very important to keep politics alive".

"Everything is political. If you are not politically conscious, you won't understand the effects of what, for example, the State or the administration is doing on you. You won't understand the hows and whys of it, why a particular restriction is being applied to a particular aspect of something. This is especially important after COVID, after which people have become very individualistic. They're not really thinking about community or the larger social context everything is happening in. That hampers development," she said.

With the revival of student elections and campus politics, Naim hopes that an environment conducive to producing future leaders from the institute will be re-invigorated.

"There is a lack of leadership from AMU. There was no intellectual leadership, I would say, for a long time. This is a gap people are talking about. In fact, in AMU, the word leader is looked at as a negative term because of things like regional lobbies that had developed in campus elections," she said.

The 50-odd people linked to the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, locked away in various jails in Mumbai for a string of recent attacks, fit a broader pattern — a ragtag army of mostly boys, lured by promises of easy money and a life abroad, who are hired to shoot and scoot

By SADAF MODAK, MOHAMED THAVER, SUKHBIR SIWACH & ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA





PHOTOS: PRAVEEN KHANNA

LAWRENCE'S BOYS

GANG MEMBERS ARRESTED FOR SHOOTING AT BOLLYWOOD CELEBRITIES, POLITICIAN

BLACK HOODS over their heads, nine men sat in the accused box at the back of the courtroom. Dressed in jeans or track pants, and knockoff 'Superdry' and 'Puma' T-shirts, they wore sliders or flip-flops. On a bench ahead sat two women, also in black hoods, and flanked by women police personnel. A policeman walked up to where they sat and began removing their hoods. One by one, their faces were revealed — 11 young men and women, frail, confused.

Then, as a court official began reading out their names, they stood up, their heads bowed. For the rest of the 30-minute hearing in a Mumbai special court on October 29, the 11 stood that way.

Suspects in the Tiger Shroff shooting case, the 11 were members of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, the prosecution alleged. They fit a broader pattern of those accused in a string of recent attacks in Mumbai that have been linked to the Bishnoi brothers, Lawrence and Anmol — from the April 2024 firing outside actor Salman Khan's residence in Bandra to the killing of NCP leader Baba Siddique the same year, the February 2026 firing outside filmmaker Rohit Shetty's home, and now the attack on actor Tiger Shroff. The accused in these cases are almost all 18-23-year-olds from deprived families who do gig work or low-skill jobs: welder, showroom staff, salesmen, hotel work. Police say several belong to the Scheduled Castes or backward classes. Most of them are Class 9-10 dropouts; some have ITI or diploma credentials.

It's a ragtag army of mostly boys, allegedly scouted through local links or lured through social media to do a quick 'job' for the gang.

A Haryana Police officer who questioned some of the accused in the Tiger Shroff case says, "When they were called in, some of them came wearing torn clothes... They are almost all from poor families. Most of them had lost their fathers at a young age and had no male figure to look up to."





Two of the suspects in the Tiger Shroff case under arrest in Mumbai; (right) Radha and Babita, arrested in the same case, worked as sales persons in Sonipat

Scouting for shooters

Gurmail Singh, 25, had a turbulent life after he dropped out of school while in Class 10. As an 18-year-old in 2019, he was charged with murder and sent to Haryana's Kaithal jail, where he spent four years. Police suspect that it was in jail that he came in contact with gang members of Rohit Godara, who was then a trusted lieutenant of Lawrence Bishnoi. After Gurmail got out on bail in the murder case, he moved to Mumbai in September 2024. A month later, he was arrested in the Baba Siddique case.

Like it happened in Gurmail Singh's case, the gang scouts for recruits among young men lodged in prisons, offering to secure their bail. "When Gurmail Singh was bailed out, he was impressed by the gang and beholden to them," a Mumbai Police officer tells *The Indian Express*.

"Once the person comes out on bail, he is asked to arrange other youngsters for the job, plan logistics etc. He goes on target youngsters from his own village, especially those from poor families looking to improve their lot."

Instead, most of them end up in prisons. Of the nearly 50 persons locked away in various jails in Mumbai for high-profile attacks carried out over the last two years and traced to the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, only one has managed to come out on bail, with the pleas of others rejected on grounds of "seriousness" of the crimes.

In all these cases, police have invoked the stringent Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) against the accused, a law that makes bail hard to get.

Police say the years in jail are not part of the deal when the youngsters are signed up for the crime. Instead, they say, they are promised money, fame and, in a lot of cases, a life in Canada or the US.

"A few have a past criminal record, but most are lured by the glamour of being part of a criminal gang. But the biggest lure is the dream that they will be settled abroad. In the Salman Khan case, the youngsters were promised that they would be settled in Canada. In the Baba Siddique case, they were told they would be sent to Dubai."

The new recruits are made to speak to gangsters based abroad. "The recruits are introduced to the gangsters as 'bhai' to make them feel important," says a Mumbai Police officer

'We are stuck'

The onboarding process involves getting the recruits to speak to the big gangsters based abroad. "The recruits are introduced to the gangsters as '*bhai*' to make them feel important," says the officer.

During these calls, the gangster talks up the 'job', telling the recruit that they are part of a greater calling.

"They are told that the person they are targeting is linked to Dawood Ibrahim or has done something wrong. Or they are told that they are involved in a noble cause for the sake of the country and their religion. Their job is to motivate them. In some cases, the top guys speak to the recruits a day before the shooting to ensure that they don't get cold feet," says the Mumbai officer.

The chargesheet in the Salman Khan case says that the shooters were told that they would be "creating history". Police say they found audio messages of a conversation in which Anmol Bishnoi is heard telling Vicky Gupta, one of the shooters, to smoke a cigarette and not wear helmets, so that they appear "fearless" on CCTVs.

The recruits are usually told that after the attack, they only have to escape and reach the Nepal border, from where they will be sent abroad. But once the attacks are carried out, reality dawns. The promise of a life abroad is forgotten and the accused are almost always left to fend for themselves.

Police say the gang knows it won't have to fulfill most of its promises since arrests are almost inevitable in all these cases.

Shiv Kumar Gautam, a shooter in the Baba Siddique case, hid in a forest near his village in Bahraich, UP, for nearly a month before he was arrested. "All that while, he got no help from the gang. He used his own resources to hide in the forest, some distance from his village," says the Mumbai officer.

It's only once they are in jail, and slapped with MCOCA ,that they realise they are stuck — "*hum atak gaye*".

"In jail, when the accused in one case interacts with those accused in earlier cases, they realise they are in it for the long haul. Some find it difficult to come to terms with this reality," he says.

Officers cite the example of Anuj Thapan, one of those arrested in the Salman Khan case, who allegedly hung himself in the bathroom while in the custody of the Crime Branch when he realised that he would be in jail for the next few years.

The promised money doesn't come through either.

Chargesheets filed by the police in court claim that the gang often pays a hired hand an advance, anywhere between a few thousands and Rs 50,000, with a promise of lakhs after the work is done.

A day after the Mumbai Police arrested the suspects in the Tiger Shroff case, DCP (Crime) Raj Tilak Roushan, when asked about the amount promised to the shooters, said, "You should ask about what happened to the amount that was promised to those arrested in other cases", implying that the shooters in the Salman Khan firing, Baba Siddique murder and Rohit Shetty firing had not been paid by the gang.

Many accused got no legal help either; the few lawyers who took up the cases say they did it *pro bono*.

A lawyer, who represents two of the accused in the Baba Siddique case, says he took up their case after he got to know, through another of his clients in jail, that the two were in bad shape. "They would do some work for other inmates, like washing clothes and cleaning their cells, in exchange for some money to be able to afford essential items from the canteen. While jail rules allow families to send money orders, these two got no financial help from their relatives," says the lawyer.

Another lawyer says that while the family members of his client approached him to take up the case, they were "too poor to afford visits to Mumbai. The family sends money for legal fees, as and when they can".

In some cases, like Gurmail Singh's, who was arrested in the Baba Siddique case, the families slowly drift away.

Gurmail was nine when he lost his father, a labourer; his mother died a few years ago.

At his 80-square-foot house, in a lane inhabited by the Dalit families of Narar village in Haryana's Kaithal district, his 82-year-old grandmother, Phulli Devi, says she is tired of her grandson's ways. "It would have been better had he died. What more can I say?"

She says Singh occasionally called her from a Mumbai jail, but she did not wish to speak to him. "I never went to Mumbai to meet him," she says.

In Sonipat, anger, shame

The Tiger Shroff case has exposed a recruitment conduit running through villages in Haryana's Sonipat district.

Nine of the 11 arrested hail from different villages and localities in the district. The two women, Radha and Babita, originally from Uttar Pradesh, had also been living in Sonipat, where they worked as sales persons. Hrithik Mahato, alias Roshan, from Bihar, was the only accused without an identified Sonipat connection.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Sonipat Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime) Jitender Gahlawat said, "Some of these youngsters get into gang activities as a way out of their troubles. They get influenced by gun culture and the violence they see on reels and movies. The gangsters tap into this while reaching out to them."

He says police have identified "12 highly sensitive and 20 medium-sensitive villages in Sonipat that are prone to such activities. We are in the process of running counselling and awareness programmes."

At the homes of some of the accused that *The Indian Express* visited in Sonipat's Kharkhoda and Rohna villages, there are heavy silences, pleadings of innocence, or outbursts of anger.

At a one-storey house in Kharkhoda, 21 km from Sonipat town, the parents of Jatin Panchal insist he did no wrong.

Jatin, 27, was arrested along with Ankit Khatak and Sameer Khatri, with the three accused of being reconnaissance operatives who surveyed the residences of celebrities in Mumbai ahead of the attack on Tiger Shroff.



(Above, left) Surendera, father of Aman Sunder Mudtiya, who was arrested in the Tiger Shroff case, at Rohna in Sonipat; in the same village, family members of Kunal blame him for bringing disrepute

Salman Khan house firing

- **6 persons**, including the 2 shooters, arrested for firing outside the actor's Bandra (West) home on April 14, 2024. Lawrence Bishnoi is named as an accused
- 5 of the 6 still behind bars. Anuj Thapan died by suicide while in custody
- Trial has begun. Witness depositions are ongoing

Baba Siddique murder

- 27 arrested for murder of former Maharashtra minister Baba Siddique in Bandra East, Mumbai, on October 12, 2024. Lawrence's younger brother Anmol named as an accused
- 1 out on bail
- Recording of evidence and witness testimony is ongoing

Rohit Shetty house firing

- 15 arrested on charges of attempt to murder, accused of firing on director Rohit Shetty's Juhu home on Feb 1, 2026
- Trial has not begun

Attack on Tiger Shroff

- 13 arrested, including three women
- 6 are in police custody; the others are in judicial custody
- Police filed a case of attempt to murder, along with other charges

"Jatin has no connection with any gangster, and nobody like that ever visited our house," says his father Kishan, who runs a small welding unit from home. "Police have not given us any information about where he is or what charges he faces."

His mother Renu, 50, says that on October 21, the day her son was arrested, she had just returned from the Post Graduate Institute of Medical Sciences (PGIMS) in Rohtak, where she was being treated for gallbladder stones. She had hoped Jatin would come out and help take her indoors; instead, she found police officers taking him away.

She says Jatin tried to reassure her. "He told me, 'Mummy, I swear on you, I have done no wrong.'"

That was the last time either of his parents spoke to him.

His parents say that after his Class 12, Jatin earned a BA degree through distance learning from Rohtak, cleared a computer certification course, and studied stenography at an ITI. He also worked at a hotel in Sonipat, but left over a dispute and began assisting his father at the welding unit.

Around two months ago, he bought a car, which, police allege, his co-accused Kunal, 21, used for reconnaissance ahead of the shooting. Investigators also allege that Kunal collected a pistol and 20 live rounds from Amritsar, and persuaded Radha, "a woman he was in a relationship with", to transport the weapon to Mumbai by train with her alleged accomplice, Babita.

Kilometres away, at Kunal's home in Rohna village, the family is busy with preparations for his sister's December 4 wedding.

His 62-year-old grandfather, Sajjan, is angry and upset at the "shame" Kunal has brought on the family. "We are daily wagers, we don't have land that will make us rich overnight. It has become hard to satisfy all the needs that youngsters have. They do not want to slog like us, and want easy cash and will do anything for it," Sajjan says.

Calling Kunal "lazy and inconsiderate", his grandmother Maya says, "All I hope is that he doesn't turn up in handcuffs at his sister's wedding."

Neighbours and family members talk of Kunal's earlier brushes with violence — an alleged firing incident and a hit-and-run — but say he was never arrested.

Since Kunal's 19-year-old cousin, Aman Sunder Mudtiya, was arrested in the Tiger Shroff case, the family blames him for being a "bad influence". Aman, who dropped out after Class 10, worked at a sales counter in Kharkhoda, selling health supplements.

While investigators say they zeroed in on Aman after detecting two money transfers that Kunal had made into his cousin's bank account — Rs 15,000, followed by Rs 25,000 — his family maintains he was duped.

The two alleged shooters arrested in the case are also teenagers from Sonipat: 18-year-old Rehan Rahisuddin Ansari, a welder and Class 9 dropout, and a "19-year-old", who claimed in court that he is only 17 and should be tried as a minor.

"We have nothing to do with Rehan or his family anymore," says his uncle Mausam Khan.

Other Sonipat residents named in the case include Ankit Khatak, 18, and Sameer Khatri, and Pranjal Thakran, a 22-year-old wrestler with an engineering diploma who was arrested in Indore.

The Haryana Police, who questioned Ankit, say he sounded angry and upset with those who had involved him in the operation. A police official quotes him as saying, "*Unhone mujhe kasam diya tha ki tera naam nahi lenge. Unhone mujhe marwa diya* (They had promised me that they would not take my name. They have got me killed)."

WEB EXCLUSIVE
Microsoft cuts: Is AI taking away our jobs?
— Ganesh Natarajan
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WORDLY WISE
Time flies over us, but leaves its shadow behind
— Nathaniel Hawthorne

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

A step back from edge, a breather for India

WITH THE BSE Sensex rising over 8.8 per cent during the week to close at 81,028 points, its highest level since February 27, the run-up to Diwali couldn't have been better. The rupee strengthened and settled below 94-to-the-dollar for the first time after April 22. Ten-year Indian government bond yields fell to 7.2 per cent, having almost touched 7.5 per cent last week. And foreign portfolio investors (FPI) have started putting in money again, making net purchases of around $4.1 billion in Indian equity markets so far this month. In January-October and all of 2025, they were net sellers to the tune of $23.2 billion and $18.9 billion respectively.

There are three primary drivers behind the seeming turnaround. The first is, of course, Brent crude prices easing to sub-$100 per barrel, from last week's highs of $118. It comes in the wake of the emphatic wins of Democrats in the US midterms. The results alleviate, for now at least, worries of a military escalation against Iran by the Donald Trump administration and even raise expectations of a diplomatic resolution to the conflict in West Asia. Cheaper oil and the Democrats securing control of both houses have reduced inflation risks and also the threat from new tariff actions by the US based on Trump's "aggressive unilateralism". These have lowered 10-year US Treasury yields to 4.8-4.9 per cent from last month's near-5.4 per cent highs. The drop in US bond yields has come alongside a global sell-off in AI and semiconductor stocks, amid concerns over Democratic Congressmen seeking greater regulatory scrutiny of the industry and potential moratoriums on the construction of data centres.

All these are seen as positive developments for the Indian economy. The rupee has been under pressure from elevated crude and energy prices as well as capital pull-out by FPIs. India's limited foundational AI and chip manufacturing capabilities have meant that it has not attracted the capital flows, which have been heavily concentrated around the big hardware mega-cap tech companies. The very factors that were negative and redirecting capital away from India (high oil prices, soaring global bond yields and relative lack of direct AI play) have now turned favourable. That offers a breather for Indian policymakers who have been trying to arrest the slide in the rupee and lift sentiment in the market. But they need to still watch out for other risks — El Niño and a renewed flaring up of geopolitical tensions. This is the time to double down on macroeconomic stability and policy continuity, which investors would ultimately value.

Retrieving common ground in America

THROUGHOUT THE rise and consolidation of Trumpism, explicitly or as unsubtle subtext, the foundation of Make America Great Again (MAGA) has been a repudiation of diversity and fair representation. Attacks on "DEI", women, people from "sh*****e countries", minorities and migrants went hand in hand with demonising establishment liberals and centrists as out-of-touch with "authentic" Americans. No doubt, some of Donald Trump's positions had wide resonance. They might even continue to echo among MAGA supporters. That said, the Democratic sweep in the midterms holds broader lessons. The centre in America appears to have moved beyond the cold arithmetic of demographic sums to reinvigorating the idea of an umbrella coalition, in which there is a recognition of common ground and shared stakes.

Between the Senate, the House of Representatives, and executive offices, after this week's election, US politics is at its most diverse. Abdul El-Sayed is the country's first Muslim senator, Chris Papas the first openly gay senator, and Peggy Flanagan the first Native American. America will have five Black governors serving simultaneously for the first time, and Hakeem Jeffries, the front-runner for Speaker, may well be the first African-American to hold the office. Nithya Raman, mayor-elect of Los Angeles, joins Zohran Mamdani as a South Asian at the head of one of the country's most important cities. They campaigned around issues that cut across traditional divides — the cost-of-living crisis, war with Iran, corruption. These diverse leaders on Democratic tickets have breached Republican bastions.

Trumpism was about appealing to working-class voters through nostalgia and nativism. The new liberal politics seems successful in wooing a large swathe of those voters back, by refusing to be trapped into playing the opponent's game. For the better part of a decade, liberal politicians across democracies have struggled to articulate a politics that is representative of diversity and also universal in its themes. A viral video from El-Sayed's campaign trail offers an answer. Asked by a conservative voter to denounce the Muslim Brotherhood, El-Sayed interrogates the very premise of the question, "I am not running to be a Muslim senator, I'm running for US Senate and I happen to be Muslim."

A bird out of time

IN HIS novel *Einstein's Dreams*, physicist Alan Lightman imagines worlds where time misbehaves — it loops, stalls, or runs at different speeds from one place to the next. The people who live in them must cope with the gap between the hour they feel and the hour the world keeps. Lightman's universe was a fantasy but for the global citizen, jet lag is an existential hazard, the price paid for crossing meridians in pursuit of commerce or pleasure. The Manx shearwater, it turns out, knows it, too. Research by ecologists at Oxford University, drawing on two decades of GPS tracking, suggests that the wild migratory seabirds that breed in burrows on windswept islands off Britain and winter in South America can lose their bearings when rapid eastward flights leave their circadian rhythm out of step with local time.

The explanation lies in the delicate balance between biology and astronomy, the scientists write in an article in *Nature*. Shearwaters use the Sun as a navigational reference, interpreting its position through an internal sense of time. But when the body clock fails to keep pace with the Earth's rotation, the compass becomes misleading, including even when the birds follow a coastline, where familiar landmarks could act as markers. Experienced adult birds appear better equipped to compensate, drawing on navigational knowledge accumulated over the years. Younger birds are more vulnerable, sometimes straying hundreds of kilometres off course.

The discovery carries a profound implication about the importance of the Sun in anchoring a migratory avian's sense of direction. But the shearwater's predicament is also a lesson in humility, in learning to go easy on one's certainties. One may know one's destination but still be hopelessly lost.

Tackling air pollution requires science-based plan, not just GRAP



GUFRAN BEIG

IT IS heartening to note the seriousness with which authorities have planned a slew of measures under Delhi's Winter Action Plan, which commenced on November 1. These include restrictions on the entry of Delhi vehicles that do not comply with BS-IV standards, the "No PUCC, No Fuel" policy and construction curbs. However, the first day of the Action Plan brought a dose of despair: The air turned "Very Poor" after a prolonged pause, reminding us that something vital is still missing. While authorities appear prepared to implement the Action Plan, experts must do more to ensure that it is firmly grounded in science.

Two major concerns demand serious attention: An immediate shift towards airshed-based mitigation and a decisive move away from quick fixes and removing the illusion that GRAP, by itself, can deliver meaningful and sustained reductions in air pollution. I shall elaborate on these shortly.

Weather vagaries are increasingly emerging as formidable factors that influence air quality under rapidly changing climate conditions. This year, the onset of Delhi's peak pollution season has been delayed by almost two weeks, with Super El Niño potentially playing a leading role. Let us understand why. Cyclone Arnab and its associated unexpected rainfall further delayed its onset. At the heart of this unusual delay was a climatic tug-of-war between sluggish wind speeds and the delayed onset of a milder winter. While slow winds favour pollution accumulation, a delayed and milder winter tends to keep pollution levels relatively lower. Both phenomena are possible footprints of the unprecedented Super El Niño — they are consistent with recent NIAS research which demonstrates a strong connection between ENSO and air pollution. The delayed winter appears to have won the first round, keeping pollution in check and pushing back the onset of the poor air season.

Paddy harvesting in neighbouring Punjab and Haryana was also delayed because of the uncertainty caused by rainfall deficits. NASA's MODIS sensors aboard Terra and Aqua may continue to miss many stubble-burning fires because the satellites pass over Punjab and Haryana at times when the fires are not yet burning or have already died down. This mismatch has become much more pronounced since 2023, making NASA fire counts increasingly unreliable. According to reliable reports, more than 90 per cent of stubble-burning events in Punjab during 2024 and 2025 occurred after 3 PM, compared with less than 3 per cent in 2021. South Korea's Korea Multi-Purpose Satellite-2A (KOMPSAT-2A) is beginning to reveal a substantially different picture through its Advanced Meteorological Imager (AMI), which, being geostationary, maps areas continuously. It is detecting abundant agricultural fires in Punjab, with fire counts orders of magnitude higher than those indicated by official estimates. NIAS air-quality modelling further reinforces this concern. When realistic additional stubble-burning emissions are incorporated, the model reproduces the abrupt rise in measured PM2.5 levels observed on November 1, attributing approximately 20 per cent of Delhi's PM2.5 burden to stubble burning. Such a magnitude of pollution cannot be adequately predicted using historical averages of recent years' fire data or NASA's conventional fire counts. After all, any model can deliver realistic predictions only when supplied with realistic real-world inputs. The sooner authorities recognise this changing ground reality and subscribe to appropriate satellite data, the sooner we can improve emissions estimates and air-quality forecasts. Proper diagnosis is the prerequisite for effective treatment, and air-pollution management is no exception.

> Two concerns demand serious attention: An immediate shift towards airshed-based mitigation and a decisive move away from quick fixes

On the policy front, unless Delhi adopts an airshed-based approach, it would effectively address only 50-70 per cent of the emission sources impacting the city, even before accounting for the additional contribution from stubble burning. A recent NIAS study, undertaken under a project of the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India, proposes a paradigm shift in India's air-quality management through an indigenous framework, "AIRSHEDEM". It demonstrates how airshed-based master planning can potentially bring mitigation planning closer to a near-100 per cent source coverage. This approach focuses on a pragmatic middle ground that is neither the entire NCR nor restricted to Delhi NCT. This could provide a scientifically sound and administratively feasible framework for effective mitigation.

The second issue is GRAP. I see a compelling clinical analogy here: GRAP is akin to an ICU intervention for a chronic patient. Emergency treatment is essential to stabilise the patient and provide immediate relief, but it cannot cure the underlying disease. It also comes at the cost of repeated public inconvenience. A science-based action plan requires focused, sustained treatment of the diagnosed causes. Similarly, GRAP's emergency restrictions are necessary when pollution peaks, but they cannot substitute for structural, long-term emission reduction. That is the key.

The next 30-40 days are likely to be particularly challenging. Stubble burning, unstable early-winter meteorology and intermittent high-emission episodes could continue to haunt Delhi's air quality. The prospect of these factors converging in the second week of November is high. The next two months may prove even more difficult as deeper winter brings local fog as well as fog carried into Delhi from the Indo-Gangetic Plain, potentially worsened by an ENSO-related decline in western disturbances — the weather systems that periodically bring rain and atmospheric relief. Combined with significantly slower winds, these conditions could leave Delhi's atmosphere choked. Of course, year-round priorities must not be lost sight of amid the seasonal crisis. Traffic congestion at junctions, poorly maintained roads, ineffective traffic management and open waste burning remain persistent sources of pollution that demand sustained attention. Delhi needs to move beyond repeatedly managing pollution episodes towards addressing their underlying causes through comprehensive airshed-based planning, sustained emission reduction and science-based policy implementation.

The writer is chair professor, National Institute of Advanced Studies, IISc Campus, and founder project director, SAFAR

To attract foreign capital, welcome it loudly and clearly



NIHARIKA YADAV

NET FDI in India has gone down from $40 billion in FY2021 to effectively zero in FY2025. There are attempts to address this, including a rationalisation of the foreign investment framework through the draft Foreign Investment Rules (FI Rules) released by the RBI. The draft Rules are a mixed bag, with some positive changes such as shorter sections, an investee-centred framework and harmonised definitions. However, these are operational revisions that are in themselves insufficient for achieving the RBI's objective of creating a "contemporary, user-friendly investment framework" or materially improving India's investment climate. The binding constraint is India's suspicious approach towards foreign capital, and it requires a deeper, first-principles overhaul of the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA).

To make progress on global economic engagement, the Indian state needs to do two things. One, it should signal, loud and clear, to foreign funds evaluating competing emerging market options that capital is welcome in India. Two, it should keep the friction between a commercial decision and its execution near zero. These objectives are hard to reconcile with the present law. Under Section 6 of FEMA, capital account transactions remain prohibited unless specifically permitted by the RBI or the government, so everything built above it, including the draft FI Rules, essentially serves as a schedule of exceptions to a default state of restriction.

India operates an extended web of capital controls under FEMA. Foreign capital is prohibited in sectors such as real estate business, and capped in others such as digital media, broadcasting, multi-brand retail and pensions. This makes India an outlier among significant economies, alongside China. No OECD country maintains general capital and exchange controls, and even emerging economies such as Chile and Mexico have avoided transaction-by-transaction regulation of the capital account.

Even in fully open sectors, the Indian state regulates individual transactions between private parties, prescribing the instrument the money may come through, the legal form the recipient may take, and the price the parties may agree on. For instance, transfers of unlisted shares between residents and non-residents require certified valuations before transaction, with the draft FI Rules further narrowing the latitude. This can force parties to transact at mandated prices rather than negotiate commercially, causing serious friction. If the concern is tax evasion, it should be addressed after the transaction, not through ex-ante controls.

These difficulties were papered over in earlier years and avoided scrutiny due to global interest in India and low interest rates worldwide. However, the same gaps are creating significant economic problems today and require a better design of the FEMA. Much of this work has been done in existing expert committee reports by Tarapore, Percy Mistry, U K Sinha, and the FSLRC.

Three key principles follow.

First, any restriction on capital flows should be exercised with caution, imposed temporarily, based on publicly stated objectives, and used as an emergency measure for managing macroeconomic risk. For national security objectives, screening mechanisms should be set up with adequate checks and balances. This should bring together departments with competing mandates to weigh the national security risk against the cost of restricting capital. Press Note 3, for instance, which restricts investment by nationality, should not have been issued by DPIIT alone, whose mandate is to promote investment. The US and UK offer good examples in the CFIUS and Investment Security Unit, respectively.

Second, rulemaking should involve public consultation, cost-benefit analysis and review. The FSLRC argues that restrictions should operate principally at the point of entry, and that once entry requirements are satisfied, foreign investors should receive national treatment comparable to domestic investors.

Third, controls should be tested against three criteria: Neutrality as to the vehicle through which money enters, neutrality as to who is investing, and a discipline tying each restriction to an identified market failure.

Restrictions on capital carry costs that emerge slowly, as investments not made and firms not built. India's approach must internalise this through a first-principles overhaul of its primary foreign exchange statute. Without that, tactical adjustments such as the draft FI Rules are unlikely to alter the status quo.

> Restrictions on capital carry costs that emerge slowly, as investments not made and firms not built. India's approach must internalise this through a first-principles overhaul of its primary foreign exchange statute

The writer is research lead, XKDR Forum

Don't light up the lung, weigh down the heart



SHASHANK R JOSHI

THE RIG Veda reminds us that the lamp is the supreme light of consciousness. Diwali was meant to mark the victory of light over darkness, not to fill our skies with sulphur and our plates with excess the body cannot absorb. This year, it arrives against the backdrop of India's rising burden of non-communicable diseases. The question is what we are willing to accept in the name of celebration. Two pressures converge: The food we eat and the air we breathe. Both are now measurable drivers of diabetes, heart disease, lung disease and metabolic deterioration. Neither needs to be abandoned. Both need to be reclaimed.

For many families, Diwali sweets have shifted from occasional prasad to a multi-day pattern of high-sugar, high-fat foods prepared in reused oils. In a country with over 100 million people living with diabetes and several hundred million more at high risk, and where polycystic ovary syndrome affects a substantial share of young women, this pattern is not neutral. Clinics see the same sequence every year: A rise in glucose levels, triglycerides, blood pressure and weight that does not fully reverse.

The second pressure is the air. Firecrackers produce sharp, multi-fold rises in fine particulate matter and other pollutants within hours. People with asthma, chronic lung disease, heart disease or diabetes experience higher rates of breathlessness, emergency visits and cardiac events in the days that follow.

These two exposures do not act in isolation. Air pollution contributes to insulin resistance and vascular injury. Excess sugar and unhealthy fats drive inflammation. Sleep disruption, alcohol and the ordinary stress of the season amplify both. The result is a short, concentrated period in which the conditions that already account for a large share of India's disease burden are allowed to accelerate. Public-health campaigns that speak of a healthier India cannot treat this week as an exception.

A few practical shifts are available to households and local authorities. Lighting oil lamps rather than bursting firecrackers preserves the visual and symbolic core of the festival while sharply reducing particulate emissions; it also sustains traditional potters. Limiting *mithai* to a small, defined amount each day, and preferring preparations based on besan, ragi, nuts or dates over those heavy in maida, khoya and deep-frying, keeps the pleasure without the sustained glycaemic and lipid burden. Municipalities and housing societies can designate quieter, lower-emission zones and support community light displays that do not rely on combustion. Clear, tobacco-style health warnings on high-sugar sweets and on firecrackers would treat these products with the same candour already applied to other recognised health risks.

Diwali marks the defeat of forces that diminish life. The contemporary forces that diminish life most widely are not only external; they include the patterns of consumption and emission that we have normalised. We can still light the lamps that the tradition actually asked for. We can still share food that nourishes rather than burdens. The choice is available this year, as it is every year. The light that matters most is the one that does not leave soot in the lungs of the next generation.

Shubh Deepavali.

> The result is a short, concentrated period in which the conditions that already account for a large share of India's disease burden are allowed to accelerate

The writer is an endocrinologist and public health physician based in Mumbai

40 YEARS AGO
November 7, 1986



Foreign assets amnesty

THE GOVERNMENT announced a Foreign Exchange Regulation Act amnesty scheme enabling Indian nationals and companies to voluntarily disclose their assets abroad without attracting prosecution. In a statement in Parliament, Finance Minister V P Singh invited all concerned to furnish declarations .

Central assistance for J&K

PRIME MINISTER Rajiv Gandhi rounded off his visit to Jammu and Kashmir by holding out a promise of liberal central assistance for all-round development of the state, which, he said, has suffered immensely because of the rivalry between the National Conference and the Congress (I). The PM said he had joined hands with Farooq Abdullah so the two parties could put their combined energy into raising people's standard of living.

India on US AWACS for Pakistan

THE PROPOSED supply of the sophisticated Airborne Warning and Control Systems (AWACS) aircraft by the US to Pakistan poses a "serious problem" for India, admitted Natwar Singh, Minister of State for External Affairs, in the Lok Sabha. He said the potentialities of AWACS were "mind-boggling". India felt that whenever arms were supplied to Pakistan by the US, it had been the victim.

Police atrocities in Idukki

A BROODING stillness wraps the blue-green hills of Thankamani, 42 km from Idukki in Kerala's high ranges. The mountains still reverberate with the moans of molested women and children who were victims of the rampage of an infuriated police force last month. "I will never forget that night," says Rosamma, tears coursing down her cheeks. The police's midnight raids followed an alleged hijacking of a bus that belonged to a Kerala Congress supporter.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

Europe can expect little from Trump's midterm defeat

— Le Monde, France

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Agnipath revision must be judged by what it does to institution it was meant to reform



SUDHIR PILLAI

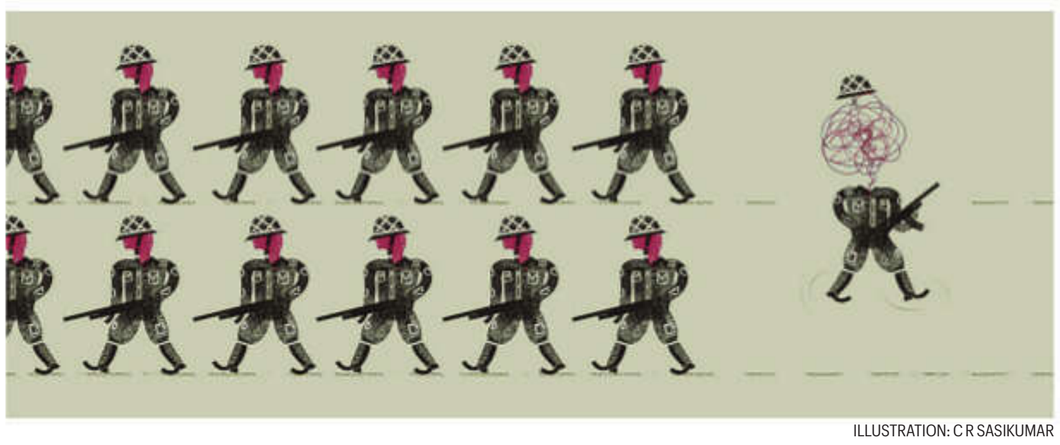


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

AT TWO in the morning, in a rolling sea, a warship's machinery has a defect. On a ridge in Ladakh, a radar goes dark. On a flight line, an aircraft is grounded by a fault that few technicians can trace. The repair depot and manufacturer's support are far away. Someone on the spot must find the fault and put things right.

In the Indian Navy, that person was often a member of a specialised cadre, the artificers. He began with four years of apprenticeship and spent much of the next two decades acquiring the judgement of a Chief Artificer: Knowing how machinery behaved at sea, in rough weather, and not merely how the manual said it should. Agnipath has brought technical entry under the same four-year tenure as everyone else. The old apprenticeship alone lasted as long as an Agniveer's entire engagement.

On November 4, the Union Cabinet approved a second, two-year engagement for the 75 per cent of Agniveers otherwise due to leave after four years. For some 18,000 Agniveers approaching discharge, this is welcome relief, and the government deserves credit. But the decision changes the scheme more fundamentally than the assurance of its continuity suggests.

Agnipath rested on three propositions: Rapid turnover would lower the forces' average age; limiting regular absorption to 25 per cent would restrain pension liabilities; and the remaining 75 per cent would return to civilian life with savings, skills and preferential employment.

The revision unsettles all three. If most Agniveers now serve six years before entering regular service, the intended age profile and pension savings require recalculation.

Civilian reintegration is no clearer. The Chief of Defence Staff suggests that wider opportunities within the forces remove the need for reserved vacancies in the police and paramilitary forces. Yet regular absorption remains conditional. Those rejected after six years will enter the civilian job market two years older, potentially without the employment support originally promised.

Military effectiveness depends on recruits becoming skilled operators, supervisors and eventually the junior leaders on whom units rely. Each step beyond Seaman, Rifleman or Aircraftsman brings greater competence, responsibility and authority. The badges signify a professional progression, not merely seniority.

An Agniveer cannot advance through this structure during the initial engagement. By year six, a batchmate absorbed at four will have spent two years in regular service, with access to professional courses, promotion opportunities and the accompanying pay progression. The Cabinet promises unspecified "seniority benefits" for those serving a second engagement, though the CDS says they will rank below the 25 per cent first chosen. It leaves unclear whether they will enjoy comparable opportunities for training, advancement and remuneration.

Military effectiveness depends on recruits becoming skilled operators, supervisors and eventually the junior leaders on whom units rely. Each step brings greater competence, responsibility and authority

Technical trades expose a deeper change. The former Artificer Apprentice entered after Class XII and underwent four years of naval apprenticeship before progressing through an established technical career. The new Agniveer (Apprentice) arrives with a three-year civilian engineering diploma, receives naval training and must subsequently qualify for regular service. The difference lies not simply in educational qualifications, but in how the Navy develops and retains technical competence. A diploma provides the foundations; mastery of a warship's machinery comes through sustained training, experience and responsibility.

There is a legal dimension too. In *Ex Navy Direct Entry Artificers Association v Union of India* (2018), the Supreme Court noted that the four-year apprenticeship of Apprentice Entry Artificers had been counted towards pension eligibility. The judgment does not govern Agnipath, but underscores why the distinction between training, engagement and pensionable service matters. Will an Agniveer's years before regular enrolment count towards qualifying service, or will the pension clock begin only upon absorption?

Chris Demchak's *Military Organizations, Complex Machines* explains why technical competence becomes more consequential as equipment grows sophisticated. Complex machines demand specialised knowledge that cannot be readily replaced. The Indian Navy invests years developing such expertise, which civilian and foreign employers readily value. Former artificers have served in Oman's royal yacht fleet and air force.

Agnipath itself recognises the need for exceptions, exempting certain medical technical cadres whose professional skills take years to develop. Avionics, radar maintenance and marine engineering demand comparable rigour. Having served as Class Authority for naval aviation, I wonder how those responsible for technical standards reconcile shortened career pathways with the demands of safety, reliability and operational readiness.

The Cabinet cites an objective assessment but does not show whether Agnipath has delivered the force structure, competence or savings promised. Christopher Paparone's *The Sociology of Military Science* reminds us that military reforms must be examined through evidence and their consequences, not merely their stated intentions.

The assessment belongs before Parliament's Standing Committee on Defence. Retention should reflect the requirements of individual services and trades, with appropriate protection for technical cadres. Six-year selection criteria must be published early. Second-engagement Agniveers need access to professional training and advancement, alongside clarity on how their service counts towards promotion, qualifying service and pension. Seniority alone cannot settle these questions.

Agnipath was conceived as military reform, not simply a recruitment contract. Its revision must, therefore, be judged by what it does to the institution and its capacity to fight the nation's wars.

The armed forces can purchase sophisticated machines. They cannot purchase the years of experience needed to understand them. That competence must be grown, and four years, or even six, is not enough.

The writer is a former Flag Officer Naval Aviation, Indian Navy

Gen Z and the politics of spontaneity are here to stay



SAGARIKA GHOSE

OUT OF protest and agitation, a new grammar of politics has been born. Two defining images capture this shift. On her visit to Delhi to join the INDIA rally at Ramlila Maidan, former Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, a street fighter for five decades, made it a point to meet Abhijit Dipke of the Cockroach Janta Party and applaud the Gen Z activists. During the Opposition protests, 29-year-old CPI(ML) leader Neha Bora strode out in front with Rahul Gandhi. India's democracy has discovered the power of a young and impatient demographic that no party can afford to ignore.

Today, Gen Z — at least one in every four eligible voters will be aged 18-29 in 2029 — is helping shape the political conversation and even, as seen in Tamil Nadu, determining election outcomes. Chief Minister Vijay may have benefitted from his superstar appeal but his defining badge was his freshness, a leader who wasn't weighed down by family legacy, divisive rhetoric or ideological dogmas. Simple messaging through Insta reels trumped the traditional Dravidian pitch.

Indian politics has always belonged to the veterans. With a few exceptions, it has been a closed-door, senior establishmentarian club, and youthful leaders have been viewed with suspicion. The young have been followers, youth have mostly waved flags, filled maidans and shouted *zindabad*. Every party has a youth outfit, but these have not usually taken leadership roles.

A 76-year-old prime minister, Narendra Modi, talks of "*yuva shakti*" but his cabinet has only one minister under the age of 40. Even when Modi addresses a college-going audience, he uses the youth as a mute backdrop to strut his own personality cult. In 2014 when Modi first stormed to power, first-time voters chose the BJP over Congress by two to one. Twelve years later, a generation that has come of age under Modi is out on the streets. The young are India's most restless constituency.

Some political figures have given youth their due. Sanjay Gandhi bears a contested legacy, but was the pioneer of youth politics, putting the Youth Congress at the centre of power. Rajiv Gandhi, PM at 40, encouraged young leaders and lowered the voting age to 18. Yet the true precedent of youth activism was Mamata Banerjee, a Youth Congress firebrand who, at 29, defeated the Left stalwart Somnath Chatterjee in Jadavpur in 1984.

Today more and more public space is being seized by younger voices. Why? The first reason is the media revolution. Instagram and the new media have democratised the public square. In an era of "hyper politics" and "hyper media" — where communication and activism connect with individuals rather than mass audiences, a meme travels faster than an old-style rally. The online world is lively, young and free of gatekeepers. Neha Bora as well as the CJP are Instagram sensations. On NEET, the cockroaches captured the pulse because they gave students a new language, a new identity and a new way to claim the power of citizenship. Be a cockroach, be fearless, challenge the mighty and laugh a lot. Satire and laughter are subversive, liberating devices. Staid public discourse is helpless against their power.

The second reason is that issues have changed. Old-style politics is all too often trapped in debates that don't resonate. It is jobs, examinations, and the right to free expression that define young lives. The examination is a life event and a leaked paper is a fundamental betrayal. These are issues that are slowly cutting across the old divides. Caste and religion remain important, but they can no longer be assumed. A leaked paper does not check your surname. Identity politics alone cannot reassure a generation whose anxieties rise above it.

The third reason is the rise of the politics of spontaneity. The trope that the youth always follow the leader is collapsing. The long, rambling speech is dying. Communication must be quick, authentic and real. This is politics without hierarchies. The young want leaders who do not talk down to them, but are with them.

This cannot be achieved through choreography of the Modi kind. At the SRCC centenary in September, Modi arrived by Metro, and called the college's alumni "OG". In July, Modi's midnight vertical video became a meme by morning. That brand of politics is, at heart, anti-young: The audience is expected to watch, never to talk back or ask questions. A generation raised on filters can recognise a filter when it sees one.

The energies of the young are indispensable to the Opposition's campaign for the restoration of democracy. Yet spontaneity also needs deliberation. A meme can remove a minister but winning a constituency takes organisation. That is what the established parties can still offer when they share the ticket and the stage. The new grammar has a simple first lesson for the old guard. Stop talking. Start listening. It's done, Bro. Gen Z and the politics of spontaneity are here to stay.

The writer is MP, Rajya Sabha, All India Trinamool Congress

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Agnipath changes

THE DECISION to extend Agniveer retention by two more years is a welcome step. ('Revamped Agnipath casts a wide net', *IE*, November 6) However, the continued modifications in Agniveer retention might dissuade future entrants. Eventually, the government may have to reconsider the continuation of the Agnipath scheme itself. The Army faces a geographically diverse and challenging spectrum of potential battlefronts. There are legitimate concerns about whether the training imparted to Agniveer recruits is sufficiently comprehensive.

Parag Deshmukh, Thane

THE UNION cabinet's decision to offer an additional two-year engagement to the 75 per cent of the Agniveers not selected for regular service after four years is a welcome course correction ('Revamped Agnipath casts a wider net', *IE*, November 6). Together with a further opportunity for regular enrolment after six years, it addresses some of the career insecurity that fuelled resentment among aspirants. Its success, however, will depend on how transparent and consistent the criteria for regular enrolment prove to be.

S S Paul, Nadia

Stubble burning

PUNITIVE ACTIONS alone cannot be a panacea for stubble burning ('A new conversation is needed on farm fires' *IE*, November 6). The persistence of farm fires reflects a structural crisis — a narrow paddy-wheat cycle, rising cultivation costs, inadequate biomass markets, and time pressures between sowing and harvesting. Studies show that farmers are elastic to incentives, not merely regulations. As Ashok Gulati has consistently written in this paper, the solution lies in crop diversification, rationalising free power and water subsidies, and creating remunerative alternatives to paddy cultivation. The next quantum leap in agriculture will come when digital agri-markets, biomass industries and climate-smart farming make residue management more profitable than burning it.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow



RAM RAJYA

Rewind to what ITBP chief said, read the warning

BY RAM MADHAV

LAST MONTH, a leaked video of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) chief's address caused consternation in some circles. Shatrujeet Kapur, the outgoing chief of the paramilitary force, was heard in that now-withdrawn video calling China the "biggest adversary" and disclosing that a face-off with the Chinese forces "happened at several locations in Arunachal, and it still continues" in the last few weeks. Congress spokespersons accused the government of suppressing facts about the border situation and keeping the country in the dark. Party president Mallikarjun Kharge, too, questioned "clean chits to China" and took potshots at Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Everybody knows that the India-China border dispute is 65 years old. There have always been transgressions by the Chinese army along the 4,057-km-long Line of Actual Control (LAC) during that entire period. Even during the UPA regime, official reports disclosed that well over 600 "transgressions" — the government's euphemism for intrusions by the Chinese army — occurred along the LAC during 2010-2013. Defence minister A K Antony did not deny the reports. He instead chose to reassure the nation that its interests would be protected.

Such intrusions continued in later years, too. But the Modi government introduced an important shift in the border patrolling policy after the 2014 standoff. Starting with the Doklam tri-junction face-off in 2017, India not only engaged in diplomatic manoeuvres but resorted to strong ground posturing. The earlier practice of disengagement and withdrawal in the event of patrolling face-offs between the two sides was discarded. "Proactive diplomacy together with strong ground posturing" is the new mantra for border patrolling along the LAC.

What the Opposition missed in the ITBP chief's comments was his warning about the growing technological disparity between India and China

What the Opposition missed in the ITBP chief's comments was his warning about the growing technological disparity between India and China and the importance of technological preparedness. Capability matters more than parity. Two recent wars — the US-Iran conflict and the Ukraine-Russia War — tell us the story of how a weaker country can ward off a grave military threat from an adversary several times stronger militarily.

In the 1990s and 2000s, when China was a rising military power, it did not try to match the numbers of its military hardware with the US. Instead, it focused on developing the capability to counter the US's hardware in terms of ships and satellites. When the US deployed hundreds of spy satellites over Chinese Low Earth (LEO) and High Earth (HEO) Orbits, China did not look to match it in number of satellites. Instead, it developed ground-based laser systems that could "dazzle" or even "kill" those satellites. Similarly, to tackle the powerful US Navy, China did not rush to increase the number of its naval vessels. Instead, it developed sea-skimming supersonic missiles that can travel distances of up to 500 km unnoticed by enemy naval radar systems and destroy enemy ships and submarines. This capability of China led to the US Army designating several of its platforms, systems, and bases as "wasted assets."

The ITBP chief was suggesting that India should develop such drone and anti-drone capability. The DRDO has recently developed high-power laser-based directed-energy weapons (DEWs) that can track and destroy individual drones as well as drone swarms, a new threat mastered by India's adversaries.

"A nation's ability to fight a modern war is as good as its technological ability," Frank Whittle, the British RAF officer who invented the turbojet engine, once said. An apt quip for today.

The writer is national vice-president, BJP and president, India Foundation



SHAMA RANA

Red lipstick, floral nightie — society fixes rules for both

YEARS AGO, when I lived as a paying guest, my landlady spent most of her day in a nightie. She cooked, supervised the domestic help, received the milkman and exchanged neighbourhood intelligence in it. Within the house, the nightie enjoyed complete freedom. But beyond the main gate, she changed. Years later, I understood the ritual. The woman could cross the gate; the nightie could not.

A recent article ('Red lipstick: Make-up or manifesto', *IE*, October 25) got me thinking about the other end of this peculiar spectrum of female presentation. If red-stained lips scream "look at me", the nightie borders on "please don't". Acceptable femininity demands being attractive but not attention-seeking, comfortable but never careless. Earlier this year, a notice reportedly displayed at a UCO Bank branch in West Bengal went viral for asking customers not to enter wearing "half-pant and nightie". Perfectly acceptable beside a pressure cooker, the nightie loses social clearance at the front door.

The nightie staged a domestic revolution. It liberated women from sari pleats, petticoats, pins and the requirement to remain properly assembled while cooking, cleaning and caring. You pulled it over your head and got on with life. The complication began when somebody else could see it.

A friend once told me that during her pregnancy, the staircase in her house came with an unofficial dress code. Her in-laws lived downstairs, so she could spend the day upstairs in a nightie, but descending one flight required a wardrobe change. Pregnancy could alter the body, gait and centre of gravity; apparently, it could not alter the rules of propriety. Somewhere on the staircase, the nightie lost its character certificate.

The traditional nightie is loose, floral and generous with cloth. If it ever intended to scandalise society, it chose a remarkably inefficient business model. Still, Indian ingenuity found a solution — the humble dupatta. Throw one over a nightie and a cultural miracle occurs. Nothing underneath has changed, but the ensemble suddenly acquires respectable intentions. The nightie says, "I would like to be comfortable"; the dupatta hastily adds, "but I have not forgotten my values". Apparently, *sanskaar* can be layered.

It liberated women from sari pleats, petticoats, pins and the requirement to remain properly assembled while cooking, cleaning and caring

Consider the Indian man. He can descend in ancient shorts, a fading T-shirt and rubber slippers, buy milk, squeeze tomatoes and conduct a 20-minute seminar on geopolitics with the security guard. Nobody objects. He is simply Uncle, and Uncle needed tomatoes.

Then luxury loungewear arrived and exposed the absurdity. Satin pyjamas and expensive robes stroll through hotel lobbies. You have dressed very carefully to look as though you have not dressed at all. The Rs 400 floral nightie enjoys no such diplomatic immunity. Its Rs 4,000 cousin is "elevated loungewear", while the humble maxi raises eyebrows downstairs. The difference is not modesty; it is what class allows us to call fashionable.

Perhaps that is the nightie's real offence. It belongs to the uncurated woman — hair tied without strategy, face unprepared, stomach unheld, body relieved of the obligation to be visually pleasing. Most unforgivably, it does not care who is looking. The nightie reveals almost nothing of the body, but plenty about a woman who has decided not to dress for other people.

Red lipstick and the floral nightie live at opposite ends of the bedroom, one on the dressing table and the other in the cupboard, but society has written rules for both. The problem was never lipstick or nightwear. It was the expectation that a woman must continuously calibrate herself for other people's comfort.

My landlady understood that bargain without articulating it. Indian women have crossed classrooms, offices, courtrooms and boardrooms. The nightie is still negotiating the main gate.

Rana is a Gurgaon-based writer

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TRUMP ON AI: Will work with many states that want to become rich by having them

TRUMP MEDIA'S investors lost $2.2 bn, shareholders question their investment

DEMOCRATS PLANNING flood of AI bills when they take control of Congress

Midterm losses weaken Trump, but leave his grip on foreign policy intact

Trump will retain broad latitude to pursue goals on world stage

Reuters
Washington, November 6

THE REPUBLICAN Party's staggering losses at the ballot box this week have left President Donald Trump diminished in Washington and facing tougher legislative oversight and scrutiny of his agenda. But on foreign policy, he could remain unbowed.

Even as Democratic lawmakers seek to rein in the Republican president when they take control of Congress, Trump will retain broad latitude to pursue his objectives on the world stage, from Iran and Israel to Ukraine and China, during his final two years in office.

The central question, analysts say, is whether Trump will feel chastened by his party's poor showing in Tuesday's midterm elections or emboldened to take more dramatic steps to craft his legacy in US relations with friends and foes alike.

Most urgent is the intractable war against Iran, which Trump acknowledged on Wednesday contributed to his party losing both chambers of Congress.

He insisted, though, he had no regrets about attacking the Islamic Republic and it was essential to stop Tehran from acquiring a nuclear weapon, which it says it has never sought.

The midterms outcome illustrated voter backlash after eight months of conflict that have driven US gasoline prices up and his approval ratings down.



President Donald Trump speaks to mediapersons after signing an executive order in the Oval Office on Thursday. AP

Democrats had accused Republicans of ceding Congress' war-making powers and giving Trump a free hand internationally, not just against Iran but with his approach to Russia's war in Ukraine, his tariffs campaign, his capture of Venezuela's president, and deadly boat strikes off Latin America.

Senate Democratic leader Chuck Schumer told reporters on Wednesday his party's mandate is to put a check on "Trump's chaos at home and abroad" and end the Iran war.

That is easier said than done, given the extensive leeway with foreign policy and military operations presidents have long possessed. "A Democratic Congress has ability to stop Trump's domestic legislative agenda, but it doesn't have much ability to stop a president from exercising his powers as commander-in-chief," said William Wechsler, senior director of Middle East programs at Atlantic Council.

Democrats' main tools could be investigations, Trump nominees' confirmation hearings and funding authority to curb his foreign operations, but analysts say their leverage will be limited.

Taking control of Congress in January, Democrats will also seek to revive support for Ukraine, under pressure from Trump as it fights a 4-1/2-year-old Russian invasion.

Democrats hope to draw more Republicans into efforts to approve new aid to Ukraine and build a majority that could withstand a veto by Trump

Trump's lifting of sanctions on Russian diesel exports prompted criticism for reinforcing the impression that he was siding with Moscow.

Fed up with politics and struggle, young voters drive Republican losses

Sabrina Tavernise & Ruth Igielnik
November 6

ALIENATED BY an older generation of politicians who felt out of touch and irrelevant to their lives, young voters revolted on Tuesday, powering the rout of President Donald Trump's Republican Party.

In swings of monumental proportion, young men ages 18 to 29 veered toward Democratic candidates by nearly 40 percentage points since 2024, according to preliminary results from Times Voter Trends. Young women, who were already inclined to support Democrats, swung by 27 points. In the Texas Senate race, men ages 18 to 44 swung nearly 50 points toward the Democrat, James Talarico.

"He is my age," said Tristan Waumsley, 35, of Richmond, Texas, who voted straight Democratic at the state level for the first time in his life. "He sounded like I could have talked to him myself. He's somebody normal, like me."

Republicans have run Texas for years and not produced any real change in his life. With Talarico, he said, "maybe we can bring society forward, instead of regressing."

The youth movement swept in or bolstered politicians who looked more like them: Abdul El-Sayed, the senator-elect of Michigan; Rob Sand, governor-elect of Iowa; Sen. Jon Ossoff in Georgia; Nithya Raman, newly elected mayor of Los Angeles; and Sam Forstag, an incoming congressman from Montana.

And while the Democratic winners seem to be speaking their language, many voters under 45 — younger millennials and Generation Zers — were quick to say their support was not an ideological conversion, but granted temporarily to jump-start real change on the issues such as the cost of living, US relations with Israel and Iran war.

Though it felt unfamiliar to vote for Democrats, Waumsley said he was happy about his choice. But he emphasized that he was voting for the people, not the party, and that he would be watching them closely to make sure they followed through.

Discontent is spreading globally, fuelling youth movements from Bangladesh and India to Serbia and France. Governments have prioritised baby boomers through free healthcare and subsidised retirement, while education systems have been strained, health insurance costs have soared and older generations have held on to jobs. NYT



Nithya Raman

Nithya Raman defeats Bass in Los Angeles mayoral race

Reuters
Los Angeles, November 6

DEMOCRATIC SOCIALIST-backed candidate Nithya Raman defeated incumbent Karen Bass in a closely fought race for Los Angeles mayor.

Bass conceded on Thursday to one of the latest among a new wave of fast-rising democratic socialists and progressives who have dethroned centrist politicians in recent elections across the country.

Raman, a city council member, advocate for the homeless and onetime ally of Bass, stunned the political establishment in the second-largest US city when she challenged the mayor. She is the first Los Angeles mayoral candidate to defeat an incumbent since 2005. The India-born urban planner first won a seat on the Los Angeles City Council in 2020.

Raman has largely embraced comparisons to New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani, who was elected a year ago, while rejecting the idea that she is simply a West Coast replica. "I am different. I am myself," she told *Vanity Fair* in an interview.

Newsrooms targeted as European bomb threat wave widens

3rd day of airline threats this week, no devices found

Reuters
Budapest, Dublin, Prague, November 6

NEWSROOMS IN Ireland and Bulgaria received emailed bomb threats on Friday from a purported "Mikhail Andropov", claiming responsibility for a widening wave of hoax threats disrupting passenger flights across Europe.

The messages, sent to Bulgaria's *Nova TV* and the Irish public broadcaster *RTE*, which evacuated its offices and suspended programming, were headlined "Message to the West" and portrayed the threats as the prelude to a series of attacks on means of transport across Europe. The British broadcaster *Sky* also said it had received a security threat.

Reuters was not able to establish the identity of the sender, the origin of the emails, or whether they had in fact come from the same source as the threats to any or all of the dozens of flights affected since Tuesday.

But they added to concern among European officials that the hoaxes are part of a campaign of "hybrid" disruptions, which many have blamed on Russia, aimed at countries that have helped Ukraine. Moscow has denied involvement.

Spanish Foreign Minister Jose Manuel Albares said Europe appeared to be facing "hybrid aggression and a form of psychological warfare". No explosive devices were found and all planes, including those threatened Friday, landed safely.

Security experts said on Thursday that the threats might be intended to punish European nations that have armed or financed Ukraine as it resists the full-scale invasion Russia launched in 2022.

It was also possible, however, that individuals were laying false trails, issuing copycat threats or acting on personal grievances.



Police stand outside *RTÉ* offices after a bomb threat forced staff to evacuate the Irish broadcaster's Dublin premises on Friday. REUTERS

• BRIEFLY

Iran sends US nuclear proposal via Qatar, sets 7 conditions for talks

Reuters
Dubai, November 6

IRAN HAS sent the United States a nuclear proposal via Qatar, to be discussed only after Washington meets Tehran's seven demands, a senior Iranian official told *Reuters* on Thursday.

The official, who spoke on condition of anonymity, said the US was reviewing the proposal but declined to provide further details. Mediators have intensified efforts to end the war between Iran and the United States amid fears it could reignite after the US midterm elections, with Trump on Tuesday declining to rule out a resumption of combat operations after the vote and Iran planning wider retaliation if war resumes.

Iran's top security official Mohsen Rezaei had said earlier on Thursday, during a visit to Russia: "On the issue of diplomacy, we have announced seven conditions to the Americans. As long as they do not execute our seven conditions, we will neither open the Strait nor have negotiations".



Iranian government supporters at a rally in Tehran on Friday. REUTERS

Iran has demanded the lifting of US sanctions, the release of frozen Iranian assets and war reparations, among other conditions, while Washington has said nuclear issues must be part of any initial negotiations.

The US and Israel attacked Iran on February 28, and Iran responded with strikes on Israel and Gulf states that host US bases. Conflict also erupted in Lebanon between Iran-backed Hezbollah and Israel, and more recently spread to Yemen, from where the Iran-aligned Houthis have struck energy facilities, airports and other targets in Saudi Arabia.

Airstrikes on market in southwestern Yemen kill at least 30, say Houthis

Cairo: Airstrikes hit a market in southwestern Yemen on Friday, killing at least 30 people, according to an official with Iran-backed Houthi rebels.

A Houthi health ministry spokesperson, Anees Alsabahi, told Houthi-run TV *Al Masirah* that 15 people were also wounded in the airstrikes on the market in al-Waziyah in the province of Taiz. He said that the death toll was expected to rise from the airstrikes, which he blamed on Saudi-led coalition.

Local officials in Taiz acknowledged an attack on a busy market killed and wounded people, without providing details on the toll. REUTERS

UNITED STATES

Jay Rockefeller, heir to famed dynasty and healthcare advocate, dies at 89



Senator Jay Rockefeller

JOHN D "Jay" Rockefeller IV, the progeny of one of America's most famous and wealthiest families who during three decades in the US Senate sought expanded healthcare for the poor and excoriated President George W Bush's handling of the Iraq war, died aged 89 on Friday at his home in Washington, his wife Sharon Percy Rockefeller said. She added that plans were underway for a service at the Washington National Cathedral. Rockefeller, a tall, soft-spoken Democrat with liberal views, was elected in 1984 to the first of his five six-year terms representing West Virginia in the Senate after two terms as governor of the poor coal-mining state. Rockefeller voted in 2002 in favor of the Republican Bush's measure authorizing the Iraq war. REUTERS

Meghan Markle's father arrested on child sexual abuse material charge

Washington: Thomas Markle, father of Prince Harry's wife Meghan Markle, has been arrested for possessing child pornography, the US Justice Department said on Friday.

Markle, 82, of Lakeland, Florida, is charged with one count of possession of child pornography, the US Attorney's Office for the Central District of California said in a statement. He is expected to appear in court in Tampa on Friday.

"Mr. Markle is accused of possessing child sexual abuse material, including photographs depicting himself with minor girls," First Assistant United States Attorney Bill Essayli said. "These allegations are extremely serious, and we will prosecute Mr. Markle to the fullest extent of federal law."

A Justice Department official said the Federal Bureau of Investigation had arrested Thomas Markle. A spokesperson for Meghan Markle did not respond to a request for comment.

The *Daily Mail*, said Markle Sr was arrested at his senior living community in Lakeland over alleged possession of child sexual abuse material. Material was also found in a storage unit in Mexico as well as the Philippines, it reported Friday. REUTERS

Kenyan cult leader gets 200 years in jail for 191 murders

Mombasa: The leader of a Kenyan doomsday cult linked to the deaths of over 400 people was sentenced on Friday to 200 years in prison for the murders of 191 people.

The High Court in Kenya's coastal city of Mombasa issued the sentence for Pastor Paul Mackenzie. He was convicted of murdering 190 children and one adult after he ordered his followers to starve themselves to death in order to meet Jesus.

Justice Diana Kavedza said that Mackenzie, leader of Good News International Church, bore the "primary criminal culpability" for ordering his followers to fast to death. REUTERS

Zelenskyy presses Western allies for clear postwar security guarantees

Associated Press
Kyiv, November 6

UKRAINIAN PRESIDENT Volodymyr Zelenskyy says his government is seeking specific guarantees from Western allies on how post-war security support would function when the nearly five-year war sparked by Russia's full-scale invasion finally ends.

Zelenskyy's comments in an interview aired late Thursday followed two days of discussions among allies in Brussels that focused on postwar security and reconstruction. They also came before planned three-way talks next week in Abu Dhabi between Ukraine, Russia and the US, the first trilateral peace discussions since February.



President Volodymyr Zelenskyy

While talks on the contours of peace continue, the grim reality of war remained front and center Friday in Ukraine, with more Russian drone attacks and a rising death toll from Moscow's guided bomb strike Monday on a former school operating as a humanitarian aid center.

Russian overnight drone strikes caused extensive power outages in several regions, including the Kyiv area. Two days of talks in Brussels discussed postwar reconstruction, funding for 2027 and security guarantees backed by the Ukrainian government's Western allies.

The meetings brought together officials from the US, UK, France, Germany and the European Union, along with representatives from the World Bank and the US investment group BlackRock, Ukrainian lead negotiator Rustem Umerov wrote in an online post.

FRANCE

Bus carrying schoolchildren crashes, 2 killed

A BUS carrying children to school crashed Friday morning in eastern France, killing a 7-year-old girl and an 18-year-old boy, Transport Minister Philippe Tabarot said. Sixteen people were injured, three seriously, the prefecture in Ain said. Tabarot visited the scene in a rural area northeast of Lyon, where he described the crash as a "tragic accident" and expressed condolences to the victims' families. AP

CONGO

Militants kill 33, torch homes in overnight raid

ISLAMIC STATE-LINKED militants killed at least 33 people in an overnight attack on a village in eastern Congo, burning and looting homes, a local civil society group said Friday. The attack on Cantine, in North Kivu province, was blamed on Allied Democratic Forces, or ADF, Justin Paluku, head of a local civil society group, said. "We have counted 33 bodies and over 50 houses set on fire, along with various forms of material destruction." AP

• STATE BACKING HELPS DESPITE GRUELLING HOURS AND A.I. PLAYS A KEY ROLE; HACKERS GET PERKS LIKE APARTMENTS IN THE CAPITAL AND HARD CURRENCY

From classrooms to cyber heists: How North Korea builds its army of elite hackers

Reuters
Seoul, November 6

NORTH KOREA rewards top hackers behind heists including the $6.3 billion Binance crypto hack with Pyongyang apartments and cash awards.

Leader Kim Jong Un has built a hacking force through a programme selecting about 200 of the brightest schoolchildren annually for computer studies, defectors and analysts say. Some join the military's cyber unit, which has moved from illegal gambling websites to cryptocurrency heists.

"They are actually one of Kim Jong Un's secret weapons," said Kim Heung-kwang, a defector who trained state hackers before fleeing to South Korea in 2004. "There is no other country grooming hackers like this, systematically searching for the smartest children, solely to turn them into operatives," he said.

The FBI and Binance have blamed North Korea for the hack, an allegation Pyongyang denies. Blockchain investigation firms have attributed it to a North Korean group known as TraderTraitor. Pyongyang calls the accusations fabricated political provocations.

North Korea established a cyber unit in 1998. In 2013, Kim called cyberwarfare, alongside nuclear weapons and missiles, an "all purpose sword" crucial to its strike capability.

Selection begins as early as 11 or 12, with 150 to 200 pupils chosen annually to study computer science. At 17, top performers enter leading universities before a select few join the cyber unit, Kim and two IT defectors said.

Training covers cryptocurrency protocols, reverse-engineering foreign hardware, mathematics and languages, one defector said. Those not selected as hackers are trained to develop software and apps for Western firms through remote jobs.

North Korea channels top talent into nuclear and cyber programmes, "essentially guaranteeing their future", said Lim Jong-in, professor emeritus at Korea University.



Kim Jong Un has built a hacking force through a programme selecting about 200 of the schoolchildren annually for computer studies. REUTERS

Successful heists can earn the military up to 30% of the proceeds in dollars. Hackers may get Pyongyang flats, travel to China and join the ruling party or marry into elite families, defectors said.

The United States accused North Korea-linked Lazarus Group (APT38) of stealing hundreds of millions of dollars in cryptocurrency from the Ronin network in 2022. The FBI links TraderTraitor to Lazarus.

State backing makes the hackers harder to stop: they face few consequences for repeated attacks and can refine their methods, analysts said.

"In the world of cyber crime, often, if you make a mistake ... that is all law enforcement needs to get you," said Alec Zebrick, senior manager for Asia-Pacific global services at Chainalysis.

North Korean hackers keep going because international action against them is difficult, he said.

Groups that have dealt with North Korean IT workers describe them as organised, polite and avid AI users; many earn money for the regime through remote jobs at Western firms.

"AI is the very backbone of their operation," said YouTuber Deeveeaar, who claims to have hacked cameras monitoring North Korean IT workers. He cited paid ChatGPT accounts, Claude Code and Cursor, used to write code, alter résumés and forge documents and identities.

Binance said hackers used a fake job interview and software hidden in an advertisement to compromise employees' computers, then deployed an internal AI tool to seize control.

A UN sanctions team said in 2025 that TraderTraitor had ChatGPT and DeepSeek accounts.

Despite the rewards, life is gruelling. Former workers told PSCORE last year they faced cramped housing, shifts over 10 hours, surveillance and strict targets. "There is always pressure to keep earning money," said Nam Bada, the group's executive director. "The stress is extreme, and because of the psychological strain people develop health problems they didn't have before."

Workers must meet monthly dollar targets or face humiliation and punishment, he said.

Their success could embolden Kim as their skills and ambitions grow, analysts said.

Govt eases overseas listing norms for cos

Manu Kaushik
New Delhi, November 6

THE GOVERNMENT has substantially eased overseas listing norms, a move intended to make more foreign funds available to growth-hungry enterprises and those wanting to make a turnaround with the infusion of cheaper capital compatible with their business plans.

It allowed companies with negative net worth, and unlisted firms operating in International Financial Services Centres (IFSCs) like Gujarat's GIFT City to list their securities overseas.

For companies that have completely eroded their net worth, foreign listing will be subject to the condition that a minimum of 75% of the shares or other securities offered are allotted to large institutional investors.

According to a series of amendments to overseas listing framework notified by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), companies can list convertible debentures and preference shares on overseas stock exchanges, in addition to equity shares, giving them more options to raise funds abroad.

"Provided that a company having a negative net worth shall be eligible to issue its equity instruments for listing, if the issuer undertakes to allot at least 75% of the net offer to qualified institutional buyers...," the MCA notification read.

Under the amended Companies (Listing of Equity Instruments in Permissible Jurisdictions) Rules, 2026, unlisted public companies operating in IFSCs can also list their securities overseas under the framework, provided they comply with IFSCA regulations.

The rules also make it easier for companies that have repaid overdue loans to banks and other lenders to list overseas by reducing the waiting period from two years to more than six months. However, companies that have not filed their annual returns or financial statements must clear these pending filings to avoid disqualification.

Experts said that the expansion from equity shares to equity instruments brings the MCA framework in line with the existing IFSCA Listing Regulations and gives companies more options to tap international capital markets.

"These amendments represent a progressive step towards liberalising India's overseas listing regime and enhancing access to global capital. By broadening the range of eligible securities and easing certain eligibility conditions, the MCA has sought to facilitate more efficient and flexible fundraising opportunities for Indian companies while aligning the regulatory framework with international market practices," said Anjali Malhotra, associate partner (regulatory) at Nangia Global. FE

India Inc's overseas investment soars 41%

George Mathew
Mumbai, November 6

INDIAN COMPANIES have sharply expanded their overseas investment footprint, with the value of outward direct investment (ODI) surging by a staggering Rs 4.85 lakh crore, or 40.8%, to Rs 16.71 lakh crore at the end of March 2026, from Rs 11.87 lakh crore a year earlier, according to Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data.

However, beneath the impressive headline growth lies a striking shift in the geographical distribution and composition of India's overseas investments.

The United Arab Emirates (UAE) has emerged as the biggest surprise, with Indian investment exposure to the Gulf nation more than doubling to Rs 2.71 lakh crore, driven overwhelmingly by an extraordinary increase in debt investments.

The RBI figures reveal that Indian overseas investments remain heavily concentrated in a handful of international financial and business centres, raising questions about geographical diversification, transparency and the ultimate destinations of Indian capital.

Singapore retained its position as the largest destination for Indian outward direct investment, with total exposure climbing 37% to Rs 352,822 crore in March 2026 from Rs 257,496 crore in March 2025. The city-state alone accounted for 21.1% of India's total ODI stock. But the UAE delivered the most dramatic growth. Indian ODI in the Emirates soared 160% to Rs 271,107 crore from Rs 104,236 crore, pushing it into second place ahead of the United States and the United Kingdom. Even more striking was the composition of the UAE exposure.

Debt investment skyrocketed from Rs 17,644 crore to Rs 152,778 crore — an increase of Rs 135,134 crore, or nearly nine times the previous year's level. Equity investments, in comparison, rose from Rs 86,593 crore to Rs 118,329 crore, according to RBI data.

The UAE alone accounted for roughly 34% of the overall increase in India's ODI stock during the year.

Its debt component accounted for more than four-fifths of the nationwide increase in outward direct investment debt exposure. US, meanwhile, slipped to third position despite a 32.7% rise in Indian ODI to Rs 231,782 crore. The UK followed with Rs 2,07,575 crore, up 28.4%, RBI data shows.

Together, Singapore, the UAE, the US and the UK accounted for 63.6% of India's overseas investment stock. Adding the Netherlands and Mauritius takes the concentration to nearly 80%.

The trend is particularly revealing when compared with March 2024. India's total ODI stock stood at approximately Rs 9.90 lakh crore then, according to the RBI's earlier census.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

COUNTRYWISE OUTWARD DIRECT INVESTMENT (Rs cr)

Country	March 2025	March 2026	Mar 2026 in Total
Singapore	257,496	352,822	21.1%
UAE	104,236	271,107	16.2%
USA	174,706	231,782	13.9%
UK	161,678	207,575	12.4%
Netherlands	113,766	136,596	8.2%
Mauritius	101,849	132,785	7.9%
Switzerland	48,908	55,574	3.3%
Cyprus	12,418	12,825	0.8%
China	9,790	12,373	0.7%
Jersey	11,804	12,331	0.7%
Other Countries	190,093	245,695	14.7%
All Countries	**11,86,744**	**16,71,463**	**100.0%**

SOURCE: RBI

Why AI boosted Meta's advert revenue, but hurt Google search

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, November 6

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) is reshaping the digital advertising business, but its impact on two of the world's biggest technology companies has been markedly different.

While Facebook and Instagram parent Meta is using AI to attract more advertisers and increase revenues, Google is confronting a new challenge where its AI-powered search experience is growing rapidly, but is not yet generating as much advertising revenue as conventional searches.

The divergence was particularly evident in the companies' latest quarterly earnings.

Meta reported a 26% year-on-year increase in advertising revenue to $63.1 billion during the July-September quarter. Google's search advertising revenue, meanwhile, grew 12% to $63.3 billion, a slowdown from the 17% growth it recorded in the preceding quarter.

While Google's advertising business continues to grow, its slower expansion has raised questions about the economics of AI-powered search. For Meta, however, AI has emerged as a major driver of the advertising business that underpins its social media empire.

The bigger question though, is that if these trends hold, would Meta be able to overtake Google in the digital ads business, marking a pivotal shift in the Internet landscape.

In an analysis in April, research firm EMARKETER projected Meta's worldwide net advertising revenue will reach $243.46 billion for 2026, slightly edging past Google's $239.54 billion.

How has AI helped Meta's advertising biz?

Meta's gains are primarily coming from improvements in its AI-powered recommendation and advertising systems, which help the company predict what users want to see and which advertisements they are most likely to engage with.

In its latest earnings, Meta said the number of advertising impressions across its platforms increased 10%, while the average price per advertisement rose%. The company's chief financial officer Susan Li said its AI investments were delivering substantial additional advertising revenue through stronger user engagement, better recommendations and more efficient monetisation.

For instance, improvements to Meta's recommendation systems increased the time users spent watching Instagram Reels by more than 4% during the quarter. The company also said its Generative Ads Recommendation Model (GEM) advertising model drove a 1.7% increase in conversions for certain advertising campaigns and a 9.6% increase in app advertising conversions. Meta's GEM model is an AI system that analyses user behaviour and advertising signals to predict which ads people are most likely to engage with, helping advertisers improve targeting and conversions.

A conversion refers to a desired action taken by a user after seeing an advertisement, such as purchasing a product, downloading an application or signing up for a service.

Meta is also deploying AI tools that allow advertisers to create advertisements, manage campaigns and optimise their spending. According to the company, advertisers who adopted recommendations from its Meta AI Business Assistant recorded almost 5% more conversions at the same cost per conversion, compared with similar advertisers who did not use them.

Why does Meta benefit more from AI?

According to research firm Bernstein, the answer lies in a fundamental difference between how advertising works on social media platforms and traditional search engines.

When a person searches Google for a particular product, the search query itself provides an indication of what they want. However, when someone scrolls through Instagram or Facebook, they may not be actively looking to purchase anything. Meta must therefore predict what products or services could interest them.

This makes improvements in AI particularly valuable for Meta, since better predictions allow it to deliver more relevant advertisements, improve conversions and attract greater advertising spending.

Bernstein estimated that Meta captured nearly half of incremental digital advertising spending in the second quarter of 2026. It also suggested that Meta could overtake Google Search as the largest individual destination for digital advertising spending by the end of the year. The comparison excludes Google's other advertising businesses, including YouTube.

Why is Google's AI push creating challenges?

Unlike Meta, which is deploying AI to improve an existing advertising format, Google is increasingly integrating the technology into the core search experience itself.

Its AI Overviews and AI Mode products provide users with summarised or conversational answers, potentially reducing their need to click through conventional search results. This also changes how advertisements are displayed and monetised.

During Google's latest earnings call, chief business officer Philipp Schindler acknowledged that growing usage of AI Mode had affected search revenue growth because the new experience currently generates less advertising revenue.

However, Schindler clarified that foreign-exchange effects were the single largest contributor to the slowdown in search revenue growth.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Issue of tunnel boring machine curbs should not strain ties: Chinese state-media outlet GT

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, November 6

A SINGLE issue of tunnel boring machine (TBM) should not become a source of friction between China and India, the Global Times, the mouthpiece of the Chinese Communist Party, in an editorial has said, adding that applications to export the equipment for "legitimate civilian projects would be approved".

China's Ministry of Commerce last month said exporters would need to apply for licences under provisions of its export control law and regulations governing the export of dual-use items. The restrictions will come into effect on November 18.

Along with rare earth magnets and TBMs, the Chinese government plans to impose restrictions on capital goods and technology related to the solar sector, leaving Indian industry concerned.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has that said India would develop its own TBMs if China restricted their exports.

This is not the first time China has abruptly imposed a licensing mechanism on a key export item, raising concerns about the weaponisation of supply chains. The Indian automobile industry faced disruptions in imports of rare earth magnets last year, an issue that remains unresolved.

In response to such pressure tactics, the government has announced plans to manufacture key components domestically. The Union Cabinet last year approved a Rs 7,280-crore scheme to promote the manufacturing of sintered rare earth permanent magnets (REPM), with the aim of building domestic supply chains and reducing import dependence.

The government is also preparing a production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for polysilicon manufacturing as it seeks to deepen India's solar manufacturing value chain and reduce reliance on imports.

Export restrictions

"Legitimate civilian projects have little reason for concern, and there are precedents for resolving similar issues. In 2024, India raised concerns over delays in customs clearance for TBMs manufactured in China by a German company. Minister Goyal also brought up the matter with visiting German officials. Following communication and coordination between China and India, the issues were resolved, and some of the equipment was subsequently delivered in a smooth manner," Global Times said.

It added that "a confrontational mindset" would only "narrow the space for pragmatic consultations".

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

NCLT ASKS DHOOT TO SUBMIT DETAILS OF FINANCIAL POSITION

Venugopal Dhoot declared bankrupt over Rs 12K cr default

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, November 6

THE NATIONAL Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) has declared Venugopal Nandlal Dhoot, the former promoter and director of Videocon Industries, bankrupt over the default of Rs 12,668 crore loans from the State Bank of India (SBI).

The Mumbai bench of the tribunal, in an order passed on Thursday, directed that Dhoot's estate be vested in bankruptcy trustee Ashish Narayan and distributed among the creditors. The creditors had earlier rejected the Rs 600 crore repayment plan from Dhoot.

The case relates to the personal guarantees furnished by Venugopal Dhoot for credit facilities or loans granted to Videocon Industries limited and Videocon Telecommunications Limited during 2010 and 2012.

The companies had availed rupee term loans and working capital facilities from SBI and its associated banks, who were merged in April 2017, where Dhoot had unconditionally guaranteed the due repayment and discharge of all sums of money and liabilities.

However, Videocon Industries defaulted on loan and was admitted into the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) in June 2018.

That process was consolidated with those of 12 other Videocon group companies by an NCLT order in August 2019.



NCLT has directed that Dhoot's estate be vested in bankruptcy trustee Ashish Narayan and distributed among the creditors. CREDIT

Before the companies went into insolvency, the SBI had issued demand notices to Dhoot in February 2018 seeking the repayment of loans.

Later, the SBI got a separate personal insolvency resolution process initiated against Dhoot in April 2026 for not presenting any repayment plan of its dues.

After two months, the personal guarantor submitted a Combined Repayment Plan with a Detailed Project Report for a proposed development at Siliguri, offering Rs 600 crores over 36 months, which the petition states to be just 0.42% of the admitted dues.

The resolution professional in the case opined that the proposed repayment mechanism was substantially contingent on future development, approvals and cash flows that could not be verified, and offers nothing upfront and any realisation. Due to these uncertainties in the repayment, the creditors agreed to close the personal insolvency and initiate bankruptcy process against Dhoot. In July 2026, the NCLT rejected Dhoot's repayment plan and initiated the bankruptcy process for the default of Rs 12,668 crore loans (including interest and penalties), as submitted by SBI.

The tribunal has directed Venugopal Dhoot to submit details of his financial position to the Bankruptcy trustee. The Bankruptcy Trustee shall issue a public notice inviting claims from the creditors and conduct the administration and distribution of the estate of the bankrupt in accordance with the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code.

PM Modi to meet chief secretaries on key reforms & technology

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi is likely to meet chief secretaries of states and Union Territories on December 26–27 to deliberate on key socio-economic priorities, including deregulation, the use of technology in governance and best practices in infrastructure development, sources said.

The discussions are expected to focus on accelerating reforms and advancing the broader vision of Viksit Bharat.

Deregulation is expected to be a key pillar of the next-generation reform agenda, with emphasis on simplifying regulations and eliminating unnecessary licences, approvals, permissions and frequent renewal requirements.

A systematic review of existing laws, regulations and administrative processes is being undertaken by a High-Level Committee, guided by the Prime Minister's vision of Trust-Based Governance, sources said. FE

BRIEFLY

Rupee rises past 94/$ as oil slides

Mumbai: The Indian rupee strengthened past 94 per dollar on Friday, regaining appeal among emerging-market currencies after spending much of the year in the doldrums, and also posted its best week in three weeks. Helped by the unwinding of the once-dominant AI trade and a sharp fall in oil prices after the Democrats swept the US midterm elections, the rupee rose to its highest level since April 22, backed by strong inflows into equity and debt markets. REUTERS

Foreign exchange reserves drop by $2.7 bn to $717 bn

Mumbai: India's forex reserves dropped by $2.691 billion to $717.056 billion during the week ended October 30, the RBI said on Friday. In the previous week, the forex kitty had reduced by $1.269 billion to $719.748 billion. The reserves had touched an all-time high of $785.706 billion during the week ended September 4, driven by a heavy flow of currency as part of a special concessional swap for deposits from the diaspora through which banks raised a record $133 billion. PTI

Electric vehicle sales jump 45% to 3,54,625 units in October

Mumbai: Electric vehicle sales in the country surged 45% to 3,54,625 units in October from the same month last year, led by e-two-wheeler sales, according to Federation of Indian Automobile Dealers' Association (FADA) data released on Friday. The total e-vehicle sales in October 2025 were 2,44,764 units. E-two-wheeler sales stood at 2,24,064 units in October this year, up 48.49% from 1,50,890 units in the same month last year, according to FADA data. PTI

Need only serious players for Semicon 2.0, says Vaishnaw

New Delhi: IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Friday said the government's semiconductor programme, as well as manufacturing schemes for components and mobile phones are meant only for serious, technologically capable players and that there is no place for "frivolous" applicants. "We don't want placeholders," Vaishnaw said in a strong message to the industry. PTI

TRUMP ON FRIDAY SAID HE WOULD WORK WITH US STATES THAT "WANT TO BECOME RICH" BY EMBRACING AI, WITHOUT OFFERING DETAILS

Democrats planning flood of AI bills after Congress takeover

Reuters
Washington, November 6

DEMOCRATS ARE planning to unleash a flood of new legislation targeting artificial intelligence systems and data-center development when they take control of the US Congress in January, lawmakers, congressional aides and advocates said.

The plans would mark a sharp shift from the Republican-led Congress, where lawmakers largely focused on promoting AI development and declined to pass legislation restricting aspects of the technology at a time when voters turned against the rapid development of data centers and their extensive power needs.

Democrats plan on introducing bills aimed at shielding consumers from rising electricity costs tied to data centers, requiring independent testing of advanced AI systems and clarifying when AI companies can be held liable for harm caused by their products, they said.

Any legislation would face steep odds while Republican President Donald Trump remains in the White House, as he has repeatedly dismissed calls to write mandatory rules for AI technology.

On Friday, Trump said he would work with US states that "want to become RICH" by embracing AI, without offering details. But Democratic lawmakers and outside advocates said control of congressional committees would give the party a platform to advance proposals, compel testimony from industry leaders and build support for action if AI systems cause real-world harm. Representative Greg Casar, a Texas Democrat and chair of the Congressional Progressive Caucus, already said this week that AI executives should be called to testify under oath.



Senator Chuck Schumer said on Thursday that protecting consumers from higher energy costs linked to the rapid expansion of data centers would be among his priorities next year. REUTERS

Federal government restrictions on AI development could hurt the industry's profits if they slow the release of new models or prompt the companies to change how their AI tools perform to address concerns that their products are harming people.

Technology shares sold off dramatically on Thursday on growing concerns that a new Congress will slow AI development, and also on fears that the massive capital expense on building out AI will not yield sufficient returns.

Stocks on Friday extended their slide in both Europe and Asia following the rout, though Wall Street futures pointed to a modest bounce for the Nasdaq later on Friday.

MULTIPLE BILLS LIKELY

Senator Chuck Schumer, a New York Democrat who is expected to become majority leader, said on Thursday at an event in Washington that protecting consumers from higher energy costs linked to the rapid expansion of data centers would be among his priorities next year.

Representative Lori Trahan of Massachusetts, one of the Democratic Party's leading voices on AI policy, plans to push legislation requiring independent experts to evaluate leading AI models against safety standards, said Francis Grubar, her deputy chief of staff.

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
81,028.02	25,030.35	₹141,452	₹93.91
1,718.01	493.75	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
2.17%	2.01%	₹182,868	$94.52

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF NOVEMBER 5, 2026

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad- 500003, Telangana, India
CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD - OPERATION, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for supply of Carbon-Dioxide Gas

1	**Tender Enquiry No. 228/GATP/OPERATION/20018358 dated 06/11/2026** **"Procurement for supply of Carbon Dioxide Gas (8000kg) at** 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 06/11/2026 from 17:00 Hrs, onwards
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

No. 16890/PB GATP-119/26

KARNATAKA STATE NATURAL DISASTER MONITORING CENTRE (KSNDMC)

(A Regd. Society of Govt. of Karnataka)
Major Sandeep Unnikrishnan Road, Near Attur Layout, Yelahanka, Bengaluru - 560 064. Ph.: 080-67355000
No. KSNDMC/ADM/7/2025-ADM Date: 05.11.2026

E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

KSNDMC invites tenders for the following through e-procurement portal on **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** Tender is invited for 1) Supply, Installation and Comprehensive Annual maintenance of addressable analogue fire alarm system. Tender No. KSNDMC/2026-27/IND0006/Call-3. Last date for submission of bid is **21.11.2026 at 05:00 PM.**, 2) Supply, Installation and Comprehensive Annual Maintenance of Servers, LTO Tape library, Workstations, Laptop Computers, SAN Storage, SAN Switches and Ethernet Switches, Tender No. KSNDMC/2026-27/IND0008. Pre bid meeting is on **13.11.2026 at 11:00 AM,** Last date for submission of bid is **05.12.2026 at 05:00 PM.** Further tender details can be obtained through e-procurement portal of GoK

DIPR/DD-C.P/3569/KSMCA/2026-27 **Sd/- Director**

NPCL NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED

CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506

Notice Inviting Bids for Procurement of Power on Short Term basis

Bids are invited by "**Noida Power Company Limited having its registered office at Electric Sub-station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida – 201310 (U.P.)"** for procurement of up to 200 MW during **01.04.2027 to 31.03.2028** as per the Guidelines of Ministry of Power, GoI dated 30.03.2016. Bid Document is available on **www.mstcecommerce.com.**
The Company reserves the right to reject all or any of the Bids or cancel the bidding process at any stage without assigning any reasons whatsoever and without any liability.
For any clarification, contact at e-mail id **powertradingnpcl@rpsg.in or mobile no. 9718804966.**

Head (Power Management Services)

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA
HYDERABAD METROPOLITAN WATER SUPPLY & SEWERAGE BOARD

O/o. Chief General Manager (Engg), PCC-II, Khairatabad, Hyderabad-04, TG.

e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

e-Tender Notice No. and Date	Name of Work	Approximate Estimate Contract Value
EP-01/CGM (E)/ PCC-II/Bandlaguda-Reservoirs-IOD/ 2026-27, dated: 03-11-2026	Development of water supply infrastructure Construction of three reservoirs, Laying of MS / DI Inlet, Outlet and Distribution mains in six new colonies situated in Bandlaguda area of Chandrayangutta Assembly Constituency.	Rs.34.79 Crores

(1) The bid documents download starts online on or after: **07-11-2026. (2)** Name and address of Chief General Manager (Engg), concerned- **Chief General Manager (Engg), Project Construction Circle-II, HMWSSB, Khairatabad, Hyderabad-500004. (3)** The contractors/firms are requested to upload the information in the "ZIP" format preferably. **(4)** Further details can be seen @ https://tender.telangana.gov.in

Sd/- Chief General Manager (Engg), PCC-II, Khairatabad, Hyderabad-04, TG.

TAMIL NADU TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD

Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
T-2402	SE / Transmission-II	Procurement of 765 KV 160 KN and 210 KN Polymer Composite Long Rod Insulator

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tantransco.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app** DIPR/3466/Tender/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of work and its location :-	119-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27 Electrical improvement of Staff Amenities including Rewiring of Railway Quarters and Allied Electrical Works in the jurisdiction of SSE/PS/PHG.
Approx. cost of the works in :-	Rs. 25889940.00/-
Address of the office :-	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money :-	Rs. 517800.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender :-	30.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender :-	30/11/2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board :-	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi. 3910/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

25001/1470/2627

Office of the Engineer-in-Chief, Rural Water Supply & Sanitation (RWSS)
Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water Department
Jal O Parimal Bhawan, Bhubaneswar-751001

NOTICE

No. 12774/ RWSS Date: 04.11.2026

Technical Briefing on Tablet Based In-line Chlorination (ILC) Pilot Project

The Engineer-in-Chief, RWSS, Odisha will hold a Technical Briefing on the proposed In-line Chlorination Pilot Project for piped drinking water supply schemes in select districts of Odisha. The briefing will provide an overview of ILC implementation, responsibilities, technical requirements and operational expectations. Interested contractors/vendors, and manufacturers, suppliers and authorised vendors of chlorine tablets, are invited to attend.
Date & Time: 10 November 2026, 4:00 PM
Venue: Conference Hall, O/o the Engineer-in-Chief, RWSS, Jal O Parimal Bhawan, Bhubaneswar.
Please confirm attendance by 09/11/2026 at **cerwssodisha@gmail.com/ tpeicrwss@gmail.com**, giving your firm's name, one representative and contact details. Written queries may be sent in advance to the same email.
Attendance is not mandatory and does not give any right or preference in bidding.

Sd/-
OIPR-25001/25040/1/26-27/0004 **Engineer-in-Chief, RWSS (O)**

BANARAS LOCOMOTIVE WORKS VARANASI-221004

Bid No.: E-30/2026-2027 Date : 05-11-2026

E-TENDERS NOTICE

E-Tender are invited for & on behalf of the President of India for supply of following items. Only e-offer will be accepted for which vender must have Class III Digital Signature and registrations on IREPS. The details of tenders are in the following sequence: **S.No.,Tender No. (Due Date), Desc and Qty. 01.** 10261354B, (30/11/2026), DETECTOR REPAIR INCLUDES CRANCCASE AND LOW WATER KIT , (PL No.16020571), 709 Nos. **02.** 10251228C, (07/12/2026), (Developmental Tender) REPAIR KIT FOR INJECTOR ASSEMBLY, (PL No.16040247), 320 Sets. **03.** 10262029, (23/11/2026), Development Tender for BOLT ASSEMBLY, (PL No.16350030), 320 Nos. **04.** 10261680, (26/11/2026), Price Agreement Fully Machined Crankcase Assembly, (PL No.16020017), 48 Nos. **05.** 05265058B, (30/11/2026), Supply, Testing, Installation & Commissioning of EOT crane 25 Ton, 01 Nos. **Coorigendum, S.No. 06, Bid No.:** E-27/2026-27, **Tender No.**: 04262129, **Due Date**: 09/11/2026, **Revision**: 01, **Detail of Correction:** Due Date: To be read as 17/11/2026 instead of 09/11/2026, **Coorigendum, S.No. 07, Bid No.:** E-28/2026-27, **Tender No.**: 09265005, **Due Date**: 06/11/2026, **Revision**: 01, **Detail of Correction:** Due Date: To be read as 13/11/2026 instead of 06/11/2026. The details of above tenders are available on www.blw.indianrailways.gov.in and www.ireps.gov.in.

P.R.O./BLW/S-32 SMM

/blwvaranasi "website:- blw.indianrailways.gov.in"

UJVN LTD.

H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website : www.ujvnl.com

Letter No 1055 **Tender Notice** Dated 06.11.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil-I), Tiuni-Plasu, UJVNLtd, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :
Tender No.: 05/EE(Civil-I)/Tiuni Plasu/2026-27
Name of work: "Work related to Architectural Services, Structure drawing, Planning, Detailed estimate, Internal electrification and Internal water supply of Field hostel at Tiuni Plasu HEP (2*36=72 MW)"
Estimated cost : 9,04,115.00(Excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 06-11-2026 From 17:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of Tender : 27-11-2026 Upto 15:30 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website **www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer(Civil-I), Tiuni-Plasu, Dakpathar

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग

हरिद्वार
पिन कोड–249404

संख्याः 85/01/E-4/FOREST (DR)/2024-25, दिनांकः 06 नवम्बर, 2026

विज्ञप्ति

"सहायक वन संरक्षक, लौगिंग अधिकारी एवं वनक्षेत्राधिकारी संयुक्त मुख्य (लिखित) परीक्षा–2025"

एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि **सहायक वन संरक्षक, लौगिंग अधिकारी एवं वनक्षेत्राधिकारी संयुक्त मुख्य (लिखित) परीक्षा–2025** के परीक्षा परिणाम दिनांकः 17 अगस्त, 2026 में सफल अभ्यर्थियों के अभिलेखों का सत्यापन दिनांकः 07, 08, 09 एवं 21 सितम्बर, 2026 को किया गया है, जिसके क्रम में अनर्हता/अभ्यर्थन निरस्त सूची एवं वांछित अभिलेख से संबंधित सूची दिनांक 06 नवम्बर, 2026 आयोग की वेबसाइट **psc.uk.gov.in** पर प्रसारित की गई हैं। उपरोक्त सूचियों के अभ्यर्थियों को प्रत्यावेदन/प्रमाणपत्र प्रस्तुत करने के लिए **दिनांक 23.11.2026 तक का समय प्रदान किया गया है।** उक्त तिथि के पश्चात प्राप्त होने वाले प्रत्यावदेन/प्रमाणपत्र पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा। विस्तृत विवरण के लिए अभ्यर्थी अनर्हता सूची, अभ्यर्थन निरस्त सूची एवं वांछित अभिलेख से संबंधित सूची का अवलोकन आयोग की वेबसाइट पर कर सकते हैं।

(अशोक कुमार पाण्डेय) सचिव।

विद्युत वितरण मण्डल उत्तराखण्ड पावर कारपोरेशन लि०

हाईडिल कलोनी रानीखेतः 263645 (जि०–अल्मोडा, उत्तराखण्ड) दूरभाषः (05966) 220620

पत्रांक :–6653/वि०वि०म०(रा)/ई–निविदा दिनांक :– 06/11/2026

ई–निविदा सूचना

विद्युत वितरण मण्डल रानीखेत निम्न ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करता है :–

क्र. सं.	ई–निविदा संख्या	कार्य का नाम	ई–निविदा क्रय/ जमा करने की ऑनलाइन अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय	ई–निविदा (भाग–1) खुलने की ऑफलाइन/ऑन लाइन तिथि एवं समय
1	वि०वि०म०(रा०) 84/2026–27	वि०वि०ख० भिकियासैंण के अधीन 33/11 केवी० उपसंस्थान देघाट के पत्थरखोला फीडर से पोषित विभिन्न ग्रामों / क्षेत्र में ए०बी० केबल स्थापित करने सम्बन्धी कार्य टर्नकी के आधार पर सम्पादित करना।	27.11.2026 15:00 बजे तक	28.11.2026 12:00 बजे
2	वि०वि०म०(रा०) 85/2026–27	वि०वि०ख० भिकियासैंण के अधीन 33/11 केवी० उपसंस्थान स्याल्दे के नैल फीडर से पोषित विभिन्न ग्रामों / क्षेत्र में ए०बी० केबल स्थापित करने सम्बन्धी कार्य टर्नकी के आधार पर सम्पादित करना।	27.11.2026 15:00 बजे तक	28.11.2026 12:15 बजे
3	वि०वि०म०(रा०) 86/2026–27	वि०वि०ख० भिकियासैंण के अधीन 33/11 केवी० उपसंस्थान स्याल्दे के 11 केवी० देघाट फीडर से पोषित विभिन्न ग्रामों / क्षेत्र में ए०बी० केबल स्थापित करने सम्बन्धी कार्य टर्नकी के आधार पर सम्पादित करना।	27.11.2026 15:00 बजे तक	28.11.2026 12.30 बजे
4	वि०वि०म०(रा०) 87/2026–27	वि०वि०ख० भिकियासैंण के अधीन 33/11 केवी० उपसंस्थान देघाट के 11 केवी० नागचुला फीडर से पोषित विभिन्न ग्रामों / क्षेत्र में ए०बी० केबल स्थापित करने सम्बन्धी कार्य टर्नकी के आधार पर सम्पादित करना।	27.11.2026 15:00 बजे तक	28.11.2026 12:45 बजे
5	वि०वि०म०(रा०) 88/2026–27	वि०वि०ख० अल्मोडा के अधीन 33/11 केवी० उपसंस्थान सोमेश्वर के 11 केवी० सोमेश्वर फीडर से पोषित विभिन्न ग्रामों / क्षेत्र में विजल कण्डक्टर को ए०बी० केबल में परिवर्तित करने सम्बन्धी कार्य टर्नकी के आधार पर सम्पादित करना।	27.11.2026 15:00 बजे तक	28.11.2026 13:00 बजे

उक्त ई–निविदाओं की अन्य नियम व एवं शर्तें वैबसाईट **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर देखी जा सकती है। उक्त ई–निविदाओं का शुद्धि पत्र/ विस्तारीकरण/निरस्तीकरण आदि की सूचना वैबसाईट **www.uktenders.gov.in** में ही प्रकाशित / उपलब्ध होगी साथ ही पूर्व में प्रकाशित **ई–निविदा संख्या**–82/2026–27 को निरस्त किया जाता है।

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अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender Notice No.: SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T43 Date 05-11-2026

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India invites sealed "OPEN" E-Tender for the following work:-
Sl. No.-01, Name of work: 25 KV Electrification work in connection with Modification of Chhapra Kacheheri Yard of N.E.Railway Varanasi Division. Tender Reference No.: SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T43, Approx. Cost (in Rs.): ₹ 2,57,30,492.36, Earnest Money (in Rs.): ₹ 5,14,600/–, Cost of tender documents (in Rs.): Nil, E-Tender closing date and time: 27-11-2026 up to 14:45 Hrs., Completion period: 09 Months.
• Open E-Tender Online will be submitted up to 14:45 Hrs. on date 27-11-2026. • For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian Railway i.e. *www.ireps.gov.in*

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD CPRO/Vidyut-253 **Varanasi**

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

राजस्थान सरकार
कौशल, नियोजन एवं उद्यमिता विभाग
प्राविधिक शिक्षा निदेशालय (प्रशिक्षण) जोधपुर
W–6, रेजीडेंसी रोड, गौरव पथ, रातानाडा, जोधपुर

No: DTE/T-4(SCHEME)/PMPES/4324(5)/2026/62584 दिनांक : 16/10/26

Corrigendum-I

ई–निविदा सूचना संख्या 02/2026–27 में निम्नानुसार संशोधन किये जा रहे हैं:–

S.No.	UBN No.	Corrigendum
01	UBN No. TET2627SLOB00161 TET2627SLOB00162	RFP में निम्नानुसार आवश्यक संशोधन किये जा रहे है– 1. Last date of receiving queries - 12.11.2026 2. Pre-Bid Conference - 26.11.26 3. Authority response to queries latest by 30.11.2026 4. Authority additional response if any 10.12.2026 5. Bid due date - 30.12.2026 6. Opening of technical bid - 30.12.2026 7. Announcement of qualified bidders - 14.01.2027 8. Opening of Financial bid- 21.01.2027

अन्य नियम एवं शर्तें पूर्ववत् रहेंगी।
DIPR/C/18280/2026 निदेशक (प्रशिक्षण)

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.

निविदा सूचना/2026–27

No. NIT/2026-27/9077-88 Date: 05.11.2026

निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पथकर वसूली हेतु ई–टेन्डरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:–

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रू०)	निविदा सूचना संख्या
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-		
On Chomu-Mahla BOT Road" for a period of 01 Year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00731**	1003.87 Lakh	ई–447/26–27
On Sikar-Jhunjhunu-Luharu Road SH-08" for a maximum period of 90 days. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00736**	860.02 Lakh	अल्पकालीन ई–452/ 26–27

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in** तथा **http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc** पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।

महाप्रबंधक

Kalyan Singh Super Speciality Cancer Institute

C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-(226002)
Website: https://cancerinstitute.edu.in , Email: jdmm.sscih@gmail.com

TENDER NOTICE

1. GEM/2026/B/8187245 dated: 05.11.2026 for the item-**Micro Bipolar Cautery Forceps, 2. GEM/2026/B/8167042 dated: 05.11.2026** for the item-**Neuro Bio Feed Back, 3. GEM/2026/B/8218778 dated: 05.11.2026** for the item-**Surgical Workstation (PAC item), 4. GEM/2026/B/8218712 dated: 05.11.2026** for the item- **High End EV Workstation (PAC item).**
Offers are invited from Original Equipment manufacturers/Direct Importers/Authorized Distributors (declared by principal firm only) for the supply & installation of aforementioned Equipment/items. **Bidders should submit their Representation only on GeM Portal regarding Equipment/ items** within time frame provided by GeM.
For more detailed information you may please visit the GeM Portal **www.gem.gov.in** or our website **https://cancerinstitute.edu.in**, for reference only. The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any tender in part or full without assigning any reason thereof.

Advt No:- KSSSCI/Tender-22/2026-27 DIRECTOR

Kind Attention Rail Passengers!

IMPORTANT NOTICE

It has been decided by the competent authority that the functioning of PRS/Locations in Delhi Division on the occasion of **"DEEPAWALI"** festival on **08.11.2026 (Sunday)** will be as under:

1. Advance Reservation Counters (Open in First Shift and Closed in Second Shift):
The following advance reservation counters will function as per their usual timings during the first shift, i.e. from 08:00 hrs to 14:00 hrs., and will remain closed during the second shift, i.e. from 14:00 hrs. to 20:00 hrs., being Sunday and Deepawali festival:
Anand Vihar Terminal (PRS), Sahibabad, Gurugram, Palam, Delhi Cantt., Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Faridabad, Ballabh Garh, Palwal, Tapri, Narela, Sonipat, Panipat, Karnal, Kurukshetra, Jind, Rohtak, Modi Nagar, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Muzaffar Nagar, Greater Noida, Shakur Basti, Bahadur Garh, Nangloi, Shamli, Deoband and Pataudi Road.

2. Current Reservation Counters (24x7):
Current Reservation Counters at **New Delhi Railway Station (Paharganj and Ajmeri Gate sides), Delhi Main, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Anand Vihar Terminal, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Delhi Cantt. and Meerut City Railway Stations** will function as per their usual timing (24x7).

3. Advance Reservation Counters (Closed for the Whole Day):
Being Sunday, the following PRS locations, which normally remain closed on Sundays, will remain closed for the whole day:
Baraut, Noli, Naya Ghaziabad, Mansa, Narwana, Tohana, Murad Nagar, Maur, Khatauli, Gohana, Samalkha, Ganaur, Kaithal, Shahabad Markanda, Jhajjar, Darul Uloom, Saket Court, Dwarka Court, Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT) and Chaudhary Charan Singh University (MTC).

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Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 12.12.2026 from 10 am onwards.
Auction Date: 12.12.2026 - MUZAFFARNAGAR DISTRICT - CIVIL LINES MUZAFFARNAGAR: 4276001516, 4276001598, 4276001639, 4276001684, 4276001694, 4276001717, 4276001719, 4276001736, 4276001750, 4276001769, 4276001812, 4276001818, 4276001841, 4276001851, 4276001853, 4276001878, 4276001891, 4276001898, 4276001902, 4276001922, 4276001936, 4276002006, 4276002038, 4276002075, 4276002076, 4276002092, 4276002101, 4276002106, 4276002132, 4276002180, 4276002203, 4276002235, 4276002291, 4276002314, 4276002323, 4276002463, 4276002580, 4276002589, 4276002599, 4276002645, 4276002652, 4276003669, 4276003675, 4276003710, 4276003729. **KHATAULI-MUZAFFARNAGAR:** 4300000979, 4300001000, 4300001005, 4300001027, 4300001091, 4300001125, 4300001137, 4300001142, 4300001148, 4300001172, 4300001173, 4300001174, 4300001255, 4300001258, 4300001301, 4300001313, 4300001336, 4300001360, 4300001378, 4300001394, 4300001430, 4300001432, 4300001479, 4300001494, 4300001495, 4300001496, 4300001512, 4300001513, 4300001533, 4300001611, 4300001657, 4300001688, 4300001843, 4300002741. **Auction Date: 12.12.2026 - SAHARANPUR DISTRICT - DELHI ROAD -SAHARANPUR:** 4495000891, 4495000898, 4495001065, 4495001086, 4495001296, 4495001303, 4495001324, 4495001334, 4495001348, 4495001352, 4495001378, 4495001447, 4495001458, 4495001525, 4495001662, 4495001763, 4495001820, 4495001842, 4495001843, 4495001866, 4495001905, 4495001961, 4495001970, 4495001986, 4495002015, 4495002019, 4495002069, 4495002086, 4495002095, 4495002100, 4495002101, 4495002103, 4495002121, 4495002126, 4495002137, 4495002140, 4495002142, 4495002147, 4495002161, 4495002173, 4495002236, 4495002265, 4495002321, 4495002348, 4495002385, 4495002402, 4495002464, 4495003794, 4495003830, 4495003918, 4495003985. **DEOBAND:** 4204001786, 4204001787, 4204002085, 4204002122, 4204002127, 4204002157, 4204002179, 4204002181, 4204002201, 4204002218, 4204002253, 4204002279, 4204002280, 4204002283, 4204002309, 4204002343, 4204002368, 4204002397, 4204002430, 4204002440, 4204002467, 4204002469, 4204002495, 4204002509, 4204002534, 4204002539, 4204002544, 4204002545, 4204002556, 4204002573, 4204002578, 4204002585, 4204002595, 4204002617, 4204002633, 4204002634, 4204002669, 4204002686, 4204002689, 4204002713, 4204002714, 4204002715, 4204002740, 4204002747, 4204002756, 4204002762, 4204002770, 4204002783, 4204002810, 4204002901, 4204002908, 4204002989, 4204003046, 4204003136, 4204003148, 4204003153, 4204003204, 4204003217, 4204003222, 4204003227, 4204003231, 4204003242, 4204003264, 4204003285, 4204003288, 4204003315, 4204003335, 4204003387, 4204003407, 4204003419, 4204003448, 4204003450, 4204003459, 4204003463, 4204003495, 4204003496, 4204003498, 4204003516, 4204003527, 4204003571, 4204003594, 4204003609, 4204003648, 4204003659, 4204003693, 4204003882, 4204003941, 4204003971, 4204004037, 4204004047, 4204004076, 4204004130, 4204005901, 4204005905, 4204005912, 4204005929, 4204005952, 4204006058, 4204006126, 4204006162, 4204006172. **GANGOH:** 4391002847, 4391002848, 4391002849, 4391003476, 4391003486, 4391003488, 4391003493, 4391003526, 4391003539, 4391003603, 4391003639, 4391003729, 4391003761, 4391003774, 4391003791, 4391003795, 4391003806, 4391003807, 4391003818, 4391003829, 4391003832, 4391003839, 4391003866, 4391003897, 4391003907, 4391003919, 4391003930, 4391003935, 4391003944, 4391003974, 4391003975, 4391003977, 4391003985, 4391004024, 4391004032, 4391004059, 4391004083, 4391004085, 4391004107, 4391004122, 4391004124, 4391004142, 4391004143, 4391004144, 4391004146, 4391004192, 4391004249, 4391004250, 4391004284, 4391004329, 4391004337, 4391004360, 4391004363, 4391004412, 4391004437, 4391004438, 4391004439, 4391004472, 4391004473, 4391004474, 4391004485, 4391004524, 4391004543, 4391004562, 4391004569, 4391004570, 4391004574, 4391004576, 4391004585, 4391004591, 4391004601, 4391004603, 4391004621, 4391004630, 4391004634, 4391004639, 4391004645, 4391004659, 4391004665, 4391004710, 4391004715, 4391004743, 4391004744, 4391004750, 4391004753, 4391004762, 4391004766, 4391004770, 4391004804, 4391004819, 4391004845, 4391004852, 4391004910, 4391004983, 4391005060, 4391005307, 4391005331, 4391007107, 4391007148, 4391007202, 4391007336, 4391007425. **SAHARANPUR-DEHRADUN ROAD:** 2764002472, 2764002624, 2764002888, 2764002889, 2764002963, 2764003022, 2764003043, 2764003065, 2764003072, 2764003076, 2764003115, 2764003137, 2764003147, 2764003150, 2764003161, 2764003162, 2764003163, 2764003164, 2764003173, 2764003221, 2764003269, 2764003274, 2764003286, 2764003296, 2764003315, 2764003333, 2764003344, 2764003368, 2764003387, 2764003414, 2764003416, 2764003421, 2764003460, 2764003477, 2764003486, 2764003490, 2764003524, 2764003542, 2764003547, 2764003558, 2764003564, 2764003600, 2764003613, 2764003638, 2764003645, 2764003654, 2764003676, 2764003680, 2764003681, 2764003687, 2764003694, 2764003702, 2764003733, 2764003754, 2764003787, 2764003790, 2764003879, 2764003896, 2764003938, 2764003940, 2764003958, 2764003961, 2764003966, 2764003981, 2764004001, 2764004009, 2764004015, 2764004085, 2764004104, 2764004292, 2764004305, 2764004319, 2764004337, 2764004338, 2764004342, 2764004396, 2764004399, 2764004418, 2764004438, 2764004464, 2764004465, 2764004491, 2764004514, 2764004541, 2764004563, 2764004581, 2764004639, 2764004665, 2764004703, 2764004866, 2764004919, 2764004931, 2764004940, 2764004955, 2764005007, 2764005009, 2764005010, 2764005028, 2764005029, 2764005030, 2764005052, 2764005053, 2764005055, 2764005065, 2764005066, 2764005125, 2764005139, 2764005171, 2764005172, 2764005207, 2764005209, 2764005214, 2764005218, 2764005257, 2764005275, 2764005368, 2764005414, 2764005511, 2764005547, 2764005560, 2764005561, 2764005563, 2764005564, 2764005584, 2764005600, 2764005608, 2764005617, 2764005705, 2764007951, 2764007961, 2764007966.
Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 23.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at SAHARANPUR DISTRICT - SAHARANPUR-DEHRADUN ROAD: GROUND FLOOR , DOOR NO:2A/2327, DEHRADUN ROAD, SAM INTER COLLEGE, SAHARANPUR, UTTAR PRADESH -247001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

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Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 11.12.2026 from 10 am onwards.
GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR DISTRICT - BHANGEL: 4175003053, 4175004132, 4175004380, 4175004432, 4175004528, 4175004539, 4175004563, 4175004564, 4175004573, 4175004608, 4175004682, 4175004705, 4175004741, 4175004753, 4175004754, 4175004762, 4175004784, 4175004793, 4175004796, 4175004799, 4175004802, 4175004803, 4175004831, 4175004836, 4175004837, 4175004846, 4175004848, 4175004862, 4175004868, 4175004878, 4175004896, 4175004900, 4175004937, 4175004938, 4175004948, 4175004957, 4175004974, 4175004990, 4175004991, 4175004998, 4175005007, 4175005014, 4175005034, 4175005052, 4175005066, 4175005067, 4175005068, 4175005077, 4175005096, 4175005124, 4175005126, 4175005150, 4175005156, 4175005158, 4175005169, 4175005176, 4175005254, 4175005274, 4175005276, 4175005331, 4175005429, 4175005462, 4175005505, 4175005519, 4175005569, 4175005641, 4175005645, 4175005685, 4175005722, 4175005740, 4175005747, 4175005756, 4175005790, 4175005798, 4175005808, 4175005831, 4175005833, 4175005863, 4175005864, 4175005868, 4175005920, 4175005971, 4175005977, 4175005992, 4175006005, 4175006021, 4175006037, 4175006061, 4175006111, 4175006115, 4175006146, 4175006162, 4175006215, 4175006216, 4175006221, 4175006336, 4175006343, 4175006384, 4175006412, 4175006435, 4175006453, 4175006485, 4175006488, 4175006571, 4175008056, 4175008098. **DADRI:** 4393001223, 4393001337, 4393001423, 4393001442, 4393001453, 4393001464, 4393001466, 4393001472, 4393001479, 4393001508, 4393001546, 4393001588, 4393001594, 4393001602, 4393001615, 4393001616, 4393001623, 4393001676, 4393001682, 4393001683, 4393001684, 4393001704, 4393001716, 4393001725, 4393001739, 4393001758, 4393001759, 4393001769, 4393001845, 4393001850, 4393001873, 4393001874, 4393001894, 4393001896, 4393001902, 4393001909, 4393001913, 4393001917, 4393001932, 4393001962, 4393001967, 4393001979, 4393001998, 4393002011, 4393002015, 4393002024, 4393002025, 4393002030, 4393002045, 4393002059, 4393002076, 4393002080, 4393002115, 4393002139, 4393002142, 4393002147, 4393002165, 4393002200, 4393002202, 4393002214, 4393002215, 4393002225, 4393002244, 4393002275, 4393002291, 4393002304, 4393003138, 4393003165. **HOSHIYARPUR - NOIDA SEC-51:** 4508000443, 4508000456, 4508000484, 4508000502, 4508000510, 4508000526, 4508000550, 4508000558, 4508000564, 4508000582, 4508000588, 4508000589, 4508000614, 4508000674, 4508000687, 4508000690, 4508000692, 4508000701, 4508000730, 4508000751, 4508000768, 4508000794, 4508000808, 4508000844, 4508000873, 4508000877, 4508000878, 4508000913, 4508000931, 4508000941, 4508001357, 4508001391, 4508001409. **JEWAR:** 4453000937, 4453000960, 4453000984, 4453001010, 4453001027, 4453001085, 4453001098, 4453001120, 4453001166, 4453001171, 4453001208, 4453001224, 4453001243, 4453001250, 4453001269, 4453001404, 4453001484, 4453001511, 4453001538, 4453001544, 4453001581, 4453001604, 4453001611, 4453001612, 4453001630, 4453001640, 4453001658, 4453001660, 4453001678, 4453001700, 4453001776, 4453001783, 4453001796, 4453001835, 4453001853, 4453001856, 4453001873, 4453001899, 4453002133, 4453002165, 4453002220, 4453002221, 4453002237, 4453002271, 4453002277, 4453002280, 4453002328, 4453002629, 4453002644. **KASNA:** 4471001097, 4471001123, 4471001213, 4471001279, 4471001290, 4471001291, 4471001307, 4471001322, 4471001337, 4471001342, 4471001357, 4471001367, 4471001380, 4471001383, 4471001398, 4471001406, 4471001415, 4471001421, 4471001470, 4471001478, 4471001513, 4471001546, 4471001556, 4471001583, 4471001760, 4471001793, 4471001875, 4471001891, 4471001910, 4471001911, 4471001938, 4471001953, 4471001987, 4471001989, 4471002036, 4471002037, 4471002040, 4471002069, 4471002071, 4471002204, 4471002217, 4471002219, 4471002238, 4471002257, 4471002276, 4471002311, 4471002323, 4471002386, 4471002392, 4471002445, 4471002467, 4471002482, 4471002516, 4471002523, 4471002528, 4471002540, 4471003731, 4471003748, 4471003823. **NOIDA:** 0697002670, 0697002735, 0697002740, 0697002803, 0697002830, 0697002874, 0697002913, 0697002945, 0697002980, 0697002981, 0697002999, 0697003016, 0697003060, 0697003061, 0697003068, 0697003090, 0697003107, 0697003115, 0697003119, 0697003122, 0697003137, 0697003163, 0697003215, 0697003216, 0697003299, 0697003344, 0697003389, 0697003403, 0697003514, 0697003591, 0697003701, 0697003785, 0697003790, 0697003813, 0697003839, 0697003870, 0697003872, 0697003878, 0697003883, 0697003892, 0697003909, 0697003948, 0697003954, 0697003961, 0697003970, 0697004098, 0697004123, 0697004134, 0697004135, 0697004136, 0697004157, 0697004165, 0697004175, 0697004179, 0697005105, 0697005114, 0697005149, 0697005155, 0697005162, 0697005195, 0697005219, 0697005244. **NOIDA SEC 12-22:** 4174000104, 4174000952, 4174002387, 4174002505, 4174002520, 4174002525, 4174002541, 4174002557, 4174002579, 4174002599, 4174002650, 4174002658, 4174002678, 4174002712, 4174002768, 4174002846, 4174002856, 4174002900, 4174002915, 4174002923, 4174002942, 4174002969, 4174002992, 4174002999, 4174003012, 4174003043, 4174003058, 4174003

NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF STUDY AND RESEARCH IN LAW, RANCHI

At Nagri, PO- Bukru, Kanke-pithoria Road, Kanke, Ranchi, 834006

Ref:NUSRL/RNC/2026/ 1054 Date: 05/11/2026

Engagement Notice

National University of Study and Research in Law, Ranchi, invites applications from eligible candidates for the engagement of One (01) **Research Assistant (Intellectual Property Rights)** under the **DPIIT–IPR Chair**, established with the support of the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India.

The engagement shall be for undertaking research, academic, administrative and project-related activities of the DPIIT–IPR Chair.

- Tenure: The initial engagement shall be up to 31st March 2027. Further extension may be considered based on satisfactory performance, project requirements and availability of funds.
- Last Date of Receipt of Application: 16th November 2026

The Details of Procedure for applying are available on the Announcement Section of NUSRL website www.nusrlranchi.ac.in

Sd/-
Registrar
NUSRL Ranchi

PR 393524 Law (26-27) D"

झारखण्ड सरकार

महिला, बाल विकास एवं सामाजिक सुरक्षा विभाग

झारखण्ड मंत्रालय, प्रोजेक्ट भवन, धुर्वा, राँची – 834 004
दूरभाष – 0651–2400757, ईमेल –swdjharkhand@gmail.com
पत्र स०–03 / म०स० / CP–38/2016–

सूचना

सूचित किया जाता है कि दिव्यांगजन सशक्तिकरण विभाग, भारत सरकार द्वारा वित्तीय वर्ष 2026–27 के लिए दिव्यांग छात्र / छात्राओं को छात्रवृति हेतु National Scholarship Portal को आवेदन समर्पण किया जा रहा है।

Portal पर Pre Matric (वर्ग ix एवं x), Post-Matric (वर्ग xi से Post-Graduate Degree/Diploma) तथा Top Class Scholarship (Graduate/Post Graduate Degree/Diploma in Notified Institute of excellence in education) योजनान्तर्गत आवेदन समर्पित किया जाना प्रक्रियाधीन है, इस हेतु निम्नवत् तिथियों का निर्धारण किया गया है :–

Scheme	Last Data for Online Application
Pre Matric	15/11/2026
Post-Matric	30/11/2026
Top Class Scholarship	30/11/2026

राज्य के सभी योग्य एवं Benchmark दिव्यांग छात्र / छात्रा (40 प्रतिशत एवं अधिक दिव्यांगता से ग्रसित) Portal के URL-https://scholarships.gov.in पर वांछित दस्तावेजों के साथ निर्धारित तिथि के अन्दर छात्रवृत्ति हेतु आवेदन दर्ज कर सकते है।

ह0 / –
(विक्रमा राम)
सरकार के अवर सचिव।

PR 393445 Women, Child Development & Social Security(26-27)D

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e-Procurement Cell
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
SPECIAL WORKS DIVISION BUILDING CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT, RANCHI.
VERY- VERY SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITATION QUOTATION
Quotation Reference No:BCD/Special Work Division BCD, Ranchi/NIQ-41/2026-27
(Rate Purpose Only)

E- quotations are invited for the work of **Replacement work of all Battery of Online UPS (6No, 15 Kva), Repairing work of LT cum DG Synchronizing panel and Replacement of Main Drive of CAR Lift No-1 at New Jharkhand Bhawan, Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi** for Supply of Battery of Online UPS (6No, 15 Kva), Repairing work of LT work etc. for all Materials from Reputed Shop Keepers, Manufacturers, Suppliers, Retailers, Distributors, Furniture Suppliers, Registered B.C.D. Contractors and other for following items. They should quote their rates for unit mentioned in the table. If they do not deals all of the below mentioned items. Then they are allowed to quote their rate for part of the items which ever they deals. The rates should be exclusive of all types of Taxes, GST, Contractor's Profit and overhead charges etc. but inclusive of Royalty. All Rates should be exclusive of Labour Cess.

Term and Condition

1. The quotationer shall furnish pan, GST registration no.
2. The rate quoted by quotationer shall be firm and final.
3. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject/cancel any or all quotations without assigning any reason thereof.

नोट:–
1. वेबसाईट में ई–कोटेशन प्रकाशन की तिथि 13.11.2026 के अपराह्न 3:00 बजे।
2. वेबसाईट में ई–कोटेशन अपलोड की अंतिम तिथि 19.11.2026 के अपराह्न 3:00 बजे तक।
3. ई–कोटेशन खोलन की तिथि एवं समय 20.11.2026 अपराह्न 3:30 बजे।
4. ई–कोटेशन आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता कार्यपालक अभियंता, विशेश कार्य प्रमण्डल, भवन निर्माण विभाग, राँची।
5. ई–कोटेशन प्रकोष्ठा का दूरभाष सं0–7903899611

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

Nodal Officer
e-Procurement Cell, Office of the Executive Engineer
Special Works Division, BCD, Ranchi

PR 393487 Building(26-27)D

भर्ती विज्ञापन
(पंचम राज्य वित्त आयोग, झारखण्ड)
(प्रथम तल , योजना भवन , नेपाल हाउस , डोरण्डा , राँची– 834002)
Email Id: 5thsfcjharkhand@gmail.com

विज्ञापन संख्या : SFC–01 / 2026 आवेदन की अंतिम तिथि– 17.11.2026

एतद द्वारा निम्नलिखित संविदा आधारित 03 पदों हेतु पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशन आरक्षित वर्ग (सलाहकार / विषय विशेषज्ञ) आरक्षित / अनारक्षित (अनुसंधान सहायक)योग्य / पात्र अभ्यर्थियों से आवेदन आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं :–

1.	सलाहकार / विषय विशेषज्ञ	01 पद (अनुसूचित जनजाति–01)
	कार्यकाल	अधिकतम एक (01) वर्ष या 30.09.2027 तक (जो पहले पूर्ण हो)
	मासिक परिलब्धि	रु.1,23,200 / – प्रति माह (समेकित / एकमुश्त)
	उम्र	अधिकतम 64 वर्ष (01.09.2026 तक)
	आवश्यक योग्यताएं (शैक्षणिक यो गयता एवं तकनीकी ज्ञान)	• किसी प्रतिष्ठित संस्थान / विश्वविद्यालय से कम से कम 55 प्रतिशत अंकों के साथ स्नातकोत्तर (अधिमानतः अर्थशास्त्र / समाजशास्त्र / लोक नीति / ग्रामीण या शहरी विकास–प्रबंधन)। • एमएस ऑफिस (MS-OFFICE) में दक्षता। • सांख्यिकीय सॉफ्टवेयर और एआई अनुप्रयोगों का समुचित एवं व्यवहारिक ज्ञान। • सांख्यिकी, डेटा विश्लेषण तथा स्थानीय स्वशासन के कार्यों, पदाधिकारियों और वित्त–बजट की जानकारी। • संबंधित विषय में पीएच.डी. या समकक्ष शोध / कार्य अनुभव।
	वांछनीय योग्यताएं (अनुभव एवं शोध प्रकाशन)	• लोक वित्त / लोक नीति / स्थानीय शासन / ग्रामीण या शहरी विकास पर कम से कम 10 वर्षों का शोध अनुभव। • सहकर्मी–समीक्षित पत्रिकाओं / पुस्तकों में गुणवत्तापूर्ण शोध एवं प्रकाशन। • स्थानीय स्वशासन तथा झारखंड अथवा अन्य राज्य विशेष से संबंधित मुद्दों पर शोध अनुभव।
	शोध / अनुसंधान सहायक	02 पद (अनारक्षित–01 , अनुसूचित जनजाति–01)
	कार्यकाल	अधिकतम एक (01) वर्ष या 30.09.2027 तक (जो पहले पूर्ण हो)
	मासिक परिलब्धि	रु.55 ,700 / – प्रति माह (समेकित / एकमुश्त)
	उम्र	45 वर्ष / आरक्षित श्रेणी को 05 वर्ष की छूट (उम्र सीमा की गणना 01-09-2026 के तिथि तक की जायेगी)
	आवश्यक योग्यताएं (शैक्षणिक योग्यता एवं तकनीकी ज्ञान)	• किसी प्रतिष्ठित संस्थान / विश्वविद्यालय से कम से कम 55 प्रतिशत अंकों के साथ स्नातकोत्तर (अधिमानतः अर्थशास्त्र / समाजशास्त्र / लोक नीति / ग्रामीण या शहरी विकास–प्रबंधन)। • एमएस ऑफिस (MS-OFFICE) में दक्षता। • सांख्यिकीय सॉफ्टवेयर और एआई अनुप्रयोगों का समुचित एवं व्यवहारिक ज्ञान। • सांख्यिकी, डेटा विश्लेषण तथा स्थानीय स्वशासन के कार्यों, पदाधिकारियों और वित्त–बजट की जानकारी।
	वांछनीय योग्यताएं (अनुभव एवं शोध प्रकाशन)	• सहकर्मी–समीक्षित पत्रिकाओं / पुस्तकों में गुणवत्तापूर्ण शोध एवं प्रकाशन, संबंधित क्षेत्र में कार्य / शोध अनुभव। • स्थानीय स्वशासन से संबंधित मुद्दों पर शोध अनुभव।

नोट :– शोध / अनुसंधान सहायक हेतु विधिवत आवेदन करने वाले अभ्यर्थी को पुनः आवेदन करने की आवश्यकता नही है।

2- वित्त विभागीय संकल्प सं.–1478/वि. दिनांक–29-04-2026 के आलोक में यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः संविदा आधारित होगी एवं इस नियुक्ति की वैधता पंचम राज्य वित्त आयोग के कार्यकाल (दिनांक–30-09-2027) तक सीमित रहेगी। उक्त के आधार पर भविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति का किसी प्रकार का दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।

3- उपरोक्त 02 पदवर्ग क्रमशः क्र.1 एवं क्र.2 हेतु योग्य / पात्र अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा अलग–अलग आवेदन भरा जा सकेगा। साथ ही आवेदक द्वारा आवेदन हिन्दी / अंग्रेजी में भरा जा सकेगा।

4- आवेदन प्रपत्र आयोग के **Website: http//:sfc.jharkhand.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध रहेगी। पूर्णरूपेण भरे हुए आवेदन को आयोग के **e-mail Id: 5thsfcjharkhand@gmail.com** पर निर्धारित अंतिम तिथि दिनांक–17.11.2026 के सायं 05:00 बजे तक भेजा जा सकेगा एवं इसके पश्चात प्राप्त आवेदनों पर विचार नहीं किया जाएगा।

5- आवेदन पत्र के साथ मात्र मैट्रिक, इन्टरमीडिएट, स्नातक, स्नातकोत्तर के अंक पत्र, सक्षम स्तर से निर्गत जाति प्रमाण पत्र (मात्र ST अभ्यर्थी के लिये, जो अनुमंडल पदाधिकारी से अन्यून स्तर का न हो) एवं पीएच.डी. की डिग्री scan कर संलग्न की जायेगी। वर्णित **Documents** के अलावे कोई अभिलेख संलग्न नहीं किया जाएगा।

6- उक्त वर्णित पदों पर चयन मैट्रिक, इन्टरमीडिएट, स्नातक, स्नातकोत्तर के अंक प्रतिशत आधारित weightage एवं पीएच.डी. के मूल्यांकन इत्यादि तथा अंतर्विक्षा / साक्षात्कार में प्राप्त अंकों के समेकन के आधार पर किया जाएगा।

7- अंतर्विक्षा / साक्षात्कार हेतु सूचीबद्ध अभ्यर्थियों की सूची पदवर्गवार एवं अंतर्विक्षा की निर्धारित तिथि की सूचना आयोग के वेबसाईट पर जारी की जायेगी। संबंधित अभ्यर्थी को उनके e-mail Id पर भी सूचना दी जायेगी। अतः आयोग के वेबसाईट का नियमित अवलोकन (site visit) आवश्यक है।

8- अंतर्विक्षा हेतु TA/DA देय नहीं होगा।

9- अंतिम रूप से चयनित अभ्यर्थियों का परिणाम आयोग के वेबसाईट पर जारी की जायेगी एवं संबंधित अभ्यर्थी को उनके e-mail Id पर भी सूचना दी जायेगी।

10- कार्यावधि पूर्ण होने पर आयोग द्वारा कार्य अनुभव प्रमाण पत्र निर्गत किया जायेगा।

ह0 / –
(सचिव)
पंचम राज्य वित्त आयोग, झारखण्ड।

PR 393482 Finance(26-27)D

बिहार सरकार

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
भवन निर्माण विभाग, भवन प्रमंडल, मोतिहारी
केवल ई0 निविदा पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट **www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in** पर
अल्पकालीन पुनः ई0 निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना **(S.B.D)**
अल्पकालीन पुनः ई0 निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0 – 18 / 2026–27

कार्य का विवरणी :–

क्र0 सं0	कार्य का नाम	परिमाण विपत्र की राशि (रूपये में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रूपये में)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य रूपये में।	बिड प्रोसेशिंग शुल्क सेवा कर सहित	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
01	02	03	04	05	06	07
01	पूर्वी चम्पारण जिलान्तर्गत पिपराकोठी प्रखण्ड में प्रखण्ड – सह – अंचल कार्यालय – सह – आवासीय भवनों के निर्माण एवं परिसर के विकास कार्य (विद्युतीकरण सहित)।	28,21,56,260.00	28,21,600.00	10,000.00	As per website	15 माह।

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :– **कार्यपालक अभियंता, भवन प्रमंडल, मोतिहारी** ।
2. निविदा आमंत्रण की तिथि :– दिनांक –04 / 11 / 2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड करने की प्रारंभिक एवं अंतिम तिथि :– दिनांक –19 / 11 / 2026 से दिनांक–15 / 12 / 2026 तक।
4. निविदा कागजात अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक – 16 / 12 / 2026 को 03:00 बजे अप0 तक।
5. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक – 17 / 12 / 2026 को 03:30 बजे अप0 ।
6. वित्तीय बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– तकनीकी बीड मूल्यांकन के पश्चात् ।
7. निविदा (परिमाण विपत्र) बिक्री, प्राप्ति एवं खोलने का स्थान :– **वेबसाईट (www.eproc2bihar.gov.in)**
8. प्रिबीड मिटिंग की तिथि समय एवं स्थान :– (i) दिनांक– **01 / 12 / 2026** को 03:00 बजे **अपराहन् अधीक्षण अभियंता**, भवन अंचल, मोतिहारी का कार्यालय। (ii) दिनांक– **04 / 12 / 2026** को 03:00 बजे **अपराहन मुख्य अभियंता (उ0)** भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना का कार्यालय।
9. निविदा वैधता की तिथि :– 120 दिन।
10. इस निविदा का विज्ञापन वेबसाईट **www.prdbihar.gov.in/ (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)** पर देखा जा सकता है।
11. कार्य की विशिष्टियों अथवा निविदा की शर्तो के संबंध में किसी भी प्रकार की पृच्छा या स्पष्टीकरण प्रीबिड मीटिंग की तिथि

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
भवन प्रमण्डल, मोतिहारी

PR. No. 014966 (BCD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

बिहार सरकार

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सिंचाई प्रमण्डल, नवादा
email:- ee.wrd.nawada@gmail.com
अति अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–05 / 2026–27
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)

1. कार्य का विवरण :–

क्रम संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू0 में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रू0 में)	परिमाण – विपत्र का मूल्य (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में) (रू0 में)	बेल्ट्रॉन को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में) (रू0 में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	कोरिहारी सिंचाई योजना अंतर्गत विभिन्न नहर संरचनाओं के निर्माण, पुनर्निर्माण एवं आवश्यक मरम्मति कार्य।	24.99874	50000.00	5000.00	1180.00	03 (तीन) माह

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :– दिनांक 03.11.2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि :– दिनांक 11.11.2026 से दिनांक 18.11.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराहन तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
4. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक 18.11.2026 के 3:30 बजे अपराहन । (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
5. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायगी। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
6. निविदा खोलने का स्थान :– www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर
7. निविदा की वैधता की अवधि :– 120 दिन
8. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, सिंचाई प्रमंडल, नवादा।
9. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है। विस्तृत जानकारी **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता,
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, नवादा
मो0 नं0 – 7463889331

PR. No. 014923 (WRD) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

Govt. of Bihar

RURAL WORKS DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE ASSISTANT ENGINEER, TESTING & QUALITY CONTROL LABORATORY, **JEHANABAD**

INVITATION FOR QUOTATION
Tender Notice no.- RWD/Q&C/JEHANABAD/03/2026-27

Sealed quotations are invited from reputed and eligible **manufacturers / OEMs / authorized dealers / suppliers** for Supply, Installation, Demonstration and Training of Laboratory Equipment for Testing & Quality Control Laboratory, Jehanabad, Rural Works Department, Government of Bihar.

The equipment shall be of suitable quality and conform to applicable **BIS/IS, IRC, MoRD/MoRTH** and other relevant standards/specifications.

1. Scope of Supply

Laboratory equipment for Earthwork/Subgrade, Granular Sub-Base, WBM/WMM, Bitumen & Emulsion, Bituminous Mixes, Concrete testing and miscellaneous laboratory requirements. The item-wise list and maximum permissible rates are available in the detailed quotation document.

2. Principal Commercial & Technical Conditions

Particular	Condition
Warranty	Minimum 1 year warranty on all equipment.
AMC	Separate quotation for 4-year AMC for specified Table-B equipment. Maximum AMC: 8% of equipment cost per annum.
Standards	Applicable BIS/IS, IRC, MoRD/ MoRTH/ ASTM/other prescribed standards shall be complied with.
Calibration	Valid calibration certificate traceable to are cognized/NABL-accredited laboratory, wherever applicable.
Eligibility	OEM or authorized dealer/distributor .Authorization and details of previous similar supplies to Govt. Departments/PSUs/reputed organization.
Rate	F.O.R. Testing & Quality Control Division/Laboratory at District Headquarters ,inclusive of all taxes and charges. No additional charges.
Delivery	Within 20 days from date of issue of Supply Order.
Installation	Supplier responsible for installation, commissioning, calibration and demonstration/training.
Payment	50% after successful supply/delivery; 45%afterinstallation, calibration, commissioning and training; 5% retained as security Deposit.
EMD	Rs 25,000/-by Demand Draft in favor of Assistant Engineer, payable at Jehanabad
Validity	Minimum 90 days from the last date of submission.

1. Submission of Quotation

The quotation, duly signed and stamped on each page, shall be submitted in a sealed envelope superscribed **"QUOTATION FOR SUPPLY OF EQUIPMENT FOR TESTING AND QUALITY CONTROL, LABORATORY"** and to be submitted at Concerned Office.

The quotation shall be accompanied by: (i) GST Registration Certificate, (ii) PAN,(iii) OEM/Authorized Dealer certificate,(iv) EMD of Rs 25,000/-, and (v)Quoted equipment and AMC rates.

Start date of submission: Last Date & Time of Submission: 27-11-2026 , 3.00 PM
Date & Time of Opening: 27-11-2026 , 3.30 PM

2. Other Conditions

The supplier shall be responsible for servicing and maintenance during the warranty/AMC period. Failure to attend complaints/breakdowns within the prescribed period may result in forfeiture of security deposit and debarment/ blacklisting as per departmental terms.

The Department reserves the right to increase, decrease, add or delete any item as per actual requirement and to accept or reject any or all quotations, wholly or partly, without assigning any reason.

3. For Further Details

Please visit the website: **https://eadvtprd.bihar.gov.in/Public_AdView01.aspx**

4. For any Further Enquiry Please Contact: **7352166155**

Assistant Engineer
Testing & Quality Control Laboratory, Jehanabad
Rural Works Department, Government of Bihar

PR- 015053 (RWD) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

Govt. of Bihar

INDIRA GANDHI INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
Sheikhpura, Patna-14 (Bihar), Email id-director@igims.org
Tel.: 0612-2297631, 2297099; Fax:0612-2297225; Website: igims.org

Memo No.: 4945/Adm

RECRUITMENT NOTICE

Applications are invited on prescribed Performa from Indian citizen for appointment on following posts on Deputation at IGIMS, Patna. The last/closing date of submission of the application is 30 days from the date of the publication of the advertisement in the employment news through Registered Post/Speed Post/Courier.

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Post	Mode of appointment
1.	Sr. Administrative Officer	01	Deputation
2.	Administrative Officer	01	Deputation
3.	Finance & Chief Accounts Officer	01	Deputation
4.	Accounts Officer	02	Deputation
5.	Stores Officer	01	Deputation
6.	Executive Engineer. (Civil)	01	Deputation/Contract
7.	Jr. Engineer (Civil)	01	Deputation/ Contract
8.	Jr. Engineer (Mechanical)	01	Deputation/ Contract
9.	Jr. Engineer (Bio Medical)	01	Deputation/ Contract
10.	Public Relation Officer	01	Deputation
11.	Assistant Public Relation Officer	01	Deputation

Details of posts, requisite qualification, experience, upper age limit, pay-scale, reservation rules, application fee etc. is given as under. Performa of application can be downloaded from Institute's website www.igims.org. The applicants are requested to regulary visit the Institute website for further updates.

Advt. No.:- 02/Adm/Non Faculty Post/IGIMS/26

Chief Administrative Officer
IGIMS, Patna-14

PR- 015079 (B & C) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
SOIL INVESTIGATION DIVISION,
ADVANCE PLANNING,
ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT,RANCHI
NirupanBhawan,3rd Floor,Room No. 403,56-Set,
Doranda,Ranchi-834002

e-Procurement (Very Short Tender Notice)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.-23/2026-27 1st Call
e-Tender Ref No:–RCD/SID/AP/RAN/23/2026-27
Date:- 05.11.2026

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Widening & Strengthening/Reconstruction work of Road from Chandrapura, Sidho - Kanho Chowk to Jamuatand Chowk (2 lane Paved Shoulder) including Replacement of Culverts and Bridges, Proposal for Construction of new Culverts, Bridges, ROB's, RUB's, Complete Land Acquisition Proposal including Ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Proposal, Forest Diversion Proposal and Proposal of Utility Shifting in details etc. as required by the Department (If any) under Road Division Bokaro in the State of Jharkhand. *Empanelled consultant with RCD under category-I vide letter No. 4073 (S) WE Dated 28.09.2026 are allowed to Bid.
2	Tentative Length	14.00 km
3	Period of Completion of Work	60 Days
4	Cost of Tender documents	Rs 5,000/- (Five Thousand) only. Non refundable Fee.Tender fee will be recived through online mode only. The quotationers have to deposit a fixed amount ofRs 20,000 as Earnest Money. As per the Departmental Letter no.-4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest MoneyDeposit be received in online mode only through e-procurement (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating sistim Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & eGovernance Department, Government ofJharkhand vide letter no 120 dated 03.10.2023.
5	Mode of Bid Submission	e-tendering(http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	10.11.2026,10:30 AM
7	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	19.11.2026 12:00PM
8	Last Date/Time of Submission of Tender Fee & EMD	19.11.2026 12:00PM
9	Date and Time of Bid opening	20.11.2026 12:30 PM
10	Bid validity	120 days
11	Bid Submission Address	Chief Engineer(Communication),Road Construction Department,1st Floor, Engineer Hostel No.-2, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
12	Designation and Contact no. of Tender inviting Officer	Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division,Advance PlanningRCD, Ranchi Mob-9905660677.

Note:-Only e-Tender shall be accepted.

Sd./-(Ravi Shankar Pravakar)
Executive Engineer,
Soil Investigation Division, Advance Planning,
Road Construction Department,Ranchi.

PR 393495 (Road)26-27*D

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
तिलैया नहर प्रमंडल, वजीरगंज, गया।

निविदा आमत्रण सूचना संख्या–01SBD/2026-27
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

शुद्धि–पत्र

इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक– 2220 दिनांक–15.10.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–01SBD/2026-27 जो PR N0 – 014007 (WRD) 2026-27 से विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित है, उसके **कंडिका संख्या–24 "निविदादाता द्वारा न्यूनतम दर उद्धत करने के संबंध में पथ निर्माण विभाग, पटना का पत्रांक– 4439 (E) दिनांक– 17.07.2023 एवं जल संसाधन विभाग, पटना का पत्रांक– 536 दिनांक– 18.07.2023 के आलोक में माननीय उच्च न्यायालय, पटना के CWJC No- 9941/2022 मे दिनांक– 06.07.2023 को पारित आदेश का अनुपालन अनिवार्य होगा "** को विलोपित किया जाता हैं।

निविदा में प्रकाशित अन्य नियम एवं शर्ते पूर्ववत् रहेगें।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
तिलैया नहर प्रमण्डल, वजीरगंज, गया
मो0 :– 7463889885

PR- 015056 (WRD) 2026-27

उक्त सूचना **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से भी प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

बिहार सरकार

समाहरणालय, बाँका
(मद्यनिषेध शाखा)
अल्पकालीन आम सूचना
फोन–06424–222304(0), 222303(R) , E-Mail Address-dm-banka.bih@nic.in

एतद् द्वारा निम्नांकित वाहन के स्वामियों को सूचित किया जाता है कि मद्य निशेध अभियान के अन्तर्गत पुलिस के विभिन्न थाना जिला बाँका द्वारा जब्त निम्नांकित वाहनों का बिहार मद्य निशेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम 2016 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत् **जिला पंचायती राज पदा0–सह–मद्यनिशेध दण्डा0, बाँका** के द्वारा अधिकृत न्यायालयों में राज्यसात का प्रस्ताव प्राप्त हुआ है। यदि वाहन स्वामी प्रपत्र IV आवेदन जमा कर अपना वाहन मुक्त कराना चाहते हो अथवा उन्हें आपत्ति / दावा समर्पित करना हो तो वे अपना पक्ष नीचे कॉलम में अंकित न्यायालय में अंकित तिथि को स्वयं अथवा अधिवक्ता के माध्यम से **अपना पक्ष प्रस्तुत** कर सकते है। निर्धारित अवधि तक वाहनों के संबंध में प्रपत्र IV / दावा / आपत्ति प्राप्त नहीं होता है तो एकपक्षीय आदेश पारित कर दिया जायेगा।

क्र0 सं0	थाना का नाम	कांड सं0 / दिनांक	जप्त वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन निबंधन संख्या / चेचिस संख्या / इंजन संख्या	वहन स्वामी का नाम व पता	न्यायालय का नाम	उपस्थित होने का दिनांक
1	उत्पाद थाना बाँका	135/26, 29.03.2026	बजाज डिस्कवर मोटरसाईकिल	DL8SAA6 106	अज्ञात	जिला पंचायती राज पदा0–सह– मद्यनिषेध दण्डा0, बाँका	01.12.2026

समाहर्त्ता,
बाँका

PR. No. 015045 (Excise) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

रक्त की आवश्यकता पड़ने पर लाईसेंस प्राप्त ब्लड बैंकों से ही रक्त प्राप्त करें।

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, SHABNAM PERWEEN, W/o-MOHD AKHLAK AHMAD, R/o-H.No-A-42, F/F, A-BLOCK, NEW SEELAMPUR, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to SHABNAM PARVEEN, for all purposes. 0040887971-3

I, SANJAY GOEL S/o Late JAGDISH PRASAD GOEL R/o C-245, Ground Floor, Lohia Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201001 have changed my name to SANJAY KUMAR GOEL for all purposes. 0071070371-1

I,Megha,D/o-Ravinder Khanna, R/o-F-31,East of Kailash,New Delhi-110065,have added surname to my name and shall henceforth be known as Megha Khanna,for all records,documents and purposes. 0040887969-6

I Kumar Gaurav S/o B.S. Khurana R/o Flat No.51B, 3rd Floor, DDA Flats, BLK -C3, Keshav Puram, New Delhi-110035 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Thritika to Thritika Khurana for all purposes. 0040887837-1

I, Paramjeet Singh Rawat S/o Nandan Singh Rawat R/o-D228, Konark Enclave, Sec-17, Vasundhra, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Pramjeet Singh Rawat. 0071070447-1

I,Shikha Rani,W/o-Deepak Gupta,R/o-Flat No.-208, Second Floor,Plot No.-40, Divya Apartments,Dayanand Colony, Gurgaon(Haryana)-122001,have changed my name to Shikha Gupta for all Purposes. 0040887973-1

I Kalpana Sood W/o Pramindra Lal R/o B-90, Swasthya Vihar, Shakarpur, East Delhi, Delhi - 110092, have changed my name to Kalpana Sood Lal 0071070374-1

I,Digambar Singh,S/O-Panna Lal,R/O-H.No-C-18A,Sawan Park, Ashok Vihar Phase-3 North West Delhi, Delhi-110052 Have Changed My Name To Digamber. 0040887969-8

I,Shivani Gupta,D/o-Mukesh Gupta,R/o-109 Master Block,street no.3 Shakarpur,Delhi-110092,declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Shivani Gupta Gupta in my Passport No. AG045807,The actual name of mine is Shivani Gupta. 0040887969-1

I,Aadil Solanki,S/o-Manish Kumar R/o H.No.228, Pooth Kalan, North West Delhi-110086 have changed my name to Aadi Solanki. 0040887975-1

I, Samia W/o MD Faizan R/o-Mohalla Pathanana, Jhinjhana, Shamli have changed ny name to Samiya for all purposes. 0071070444-1

I, Paramjeet Singh Rawat S/o Nandan Singh R/o-D228, Konark Enclave, Sec-17, Vasundhra, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Pramjeet Singh Rawat. 0071070418-1

I, SUHAIL s/o Parvez tomer R/o 0, Nidori,samaipur, ghaziabad, I have changed my name to SUHAIL TOMER For all purposes 0040887969-3

I,DEV RAJ,S/O-DEVINDER KUMAR,R/O-PLOT NO-5,2ND FLOOR,SITE 7,NEW RAJINDER NAGAR,RAJENDER NAGAR,DELHI-110060,have changed my name to DEV RAJ BHURANDA. 0040887992-1

I, ANIL, S/o- Late Sh. Bhagwan Baisla, R/o- H. No. 1524, Gali No.1, Wazir Nagar, Kotla Mubarak Pur, New Delhi-110003, have changed my name to ANIL BAISLA, for all future purposes. 0040887971-2

I, Nidhi Malhotra w/o Ashish Sahni r/o Flat No.-27, Pocket-13, Sector-22, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name as NIDHI SAHNI permanently. 0040887841-1

I,Shelly Singh Chauhan,D/O-Sri D K Chauhan,have changed my name to Shelly Srivastava,for all future purpose,wide affidavit,dt.14-06-2023 sworn before,Notary J Anand Kumar 0040887969-5

I, Ravi Yadav, S/o Ghamandi Singh, R/o K-252, First Floor, Indra Gali No.3, Gautam Vihar, Garhi Mendu, PO: Bhajan Pura, Delhi-110053, declare that name of my wife has been wrongly written as Roopa Yadav in my minor daughter's namely Nabbya Yadav, aged 15 years in her school documents. The actual name of my wife is Rupa Yadav, which may be amended accordingly. 0040887839-1

I,RITU,D/o.Ram Janam,R/o.80-B,Kallu Mohalla,Garhi Village,East of Kailash, South Delhi-110065,have changed my name to RITU SHARMA permanently 0040887971-4

I Bijendra Rohatgi S/O Parshad Bala Resident 5D, Pocket-K, Sheikh Sarai Phase-2, Delhi-110017 have changed my name to Vijender Rohatgi. 0040887969-7

I Sofia Messey D/o Maxwell Massey R/o N-19/C-2, Near Suraksha Nursing Home, Dilshad Garden, East Delhi, Delhi-110095 have changed my name to Sofiya Massey for all purposes. 0040887837-2

I, Manisha Yadav, W/o Naveen Yadav, DOB: 20-10-1989, resident of Baldhan Kalan, District Rewari, Haryana - 123411, have changed my name from Manisha Yadav to Manisha Kumari and shall henceforth be known as Manisha Kumari for all purposes. 0130071140-1

I,PARVEEN ALAM,s/o-ummed ali tomer,R/o-H.No-26,Vikram Enclave Extension shalimar garden,sahibabad,ghaziabad, uttarpradesh -201005,I have changed my name to PARVEZ TOMER For All purposes. 0040887969-2

I, ANKUSH KUMAR, clarify that in my Class 10th marksheet, my parents' names are misspelled. AJAY KUMAR refers to my father, AJAY KUMAR PANDAY, and AARTI PANDEY refers to my mother, ARTI PANDAY. This is for official records. 0040887974-1

I,SHAIFALI GOGIA,D/o-Prakash Chand Gogia,R/o-House-No.238,Jagriti Enclave, Vikas Marg, Delhi,East Delhi,Delhi-110092,have changed my name to,SHAIFALI P GOGIA for all future purpose. 0040887971-1

I,Lalit Kumar Goyal,S/o-Mukesh Kumar Goyal,R/o,313/27-A,Inderlok, Delhi-110035,affirm that the names Lalit Kumar Goyal & Lalit Kumar, are one and the same person. 0040887969-4

I, Sofiya Haidry W/o Vajahat Ali R/o Mohalla Kot, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to KM Sofiya Haidry. 0071070373-1

I,KRISHNA W/O DEV RAJ BHURANDA R/O PLOT NO-5,2ND FLOOR,SITE 7,NEW RAJINDER NAGAR,RAJENDER NAGAR,DELHI-110060 have changed my name to KRISHNA BHURANDA. 0040887992-2

I, Ifra W/o Mohd. Salman & D/o Suresh R/o 36/79, Block-36, Trilok Puri, Delhi-110091, having changed my name to Kajal for all purposes. 0040847437-1

LOST & FOUND

LOST AND FOUND THE ORIGINAL SALE DEED OF PROPERTY NO. IX/7158, GANDHI NAGAR, DELHI-110031 IN FAVOUR OF MY GRAND MOTHER SMT. LAXMI RANI W/O LATE SH. OM PARKASH CHANANA HAS BEEN LOST/MISPLACED WHILE SHIFTING THE RESIDENCE ON 5TH SEPTEMBER 2026. A POLICE REPORT HAS BEEN LODGED. ANY PERSON WHO FINDS THE SALE DEED MAY PLEASE RETURN THE SAME. CONTACT- SUNIL CHANANA-PH. 9582005455 0040887837-3

I, Ashok Kumar Gupta, S/o Late Sat Narain, hereby inform the public that I have lost the original General Power of Attorney and Special Power of Attorney dated 06.03.2003, executed between Alka Arora and Gian Chand Goel, pertaining to H-1421, DSIIDC Indl Area, Narela, Delhi LR No: 777595/2026. Finder may kindly contact 9810056400 0040887970-1

LOST OF my FDR(File No.F16(6891)/2012/RHN,Application No.48820,Priority No.12304 in Rohini LIG Scheme,A-1/1479,Sector-34, Rohini, Delhi In the Name of Davinder Pal Singh,S/o-Sh.Inder Jit Singh.Finder may Contact-Davinder Pal Singh,S/o-Sh.Inder Jit Singh at-HOUSE-NO.32/54,PATEL NAGAR,DELHI-110008. 0040887969-9

AFFIDAVIT I, RAJESH JHA, father of ADI NARAYANAN JHA, resident of N-25C, Saket, New Delhi 110017, hereby affirm that: My son's Pass Certificate Cum Statement of Marks, issued by CISCE, New Delhi, has been misplaced. Rajesh Jha DEPONENT 0050301078-1

EDUCATIONAL

Dowsing & Vastudosh Global Standard Workshop, organized by School of Indian Dowsers andGeomancy on Online Zoom, Batch 218, on 15th and 22nd November, two Sundays, Practical Workshop, morning 9:30 AM to 2 PM. Complete registration call and bank payment via mobile. Kit delivered to your doorstep. Lecher Antenna Cosmic Energy 2-day global standard training, 28th batch, 12th and 13th December, full day in Dadar, Mumbai, including a site visit. Syllabus covered in both workshops : Vastu Energy, Land Testing and Defects, Health and Healing,Geopathic Stress, Harmful Water, Detailed advanced curriculum. More Information & Contact on Website : Hundreds of photos and reviews/ feedback are available on https://www.indiandowsers.org Watch four videos on YouTube Channel : Dowser's Diary. Contact : Prof. Ravi Vaidya Sir, Principal Dowser, Mobile : 9821349038/ 9821380289. 0071070037-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to the general public that my clients, **Shri Jugal Kishore** (S/o Shri Bhagwan Dass) and **Smt. Yashoda** (W/o Shri Jugal Kishore) (both husband and wife), residents of Flat No. A-33, Pocket-1, Paschim Puri, New Delhi, have disowned and debarred their son, **Pawan Kumar @ Raju,** daughter-in-law, **Hanshu @ Pooja,** and their children, **Master Yashveer** and **Baby Myra,** from all their movable and immovable properties/assets, and have severed all kinds of relations with them due to their misconduct and bad behavior. If anyone deals with them, they shall do so at their own risk, cost, and consequences. My clients and the rest of their family members shall not be responsible for any of their unlawful, illegal, or wrongful acts or deeds.

Sd/-
KHALIL AHMED
Advocate
CH.No.C-24 B CL JSPH BLC.
TIS HAZARI COURTS DELHI

LOST PROPERTY DOCUMENTS NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that the original registered Sale Deed (Registration No. 1318, Dated 29 May 2015) and the original Deed of Apartment (Registration No. 1319, Dated 29 May 2015), both executed at the office of the Sub-Registrar, Tigaon, Faridabad, regarding Flat D-2001, Redwood Residency, Tigaon Road, Sector 78, Faridabad in the joint names of Jai Prakash Rai and Aditi Rai have been lost/misplaced together. A Lost Property Report has been lodged at Police Station Kheripul, Faridabad under LPR No. 132250912600620. If found, please return to the sender or contact at 9984923764 within 15 days.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public at large that my client, Mr. ANUJ SHEORAN son of Late Sh. Satyavir Singh Sheoran, permanently residing at H. No. B-813, Jal Vayu Towers, Sector-56, Gurugram (Haryana)-122011, and presently residing at 626, Broadway, Apt 213, Santa Monica, CA-90401, United States of America, has revoked, cancelled and withdrawn, with immediate effect, the General Power of Attorney dated 21.06.2022, registered with the Sub-Registrar, Wazirabad, Gurugram, under Registration No.294, with stamp details, Sr. No. G0T2022F3158 and GRN No. 91610941, executed by him in favour of Mr. ATUL SHEORAN son of Late Sh. Satyavir Singh Sheoran, resident of H. No. B-813, Jal Vayu Towers, Sector-56, Gurugram - 122011. Mr. Atul Sheoran, and any sub-attorney or representative appointed by him, has no authority to act for my client in respect of any of his movable or immovable properties. Any person, bank, institution or authority that deals with Mr. Atul Sheoran or any person claiming through him on the strength of the said General Power of Attorney after this notice does so at his or its own risk, cost and consequences. My client will not be liable for, or bound by, any such dealing.

Karan Bhardwaj (Advocate)
Ch. No.914-915 Patiala House Court
New Delhi-110001. **Mob. No.** 9999821823

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public at large that my client **Mr. Davinder Kumar Goel** S/o Late Khubi Ram Gupta R/o H.No.579, 1st Floor, Sector-29, Faridabad, Haryana, (M) 9871980211 have severed all his relations with his son namely **Devesh Goel** H.No.579, 1st Floor, Sector-29, Faridabad, Haryana, (M) 9350682806, have disowned and debarred them from all their movable and immovable properties due to his misbehave, ill treatment and disobedience and my client shall not be responsible for his debt or any liability or any or loan in past, present and future, Any person deals with him shall do it at his/her/their own risk, costs and my clients shall not be responsible for the same.

Sd/-
NAVIN KUMAR JHA (Advocate)
Ch. No. B-98, B.G.S. Block,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-54

COURT NOTICE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
(Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
In the Court of
Dr. Pankaj Sharma, DJ-2+ Waqf Tribunal, Room No. 22, Patiala House Courts, New Delhi.
SUIT No. CS/585/2019
ANTRIKSH BHAWAN FLAT OWNER WELFARE SCIETY
.....Plaintiff/Petitioner/s/ Appellant/s
Against
GANESH DAS BHOJRAJ
.....Defendant/ Respondent

To
SH. GANESH DAS BHOJRAJ
FLAT NO. 212-A, 2ND FLOOR, ANTRIKSH BHAWAN, 22, K.G. MARG, NEW DELHI-110001.
ALSO AT: H-5/4, MODEL TOWN, NEW DELHI-110009.

WHEREAS you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the **07.12.2026 @10 AM** the day fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the court, this 20.08.2026

Seal Sd/-
Judge

न्यायालय प्रधान न्यायाधीश परिवार न्यायालय, सहरसा।
विवाह विच्छेद वाद सं- 72/2025
आभा देवी .....आवेदिका
बनाम
गाँधी कुमार साह .....विपक्षी/ प्रतिवादी

नोटिस बनाम प्रतिवादी 1. Gandhi Kumar Sah Rio House No. 115, A BLOCK, Gali No.-06. Kailash Vihar, Panshali, Rohini Sector-32, Pincode- 110042, New Delhi.

बजरिये इस प्रकाशन नोटिस के आप प्रतिवादी को सूचित किया जाता है कि आपलोगों के विरुद्ध आवेदिका ने नजारत नोटिस एवं निबंधित नोटिस भेजा था बावजूद इसके आपलोग अभी तक न्यायालय में जानबुझकर हाजीर नहीं हुये हैं। अतः इस प्रकाशन नोटिस द्वारा आप को आगाह किया जाता है आप इस बाद में निश्चित अगली तारीख 18.11.2026 को 10 बजे दिन में स्वयं या अपने अधिवक्ता के माध्यम से उपस्थित होकर अपना पक्ष पेश करें, अन्यथा आपके अनुपस्थिति में न्यायालय द्वारा एकपक्षीय सुनवाई आदेश पारित कर दिया जायेगा।

मुहर हस्ता/-
प्रधान न्यायाधीश,
परिवार न्यायालय, सहरसा

IN THE COURT OF SH. HARISH KUMAR, DISTRICT JUDGE (COMMERCIAL COURT)-04 WEST DISTRICT, ROOM NO.202, 2ND FLOOR, EXTENSION BLOCK, TIS HAZARI COURTS DELHI
SUMMON FOR PUBLICATION
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
(Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
Suit No. CS (COMM)/208/2026
BANK OF BARODA
.....Plaintiff
Vs
KAVITA SHARMA
.....Defendant

To,
DEFENDANTS
MRS KAVITA SHARMA
W/O SH. ALOK GOYAL
R/O H. NO. A-26, GALI NO. 1, JOHARI PUR, GOKAL PURI, NORTH EAST, DELHI-110094
THE DEFENDANT ABOVE NAMED.

WHEREAS you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the **20.11.2026** the day fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex-parte.

Given under my hand and the seal of the court, this **14.10.2026.**

Seal Sd/-
Judge

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page
The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

North Eastern Railway

CORRIGENDUM-I

Tender notice number NER_S&T_Project_Gorakhpur_01_2026. was invited on 08.10.2026, Corrigendum-1 has been issued with amendments. Detailed information can be seen on e-tendering website 'www.ireps.gov.in'. This is approved at the competent level.

Dy CSTE/Project/GKP
CPRO/Signal-142 Gorakhpur

DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

PUBLIC NOTICE

Sadhna Plus and **Har Khabar** have severed all ties and association with **Mr. Brij Mohan Singh,** or his allies and **Vibrant Broadcasting,** with immediate effect. Any person/entity dealing with **Mr. Brij Mohan Singh** or his companies shall do so entirely at their own risk and responsibility. The Company shall have no liability whatsoever for any such dealings.

(Director)
Sharpline Broadcast

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
RAILWAY RECRUITMENT CELL/NORTHERN RAILWAY
Employment Notice No. RRC/NR 03/2026/Act. APP.

INDICATIVE NOTICE

RRC Website: www.rrcnr.org

Online Application are invited from eligible and desirous candidates for 4651 slots against Engagement of Act. Apprentices under the Apprentices Act 1961 for imparting training at various Division/units/Workshops over Northern Railway for the year 2026- 27.

Important Dates	
Date of Publication of Detailed Notification on RRC Website	06.11.2026
Date of start of online Application	11.11.2026
Date & time of closing of Online Application	11.12.2026 at 23:59 hrs.
Expected Date of Display of Merit	February 2027

3911/26 **CHAIRMAN/RRC**

"BEWARE OF TOUTS, BROKERS AND JOB RACKETEERS"

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-09 कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय) (30प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम) 2-शंकरनगर (नियर संदीप गैस एजेंसी), दिल्ली रोड, सहारनपुर

Ref No. : 2124/E-Tender/216
Date : 03-11-2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय) की ओर से जनपद - मुजफ्फरनगर में अटल आवासीय विद्यालय में सुरक्षा के दृष्टिगत अतिरिक्त कार्य अनुमानित लागत रू० 104.83 लाख (लेबर सेस सहित एवं जी०एस०टी० रहित) हेतु दिनांक 13.11.2026 अपरान्ह 05:00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 04.11.2026 से दिनांक 13.11.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 13.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 17:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक यूनिट-09, सी०एण्ड डी०एस० 30प्र० जल निगम (नगरी), सहारनपुर में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रू० 11800.00 (रू० 10000.00 + GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

NATIONAL DEFENCE COLLEGE, NEW DELHI
(Ministry of Defence) Government of India
ENGAGEMENT AS CONSULTANT (SUBJECT MATTER EXPERTS) AT NDC

1. Online applications are invited from Indian Nationals for full time engagement as Consultant (Subject Matter Expert) at National Defence College, New Delhi for a duration of 12 months (01 Jan 2027 to 31 Dec 2027).
2. Description of Post.
(a) **Name:** Consultant (SME).
(b) **No. of Posts:** One
(c) **Qualification:** NDC course or equivalent, with expertise in National Security & Strategies
(d) **Remuneration:** Rs 65,000/- to Rs. 80,000/- per month, depending upon pay level.
(e) **Age-Limit:** Age of the candidate should not be more than 65 years as on 31 Dec 2027.
(f) **Period of Engagement:** 12 Months i.e 01 Jan 2027 to 31 Dec 2027 (extendable for another 12 months)
(g) **Selection Procedure:** Through Screening-cum-selection committee iaw MoD Guidelines.
(h) **Last Date of application:** 28 Nov 2026.
3. Detailed advertisement is available on NDC website **www.ndc.nic.in** and MoD website **www.mod.gov.in**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Eshmeet Singh S/o Manpreet Singh R/O B-2/5, Upper Ground Floor, Rajouri Garden, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 58/2024 U/S 302 IPC, PS Kirti Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Eshmeet Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Eshmeet Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Eshmeet Singh** of **FIR No. 58/2024 U/S 302 IPC, PS Kirti Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **09.12.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Vasundhara Azad
Chief Judicial Magistrate
West, Room No. 146, 1st Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/16043/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi @ Jhotta, S/o Puleshwar, R/o jhuggi No. C-124, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 697/23, U/s 380/454/411/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ravi @ Jhotta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ravi @ Jhotta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ravi @ Jhotta** accused of **FIR No. 697/23, U/s 380/454/411/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.02.2027.**

By Order - Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North
Room No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/16025/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajan S/o Badri Kamat R/o A-5/165, JJ Colony, Bhalaswa Dairy, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 03948/2021 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rajan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rajan** of case **CC No. 03948/2021 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West, Court No. 101, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15954/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Arif** S/o Alauddin R/o Plot No. 7, Khasra No. 26/6, First Floor (RHS), Gali No. 1/2, Near Main Road, B-Block, Rajiv Nagar Mandoli, Pole No. NNG X 010, Harsh Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 927/2021 u/s 135 I.E. Act at P.S. Harsh Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Arif** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Arif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arif** accused of FIR No. 927/2021 u/s 135 I.E. Act at P.S. Harash Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.01.2027.**

By Order: Sh. Ashish Rastogi,
Additional Sessions Judge-04 (I.E. Act)
Room No. 21, 1st Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/16078/NE/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice NO. 56/2026-2027 Dated: 06.11.2026
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	08265530	5 WATT VHF DIGITAL SET	10999 NOS	30.11.26
02	02262203	MODIFIED WASHABLE SIDE BODY FILTER	7423 NOS	30.11.26
03	16260865A	HOUSING BEARING KIT FOR HHP	148 SET	01.12.26
04	77265654	52 KG SPECIAL MACHINE CHECK RAILS 7.5M	58 SET	03.12.26
05	12261029	ELASTOMERIC 19 CORE 750 V TRAIN LINE WIRE CABLE	5139 MTR	07.12.26
06	19260699	NI-CD BATTERY SET FOR ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVE	12 SET	07.12.26
07	77265080A	COMBINATION FISH PLATE 1 M LONG	419 SET	10.12.26

NOTE- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for details. **2.** No Manual offer will be entertained. 3902/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii)Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Krishna Murari,** R/o: RZ, Third Floor, Gali No. 33, Tughlakabad Ext., Kalkaji South Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. : 4430/2022, U/s: 138 NI Act,** registered at P.S.: Darya Ganj, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Krishna Murari** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Krishna Murari** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Krishna Murari** accused **FIR No. : 4430/2022, U/s: 138 NI Act,** registered at P.S.: Darya Ganj, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Aradhana
Judicial Magistrat First Class (NI Act)-09 (Central), Extension Block, Tis Hazari, New Delhi

DP/15754/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Arun @ Teesmarkhan S/o Raju R/o H. No. K-111, K Block, Raghubir Nagar, Khyala, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 630/2022 U/s 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Khyala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Arun @ Teesmarkhan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arun @ Teesmarkhan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arun @ Teesmarkhan** of case **FIR No. 630/2022 U/s 411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Khyala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Sheetal Rani
Judicial Magistrate First Class-12
West, Room No. 152
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/15874/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kamal Singh S/o Shalik Ram R/o H. No. 114/16, Ground Floor, Deep Enclave Part - I, Vikas Nagar, Uttam Nagar, Delhi 2nd Add. H. No. S-152/129, Road No. 3, Indira Camp, Andrews Ganj, New Delhi 3rd Add. Village Pilkhini, PO Hamaapur, Ps Sirpura, Distt. Etah, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 176/2022 U/S 323/341/506/34 IPC, PS Defence Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Kamal Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Kamal Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kamal Singh** of **FIR No. 176/2022 U/S 323/341/506/34 IPC, PS Defence Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **07.12.2026**

By Order,
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
Room No. 206, South East
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/15753/SD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Asgar Shafi S/o Late Shafiduddin R/o H.No. 4195, Gali Shahatara, Ajmeri Gate, Near Chawri Bazar Metro Station, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Ex. CLR No. 94/2022 U/S 12 DV Act, PS Jafrabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Asgar Shafi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Asgar Shafi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Asgar Shafi** of **Ex. CLR No. 94/2022 U/S 12 DV Act, PS Jafrabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **05.01.2027.**

By Order,
Ms. Pooja Suhag
Judicial Magistrate First Class(Mahila Court)-03
Room No. 08, 2nd Floor, Shahdara
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14826/NE/2026(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	SPECIAL REPAIR OF SUB DIVISIONAL COURTS AT MEHAM IN DISTRICT ROHTAK (SPECIAL REPAIR TO EI ONLY) + 1 WORKS	04.11.2026 11.11.2026	12.29 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
2	PANCHAYATI RAJ, FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF DRAINS AND TREATMENT PROCEDURE OF WASTE WATER (GWM) AT VILLAGE BIJOPUR BLOCK BALLABGARH DISTRICT FARIDABAD + 2 WORKS	05.11.2026 12.11.2026	117.31 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467905067 prexeeng.fbd1@gmail.com
3	PANCHAYATI RAJ,SONIPAT	CONST. OF NALA 2X2 GOVT. SCHOOL TO H/O BHOPAL S/O MAMAN AT VILLAGE KHIZARPUR JAT MAJRA	CLOSING DATE 12.11.2026	10.76 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9268376188 brijmohansdo@gmail.com
4	PANCHAYATI RAJ,KAITHAL	CONST.OF RASTA FROM SARSA PWD ROAD TO F/O RAJKUMAR S/O MAN SINGH AT VILLAGE-PABNAWA, BLOCK -DHAND(KTL)	04.11.2026 11.11.2026	16.80 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01746-234748 prexeeng.ktl@hry.nic.in
5	PANCHAYATI RAJ, PINJORE	BDPO OFFICE :REPAIR AND CONST. OF B/WALL OF BDPO OFFICE BLOCK PINJORE DISTT. PKL	05.11.2026 12.11.2026	2.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466110204 sdoprpinjore@gmail.com
6	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	PROCUREMENT OF SPORTS ITEMS FOR PRIMARY, UP-PRIMARY AND SEC/SR. SEC SCHOOLS I. KIT-I (CONSISTING 09 ITEMS) II. KIT-II (CONSISTING 12 ITEMS) III. KIT-III (CONSISTING 17 ITEMS)	06.11.2026 20.11.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
7	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA,ROHTAK	SUPPLY, ERECTION AND COMMISSIONING OF 03 NO. DG SETS OF DIFFERENT CAPACITY AS PER SITE CONDITION AT PERMANENT PUMP HOUSES AT RD 5750 OF PILANA MINOR, RD 169500 OF KAHANAUR DISTY., RD 8000 (SANGHI-I PUMP HOUSE) OF SANGHI MINOR AND RD 10000 OF JINDRAN PUMP HOUSE.	CLOSING DATE 16.11.2026	75.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xenwsdnrtk@gmail.com
8	HARYANA STAFF SELECTION COMMISSION, PANCHKULA	REGARDING PUBLICATION OF E-TENDER NOTICE FOR PROVIDING SERVICES OF CCTV CAMERA WITH LIVE STREAMING, BIOMETRIC/FR/IRIS/QR, FRISKING AND JAMMERS FOR VARIOUS EXAM RELAT

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

• CULTURE

Music to the ears: How composers work for films

Yashee
New Delhi, November 6

MUSIC IN a film can establish the mood of a scene, convey a character's emotions, build tension or make an ordinary moment memorable. But how does a composer decide what a film should sound like? And how does the process of creating a film score differ from composing songs for a movie? The collaboration between German composer Hans Zimmer and Indian composer A R Rahman for the two-part Ramayana brings these questions into focus.

A film's musical language

The process generally begins with conversations between the director and composer. Once the film is sufficiently developed, they watch it together and decide where music is required, where silence might work better, and what emotions the music should convey. For instance, a scene showing a character remembering a loved one may need a recurring melody, while a chase sequence might require fast-paced percussion and rising tension.

The composer then begins developing the film's musical language. This can involve researching the story, its historical or cultural setting, and the instruments and musical traditions that might suit it. Zimmer, for example, is known to research deeply, like studying the Fibonacci mathematical sequence for *The Da Vinci Code* (2006).

The composer also decides on the film's sonic palette — the combination of instruments, electronic sounds, textures and effects that will give its music a distinctive identity. An important technique is the use of recurring musical themes, known as leitmotifs. A character, place or idea may have its own musical identity, which returns at important moments.

Once the initial ideas are ready, the composer creates musical sketches or digital versions called mock-ups. These allow the director to hear how the music might sound before the final recording.

The next stage is orchestration: deciding which instruments will play which parts. The music is then recorded, mixed and integrated with the film's audio.

Bollywood vs Hollywood

Bollywood and Hollywood increasingly have overlaps, but some elements stand out.

Hindi cinema has traditionally incorporated songs into the narrative. Since *Alam Ara* (1931), the first Indian talkie, songs have been central. They convey romance, grief, celebration and conflict, often through elaborate choreography and actors lip-syncing to playback singers.

The music director traditionally composes the songs, working with lyricists, singers, arrangers and musicians. Playback singers record the vocals, which are subsequently matched to the actors' performances on screen. The songs may be recorded and released as an album even before the film's release.

Hollywood, by contrast, has traditionally placed greater emphasis on the background score — the instrumental or vocal music composed specifically to accompany the action, without necessarily being performed by onscreen characters. Hollywood musicals are an important exception, with songs integrated into the narrative.

Hindi film music historically developed around the music director and a network of arrangers, assistants, lyricists and studio musicians. In Hollywood, the composer is generally commissioned to create the film's score, with specialised teams handling other aspects. However, these are broad tendencies: Indian films also have elaborate orchestral scores, and Hollywood productions use original songs extensively.



• LEGAL

Arrest, detention and the 24-hr safeguard for liberty

An accused must be produced before a magistrate within 24 hrs. SC ruled that this clock starts at detention, which is equivalent to arrest under Article 22



AMAAL SHEIKH

UNDERLINING THAT "the Constitution does not recognize any detention *dehors* [outside] arrest," the Supreme Court on Thursday held that the 24-hour deadline to produce a person before a magistrate begins when the person is first detained and not when the investigating agency chooses to record a formal arrest.

A bench of Justices Ujjal Bhuyan and Atul S Chandurkar said that searches, seizures and questioning that follow an interception cannot be treated as a pause in a Constitutional safeguard. "There is no such thing called temporary disruption of liberty," the bench said, as it set aside the Tripura High Court's refusal of bail in a drug smuggling case.

The court directed the magistrates to record when an accused's liberty was first curtailed, and calculate the 24-hour deadline from that time. It said that if the person is produced before them after the deadline has passed, they must order their release.

Magistrates should also examine whether the detention was reasonable. Even if the accused was produced within 24 hours, they can refuse remand if they find that the person was kept in custody on unreasonable grounds.

The ruling comes amid large-scale detentions which police describe as preventive and can last up to 24 hours. While the case arose under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985, it demonstrates that the label an agency uses for restraint does not decide when the clock starts.

Legal framework

The law governing the detention of a person during a criminal investigation is laid down in three provisions — in the Constitution, the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) and the NDPS Act.

ARTICLE 22 OF THE CONSTITUTION says a person has the fundamental right to be informed about the grounds of arrest and to get legal representation. Clause (2) specifically states that a person "arrested and detained" shall be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours, excluding the travel time taken to reach the court. No person shall remain in custody for more than 24 hours without the approval of a magistrate.

SECTION 58 OF THE BNSS states that a person who has been arrested without a warrant cannot be detained for longer than "reasonable".

THE NDPS ACT gives officers the powers to search, seize and arrest people suspected of drug-related offences. Section 37 specifically places restrictions on cases involving certain serious drug offences. It governs the conditions of bail too and does not extend the time the police can keep an arrested person in custody.

Arrest vs detention

In practice, the terms "arrest" and "detention" are often used interchangeably. "Arrest" is a formal act of police taking a person into custody in connection with an offence, marking the beginning of criminal proceedings. Once a person is arrested, a range of constitutional and statutory safeguards immediately come into play.

The BNSS does not define "detention" per se. Instead, it gives police a set of powers that allows them to stop, remove or temporarily hold people in certain situations, including when a crime has taken place.

At the heart of the latest judgment is the court's interpretation of Article 22(2). It said that the phrase "arrested and detained in custody" is "conjunctive and not disjunctive" — that is, the two words are joined by "and" not "or".

The court said that because both the terms are joined together, they are synonymous. The court held that the "sacrosanct" 24-hour countdown to produce the person before a magistrate would begin the moment their liberty is curtailed. The only time period that is excluded from the 24 hour limit is the journey to the magistrate.

It said: "The prescription of 24 hours time period would commence the moment a person is detained by the arresting authority suspecting him to have committed an offence, when his liberty is effectively curtailed... any attempt to draw an artificial distinction between 'arrest' and 'detention' would dilute or negate the fundamental protection guaranteed by the Constitution."

Buffer zones

The bench in its 97-page judgment disapproved of the views taken by the Orissa High Court in the *Aryaman Pattnayak* case, the Madras High Court in the *Kannan* case, and the Kerala High Court in the *Arun K Thomas* case, saying these decisions "do not lay down the correct law".

The High Courts had attempted to carve out investigative procedures for law enforcement before recording a formal arrest while calculating the 24-hour deadline.

Rejecting the Orissa High Court's view that detention becomes arrest only after a "short investigatory hold", the Supreme Court called it "constitutionally unsustainable" and said it delved "into a realm of uncertainty".

It also rejected the Kerala High Court's view that the 24-hour clock remains suspended during search and seizure, saying that "creation or contemplation of such buffer zone is unconstitutional".

The bench said that the Constitution does not recognise the concept of "temporary disruption of liberty" and that High Courts cannot invent a statutory buffer zone that freezes or suspends the fundamental rights for executive convenience.

Informal custody

The bench also said that even if the suspect is produced before a magistrate within 24 hours, Section 58 of the BNSS imposes a dual limit, that is, a 24-hour limit and that the detention within those 24 hours must be "reasonable".

The court said that "remand is never a mechanical exercise" and held that if there is an unexplained gap that exists within the 24-hour window, magistrates are allowed to decline the police remand on the ground of unreasonableness alone.

Fundamental rights

The Tripura High Court had relied on the Supreme Court's ruling in *State of Punjab v. Sukhwinder Singh* (2026), which held that the restrictions on bail under Section 37 of the NDPS Act had to be satisfied before bail could be granted.

The Supreme Court expressed reservations about this observation, saying that fundamental rights cannot be exercised under the framework of Section 37. It said that where there is a violation of Article 21 — which guarantees the protection of life and personal liberty — the restrictions under Section 37 "would have to give way". It referred to the Supreme Court's ruling in *Union of India v. K A Najeeb* (2021), which recognised that Constitutional rights could prevail over statutory restrictions on bail.

• IN PRACTICE: ARREST VS. DETENTION

An arrest is a formal act of taking a person into custody in connection with an offence. The act triggers safeguards such as the right to know the grounds of arrest and production before a magistrate within 24 hours.

Detention is understood as the temporary custody of a person in order to prevent a law and order problem. The police usually practice it during protests, especially when Section 163 of the BNSS is imposed. No case is registered against a detained person, and the person is usually let go within hours. These are usually described by the executive as preventive powers. Under Section 172 of the BNSS, police can 'detain or remove' a person who ignores a lawful direction, with release within 24 hours for petty offences.

The label of detention is sometimes used to avoid the scrutiny that follows an arrest. To the person in custody, it quite often feels the same.



The Supreme Court has now reiterated that when a person is held on suspicion for an offence and their liberty is restrained, the 24-hour clock starts then, and not when the police formally records their arrest.

Custodial violence

The Supreme Court bench also linked the 24-hour limit to the need to prevent custodial violence.

'The worst violations of human rights take place during the course of investigation,' it said.

• ECONOMICS

Reading the rise of the Democratic Socialists in capitalist US



WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

WITH THE Democrats' landslide victory, the US midterm election results have sent the Republican Party back to the drawing board. But beyond the two main parties, the elections have thrown up a third political force — one that could fundamentally alter US politics in the coming years.

It is called the Democratic Socialists of America (DSA), the largest socialist organisation in the United States. According to the DSA, it has fought 294 elections and won as many as 149 so far this year. To be sure, the DSA is not yet a separate political party, but is working as a left-wing grouping within the Democratic Party.

Its members include some of the most well-recognised faces in US politics, such as Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (House of Representatives member), Zohran Mamdani (Mayor of New York) and Nithya Raman (who just won Los Angeles Mayoral election).

What is Democratic Socialism?

DSA members have often tried to encapsulate its vision as a system that provides everything a person needs to live a dignified life, covering basic housing, food, healthcare, etc. Its agenda includes:

- Free universal healthcare.
- Housing as a human right, including strictly regulating investment properties and establishing universal rent control.
- Green New Deal, which involves passing a federal jobs guarantee and massive investment in sustainable, publicly-owned energy and transit infrastructure.

Many in the mainstream view the DSA as left-wing radicalism on steroids. The Trump White House has taken notice, and its Council of Economic Advisors released a brief, warning Americans about the cost of the DSA's key demands (*see graphic*). DSA representatives have called these calculations a gross overestimate, but have not provided estimates of their own.

How does it differ from Social Democracy?

Social Democracy, as practised by many parties in Europe, is a political ideology that tries to address the excesses of capitalism by attempting to make society more equitable through extensive regulation of the private sector, as well as social welfare programmes for fair distribution of wealth.

As Encyclopaedia Britannica put it, "While social democrats seek to improve capitalism through regulation and welfare, democratic socialists aim to fully abolish capitalism in favor of a decentralized socialist economic system where workplaces are under democratic control."

Why is socialism gaining ground?

Ostensibly, the US economy has done quite well. Since the global financial crisis of 2008, it has expanded the gap between itself and the other Western European economies. Per capita incomes, too, have grown.

But these measures hide wide inequalities and concentration of economic power. Last year, Democratic Socialist Senator Bernie Sanders wrote: "While the rich get richer, the middle class struggles to pay the rent, put food on the table, and pay for health care... One man (Elon Musk), worth nearly $400 billion, now owns more wealth than the bottom 52% of American households. The top 1% own more wealth than the bottom 93%"

Since then, Musk has become the world's first trillionaire, and reportedly spent around $450 million in favour of Republican candidates in the midterms. Sanders has argued that the US has essentially become an oligarchy with just three huge Wall Street firms — Vanguard, BlackRock, and State Street — as major stockholders in 95% of S&P 500 corporations. The rise of DSA, then, can be read as a response to these excesses.

• Trump admin claims DSA agenda will cost US

$47 trillion — Medicare for All	$370 billion — Green New Deal
$4 trillion — Cancelling student debt and providing free college education	$16 billion — Universal rent control
$920 billion — 32-hour workweek	NOT SCORED IN $: Abolish the police and prison system
$527 billion — Open borders and amnesty	$53 trillion — TOTAL COST BETWEN 2027 AND 2036

Estimated additional burden per household: **Even if $4 trillion is raised from wealth tax, that still leaves roughly $355,000 of additional strain on every American household.**

SOURCE: WHITE HOUSE COUNCIL OF ECONOMIC ADVISERS

• GLOBAL

Who will form Israel govt? Advantage Eisenkot, but don't count Netanyahu out

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, November 6

ISRAELI PRIME Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's main rival, Gadi Eisenkot, on Thursday appeared to have secured the backing of a majority of lawmakers to try to form a government, with the Arab-led Joint List formally endorsing his candidacy.

Eisenkot and his allies have not yet indicated whether they would accept the backing of the three-party alliance. Earlier, another Arab-led party, Ra'am, had said it would back the former military chief.

Israel President Isaac Herzog Thursday said it was still unclear who could break the deadlock that emerged after the October 27 national election, but pledged to nominate a candidate on Sunday.

But both Eisenkot and Netanyahu's alliances have been reluctant to rely on the two Arab blocs — which are critical of Israel's policies but have emerged as potential kingmakers. As for the Arab parties, such an alliance would mean backing a government unlikely to end Israel's wars or curb settlement expansion in the occupied West Bank.

Who stands where in Israel

Sixty-one seats are needed for a majority in the 120-member parliament (Knesset).

Netanyahu's right-wing and ultra-Orthodox coalition won 53 seats, while Eisenkot's fractious alliance comprising his centrist Yashar party, as well as right-wing and centre-left factions, got 48 seats.

But two Arab-led alliances together won an unprecedented 19 seats. With their backing of, should he accept it, Eisenkot will have the support of 67 lawmakers.

Meanwhile, the ultra-orthodox United Torah Judaism (UTJ) party, a longstanding ally of Netanyahu, declined to recommend any candidate to President Herzog, leaving the PM with just 46 lawmakers.

Eisenkot's options

1. ALLYING WITH ARAB PARTIES

Eisenkot's Yashar party could form a minority government with outside support from the Arab blocs. Both have endorsed Eisenkot, although this does not guarantee they would support him in a parliamentary confidence vote. Ra'am is willing to join a coalition, while the Joint List has expressed interest in extending outside support, conditional on protections for Israel's Arab communities.



Gadi Eisenkot, leader of Yashar party. X

Eisenkot has long ruled out forming a government with the help of the Arab parties, citing a lack of shared values.

On October 31, he issued four conditions for a prospective government — recognising Israel as a Jewish, democratic, liberal and equal state; upholding the values of the Declaration of Independence; requiring all citizens to undertake military, national or civilian service; and dismantling Hamas's military and governing power in Gaza.

The conditions are likely to complicate negotiations with the Arab-majority parties, particularly over Israel's character as a Jewish state and the Palestinian conflict.

2. ALLYING WITH THE ULTRA-ORTHODOX

Eisenkot could seek support from the UTJ, which has won seven seats and is unhappy over the failure of Netanyahu's Likud party to preserve military exemptions for ultra-orthodox Jews.

A government can win the Knesset's confidence vote with even a simple majority. However, Eisenkot would still need reliable parliamentary support to pass legislation and budgets, leaving a minority government vulnerable to collapse.

But the biggest reason for UTJ to leave Netanyahu would also be its biggest obstacle to joining hands with Eisenkot: he has made national service for all Israelis a condition for joining his government.

3. A COALITION... WITH NETANYAHU

A third alternative could be a national unity government that brings together Netanyahu and some of his political opponents, potentially under an arrangement to rotate the premiership. But it would require opposition leaders to abandon their central promise of removing Netanyahu.

There is precedent for this. Following the October 7, 2023, Hamas attack, former IDF chief turned lawmaker Benny Gantz and Eisenkot joined Netanyahu's emergency wartime government. An power-sharing arrangement between Netanyahu and Gantz in 2020, collapsed before Gantz could serve as prime minister.

How Netanyahu can benefit

Despite the backing of 67 lawmakers, Eisenkot still faces the challenge of turning their endorsements into a viable governing coalition, given the deep ideological divisions among his prospective allies.

Under Israel's Basic Law, the outgoing government continues to exercise its functions until a new one takes office.

If the president's nominee fails to form a government within 28 days, extendable by another 14, the President can either give another lawmaker 28 days or inform the Knesset that no government can be formed. In either case, lawmakers may subsequently seek a final 14-day mandate for a candidate backed by at least 61 members. Continued failure would trigger fresh elections. Netanyahu has benefited from such political deadlock before. Between 2019 and 2020, he headed successive caretaker governments as Israel held repeated elections.

'I am not against delimitation... but it has to be scrutinised'



RENUKA PURI

Chief Minister of Keralam VD Satheesan in conversation with Vandita Mishra (centre), National Opinion Editor, and Liz Mathew, Deputy Editor, at The Indian Express Adda on October 23

Keralam Chief Minister VD Satheesan on why empathy matters in governance, his vision for the state, the INDIA bloc and the challenges before Congress. He was in conversation with *The Indian Express* National Opinion Editor Vandita Mishra and Deputy Editor Liz Mathew

Radico SPIRIT OF EXCELLENCE presents EXPRESS AdDA

Vandita Mishra: Five months after you became Chief Minister, do you feel the pressure of being different, from the two-term regime you ousted and from the powerful rivals you defeated within your party?

No. People are expecting more from us because before the election, we kept our communication lines open with them. We criticised and exposed the last government and people have naturally asked for an alternative. We prepared by conducting health and education conclaves, interacting with experts and focusing on Kerala's future. Now the people are expecting more from our side. That is the only pressure. The party, cabinet, MLAs are supporting UDF (Congress-led United Democratic Front). Our UDF is a model coalition for the country. There are 10 parties, but we act like a single party. We want to deliver on our promises. We are working hard for that.

Liz Mathew: While you were in the Opposition, you spoke about every leader having a vision for the future of the state. Now that you have completed almost six months as the CM, what is the picture of Kerala you want after five years of your term?

We have a long-term target for Kerala. We studied our disadvantages — high population density, scarce land and strict regulations like the Forest Act and Coastal Regulation Zone. Then we focused on our advantages — two international sea ports, a container terminal, 18 mini ports, and a 600km coastline — to transform Kerala into a port city.

Studying demographic shifts, Kerala's youth share is shrinking while senior numbers grow. We became the first state to create a department for senior citizens. In the first cabinet we took that decision, introducing a bill to guarantee rights to senior citizens. A civilised society is measured by how it treats its elderly, and we aim to make Kerala the most civilised society in this aspect within five years.

This is not just a welfare project; this is the silver economy. We want to make senior citizens more active, integrating them with youngsters. For example, when youngsters begin startups, we provide an experienced techno mentor who is a senior. If somebody is weak in management or marketing, we provide a management mentor.

We have Kudumbashree women units across the state. We want to make them economically self-reliant. We have four international airports in Kerala and want to make it an aviation hub. We are establishing a global convention centre in Cochin, an aviation institute, pilot training, MRO, cargo facilities, and tourism upgrades.

Vandita Mishra: Many of these things will take time but do you have to contend with an impatience to make a break from the past? Your critics call you 'Pinarayi in khadi', just as they called Pinarayi 'Modi in a *mundu*'.

Anybody can create such things. Now, on social media, you can damage anyone or whitewash a culprit. People make mistakes. I will also make them but I will correct them, too. But criticising everyday when we are talking about serious things is not good.

A CIVILISED SOCIETY IS MEASURED BY HOW IT TREATS ITS ELDERLY. IN THE FIRST CABINET WE TOOK THAT DECISION, INTRODUCING A BILL TO GUARANTEE RIGHTS TO SENIOR CITIZENS

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SINCE MY COLLEGE DAYS, THE GOVERNMENT OF THE DAY BLAMED A 'FOREIGN HAND' FOR PROTESTS. THIS IS AN ORGANIC AGITATION. YOU HAVE TO INTERACT WITH GEN Z

Liz Mathew: Your image is diametrically opposite to that of Pinarayi Vijayan. He was known as a doer who could bulldoze many things. Do you think your image as a nice person is a baggage for you?

Decades ago, I thought whatever I believed was right. Now after interacting with many people, I know we can correct many things. There should be a final result after interactions. Now we are holding interactions with experts. We have knowledge partners in all projects, and are discussing with seniors, experienced persons, and officers.

I have given confidence to all officers that if they are doing something in good faith, they will be protected. There may be procedural irregularity or media attack, but I will protect them. That is the confidence we are giving officers.

Vandita Mishra: You talk of Kerala as an investment hub. But you are caught in a situation where the state's revenue raising capabilities are narrowing while committed expenditures, including social sector spending which makes the Kerala model so progressive, remain high. You have persisting deficits and rising debt. Do you think the state needs a new contract with the Centre, because the tax devolution share has been falling?

After coming to power, we made a detailed study on the fiscal situation with experts and placed a white paper on the table of the legislature. Our committed expenditure is 80 per cent of revenue—salary, pension, interest—and debt is more than 5 lakh crore. We are facing a fiscal crisis.

In the first budget, there was pressure on me to increase taxes, but I did not do that. I don't think an increase in tax is the solution. To stimulate the economy, first, the government has to spend.

For example, during Onam, we gave money to the poor and lower middle class — their pension, arrears — nearly Rs 4,000 crore. When asked why we pushed this amount, I said it creates demand in the market. During the festival, people came to the market, the market was stimulated, wholesale and retail business increased, and we got the largest GST share last month since GST was introduced in Kerala. We need more investments to stimulate the economy, and we hope the situation will improve.

Vandita Mishra: Kerala shares its predicament with other southern states — aging population, fiscal stress, committed social expenditures. Recently, Chandrababu Naidu, Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh, took an initiative for a "southern alliance". He cited river interlinking but the initiative can be read as an attempt to improve these states' bargaining position with the Centre.

That's a very good idea — not for bargaining with the Centre, but for many other things coordination between southern governments and southern chief ministers will be good. In the GST Council also we can place many things, and on devolution of taxes we can raise many things. For example, in the 10th Finance Commission we got 3.5 per cent, and the last Finance Commission recommended only 2.32 per cent. From 10th to 16th Finance Commission, our devolution share went down.

And another thing is that from shifting from the Planning Commission to NITI Aayog, they shifted from planning to projects. Now in all departments there are projects and we have to avail the projects. When checked, we had claimed only 20 to 25 per cent. Now the various departments are preparing detailed project reports according to the guidelines of the central projects with our knowledge partners.

Liz Mathew: There is a general impression that you as Chief Minister wanted to take so many initiatives but there have been some obstacles, some internal pressure groups. Do you think that a powerful pressure group from within is creating obstacles for you?

No, no, I don't think so. For the projects and for the governance side I don't have any pressure from our party or from our coalition. Because we are preparing all the projects only after discussion with cabinet ministers and senior leaders, taking unanimous decisions in the cabinet and moving ahead. They are all confident that we can do a lot of things. Nobody is putting pressure on us regarding governance.

Vandita Mishra: Student protests have emerged in many parts of the country, demanding greater accountability in the education system and the Election Commission's conduct of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. In Kerala, police filed FIRs against CJP protesters in the protests' first round. Even as Congress supports the CJP cause in Delhi, your police was rounding up protesters in Kerala. How do you explain that? Between the Left and Congress, an older contradiction has resurfaced — you face off in the state while cooperating in Delhi.

The agitations of the students and youngsters stem from real worries — unemployment is a major thing and failures in the education system are real. You know that the nature of jobs has been changing across the world because of new futuristic technologies. We have declared a global job watch in my budget and appointed experts in 12 sectors to watch what is happening to jobs in their sector. They will report to the government, and we will restructure the curriculum. We have to start new academic programmes; otherwise we will be in trouble.

In India, we need to take steps for employment generation, the unemployment rate is going up, and there is dwindling trust in the present education system. Students are worried about exams and education, making this protest an organic response. Through social media messages, students connect and assemble.

In history, student agitations have led to upheavals — even the French Revolution began with youngsters discussing

NEHRUVIAN SOCIALISM IS A BALANCE BETWEEN DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES AND WELFARE

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COALITION IS A REALITY. THERE IS AN ANTI-INCUMBENCY AGAINST THE EXISTING GOVERNMENT. OUR JOB IS TO TRANSLATE THIS ANTI-INCUMBENCY TO VOTE

• • •

IF I DON'T HAVE ANY EMOTIONAL ELEMENT IN MY THINKING, IN MY MIND, IN MY HEART, GOVERNANCE BECOMES PURELY MECHANICAL — POLICE, CARS, SALUTES. ALL RULERS SHOULD BE EMOTIONAL

the system in coffee houses. That is happening in India.

Vandita Mishra: So why did your police file FIRs against protesters?

Police filed FIRs when there were roadblocks. Then we asked them to quash all the FIRs.

Vandita Mishra: And the Congress-Left joining hands for the protest?

They are part of the INDIA front. They are agitating together for a cause. It's quite natural and organic and Rahul Gandhi is leading the agitation.

Vandita Mishra: And he is giving more importance to AISA's Neha Bora than to NSUI or Youth Congress?

This is not a single-party agitation. When a leader is leading that agitation, he has to accommodate everybody—NSUI, Youth Congress, and coalition partners. When photos were taken with allies, that is normal in broad coalitions.

Vandita Mishra: How do you look at the government's effort to paint the protests as part of a foreign conspiracy—the foreign hand?

Since my college days, governments have blamed a 'foreign hand' for protests. What foreign hand? This is an organic agitation, a natural one. You have to interact with Gen Z. They are depressed and worried. They don't have hope. We have to give them hope about the future regarding higher education and employment opportunities, which we are doing in Kerala.

Liz Mathew: Looking at 2029, people say a coalition era is coming up. What do you think about Congress's ability to stitch coalitions, given criticism from allies, compared to the BJP's record in keeping coalitions intact?

Coalition is a reality. There is an anti-incumbency against the existing government. Our job is to translate this anti-incumbency to votes. For that, coalition will play a major role. This is an opportunity to rally all the coalition parties. Now, all are rallying behind Rahul Gandhi.

Liz Mathew: So do you justify dumping a coalition partner post-election and joining hands with another one just for power?

No, Mr Stalin himself agreed for the coalition from the other side. Otherwise they were not able to form the government and there would have been presidential rule. This happens everywhere; only after election do coalitions form in many places.

Vandita Mishra: There are still two-and-a-half years to go for the next Parliamentary election. Till then, state leaders have different models for dealing with the Modi government —Revanth Reddy calls Modi 'elder brother', while Omar Abdullah takes a non-confrontational stance. What is your approach going to be?

I have not started with a fight against the Central government. We have not

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TR Kishor Nair, CEO, Avaada Energy



Puneet Kumar, Resident Commissioner, Kerala House, New Delhi

declared war. On the ideological side, we will fight against the BJP and the Sangh Parivar with no compromise. But government to government, cooperative federalism is here under constitutional provisions. We will try to get our due share and bring major projects by meeting the Prime Minister and concerned ministers.

Liz Mathew: You are very clear about your stand on secularism, but in the present scenario, do you think secularism is becoming a baggage for Congress? In the state, you've been accused of coming under pressure from the Muslim League, a key partner in your government.

Nobody, no party is putting pressure on me. This is an old story. They are agreeing with our decisions, and we are taking decisions unitedly. In elections, we took an adamant secular stand with no compromise. Even when the majority community leader was spreading hate campaigns at the peak hour, I said no, if you are talking about this type of communalism we will never compromise. As for the Indian Union Muslim League, this is not the 1940s' Muslim League. The Muslim League takes a secular approach, preventing extreme outfits from occupying that space. Muslim League candidates received widespread Hindu and Christian support. Kerala is secular. In my constituency, where the majority community has 52 per cent votes, they voted for me because they are secular. Our election results in Kerala stand as a model for the nation. Our state is secular.

SCAN THE QR CODE TO WATCH THE ADDA

Vandita Mishra: We are talking about secularism, and I want to bring you to socialism. A few months ago, you declared that you are a Nehruvian Socialist. That's a courageous thing to say when Nehru has almost been made a swear word. What did you mean when you said you are a Nehruvian socialist, and can we apply that test to your budget proposals?

Yes, this is a balance between development and welfare. If we are losing money and the fiscal situation is going bad, we won't be able to do welfare activities. So we want to fill the exchequer. What was the priority of Pandit*ji* after getting freedom? To give food to all the people in India — that was in the first five-year plan.

Planning considers regional balance and backwardness, whereas shifting from planning to projects lacks regional balance. Where we implement development projects, the living standard of people living there must increase — it is not about constructing multi-storied buildings while evicting people to slums. Our approach is different. We are an enivromentally friendly government — no compromise with nature. In our first cabinet, we took a decision for free travel for women on buses. That is not a freebie; it is respect of the state government to women coming from suburbs and rural areas to work in cities for 2,000 or 3,000 rupees. Through savings initiatives like the Pinky fund, they build self-reliance while stimulating the market.

Liz Mathew: You always come up as a very sensitive and a bit emotional person. I have seen your eyes moist when you talk about characters or books. How does that sensitive VD Satheesan persona fit into the Chief Minister role?

I'm an ordinary person; when I see something touching, I may cry or laugh. These are human things. If I don't have any emotional element in my thinking, in my mind, in my heart, governance becomes purely mechanical —police, cars, salutes. All rulers should be emotional. Emotionally, they have to observe what is happening around them and have the determination to solve the issues. For senior citizens, we assured that nobody will be alone; the government will be with them. A volunteer corps across panchayats gathers data on elderly care needs to ensure basic welfare and palliative support. If there is no emotional element, how can I do that?

Vandita Mishra: You're known to be a voracious reader. But in your state, despite high literacy rates and a literary tradition, the reading habit in the young is increasingly threatened. What steps can the government take to encourage a reading culture among the young?

There is a story that reading is dying, but I'm not saying that — good books are coming up and the reading community in Kerala is growing. We are planning to start something as part of the curriculum in schools: the first thing is to read two or three newspapers every day. We also promote and congratulate new young writers. The reading community is growing in Kerala.

Liz Mathew: In your speeches, you cited authors from Alvin Toffler to Yuval Noah Harari. How much do these books, and what you are reading currently, help you as Chief Minister?

We learn many things from books. Recently I read Ameer Shahul's *The Silent Syndicate*. It shows how international syndicates inflate medical costs and how generic medicine production drastically lowers prices. Atul Gawande's *Being Mortal* instigated me for the care of senior citizens. Lisa Mosconi's *The Menopause Brain* increased my respect for women. Reading Amitav Ghosh's *The Nutmeg's Curse* inspired an international maritime museum in our budget, reflecting Kerala's ancient trade relations via Muziris port. From books we get updated information across many subjects.

Vandita Mishra: Reports say the government may bring out the delimitation bill again in Parliament. What is your position on it?

I am not against delimitation; delimitation is a constitutional procedure. But why are they increasing the number of seats across the country in a way that creates discrimination against certain states? We are opposing the increasing of seats without proper methodology. It has to be examined and scrutinised.



It was an evening of conversations and ideas at the Express Adda, held in New Delhi



ALOK KUMAR
CEO,
ERAM-HCM INDIA

How will Kerala become a global talent hub, tapping international labour demand through government initiatives and public-private partnerships?

We are showcasing Kerala's talent pool, from engineers and management professionals to diploma and ITI holders, even in remote villages. Our workforce is also competitively priced. To address brain drain, we are restructuring curricula and introducing industry-linked academic programmes. We will explore PPP models for investment and create opportunities for the diaspora to channel remittances into productive investments in Kerala.



AYUSH NAMBIAR
GLOBAL MANAGING DIRECTOR,
THE NAMBIAR GROUP

When will Kerala roll out the red carpet for entrepreneurs like me, who are from the state living elsewhere, to invest, create jobs and boost its economy?

Kerala has changed. As the Opposition, we supported the previous government's investors' meet. There are no strikes in the state. As a trade unionist for 20 years, my approach has been to link workers' incentives to company profits. We are also simplifying investment procedures through a single-window clearance system, amending 19 existing Acts and ensuring time-bound approvals. Investors will be protected, with the Chief Minister's office monitoring progress.



BINAY GUPTA
FOUNDER & CEO,
GEOSYNTHESIS

How can Congress counter BJP's Hindutva and reshape its secularism to overcome the perception of being anti-Hindu?

We can politically and ideologically oppose the BJP's communalism. Congress is a secular party with strong secular credentials and will never compromise with communal forces. Protecting minorities is enshrined in our Constitution, which guarantees equal rights and prohibits discrimination. We must uphold constitutional morality and protect the rights of all communities. Congress will continue to fight communalism without compromise.



ASHISH DUA
ALL INDIA CONGRESS COMMITTEE
MEMBER

What short-term measures is Kerala taking to mitigate the economic impact of the ongoing Middle East conflict, particularly on remittances?

We are watching the situation very seriously. There is a sense of insecurity in the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC). One phase is complete, and the second phase is beginning in Saudi Arabia. We are very concerned and are closely monitoring the developments. Nothing seems to be happening at the moment, but we have to keep a close watch. It is a serious matter, as it could also affect our economy.



RATAN KAUL
FOUNDER PRESIDENT
PUBLIC DIPLOMACY FORUM

When are you hosting Raihan Vadra's exhibition? I would love to come and see it in Kerala.

This is a question of freedom of expression. Why were those photographs removed (from Bikaner House, New Delhi)? I tweeted that we welcome him, his friends and anyone else to Kerala, and will make arrangements for them to conduct such activities. This is freedom of expression, art and culture. Why are they removing them? What is their approach?

But don't worry, I am also inviting you to another event —the 70th year of Kerala with a festival that will begin in Thiruvananthapuram on November 1. It will then travel to Delhi, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata and other cities. The second phase will cover GCC countries, followed by a third phase in Europe. There will be cultural activities and there wil also be investors' meetings there.



SYED IQBAL HASNAIN
FORMER VICE CHANCELLOR,
UNIVERSITY OF CALICUT, KERALA

Can Kerala adopt the US community college model to bridge education and industry needs while keeping fees affordable?

We have to adopt new education models that are emerging across the world. That is why we have announced a Knowledge Valley in the Budget. We plan to invite legacy universities and academic groups to Kerala to introduce new programmes and certificate courses that generate employment.

Cochin University once successfully trained students in shipbuilding. It started in Kalamasheri, the industrial headquarters of Kerala, decades ago. The students who completed these shipbuilding courses were then working across the world for good salaries. But we could not continue it.

You are absolutely right, we must revive such industry-linked courses and reform higher education.



Zachariah Jacob, Co-Founder, Mahabelly and Actus Legal



Nikhil Thakur, Regional Marketing Manager-North, Joyalukkas



Alok Kumar, CEO, ERAM-HCM india



Atul K Thakur, Senior Secretary, PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry



(Left) KP Fabian, retired Indian diplomat, author and political commentator with Asok Kumar, former Special Secretary to Government of India



Geetanjali A Shah, Founder, Ed2Careers



Dalbir Singh, Chairman, One Globe Forum



(Left) P Jacob Samuel, former Chairman, The Indian Silk Export Promotion Council, with son Nebu Jacob, President, Osmosys Incorporation



G Devarajan, Special Representative of Kerala government in New Delhi



Sandeep Dhupia, Director & Head of Forensic Services, KPMG



Manuvel Mezhukanal, Founder-Chairman and Delony Manuvel, Director, Manuvel Malabar Jewellers



KP Nayar, strategic analyst



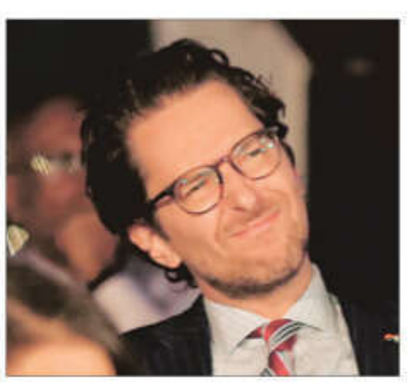
Filmmaker Meera Dewan



Naseer Abdullah, Model & Actor



OP Mishra, Retd IPS Officer



Sebastian Borchmeyer, First Secretary, Economic and Global Affairs, German Embassy in India



Aji Krishnan, Founder - Secretary, HRDS INDIA

A Spectacle that Keeps its Soul

Shubhra Gupta



CAN NAMIT Malhotra, whose clear ownership of this latest cinematic retelling of Ramayana has been a constant talking point, have conjured up just the right version of the beloved epic for this age of Kalyug? Having been done in by the horror that was *Adipurush*, anything would have been better. But something about the crescendo of publicity that accompanied every single act of constructing this one made me wary. Would this also be one of those high-profile mega-mythological projects claiming the big, bigger, biggest mantle which would prove to be a big fat zero?

I'm here to tell you that my fears have largely been unfounded. I took time to submit to the goings-on, but by the halfway mark, I'd been convinced and settled into the shenanigans of Lankapati Dashanan aka Ravana (Yash) and the fitting responses of Rama (Ranbir Kapoor) and Sita (Sai Pallavi) and Lakshman (Ravi Dubey), as well as a host of colourful characters, most of whom we know as well as our family members.

As advertised, this Ramayan, directed by Nitesh Tiwari, is unapologetically big, bigger than any other iteration we have seen before. Being fully aware that a large younger segment of the audience may not have direct knowledge of the source material, it casts a large global referential net, but it never becomes a Ramayan for dummies. It is a faithful, full-bodied re-telling which doesn't talk down, or talk up, refusing to pander to dominant ideologies. Its cast takes its time to settle into the groove, but once it does, it gets going. The background music is Hans Zimmer-AR Rahman *jodi* on full throttle, and there's enough sorcery and thrills and adventure to keep the occasional blandness at bay, and undemanding adults and kids happy.

Condensing a mammoth epic whose cultural, religious influences have continued to shape our society and polity through the ages was never going to be an easy task, but credit where it's due, the makers have managed to tell their story without being overwhelmed by it — yes, there's scale and size of the kind Indian cinema hasn't seen before, but there's also the very desi mix of melodrama and emotion, which works for a film like this, which has been created for universal viewing.

As befits a film which the makers wanted to go international with, Part One (Part 2 releases two years from now, in 2028) is a mix of many influences: a jumble of *Game of Thrones*, *Lord of The Rings*, *KGF*, nodding all the while to the version that most Indians are familiar with, Ramanand Sagar's TV series, overlaid with the aesthetics of *Amar Chitra Katha*, as well as, of course, Raja Ravi Varma, without which no Indian epic can be contemplated.

Well into the first hour, it looked as if it would be a mixed bag, with its bouquet of characters — no introduction needed — trying to find their stride in one set piece after another. The start didn't blow me away: too many pop-cultural influences tumbling around, calling attention to themselves, is never a good look. Especially because world-building takes its own sweet time, and risks becoming a drag, leaving us time to focus on the parts which come close to being borderline tacky.

But slowly, you can see the reasoning behind the stylistic choices: is there any point in doing understated when our eyes have been blinded by billionaire-driven excesses and industrial-strength jewellery? The sheen of real gold is not bright enough, so this *Ramayana* goes full glitter mode: the gilt-edged palaces and chariots aren't classy bronzy-golden but massy-brassy. Everyone, including Raja Dashrath (Arun Govil, yes, the very one who played Ram back in the day) and his three queens — Kaushalya (Indira Krishnan), Sumitra (Sonal Jha) and Kaikeyi (Lara Dutta being Lara Dutta) — is laden with heavy gems. As are the demons and *devtas*, who come and go as and when the plot requires them to.

What rescues the film from its insistent outsizeness — and the occasional aspect-ratio problem — is its array of mostly familiar characters, performed by actors who have all done their job well. That it was going to be a huge CGI-laden actioner was never hidden; what we were waiting for were the memorable moments — Ramayan is one of the most memorialised epics in the world, no exaggeration — which would transport us. We have to wait, though, till the Ram-*mi-laai jodi* of the Ayodhya *ka rajkumar* and Mithila *ki rajkumari*, along with their faithful *anuj* to go into *vanvaas* for the film to really find its *sur*.

RAMAYANA PART 1
★★★
DIRECTOR: Nitesh Tiwari
CAST: Ranbir Kapoor, Sai Pallavi, Yash, Sunny Deol, Ravi Dubey, Anupam Kher, Rakul Preet Singh, Vivek Oberoi, Kunal Kapoor, Addinath Kothare, Arun Govil, Indira Krishnan, Saurabh Sachdeva, Lara Dutta

Ranbir, who has always managed to get into the skin of everything he's played till now, including the animalesque *Animal*, starts off strangely subdued, but steadies into his role as the *maryada purushottam*. We get momentarily distracted by the fact that his double role as Parashuram comes off more impactful, but it is all too brief: Ranbir finally cuts loose in Aaranya Kaandam, when he is in the forest with Sita and Lakshman — that very *Crouching Tiger Hidden Dragon* sequence in which he leaps across trees and branches, his arrows finding an unerring mark, vanquishing a pair of deadly demons, with a bit of help from his equally agile companions, is a stand-out.

I also took some time to wrap my head around Sai Pallavi's Sita, her boyfriend blush reminding me of Zendaya's look, but she is such a good actor that she gets there: watch her as she jousts with Yash's Ravan, as he calls out "*bhikshaam dehi*", stepping outside the Lakshman Rekha, only to be dragged into his waiting winged chariot. Ravi Dubey as Lakshman is a good fit for this *Ramayana*, which needed to be both modern and contemporary without losing its traditional moorings. On that note, we may need to ask why Surpanakha (Rakul Preet Singh) is always togged out in a fetching corset, or would that be a quibble we can ignore?

Of the large supporting cast, many of whom we will see in the final part, Sheeba Chaddha, as the crafty Manthara, was a delight. No surprises there. Shobhana, as Ravan's mother Kaikashi, leaves a mark. Vivek Oberoi shows up as Surpanakha's ill-fated husband, a character I was unaware of, the segment clearly inserted to show Ravan's complex character, which has the capacity to hold contradictions — the *maha vidwan*, and the *maha yoddha* jostling with his demonic qualities: the sequence in which his legendary 10 heads are introduced is yet another stand-out. A flash of Pavan-sut Hanuman is a climactic send-off: we don't see Sunny Deol's face, but the swish of the tale is enough.

While we are told that it takes inspiration from all the many Ramayanas there are in the world, with Tulsidas and Valmiki taking centre stage, the filmmakers also ask us to go back to the source. Which, in my book, is wonderful. As is the careful keeping away from the sort of religious bigotry which could easily have made this film something else other than one of the most thrilling stories, full of kings and queens, good guys and bad guys, to come out of India. The scenes with Jatayu (voiced by Anupam Kher), as a tear trickles down his weathered beak and bloody feathers are movingly rendered: I teared up, just as I had when I read it as a child.

What can be better than hearing more of the softer, gentler 'Jai Siya Ram', rather than the muscular 'Jai Shri Ram'? Yes, the latter phrase is implicit, but is not, thankfully, in our face. I don't know what the next part brings, but for now, I'm glad that this is the route Namit Malhotra and co. chose.

• STREAMING WATCHLIST



North of North S2
NETFLIX

AS WINTER settles over Ice Cove, young Inuk mother Siaja (Anna Lambe) is determined to make life better — for herself and everyone around her. At the community center, she's pushing her boss, Helen (Mary Lynn Rajskub), to trust her with more responsibility. At home, she's trying to learn everything she can about the half-sister she never knew existed. And after her divorce, she's open to the possibility of love. She's also raising her daughter, Bun (Keira Cooper), alongside her mother, (Maika Harper), and newfound father, Alistair (Jay Ryan).



Last Man in Tower
ZEE5

DIRECTED BY Ben Rekhi and adapted from Aravind Adiga's novel *Last Man in Tower* by Sooni Taraporevala with dialogues by Juhi Chaturvedi, the engaging narrative follows a retired teacher (Manoj Bajpayee), who refuses to vacate his apartment in a Mumbai housing society. Even as he faces threats and indifference from his neighbours, he keeps warding off a lucrative redevelopment offer made by a builder (Boman Irani).



Yaga
LIONSGATE PLAY

INSPIRED BY the folklore surrounding Baba Yaga, the series follows private investigator Rapp (Noah Reid), as he arrives in the coastal town of Whittock to investigate the disappearance of Henry Park, the heir to a fishing business. Alongside local detective Carson (Clark Backo), and university professor Katherine (Carrie-Anne Moss), Rapp uncovers a web of secrets where crime and the supernatural begin to intersect. The series also features Hudson Williams.

ALAKA SAHANI



Paws and Effect

Shalini Langer

IT'S HARD to believe that this is only the second feature-length film on the beloved Dr Seuss character, and the first animation. It also means that Warner Bros Pictures and directors Alessandro Carloni and Erica Rivinoja have to work doubly hard to make *The Cat in the Hat* stand out from the current deluge.

The effort shows, with the film a dizzying cornucopia of action and colours, with little of the unworldliness of the book and all the worldliness of a studio-backed venture, which also lets it be known that it is hoping to spin at least one more movie out of a character.

In the breathless action on screen, there are very few scenes that are truly moving, laugh-out-loud funny, or even those that evoke a smile. This is despite the fact that the voice work is impressive, particularly Bill Hader as the titular Cat and Matt Berry as Waffles, the pet goldfish that survives the leap from the book to the screen.

The basic storyline is the same, about a brother and sister needing some cheer, a mother out at work, and *The Cat in the Hat* stepping in to fill the gap. However, in this film, the Cat is an employee of a corporation that takes on "clients" which could do with some happiness, he has landed in the doghouse because of how he is prone to creating a mess, and he has got one last chance – provided he can work his magic on Gabby (Xochitl Gomez) and her brother Seb (Tiago Martinez). Gabby is sulking as their mother Carmen (America Ferrera) has made them move town due to her new job. Keeping a watch on them is a nosy landlady (Paula Pell), who underlines that her tenants can't keep pets, make noise, party etc etc.

The Cat zeroes in on the children as his new customers, after first taking from the corporation's supply store a "dangerous" watch that can help one time travel. It is called Go-Backer.

That is not the extent of how literal *The Cat in the Hat* gets, with jokes such as "a fish being seasick" being underlined — just in case one didn't get it the first time.

"The Things", the Cat's help mates, who also make the transition from the book, are the film's one real creative spark, especially in how they communicate with each other, clapping and slapping, cheeks to butts.

To enter different worlds via cardboard boxes, belonging to Mom, Gabby and Seb, respectively, is also a clever narrative device. "Cardboard boxes hold some of life's most unexplored mysteries," says the Cat.

Or, as Calvin of Calvin and Hobbes would say, an empty cardboard box is a "transmogrifier"; it "turns you into whoever you'd like to be".

THE CAT IN THE HAT
★★½
DIRECTORS: Alessandro Carloni, Erica Rivinoja
VOICES: Bill Hader, Xochitl Gomez, Tiago Martinez, Matt Berry, America Ferrera, Quinta Brunson, Paula Pell

The Many Shades of Privilege

Alaka Sahani

HAVE YOU ever felt a film's quiet observations about the contradictions and complexities of human behaviour slowly unsettling you? South Korean filmmaker Lee Chang-dong evokes this feeling once again with *Possible Love*, his first feature since the much-acclaimed *Burning* (2018). Even when everything seems perfectly fine on the surface, there is an undercurrent of unease that gradually gets under your skin.

Written by Chang-dong and Oh Jungmi, *Possible Love* is inspired by a real incident from 2009, when a car factory in South Korea laid off a third of its workforce. This was followed by a workers' strike and a brutal crackdown by the authorities. For Chang-dong, this was not just another labour dispute but a critical event that could alter the course of the labour movement in the country. As a humanistic storyteller, he perhaps saw in it an opportunity to explore class inequality and the trauma that accompanies the loss of income and dignity.

When ambitious documentary filmmaker Ye-ji (Cho Yeo-jeong) chronicles the lives of laid-off workers, the film extends beyond their struggles to explore the intertwined lives of two married couples from vastly different economic backgrounds. A spirited Mi-ok (Jeon Do-yeon) lives quietly with her laid-off husband Ho-seok (Sul Kyung-gu) and their shy young son, Cheol, until she encounters Ye-ji. She later meets Ye-ji's husband, Sang-woo (Zo In-sung).



POSSIBLE LOVE ★★★★
DIRECTOR: Lee Chang-dong
CAST: Jeon Do-yeon, Cho Yeo-jeong, Sul Kyung-gu and Zo In-sung
STREAMING ON: Netflix

The affluent lifestyle of Ye-ji and Sang-woo, an heir to generational wealth, stands in sharp contrast to that of Mi-ok's family. While Mi-ok is willing to help Ye-ji with her documentary, Ho-seok is grappling with alcoholism and anger issues. As Ye-ji gains access to Mi-ok's life and home for her project, their worlds begin to collide. The resulting encounters are often awkward, particularly because Ye-ji seems determined to pretend that their considerable class differences do not matter. There is an unspoken uneasiness that Chang-dong subtly cultivates, drawing the audience into the discomfort of these interactions.

The four lead actors deliver compelling performances, bringing to life characters written with considerable care and detail. At the heart of the film is the intriguing bond between Mi-ok and Ye-ji. Through their relationship, Chang-dong examines power dynamics, hidden desires and the fragile empathy that surfaces when the privileged turn their attention to the suffering of the working class to pursue their own artistic ambitions and agenda.

At two hours and 44 minutes, *Possible Love* ***leaves the audience with observations and questions that linger long after the film ends***

Love demands patience as a slow-burn drama. But it rewards viewers with a rich cinematic experience, leaving them with observations and questions that linger long after the film ends. It evokes, in different ways, the unsettling social undercurrents of Bong Joon-ho's *Parasite* (2019) and Park Chan-wook's *No Other Choice* (2015) — two other acclaimed South Korean black comedies.

Rather than spelling out what he wishes to convey, Chang-dong allows the narrative's undercurrents to do the work, nudging viewers towards uncomfortable realisations. It is this quiet, lingering unease that makes *Possible Love* an absorbing experience.

Little Sugar, Little Sparkle

Shubhra Gupta

RITESH MENON'S short-long film, lasting just a little over an hour, is literally like the kind of Diwali *mithai* which leaves a mildly sweet after-taste which doesn't linger. You can eat it, and forget about it.

Ansh Sikka (Mihir Ahuja) is about to give his parents a surprise. He will be home for Diwali. No advance warning. It's just the kind of news that would make most desi parents jump for joy. But the Sikkas, daddy (Manoj Pahwa), mommy Neelu Kohli) and sister (Aurra Bhatnagar Badoni), have a secret: they do not love the fancy high-rise flat Ansh has bought for them, for which they have had to leave their beloved middle-class colony, missing the warmth and joy spread by close-knit neighbours who are like extended family.

A couple of interesting strands inject a little juice into this little prodigal-son-returns-to-his-senses plot. Turns out the sonny boy hasn't quite managed to make an outright purchase of the flat; it also turns out that mommy dearest, as staunchly middle-class as any other Punjabi matron who has lived in noisy Delhi neighbourhoods, quite enjoys the quiet luxuries of an apartment building with sliding glass doors which open with access cards, and neighbours who are proudly lactose intolerant.



Nothing actively wrong with these things, but nothing great either. It's one of my pet peeves, but why do these projects not work hard enough to shake off the feeling that these are sets? Am I being too demanding when I ask that these 'small colonies where neighbours refuse to mind their own business' look real?

The actors are all real. No Manoj Pahwa was harmed in this cobbled-together set-piece; nor the others. But if you want to show me a proper middle-class hood, just take a little tip from Dibakar Banerjee's delightful Delhi sagas. That may turn your bon bon into proper kaju-katli, not interchangeable patisa.

DILWALI DIWALI ★★
DIRECTOR: Ritesh Menon
CAST: Mihir Ahuja, Manoj Pahwa, Neelu Kohli, Aurra Bhatnagar Badoni, Nimisha Sirohi, Manmeet Singh
STREAMING ON: Netflix

कार्यालय कलेक्टर (आदिवासी विकास शाखा),
जिला - रायगढ़ (छ.ग.)
ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट निविदा सूचना
Portal: http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in

क्रमांक /4932/आवि/2026-27 रायगढ, दिनांक 03.11.2026

कार्यालय कलेक्टर, (आदिवासी विकास शाखा) रायगढ़ के कार्यालय में नीचे दर्शाए गए विवरण के अनुसार ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से सेवा दर पर दिनांक 09.11.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे तक निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

क्र	निविदा कमांक	कार्य का नाम	लागत (लाखों मे)
1.	203431	For event management activities including conceptualizing, designing, execution, complete operation, maintenance and catering services during the event period (15th November 2026) of Janjatiya Gaurav Divas- 2026 Dharamjaigarh, Raigarh, Chhattisgarh	200.00

निविदा में भाग लेने की प्रक्रिया एवं निविदा के संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी **Portal: http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in** में देखी जा सकती है।

हस्ता/-
सहायक आयुक्त
No. 2627040372/2 आदिवासी विकास रायगढ़

dholera A NEW ERA | Dholera Industrial City Development Limited

Tenders are invited from reputed and experienced agencies for the following. The salient features, eligibility criteria and prescribed formats for submission of tender are available at the procurement portal link : **dicdltender.nprocure.com**, as mentioned in below table, as amended from time to time including time extension, if any.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Sr. No.	Description	Bid Due Date (Online)
1	**RFQ cum RFP for "Design and Construction of Cleanroom Excluding Services on EPC Basis in Dholera Special Investment Region, Dholera"**	**30.11.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs**

Physical Bid Submission: Within 07 days from the Online Bid Due Date

The Tender submission shall be accompanied with the requisite Tender Fee, EMD, Forms, supporting documents, etc. as required in the Tender Document.
The Tender submission must be addressed to : Managing Director - DICDL.
6th Floor, Block No. 1 and 2, Udyog Bhavan, Sector-11, Gandhinagar-382011, Gujarat, India. **Phone : +91 - 079-29750500 CIN : U45209GJ2016SGC085839**
Email : tender@dicdl.in

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

PRADHANMANTRI KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJNA
RAIL KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJNA

Notice for the application of 'Kaushal Vikas Training program in Fitter, Welder and Machinist Trade for the Month of December 2026.

A short term (3 weeks) Kaushal Vikas Training Program (Skill Development) **(For the month of December 2026 from 07/12/2026 to 26/12/2026)** is being organized by CLW/Chittaranjan for the Youth under 'RAIL KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJNA' Total 25 Nos. male/female each for Fitter and Welder Trade & 15 Nos. Machinist will be selected for this Training program and this program is **free of cost.**

Eligibility:- 1. Matriculation (10th Standard pass) 2. Age:-18-35 Years (as on 07.11.2026).

Application:- Online at www.railkvy.indianrailway.gov.in website from 08.11.2026 (00:00 hrs.) to 21.11.2026(23:59 hrs.) Application forms can be downloaded from website or can be obtained from Technical Training Centre/ Near Children park, Chittaranjan, WB-713331 from where help may be taken to submit form ONLINE in prescribed time.

OFFLINE FORM SHALL NOT BE ENTERTAINED.

For Assistance: May contact to
Sri Hussain Ali (Assistant lecturer/Mech.), Mobile No. 9332563474.
Detailed information is available at Notifications of the above website **www.railkvy.indianrailway.gov.in**

Principal
Technical Training Centre
PR8/536

U.P. RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED
OBRA - SONEBHADRA
E-Tender Notice

1. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8230688,** Work of chemical of boiler water circuit U#13, 2x200MW, BTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD-Rs. 13,000.00, Amount:-Rs. 7,67,000.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 12.11.2026.
2. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8234158,** Fabrication and supply of ID Fan Impeller Housing of Model No. AN25E6 Unit#12 & 13, BTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD- Rs. 40,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 41,30,000.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 13.11.2026
3. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8233384,** Work of Boiler Maintenance work (pressure part and main boiler) during chemical cleaning of water wall circuit for U#13, 2x200MW, BTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD-Rs. 23,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 11,86,446.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 14.11.2026
4. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8230934,** Strengthening of Mill (Phase-2) of 9C, 9D, 10C, 11C & 11D, 3x200MW units of Obra 'B' Thermal Project, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD-Rs. 40,000.00, Amount:-Rs. 26,07,918.00 (Inclusive of all taxes), Last Date of Uploading Bid : 24.11.2026

For information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website **https://etender.up.nic.in.**

पत्रांक: 106/ज0स0का0/निविदा दिनांक: 06/11/2026

"Save Electricity of Nation"

कार्यालय मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार।
फोन नं० 01334-224457 **Email:** procure.kumbhmela2027@gmail.com

Letter No-1965/km/2027 **Date- 06/11/2026**

मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला 2027, हरिद्वार द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ई-टेण्डरिंग (टू-बिड सिस्टम) के अन्तर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचना **https://uktenders.gov.in** पर दिनांक 07/11/2026 से उपलब्ध होंगी। कार्य का विवरण निम्नानुसार हैः-

Sl. No.	Name of work
1	Selection of an Agency for Design, Production, Fabrication, Supply, Installation, Operation, Maintenance and Dismantling of Hoardings, Unipoles & Static Signages, Transit Hub Branding and Transport Branding for Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027
2	Selection of an Agency for Development, Installation, Operation & Maintenance of Advertising Infrastructure and Grant of Advertisement Rights on an Upfront License Fee Basis for Haridwar Kumbh Mela-2027
3	Selection of an Agency for End-to-End Design & Supply of Merchandise and Gift Hampers for Haridwar Kumbh Mela-2027
4	Selection of an Implementing Agency (IA) for Inventory Management System for Haridwar Kumbh Mela-2027
5	Selection of Service Provider for Face Recognition Based Attendance Management System for the Kumbh 2027-Haridwar
6	Selection of Service Provider for Design, Development, Implementation, Operation and Maintenance of a Mobile Application for Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027
7	**Re-tender for** Selection Of Service Provider for Development, Operation and Maintenance of Temporary Way Side Amenities and Parking Infrastructure in The Identified Peripheral Land Units During Kumbh Mela 2027 in Haridwar (Package 1,3,4)
8	**Re-tender for** Selection of Service Provider to operate and Maintain core Parking Developed at Identified Locations during Kumbh Mela-2027
9	**Re-tender for** Selection of an Operator for Setting Up, Operation and Maintenance of a Canteen/Cafeteria at Mela Bhawan, Har Ki Pauri, Haridwar for Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027

ई-निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें एवं ई-निविदा प्रपत्र वेबसाइट **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध है।

उप मेलाधिकारी,
कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार

POLICE TELECOMMUNICATION HEADQUARTER, MadhyaPradesh, Bhopal
E-mail: ssp_radio@mppolice.gov.in office Phone No. 0755-2443674,

No. PDM/PUR-71-A/Spare Parts Tait/D-18680/2026, Dated 02.11.2026

-:Notice Inviting Tender:-

e-Tenders are invited by the Senior Superintendent of Police (Radio) MP Bhopal on behalf of DGP MP Bhopal for the following items: -

S. No.	ITEM NAME	QTY	Required EMD Rs.	Tender Fee Rs.
1	Surge Protection Device Tx	02		
2	Surge Protection Device Rx	02		
3	Pen Drive 128 GB	02		
4	Pen Drive 64 GB	05		
5	Tool Kit For TP 9400	01		
6	Tool Kit For TM 9400	01		
7	Force Kit (Tool Kit)	02		
8	N Male Connector For RG 58	100		
9	N FeMale Connector For RG 58	20		
10	N Male To Female Connector	25		
11	BNC Crimping Tool	02		
12	N Male Antenna Crimping Tool for LMR 400	02		
13	Antenna Connector preparation Tool for 7/8	01		
14	BNC Connector	50	2,24,000/-	6,000/-
15	N Male Connector For 1½ inch FSJ 4-50 Cable	10		
16	3 db Gain Antenna	50		
17	TB8000/9000 Spare Power Management Unit ACDC12 aux 12	02		
18	TB 9400 Spare Lin PA 762-870M 100W	02		
19	TB 9400 Spare Reciter 762-870M 100W	02		
20	TB 94 Spare Fit Pnl Assy 100W	02		
21	TB9400 Kit Cable Single 100W Replacement Cable Set	05		
22	8 Port Active Reciever Multicoupler, +12V DC	01		
23	TTA	01		
24	Servo Stablizer	01		
25	PCB Interconnect Board	01		
26	Series Comminer Tx Ch. Single, 740-960MHz, 168mm/6.625 in 3/4 Cavity & 150W Dual Stage Broadband Isolotor	05		

1 Cost of tender documents is **Rs. 6,000/- (Tender fee) (Rupees Six Thousand only)** which is non-refundable and cannot be exempted in any condition. Must be paid online at the time of filling e tender.
2. The EMD amount will have to be deposited online through the website **https://www.mptenders.gov.in**.
3. Tender documents can also be download from the website of MP Police (**www.mppolice.gov.in**).
4. The Tender Should be submitted online on website **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** and within scheduled date and time.
5. **Schedule Date & Time:-**

S.No.	Activity of tender	Date	Day	Time
1.	Documents Publish/download/Sale Start Date	02/11/2026	Monday	1800 Hrs
2.	Bid Submission Start Date	03/11/2026	Tuesday	1830 Hrs
3.	Bid Submission End Date	23/11/2026	Monday	1500 Hrs
4.	Opening of PQ Bid	24/11/2026	Tuesday	1510 Hrs

Sd/-
Samir Saurabh
(IPS)
Senior Superintendent of police (Radio)
M.P. Bhopal
G-21101/26

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SONIPAT	ESTIMATE FOR SPRINKLING OF PUMP SET PRESSURE WATER IN M.C SONIPAT + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 11.11.2026	60,24,121/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01302260100 xenhortncs@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 50849/HRY**

भारत सरकार/GOVERNMENT OF INDIA/ अंतरिक्ष विभाग/ DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
विक्रम साराभाई अंतरिक्ष केंद्र/ VIKRAM SARABHAI SPACE CENTRE
निर्माण एवं अनुरक्षण ग्रुप / CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP
तिरुवनंतपुरम/ THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 22 / (फोन नं./ Ph. No. 0471 - 2564568 / 5669 / 4537 / 4545)

ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करते हुए संक्षिप्त सूचना / BRIEF NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER दिनांक/Date : 05.11.2026

भारत के राष्ट्रपति की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्य के लिए ई-टेंडरिंग द्वारा ऑनलाइन मद-दर निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।
On behalf of the President of India, online item-rate tenders are invited through E-tendering for the following work.

1. टर्ल्स, वीएसएसमी, तुंबा में मौजूदा बिटुमिनस सड़कों का उन्नयन (सिविल तथा विद्युत कार्य) / Upgradation of Existing Bituminous Roads in TERLS, VSSC, Thumba (Civil & Electrical works). **NIT No. VSSC/CMG/C01/17/2026-27 Dt. 04.11.2026 (पी.ए.सी/P.A.C: ₹736.89 लाख/ Lakhs)**
डाउनलोड करने की अवधि / Period for downloading: दिनांक 06.11.2026, 10.00 बजे /hrs. से /to दिनांक 19.11.2026, 23.00 बजे/hrs

इच्छुक निविदाकार ब्यौरों के लिए www.tenderwizard.in/isro या www.isro.gov.in देखें। / Interested tenderers may visit www.tenderwizard.in/isro or www.isro.gov.in for details.

प्रधान, सीएमजी, वीएसएससी
Head, CMG, VSSC

SALE PROCLAMATION
OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER
IN THE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL, DEHRADUN AT
2nd Floor, Paras Tower. Mazra, Saharanpur Road, Dehradun, UK-248171

R/C No. 406 of 2024 **Dated : 13.10.2026**

PROCLAMATION OF SALE UNDER RULES 38, 52(2)
READ WITH THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS AND BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993

Punjab National Bank Vs. Mohd. Afsar & Anr

To,
CD-1. Mohd. Afsar S/o Sh. Mohd. Jahoor (Proprietor of M/s Royal Enterprises), R/o House No.2, Mohalla Bahar Quila, Landhaura, Tehsil Roorkee, District Haridwar, Uttarakhand- 247664.
CD-2. Shekhavat Khan S/o Sh. Mohd. Jahoor, R/o House No.2, Mohalla Bahar Quila, Landhaura, Tehsil Roorkee, District Haridwar, Uttarakhand- 247664.

Whereas a sum of **Rs. 21,74,080.85/- (Rupees Twenty One Lakhs Seventy Four Thousand Eighty and Paisc Eighty Five Only)** along with pendent-lite and future interest @ 11.00% simple interest yearly w.e.f. **09.05.2024** till realization and costs of **Rs. 79,000/- (Rupees Seventy Nine Thousand Only),** in respect of Recovery Certificate in **O.A. Case No. 355 of 2024** issued by the **Presiding Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal, Dehradun** in present matter is awarded against CDs.

And wherein as on 30.06.2026, the outstanding dues stands Rs 27,65,449.16/-

And whereas the undersigned has ordered the sale of property mentioned in the Schedule below in satisfaction of the said certificate.

Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the said property shall be sold on **13.01.2027 between 11:00 A.M to 12:00 P.M (with extension of 5 minutes duration after 12:00 Noon, if required) by e-auction and bidding shall take place through "Online Electronic Bidding" through the website https://drt.auctiontiger.net of M/s E-procurement technologies ltd.**

For further detail contact: Mr Baroj Kumar, Chief Manager, Punjab National Bank (Mobile-8768994133).

The sale will be of the property of the defendant above named as mentioned in the schedule below and the liabilities and claims attaching to the said property, so far as they have been ascertained, are those specified in the schedule against each lot.

The particulars specified in the annexed schedule have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, mis-statement or omission in this proclamation.

1. The reserve price below which the property shall not be sold is **Rs 20,00,000/-**

2. The amount by which the biddings are to be increased shall be **Rs 50,000/-** In the event of any dispute arising as to the amount of bid, or as to the bidder, the lot shall at once be again put up to auction.

3. The highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of any lot provided that further that the amount bid by him is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline/acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so,

4. EMD of Rs 2,00,000/- shall be deposited positively by **11.01.2027 by way of DD in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun to be deposited with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun** and details of the property along with copy of PAN card. Address proof and identity proof. E-mail ID. Mobile No. and in case of the company or any other document confirming representation/attorney of the company and the receipt/counter file of such deposit in physical mode shall be submitted before the undersigned. **EMD and Requisite documents as mentioned deposited after last date of EMD shall not be considered for participation in the e-auction.**

5. The successful bidder shall have to pay **25% of the sale proceeds after adjustment of EMD on being knocked down by next date i.e 14.01.2027 by 3:00 P.M. in the said Account No: 7360878086, Account Name: Recovery Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal Dehradun having IFSC Code No. IDIB000D557 or by way of Demand Draft in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun to be deposited with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun.** If the next day is Holiday or Sunday, then on next first office day.

6. The purchaser shall deposit the balance **75% of the sale proceeds on or before 15th day** from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the **15th day be Sunday or other Holiday,** then on the first office day after the 15th day by prescribed mode through RTGS/NEFT/directly in to **the Account No: 7360878086, Account Name: Recovery Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal Dehradun having IFSC Code No. IDIB000D557 or by way of Demand Draft in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun to be deposited with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun.** In addition to the above the purchaser shall also deposit **Poundage fee with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun @ 2% upto Rs.1,000/- and @1%** of the excess of the said amount of **Rs.1,000/- through DD in favour of Registrar, DRT Dehradun.**

In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the deposit, after defraying the expenses of The sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, shall be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold. The property shall be resold, after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale.

The property is being sold on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS".**

The sale attracts Stamp Duty, Registration Charges, etc as per relevant laws. All expenses and incidental charges thereto shall be borne by the auction purchaser.

The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids if found unreasonable or postpone the auction at any time without assigning any reason.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY

Lot No.	Description of property to be sold with the names of the other co-owner where the property belongs to the defaulter and any other person as co-owner.	Revenue, assessed upon the property or any part thereof.	Details of any encumbrances to which the property is liable.	Claims, if any which have been put forward to the property and any other known particulars bearing on its nature and value
1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
1.	Residential land admeasuring 195.167 sq. mtrs. bearing Khasra No. 124/3/2 Min situated at Village Landhaura, Pargana Mangalore, Tehsil Roorkee, District Haridwar, **Bounded and butted as under:-East-** Land of Astbal, **West-** Rasta 4.87 M wide, **North-** Rasta 4.87 M wide, **South-** Other's property.	Not Known	Not Known	Not Known

Given under my hand and seal on this **13.10.2026.** **Recovery Officer, DRT, Dehradun**

SPECIAL BRANCH
POLICE HEADQUARTER, M.P., BHOPAL

NO. SB/Store/2026-25 (818), **Bhopal, Dated 30-10-2026**

"ONLINE E-TENDER NOTICE"

E-tender are invited by Assistant Inspector General of Police, Special Branch (G) M.P., Bhopal on behalf of DGP MP Bhopal for the following item on website **https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**:-

S. No.	Name of Item(s)	Qty.	Tender Fees (Rs.) Paid Online Through mptenders.gov.in	EMD (Rs.) Paid Online Through mptenders.gov.in	Tender No.
1	X-Ray Baggage Scanner	03	3,000/-	1,44,000/-	1st Tender

1. Cost of tender document (Tender Fee) is nonrefundable and cannot be exempted in any condition & must submit online through website **https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**.
2. Tender document can be download from the website of MP Police (**www.mppolice.gov.in**)
3. Bids shall be submitted online only at MP Tenders website: **https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**
4. **Tender Schedule:**

No.	Tender Activity	Date & Time
i	E-Tender Publish Date	31/10/2026 at 1700 hrs.
ii	Tender document download Start Date	31/10/2026 up to 1730 hrs.
iii	Submission of written queries - through e-mail: **aigg-sb@mppolice.gov.in**	**05/11/2026 up to 1700 hrs.**
iv	Pre Bid Meeting along with written queries	06/11/2026 at 1200 hrs.
V	Bid Submission Start Date	10/11/2026 at 1000 hrs.
vi	Last date of online e-Tender submission	20/11/2026 up to 1600 hrs.
vii	Bid will be opened on	23/11/2026 up to 1200 hrs.
viii	Demonstration from	Demo date will be announced separately

5. Intending Bidders are advised to visit this website regularly till closing date of submission to keep themselves updated as any change/ modification in the tender will be intimated through this website only by corrigendum/addendum/ amendment.
6. Bids will be opened as per date/time as mentioned in the Tender Critical Date Sheet. After online opening of Technical-Bid the results of their qualification as well Price-Bid opening will be intimated later.

Sd/-
D.I.G. of Police
Intellignce (G) M.P. Bhopal
Tel. No. 0755-2443654
G-21168/26

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd.,
VS, VIJAYAWADA - 520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)

ABRIDGE FORM
TENDER ID.No.1005797

APGENCO invites open tenders "Design, Engineering, manufacturing, inspection, testing, supply, loading, transportation, unloading, On-site installation & Commissioning of 20 Ton Capacity Rough Terrain Hydraulic mobile crane with 3 section boom 8.0 mtrs to 22.0 mtrs along with spare parts/consumables, standard tool kit and manuals as per latest relevant standards conforming to the technical data for CHP/Dr.MVR.RTPP" through AP e-procurement.EVC Rs. 1,60,00,000/- Schedule available Date & Time : **05.11.2026 - 18:00 Hrs** onwards, Bid submission Closing Date & Time: **19.11.2026-13:00 Hrs.** For further details visit: **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**

R.No.- 5544PP/CL/ADVT/1/1//2021-22 Dt: 06.11.2026

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Tender Notice No.: TRD_NAG_TENDER_26-27_21R, dated 04.11.2026, **Name of the Work:** Geo-Spatial Mapping and Condition Assessment of TRD Assets of Nagpur Division. **Earnest Money (in ₹):** 1,38,000.00, **Tender Cost (in ₹):** 68,99,464.00

Last date of submission of electronic offer (online): 26/11/2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

For the above tender, please visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for further details.

Divl. Elect. Engineer (Tr-D)
PAM/66/178 **SECR/Nagpur**
South East Central Railway @secrail

NPCL NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
Noida Power Company Limited, Greater Noida
Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN- U31200UP1992PLC014506)

E-TENDER NOTICE **Date:07.11.2026**

E Tender (Commercial & Technical) are invited for following job from all interested bidders

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs. in Lakhs)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NPCL/FY26-27/LV Distribution Panel /039 Dated 07.11.2026	ANNUAL RATE CONTRACT OF SUPPLY OF LV Distribution Panel/Box	5.00	07.11.2026 & 14.11.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)
NPCL/FY26-27/Isolator /040 Dated 07.11.2026	PURCHASE ORDER FOR SUPPLY OF 33kV ISOLATOR	1.50	07.11.2026 & 14.11.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-.
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website **www.noidapower.com-->Procurement-->Tenders**

DGM (CMM)

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED
(CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025

NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(Under Rule 8(6) read with Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002)

E-Auction Notice of **30 days** for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

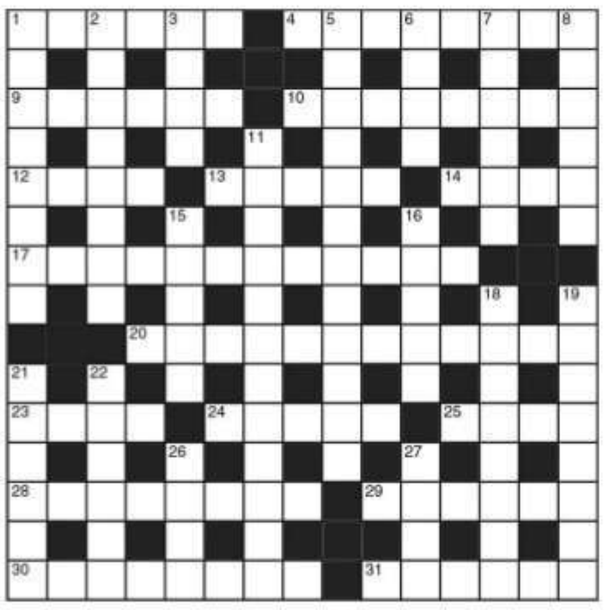
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the below mentioned Borrower and/ Co- Borrower, or their legal heirs/representatives (Borrowers) that the below described immovable property mortgaged to Axis Finance Ltd. (AFL), the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of AFL, will be sold **on 08-12-2026, "As is where is" & "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" and without any recourse basis"** for recovery of outstanding dues from below mentioned Borrower and Co-Borrowers. The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit is mentioned below. Notice is hereby given that, in the absence of any postponement/ discontinuance of the sale, the said secured asset / property shall be sold by E- Auction from 11:00 AM on the said **08-12-2026.** The sealed envelope containing Demand Draft of EMD for participating in E- Auction shall be submitted to the Authorised Officer of the AFL on or before **07-12-2026**till 11:00 am at Branch address **AXIS FINANCE LIMITED** at branch office at Chandra Kunj,3 Pretoria Street Street, Kolkata – 700071,
The sale of the Secured Asset/ Immovable Property will be on "as is where condition is" as per brief particulars described herein below;

Sr. No	Name of Borrower(s) / Co-borrower(s) Legal Heir(s) / Legal Representative/ Guarantor(s)	Date of Demand Notice and amount mentioned in demand notice	Type of possession	Reserve Price	Outstanding as on 05.11.2026
1. 2. 3.	**AMAN KUMAR JHA (Borrower)** **RITA JHA (Co-Borrower I/ Mortgagor I)** **INDRALESH JHA (Co-Borrower II / Mortgagor II)**	26.04.2025 Rs.64,60,699/- (Rupees Sixty Four Lakhs Sixty One Thousand Six Hundred Ninety Nine Only) as on 05.04.2025	**Symbolic**	**Reserve Price:** Rs. 1,23,37,750 /- (Rupees One Crore Twenty Three Lakhs Thirty Seven Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty Only) * Price below which the Flat / property/s will not be sold **Earnest Money Deposit (10% of RP):** Rs. 12,33,775/- (Rupees Twelve Lakhs Thirty Three Thousand Seven Hundred Seventy Five Only)	Rs. **60,43,065**/- (Rupees **Sixty Lakhs Forty Three Thousand Sixty Five** Only) as on 05th November 2026
	Description of Immovable Secured Assets- MOHALLA KANPUR GALI, NEPALI KOTHI, THANA – CHOWK, PATNA CITY, SRO – PATNA CITY, ANCHAL SADAR PATNA, CIRCLE NO. 182, OLD WARD NO. 34/28, NEW WARD NO. 53, TAUZI NO. 139, KHATA NO. 546, PLOT NO. 1597, JAMABANDI NO. 169, DISTRICT – PATNA, STATE – BIHAR – 800008 and boundaries of the House/Plot: East: SELF HOUSE West: LATE SUBHASH CHANDRA KAPOOR HOUSE North: PCC ROAD 11 FT South: LATE SUBHASH CHANDRA KAPOOR HOUSE				

Sr. No	Name of Borrower(s) / Co-borrower(s) Legal Heir(s) / Legal Representative/ Guarantor(s)	Date of Demand Notice and amount mentioned in demand notice	Type of possession	Reserve Price	Outstanding as on 05.11.2026
1. 2.	**Aqueel Monazir** **Md. Zafir Akhtar**	**19.05.2026** **Rs.35,50,147/- (Rupees Thirty Five Lakhs Fifty Thousand One Hundred Forty Seven Only) as on 05.05.2026**	Symbolic	**Reserve Price:** Rs. 67,57,160/- (Rupees Sixty Seven Lakhs Fifty Seven Thousand One Hundred Sixty Only) * Price below which the Flat / property/s will not be sold **Earnest Money Deposit (10% of RP):** Rs. 6,75,716/- (Rupees Six Lakhs Seventy Five Thousand Seven Hundred Sixteen Only)	Rs. **35,54,319**/- (Rupees **Thirty Five Lakhs Fifty Four Thousand Three Hundred Nineteen** Only) as on 05th November 2026
	Description of Immovable Secured Assets- **All that piece and parcel of land measuring about 1197 sq.ft. + 95 sq.ft. Total area-1274 sq.ft. more or less, together with a two storied residential building having built up area 1536 sq.ft. (ground floor 1116 sq. ft. + first floor 420 sq.ft.) bearing M.S. plot no.1098(Part) & 1100(Part), situated at Mohalla Umar Daraz Lane, Lodikatra P.S. Khajekala, ward no.31,63(New),24(ols),sheet no.223,circle no.152,old holding no.116,2,New holding no.128,property no.2021027, Patna City, District Patna,Bihar-800008** **East: Rehana Parveen** **West: Bibi Saulat Fatma** **South: Private Passage** **North: Plot No.1097,House of S.Anwar Ahmad**.				

Note :- The bidders are advised to conduct due diligence before submitting the bid. The auction shall be subject to the outcome of the litigation, Dispute if any.
At the Auction, the public generally is invited to submit their bid(s) personally. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the Immovable Property sold.
The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and the terms and conditions prescribed:
The E-auction of the properties will take place through portal **https://sarfaesi.auctiontiger.net//EPROC/** on **07.12.2026 11:00 a.m. onwards**. For further details please refer to the notice published in the newspapers and at websites: **{service provider website}** and **www.axisfinance.com.**
Contact Person Details & Mob. Nos.:
Mr. Saugata Chakraborty:9836744756
Mr. Raj Singh; Mob: 9354351692
Place:- Kolkata, West Bengal **Sd/-**
Date:- 07.11.2026 **Authorised Officer**
Axis Finance Ltd.
Registered Address: At C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025.
CIN No. U65921MH1995PLC212675.
Branch Address: Axis Finance Limited at branch office at Chandra Kunj,3 Pretoria Street Street, Kolkata – 700071

• CROSSWORD 6140



ACROSS

1 Plan a camping holiday? (6)
4 100% satisfactory (3,5)
9 Game needing a light touch with the whip (6)
10 Government head in Arab state made to go abroad (8)
12 Is coming in about an increase (4)
13 Doesn't stay on level terms (5)
14 Changeable kit (4)
17 Rules to which there can be no exception (6,6)
20 He joins the family after the match (7-2-3)
23 In the finish I get the girl (4)
24 Aids to circulation (5)
25 Thoroughfare you once followed is an eyesore (4)
28 Soldier employed by the navy (3-2-3)
29 About to lose being careless (6)
30 Insist once more that rare sets are unusual (8)
31 Excite with a bit of spooning? (4,2)

DOWN

1 Capital outcome in street repairs (8)
2 Hanging is a nuisance - attempt to get round it (8)
3 Unwatered stock (4)
5 Being confined implies having a small income (7,5)
6 The right time of life for passion (4)
7 Set on a scale doctor aged dreadfully (6)
8 Those persons holding gold as a speculation (6)
11 Yet brunettes may also enjoy it (3,2,3,4)
15 Cut a record (5)
16 Insubstantial but loud abuse (5)
18 He supplies personal cover (8)
19 Gathers dust? (6,2)
21 It bores me in the back (6)
22 Where a girl turns up after six (6)
26 Creatures with feet going in two directions (4)
27 Fit for a day's hunting (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6139 **ACROSS:** 1 Lasso, 4 Tooting, 8 Cat, 9 Bagatelle, 10 Startle, 11 Elate, 13 Skiing, 15 Mosaic, 18 Tenet, 19 Ethical, 21 Conscript, 23 Ian, 24 Satisfy, 25 Lotus **DOWN:** 1 Locusts, 2 Situation, 3 Orbit, 4 Tagged, 5 On the go, 6 Ill, 7 Glebe, 12 Anarchist, 14 Notices, 16 Calends, 17 Verify, 18 Ticks, 20 Hotel, 22 Net

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Fragility is the quality of things that are vulnerable to ___. - Nassim Nicholas Taleb (10)

PTAIO

AFIILL

GHITT

AINTVY

SOLUTIONS: Patio, Tight, Filial, Vanity

ANSWER: Fragility is the quality of things that are vulnerable to **volatility**. - Nassim Nicholas Taleb

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6495

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

9			1					4
					2	5		3
		3		4		1	2	
		7		1				
			9		6			
				3		8		
	3	1		9		4		
6		9	3					
2					5			9

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6494

8	6	1	2	9	7	4	5	3
7	9	5	6	3	4	2	1	8
4	2	3	5	1	8	7	9	6
1	8	2	7	5	9	6	3	4
6	4	9	3	2	1	8	7	5
3	5	7	8	4	6	1	2	9
2	1	6	9	8	5	3	4	7
9	3	8	4	7	2	5	6	1
5	7	4	1	6	3	9	8	2

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): It will be easy to cooperate with partners and close friends today, because an element of enthusiasm is present, particularly for social occasions and anything to do with sports, the arts and fun activities with kids. Tonight: Check your finances.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today you feel optimistic, and you have big ideas related to your job. Work-related travel is likely for many of you. You might want to decorate your home. Tonight: Listen and be cooperative.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a wonderful day to socialise. Visit museums and galleries to enjoy the arts. Sports events and fun activities with kids plus casual get-togethers will please you. Everyone's energy is positive. Tonight: Work to get better organised.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Peace and happiness with home and family are important to you today, which is why you might see ways to expand or improve your home. In fact, your family might be expanding through birth, adoption or marriage. Tonight: Socialise.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Because you're in a positive frame of mind today, you feel generous. You want to share ambitious ideas, because you're quick to see the overall forest, when others are lost in the trees. You'll excel at teaching. Travel will also appeal. Tonight: Rest at home.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): You've got big ideas when it comes to making money today. Make sure you take time to rethink things and test every angle. You don't want to bite off more than you can chew. Nevertheless, this is a great day to do business. Tonight: Discussions.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): It's a fortunate day. The Moon is in your sign dancing with Jupiter, favouring working with others. You'll be very effective in persuading anyone through sales and PR. Others will respond to you, especially because you're genuinely concerned for their welfare. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You're sitting pretty today, perhaps because you're holding a good hand. Certainly, you have a warm feeling in your tummy. You're pleased with your interactions with others and how things are playing out. Be patient this evening. Tonight: You win.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You're enthusiastic about ideas related to publishing, travel, medicine, the law and teaching today. However, be aware of the limitations of the Moon alert before you sign on the dotted line. This is a happy day for you. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You make a great impression on others today, especially authority figures. You look successful in their eyes. In turn, you'll be generous and try to help someone if you can. Tonight: Be friendly.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You want to expand your horizons by meeting new people and learning new things today; however, travel plans might be confusing. Steer clear of jealous feelings. Tonight: You're admired.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Be aware of the Moon alert today, because this is a good day for financial negotiations. This evening, steer clear of controversial subjects. Protect your precious peace of mind. Tonight: Explore and learn.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

DSEU: Delhi CM Rekha Gupta inaugurated Arpan Kendra at Delhi Skill and Entrepreneurship University's Kasturba Campus, Pitampura, in collaboration with the Office of the District Magistrate, Central North. The initiative aims to promote environmental sustainability and women's empowerment by upcycling discarded clothes into reusable products. Highlighting that 2.5 lakh kg of clothes had been donated, the CM announced plans to establish 10 more Arpan Kendras and a Women Skill and Enterprise Centre in Shalimar Bagh. The initiative will engage Self-Help Groups in skill development, product creation & livelihood generation. The event was attended by several dignitaries including Amit Nagpal, MCD Councillor, Dr. Pankaj Lathar, COF & Director PR, DSEU, (Dr.) Sushma Yadav, Dr. Suman Dhawan, Campus Director & officials. The vote of thanks was delivered by Shailendra Singh Parihar, IAS, District Magistrate, Central North and Registrar, DSEU.





SCOPE: DDP, MoD, GoI, & SCOPE in association with PESB & Knowledge Partner, Deloitte organised the National Defence Talent & Capability Conclave 2026. With over 50 participants the conclave brought together senior government officials from DDP, DPE and PSEB, and leaders from the private defence industry. Attended by over 50 participants, including leaders from 16 DPSUs and private defence companies, the conclave deliberated on leadership development, AI adoption, skill-building and industry-academia collaboration. Sanjeev Kumar, Secretary, DDP; K. Moses Chalai, Secretary, DPE; PESB Members Alkesh Kumar Sharma, Roop Narayan Sunkar; & Atul Sobti, DG, SCOPE, addressed the gathering in the presence of Joint Secretaries Vijay Namdeorao Zade, Manisha Chandra and Meera Mohanty.

GAIL reported its financial and operational performance for Q2 and H1 FY27, recording a standalone Profit After Tax of Rs.8,943 crore for H1 FY27, compared to Rs.4,104 crore in the corresponding previous period. Revenue from operations stood at Rs.84,905 crore. On a consolidated basis, PAT reached Rs.9,385 crore. The company also reported a cumulative capital expenditure of Rs.7,600 crore during H1 FY27. Deepak Gupta, Chairman and Managing Director, GAIL, highlighted the resilience of teams in maintaining uninterrupted supplies, strengthening operational efficiency, and ensuring sustainable business growth amid geopolitical challenges.

INDIAN OIL: As part of Vigilance Awareness Week 2026, themed "Probity for Prosperity", IndianOil organised its annual Inter-School Quiz Competition in Delhi-NCR, witnessing participation from 126 schools. The event was inaugurated by Shailendra Singh, IFS, Chief Vigilance Officer, IndianOil, who emphasised the importance of integrity, honesty and ethical conduct. Dr. Ajit Kumar Thakur, ED (Vigilance), and R.R. Raje, ED (HR), RHQ, were also present. PM Kendriya Vidyalaya, Vikaspuri emerged as the winner, while Sanskriti School, Chanakyapuri and Abhinav Public School, Pitampura secured the first and second runner-up positions, respectively.





REC: The India Energy Stack (IES) Taskforce meeting was held recently in New Delhi to review its Final Report outlining the strategy, architecture and governance framework for developing digital public infrastructure for India's power sector. Jitendra Srivastava, CMD, REC Limited, delivered the welcome address, while Prince Dhawan, Executive Director, REC Limited, and Smt. Swetha Ravi Kumar, Executive Director, FSR Global, presented the report. Dr. Ram Sewak Sharma, Chairperson, IES Taskforce, outlined the way forward. Shashank Misra, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Power, delivered the concluding remarks.

BANK OF MAHARASHTRA: Under the guidance of the Central Vigilance Commission, the Dehradun Zonal Office of the Bank of Maharashtra is observing 'Vigilance Awareness Week'. The theme of this year is 'Probity for Prosperity'. Besides, the zonal office organised an awareness rally, in which senior bank officials participated. The rally was flagged off by the Deputy Zonal Manager,. Ashutosh Tripathi, and the Zonal Vigilance Officer, Deepak Pandey.



CCIC participated in the ongoing Bharat Parv 2026, held at Ekta Nagar, Kevadia, Gujarat. The Prime minister of India visited the CCIC Pavillion. The visit provided an opportunity for CCIC to showcase its rich legacy, its longstanding association with artisans, weavers, and its continued efforts towards promoting India's traditional handloom & handicraft heritage. Bimal Gopalachari, Managing Director, CCIC, along with officials of the Corporation, artisans and weavers, were present at the Pavilion. Through its initiatives, CCIC is actively contributing to the vision of "Vocal for Local" and taking "Local to Global", by connecting India's traditional craftsmanship with wider domestic and international markets.





EXHIBITION: Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the 'Mann Ki Baat' painting exhibition at the National Museum, Janpath, New Delhi, recently, in the presence of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Rajya Sabha MP Dr. Vikramjit Singh Sahney. Organised by the World Punjabi Organisation, the exhibition showcases 76 paintings by artist Manjit Singh, depicting Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years of public service. Addressing the gathering, Dr. Sahney urged that the Prime Minister be conferred the Bharat Ratna in recognition of his dedication and service to the nation. Shah also felicitated the artist.

THDCIL organised recently 'VIMARSH 2026 – THDC HR Confluence', a two-day national conclave on the theme "Workforce 2026: Driving Organisational Readiness for India's New Labour Codes", at the Rasmanjari Auditorium, THDCIL, Rishikesh. The inaugural session was graced by Sipan Kumar Garg, MD, THDC India Limited, who addressed the gathering and highlighted the importance of understanding the evolving labour- law landscape and strengthening organisational preparedness to translate regulatory reforms into effective workplace practices. The opening keynote address was delivered by Dr. Onkar Sharma, Former Chief Labour Commissioner (Central), who spoke on "From Reform Vision to Four Labour Codes: The Legislative Journey". The inaugural programme also included dignitaries such as Vinay Trivedi, Former Deputy DG, Ministry of Labour & Employment, GoI, Rupin Chopra, Associate Partner at S.S. Rana & other officials.





INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT KASHIPUR inaugurated a two-day book exhibition recently at its campus in Uttarakhand. The exhibition, featuring over 20 national and international publishers and approximately 15,000 titles, was attended by faculty members, research scholars, staff and students. Prof. Neeraj Dwivedi, Director, IIM Kashipur, addressed the gathering and encouraged faculty and students to explore the collection and recommend books for the Institute Library. Covering subjects such as management, humanities, psychology, literature, biographies and Uttarakhand's heritage, the exhibition aims to promote reading, intellectual curiosity and lifelong learning.

CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA conducted a 'Vigilance Awareness Campaign-2026' recently under the theme "Towards Prosperity through Integrity. "The campaign aims to promote honesty, transparency, and ethical values in society, while fostering public awareness against corruption. As part of this initiative, various branches of the bank in the Dehradun region are organizing 'Gram Sabhas' (village meetings) in rural areas to educate the public about vigilance, cybersecurity, and necessary precautions for digital banking. In this sequence, a walkathon was organized on 30th October, 2026, by the Regional Office & staff from the Regional Office and Delhi. Speaking on the occasion, Rajat Bajaj emphasized that integrity and honesty should be an integral part of every individual's work and conduct. He urged everyone to incorporate ethical values and transparency into their daily lives.



SAIL: SAIL reported a nearly 315% year-on-year rise in PAT for Q2 FY27, reflecting improved operational and financial performance. Chairman and Managing Director Dr. A.K. Panda highlighted the company's record second-quarter production across hot metal, crude steel, saleable steel and finished steel. High-value product volumes grew 36% over Q1, while sales volumes increased 5% year-on-year. SAIL also recorded its highest-ever quarterly iron ore production and sales. Dr. Panda attributed the performance to operational efficiency, improved product mix, stronger mining operations, customer engagement and renewed emphasis on workplace safety.





IREDA: Jatin Kumar Nayak recently assumed charge as Chairman, MD of IREDA. The appointment follows the approval of the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet, as conveyed by the MNRE through Order dated 29th October 2026. He holds a master degree in commerce from Utkal University, Bhubaneshwar, Odisha. Nayak combines financial acumen with an understanding of governance, regulatory affairs and the operational dynamics of large public - sector organisations. Prior to his appointment as CMD, he held the position of Executive Director (Finance) at REC Limited. His extensive experience spans over the power sector & resource-intensive industries, including mining and metals, domestic and international resource mobilisation, corporate finance, & taxation and legal affairs.

IIFT ,GIFT City Campus, inaugurated AAROHAN 2026 – Ascent in a Changing Global Economy, a two-day business conclave in Gandhinagar on October 31. Inaugurated by Dr. K. Rangarajan, Vice Chancellor, IIFT, the event brought together industry leaders, government representatives, academicians and students to discuss emerging global business trends. Dr. Rajendra Prasad Sharma, Campus Head, welcomed the gathering, while Dr. Rahul Singh, Joint Director, DGFT, delivered the special address. The conclave featured discussions on international trade, marketing, finance, human resources, and supply chain management.



EIL has reported a strong financial performance for the Quarter which ended on 30th September 2026, marked by healthy growth in profitability and continued business momentum. They have secured Rs.7,428 crore worth of new orders during H1 FY 2026-27, comprising Rs. 5,762 crore from consultancy services and Rs.1,666 crore from turnkey projects. During Q2 FY 2026-27, PBT increased by 58% to Rs. 229 Crore, compared to Rs.145 Crore during the first quarter (Q1) of FY 2026-27. PAT also grew by 66% to Rs.180 Crore, as against Rs.109 Crore during the first quarter (Q1) of FY 2026-27. The Company continues to focus on business growth, operational excellence, diversification of project portfolio, growing international footprint & leveraging emerging opportunities across traditional energy, energy transition & infrastructure sectors.



PNB inaugurated Vigilance Awareness Week 2026, themed "Probity for Prosperity", at its Corporate Office in Dwarka, New Delhi, recently. The week-long observance commenced with a floral tribute to Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel and an integrity pledge. Executive Directors M. Paramasivam and D. Surendran, Chief Vigilance Officer Raghvendra Kumar and senior bank officials attended the ceremony. Addressing the gathering, Paramasivam emphasised ethical conduct, transparency and accountability, while Raghvendra Kumar highlighted preventive vigilance and awareness of emerging digital banking frauds. A walkathon followed the inauguration.



NHDC recently organised the exclusive handloom expo at the head office in Noida in collaboration with the Ministry of Textiles, GoI. The exhibition is open for the common masses. This year the event features 25 participants from across the country, bringing together the diverse weaving traditions of different regions. Each product reflects the skill, creativity and craftsmanship of India's weavers. NHDC continues to focus on supporting livelihoods in the handloom sector and preserving India's cultural and textile traditions. Visitors can view and purchase authentic handloom products directly from the participants.



OXFORD SCHOOL has emerged victorious in the 37th Hans Raj Prabhakar Memorial Invitational Basketball Tournament 2026, securing the championship title after an outstanding performance marked by teamwork, determination, discipline, and sportsmanship. The final match was played against Mira Model School (JP) in which Oxford School secured a memorable victory with a final score of 47-32. The winner of the Senior Boys category was the Host School, Oxford Senior Secondary School, Vikas Puri, New Delhi. The trophies were handed over to the proud Winners & Runners-up and Individual prizes along with the certificates to the players, coaches & officials by the Chief Guest Maj. Gen. Satbir Singh (Retd.), SM** in presence of Chairman Captain Shrikant Sharma and Organising Secretary Sarvpriya Prabhakar.

Sooryavanshi to lead Bihar in first two SMAT matches



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. BCCI

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 6

VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI has been named Bihar's captain for the first two matches of the 2026-27 Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy. The Bihar Cricket Association (BCA) announced a 17-member squad on Friday, with the 15-year-old set to lead the team against Saurashtra in their opener on November 14 and Railways on November 16. Both matches will be played in Indore.

This is not Sooryavanshi's first leadership assignment this year. He was named vice-captain of East Zone for the 2026-27 Duleep Trophy, serving as Ishan Kishan's deputy.

He got an opportunity to captain the side during the semi-final against Central Zone after Kishan walked off with a wrist injury. East Zone won the competition, securing the title on the basis of a 372-run first-innings lead after the final against South Zone ended in a draw in Chennai.

BCA president Harsh Vardhan said the captaincy would provide Sooryavanshi with another opportunity to develop as a cricketer and leader.

"Vaibhav has already demonstrated tremendous talent, confidence and maturity at a young age, and this responsibility will provide him with another opportunity to grow as a cricketer and leader," he said, as quoted by IANS.

The left-hander has enjoyed a sensational rise in 2026, making an impact at the Under-19 level before carrying that form into the Indian Premier League and earning an international debut. Sooryavanshi played a pivotal role in India's triumph at the 2026 Under-19 Men's Cricket World Cup, scoring 175 in the final against England. He then became the leading run-scorer in IPL 2026 for Rajasthan Royals, scoring 776 runs at a strike rate of 237.30. Those performances earned him a place in India's T20I squad. He made his international debut in the second T20I against England in Manchester in July, becoming India's youngest men's international cricketer.

BIHAR SQUAD: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (captain), Suraj Kashyap (vice-captain), Alok Kumar, Ayush Loharuka (wk), Altamash Ashraf, Param Kumar Singh, Anmol Kumar (wk), Ritwik Raj, Mayank Kumar, Raghvendra Pratap, Ashish Kumar, Vasudev Pratap Singh, Mohammad Izhar, Amod Yadav, Prashant Singh, Nawaz Khan, Himanshu Singh. Subject to fitness: Mangal Mahour, Shakib Hussain.

'Shukriya, Test cricket': Shami hangs up India whites

Express News Service
Mumbai, Novemeber 6



Mohammed Shami featured in 64 Test matches for India. PTI

Tests **64** | Wkts: **229** | Ave **27.71** | 5W: **6** | BBI: **6/56**

MOHAMMED SHAMI announced his retirement from Test cricket on Friday, bringing an end to a 13-year career in which he became one of India's most successful fast bowlers in the longest format.

The 36-year-old made the announcement in an Instagram post on Friday, accompanied by a video. Shami, who made his Test debut against the West Indies at Eden Gardens on November 6, 2013, finished with 229 wickets from 64 matches at an average of 27.71. His last Test match for India came in the 2023 World Test Championship final against Australia at The Oval.

"*Safed jersey se vida le raha hoon, lekin usse judi yaadon se kabhi nahi...* (I am saying goodbye to the white jersey, but never to the memories associated with it)," Shami wrote.

"Test cricket *mere liye sirf ek format nahi, meri zindagi ka ek behad khaas hissa raha hai. Aaj bhaari dil aur anginat khoobsurat yaadon ke saath main Test cricket se retirement lene ka faisla kar raha hoon.* (Test cricket was not just a format for me; it was a very special part of my life. Today, with a heavy heart and countless beautiful memories, I have decided to retire from Test cricket)," he added.

Shami thanked his teammates, coaches, family and the millions of Indians who stood by him through good times and difficult periods. He also acknowledged the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) and the Cricket Association of Bengal (CAB) for believing in his talent and providing him with opportunities.

"*Maidan par meri aakhri Test ball bhale hi fenki ja chuki ho, lekin Bharat ke liye khelne ka garv hamesha mere dil mein zinda rahega.* (My last Test ball may have already been bowled, but the pride of playing for India will always remain alive in my heart)," he wrote before signing off with, "Shukriya, Test Cricket. (Thank you, Test cricket)."

It was at Kolkata's Eden Gardens that Shami began his Test journey. Making his debut against the West Indies, he made an immediate impact, taking a match haul of 9/118 as India won by an innings and 51 runs.

Over the years, Shami established himself as a key member of India's pace attack, delivering consistently in both home and overseas conditions. He claimed six five-wicket hauls and one of the high points of his career came in 2018-19, when he was part of the Indian team that won a Test series in Australia for the first time.

Known for his ability to generate pace and movement off the surface, Shami was also particularly effective with the older ball, using reverse swing to trouble batsmen and deliver crucial breakthroughs.

His ability to swing the ball both ways, maintain accuracy and hit the seam hard made him one of India's most reliable fast bowlers across different conditions.

While his Test career has come to an end, Shami is likely to continue playing white-ball cricket. He has been named in Bengal's squad for the 2026-27 Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy, starting on November 14.

• BRIEFLY



Algerian Imane Khelif has been out of action since 2024. REUTERS

Olympic champion Khelif set for first bout since Paris Games

IMANE KHELIF is set to return to the ring for the first time since winning gold at the Paris Olympics, with the 27-year-old due to fight on December 15. Khelif will face Dutch boxer Clarida Sarabia in a six-round professional fight, French media said. Khelif said she never gave up despite the long absence from the ring. "Days became weeks, weeks became months. I waited, doubted. But deep inside, the fire never died. Behind closed doors, I kept fighting," she said in a video posted by Stair Event on Instagram. REUTERS

Skeet shooters miss individual medal rounds

THE SEASONED Indian men's and women's skeet shooters endured a disappointing outing at the ISSF World Championships on Friday, missing out on the individual medal rounds and finishing outside the medal positions in team events. Hopes of securing a quota place for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics ended without success. The 10m air pistol mixed team event is scheduled later in the day but event does not offer Olympic quota places. PTI

Pranavi makes cut at China Championship

ACE INDIAN golfer Pranavi Urs hung on the cut line for her entire second nine with a series of pars and then squeezed inside with a 1-under 72 at the 2026 Aramco China Championship on Friday. Pranavi, who shot even par 73 on the first day, added 1-under 72 on the second day for a 1-under total after 36 holes to ensure weekend action. Pranavi, winner of the Asian Games, is now T-58 and has a chance to make an upward move over the weekend. PTI

Sindhu named chair of IOA Athletes panel

TWO-TIME Olympic-medallist shuttler PV Sindhu and Indian men's hockey team captain Harmanpreet Singh were on Friday named as the chairperson and vice-chairperson respectively of the Indian Olympic Association's (IOA) Athletes' Commission, while Mirabai Chanu and swimmer Sajan Prakash were elected as athlete representatives to the General Body of the national sports apex body. Sindhu and Harman were appointed uncontested. PTI

India beat Nepal by 10 wickets in U-19 Asia Cup

AARYAVIR SEHWAG and Lakshya Raichandani hit strokeful half-centuries as an all-round India trounced Nepal by 10 wickets in their opener of the U-19 Asia Cup one-day cricket tournament on Friday. India scored 129 for no loss in 19.1 overs to win with 185 balls to spare. **BRIEF SCORES: Nepal U-19** 128 in 42.3 overs (Darsh Sonar 43; Arjun Rajput 3/8) **lost to India U-19** 129/0 in 19.1 overs (Lakshya Raichandani 53 not out, Aaryavir Sehwag 70 not out) by 10 wickets. PTI

Marquez and Mumbai City FC part ways

MANOLO MARQUEZ'S tenure at Mumbai City FC has come to an abrupt end, with the club confirming on Friday that both parties have mutually agreed to part ways. The decision makes him the first managerial departure of the 2026-27 Indian Super League season. The separation follows a disappointing start to the campaign, with the former champions failing to register a victory in their opening four matches, recording two draws and two defeats. PTI

Sinner splits with coach Darren Cahill

JANNIK SINNER has parted ways with coach Darren Cahill, the world number two said in a video posted on social media on Friday, with Magnus Norman poised to replace the Australian. "A large part of who I am, as a player and as a person, I owe to you," Sinner said about Cahill in a video posted on Instagram. "Of these five seasons, I won't forget a single day. Thank you, my friend, for everything. It has been a privilege." REUTERS

NEW-FOUND JOY FOR VIRAT

Kohli is rewriting his batting script with one six at a time

Batting great was always a master of the four, but sixes are becoming a bigger part of his game in autumn of his career

Sandip G
New Delhi, November 6



Virat Kohli has hit a six every 25 balls since SA series last year. AP

IN THE autumn of his splendid career, before the inevitable cold dread of winter sets in, Virat Kohli has found a new meter in his batting. The high octave of the six, a stroke that he once employed as a means to an end, but now unfurled as an act of pure expression.

He has struck sixes before - 715 across formats. But never at the frenetic frequency he is hitting them now. Since South Africa's visit to India at the end of last year, he has struck one every 153rd ball (153.5 to be exact). Since then, in 13 games, every 25th ball has travelled beyond the ropes.

The interval matters, because it is Kohli, inarguably the greatest to have played this format. It also matters, because there is no more fascinating sportsperson than one that is not only redefining, but reinterpreting himself.

He has struck sixes before, too. But seldom with this spontaneous joy. Six was not a fetish; the four was his weapon of destruction. It sufficed, because he could hit them where he willed to, when he wanted to, and who he desired to.

He scored more runs from fours than even the most savage six-hitter from sixes. The sixes were not forced or strained. But he seemed to derive more joy from a backfoot-punched four than a slogged six.

Maybe it was what Kohli loved the most. But age changes tastes and perceptions. His epic 133 not out against Sri Lanka in Hobart featured only two; his imperious unbeaten 183 against Pakistan in Mirpur contained a solitary six. But nine sixes sprinkled his most recent of 55 ODI hundreds, an unbeaten 133 against West Indies in Thiruvananthapuram.

Maximums account for 19.3 percent of his runs in this phase; before this six-spree, he had hit five-plus sixes only once in 293 outings. He has hit nine sixes and seven sixes twice each in his next 13 innings.

Only four times has he not hit a six in an innings in this span (two of them were single-digit scores). It could be a natural outcome of him batting at the highest tempo ever in his career, a strike rate hugging 120, as opposed to a mean of 94.4.

Beyond boundaries

He has struck sixes before too. But sans this enthusiasm. He hit great sixes, but was not a great hitter of sixes. Now, he is both. The routes and methods have not changed.

The staple option is waltzing down the track and hitting the bowler, often the seamer, over his head, in the arc between long-on and long-off.

The pull is the other favourite. He was always a good puller, but unless deep into the game, he often rode the bounce and played them along the ground. These days, he sways a little to his right and glides them over fine-leg if the ball strays onto his body at a suitable height.

Or he gets under them, swivels and flays them in front of the square. The six in Auckland was a classic example. He got into the position early, pivoted his weight on his back foot, got under the ball, fetched it from outside the off-stump, transferred his weight seamlessly into the shot and turned the body with the stroke.

Several maximums in the West Indies series were pulled too, but often behind square, using the bowlers' pace.

The six, now, captures his mood, freed from the burden of playing all formats. The six captures his lightness of mind. The fight against the world has ended; he is at peace with himself. He explained his six-hitting rationale after the Thiruvananthapuram ODI against West Indies: "When I play freely, then I know I can hit sixes. So, I just wanted to have some fun because I was batting well, just take a bit more risk. Just push my own boundaries and see where we go."

His liberation after a torrid period of drought began with a six-laden T20I hundred (122: six sixes) in Dubai in 2022.

Two months later, he stroked the most defining brace of sixes in his life, against Pakistan at MCG. He has struck sixes before. But they weren't a measure of his evolution. After nearly two decades as the best player in the world, he somehow retains the capacity to surprise.

No matter how certain you are that he has reached the outer limit of his talent, he can find another boundary, another edge. Often it's the other way around; batsmen reduce their big shots as they age.

Kohli chose the inverse path. The transformation has been smooth. Kohli always had the ability to hit sixes and knew their worth. It's just that he is relishing it more now.

The fours mark the spring of youthful days; the sixes embody the carefreeness of his autumnal bloom.

• Virat Kohli's six-hitting wind

VIRAT KOHLI has not changed much of his fundamentals, just that he gets into positions early and is more daring. He has not added new shots, but utilising those that he has wisely and effectively.

THE PULL has been one of his favourite strokes. Once he used to play those along the ground, now he gets under them and hits them in front of the square or glides them over fine-leg.

THE SIGHT of his charging down the deck to the seamers is a common sight. In his younger days, he used to drive them through cover for fours. Now, he blitzes them over their head.

• WTA CHENNAI OPEN 250

Maaya's quarters run offers a glimpse of future

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, November 6



Maaya Rajeshwaran lost to World no 151 Robin Montgomery. PTI

AT LAGOS last month, Maaya Rajeshwaran Revathi overcame a 0-5 first-set deficit against top seed Justina Mikulskyte in the first round. She went on to claim the title.

Maaya then rallied from 2-5 down in the third set versus world No. 115 Katarzyna Kawa in her Chennai Open opener. Three days later, having already made history, the 17-year-old again found her back against the wall. There was no escape this time. United States' Robin Montgomery was too composed, too consistent to let the lead slip. And so Maaya's memorable campaign culminated with a 3-6, 3-6 defeat in the quarter-finals. Memorable, for she ended a 15-year wait in Indian women's tennis — Sania Mirza was the last player from the country to reach the singles last eight of a WTA Tour-level tournament. Indian-American Shikha Uberoi is the only other one to have done that, back in 2005. Maaya beat Poland's Weronika Falkowska in the Round of 16 to emulate Sania and Shikha. It was only her second WTA Tour main-draw win.

The Coimbatore girl will thus always remember Chennai Open 2026 — the last edition of the WTA 250 event — as a stepping stone in her transition from juniors to seniors.

On Friday, she began confidently, breaking Robin's serve straight away. The 22-year-old American didn't take kindly to the insult and went after everything the teen dished out from there on. She wrapped up the first set in 38 minutes.

Robin only got stronger in the second set, using her double-handed forehands to powerful effect. But even as a one-sided loss became imminent, Maaya showed her promise.

She produced a series of deep groundstrokes off both flanks. Down 1-4 and two games away from bowing out, the Indian found her range to delight the home spectators momentarily. She broke back once and firmed up on serve. A smart inside-out forehand cut the deficit to 3-4. Robin, however, saw the emerging threat and stubbed it out. The 151-ranked American, who broke into the top-100 last year, closed out the match in 72 minutes. She had nothing but praise for Maaya. "I'm very glad to see someone like her come up in our sport. I think she has a very bright future," Robin said courtside of her young opponent after the victory.

Maaya got only a half-hour break before her doubles quarter-final alongside Shrivalli Bhamidipaty. She suffered a straight-sets defeat there too, losing to the Hungarian-Dutch combine of Panna Udvardy and Isabelle Haverlag 3-6, 4-6.

Nevertheless, there was lots to cherish for the prodigy, chiefly the feeling that she belongs on the professional tour. "I'm more confident, (in) that I can compete better than I think," Maaya told reporters later. She expectedly picked her first-round win over Kawa as her favourite of the three performances this campaign,as it looked most "like a battle". She will take a well-deserved break now and rest for the next few weeks, before the pre-season training for 2027 gets underway.

By virtue of her quarters run in Chennai, Maaya has leaped from No. 669 to No. 489 in the live WTA rankings. She sounded cautiously optimistic about what that leap means. "It's good, it's part of the journey. I'm happy with what I've been doing, and yeah, I'll be back for more," the spunky 17-year-old signed off.

Shelton tops Tommy Paul to reach first Paris Masters semis

Associated Press
Paris, November 6



Ben Shelton recorded his 44th win of the season. AP

BEN SHELTON won an all-American matchup against Tommy Paul on Friday to reach the semifinals of the Paris Masters for the first time. Shelton advanced with a 6-4, 4-6, 6-3 win under the roof of the Plenitude Arena after converting two of four break points.

It was his third win in five meetings between the two. The third-seeded Shelton hit 19 aces as he ended Paul's hopes of qualifying for the ATP Finals scheduled in Turin from Nov. 15-22. As a result, another American player, Frances Tiafoe, clinched his spot and will make his debut at the season-ending tournament.

"Frances has had an outstanding year. One of my best friends, and to see him make Turin for the first time is amazing," Shelton said. "I'm super happy for him, and obviously we have had a lot of Americans competing for that spot. It's been a big year from all of us, and it's cool that we are all in the mix."

Earlier, Ben Shelton beat Arthur Rinderknech 3-6, 6-4, 7-6 (5) on Thursday for the quarter-final spot.

There is only one singles spot up for grabs at the Finals, with top-ranked Alexander Zverev, Carlos Alcaraz, Shelton, Daniil Medvedev, Flavio Cobolli and Arthur Fils having already qualified. If Taylor Fritz defeats Alcaraz to reach the Paris Masters semifinals later Friday, he will join them in Turin. If he loses, Rafael Jodar will take part in the elite gathering instead. It was Shelton 44th tour-level victory of the season, improving his personal-best win tally following his 42 wins in 2024. He will next be up against either Frenchman Luca Van Assche or qualifier Rinky Hijikata.

Carlos Alcaraz will play Fritz after he advanced earlier post Matteo Berrettini withdrew from their third-round match because of an arm injury. The big-serving Italian did not specify which arm but said in an Instagram post that he has been in pain for a few days.

YOUTH OLYMPICS

Tanvi harries Yi Xin, wins spunky silver

15-year-old loses close match to China's World Jr. Champ; punch clears ensured Zhang was kept away from the net and out of balance

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, November 6

TANVI PATRI, only 15, came from 10-19 down in the decider and reached 20-20. She made Chinese junior World champion Zhang Yi Xin, 17, suffer her frittering of six very nervy match points, before letting go of the gold medal at the Youth Olympics in badminton's girls singles final at Dakar, Senegal.

In an 82-minute classic featuring badminton's hottest rivalry of India versus China, a titanic teen battle panned out. Zhang saved three match points to finish with a 21-15, 13-21, 24-26 scoreline as the Indian dragged her all the way into a corner, before the tiniest of net clips gave her a 25-24 escape and then Tanvi sent one wide to deliver a fantastic final.

And a silver she will be proud of and get pensive over, in equal measure.

At 10-19 in the third game, Tanvi was down and almost out of it as the momentum had swung and she was playing tired strokes.

But the Odia youngster doesn't give up. She carefully built nine of the next 10 points, well aware of the Chinese being nervous in a puddle of errors. The second wind was more of a breeze as she streamlined her plans and rediscovered the timing to trouble Zhang all the way to the 24th point.

Zhang had a net chord on 22 and Tanvi's crunching strokes never lost the coherence in this period, as she reclaimed the net.

The win for the Chinese had come by the slightest of margins, not because the Indian was spent or tired.



At 10-19 in the third game, Tanvi won nine of the next 10 points. OIS/NIC BOTHMA

•STAR-STRIKES

Tanvi Patri has varied influences in her game style, inspired by some of the biggest international names in badminton.

LIN DAN: Tanvi's favourite shuttler, the youngster grew up watching his match videos in China from when she was 6. The forehand backcourt cross that she plays with a jump, was a Ctrl C+Ctrl V homework when she trained in Jiangsu.

LEE ZII JIA: The Paris bronze medallist is someone whom Tanvi bases her net game on. "Smashes can be defended. But it's impossible when you attack from the net. She loves that," father Rabinarayan Patri says.

AN SE-YOUNG: The generational women's singles player had Tanvi glued to the Paris Olympics stream, as she took tips on her footwork

AYUSH SHETTY: Again, a very strong offensive game at the net — something Tanvi wishes to develop.

> **"I was down in points (third game) but somehow I managed it till the end. The drift was a challenge, as were the mistakes like in the decider I started hitting so many Outs when I changed sides."**
> TANVI PATRI

Tanvi, playing very sophisticated badminton for her age, is worth every bit of the hype she has generated over the last three months.

"Even in third game the match was good. I was down in points but somehow I managed it till the end. The drift was a challenge, as were the mistakes like in the decider I started hitting so many Outs when I changed sides," she would add.

Tanvi started 3-5 down as Zhang Yi Xin threatened to use her left-handed angles and retrieving rigour to take the first leads. However, the Indian went on a 7-point spree, picking the shuttle high on the net to play aggressively and go up to 10-5 up.

Tanvi's punch clears ensured Zhang was kept away from the net and out of balance. But the delicious deception was in how she toggled the Chinese front and back, with rally constructions that used the backhand hold and drives to match Zhang. On one point, Tanvi kept peppering Zhang's backhand which the Chinese diligently retrieved only to realise the winner buried on her forehand side.

The Bengaluru resident would win the first game with one of her signature silhouettes — the jump at the back court and a forehand bursting forth for a shooting winner. Zhang is known for her retrieving, but Tanvi was daring her every point to live up to the reputation, while scattering the shuttle with precision, a plan that punctured the Chinese belief that she could pick every shuttle.

Great footwork

The Indian was on a roll at 8-5 up before the left-hander jolted out of her indecision and took control of the net. Both have exemplary footwork and can retrieve well. But though Tanvi has far more delectable strokes, the Chinese knew how to get out of trouble and problem-solve with persistence. She waited for moments to frustrate Tanvi and raced to the second game, taking with her the crucial momentum.

Tanvi was staring at a 10-19 scoreline and a wipeout before a different kind of rallies lit up Dakar. The Chinese initially reckoned she was just two points away and Tanvi nine adrift and took it a tad easy. Then she panicked because Tanvi wouldn't stop inching towards her score. By 17-19, Zhang was melting.

So while Zhang couldn't convert her six match points, she held on for dear life and stubbed out Tanvi's three championship points with desperate scampers.

Given how the India vs China rivalry has proceeded to 15 vs 17 battling for 82 minutes, it would be easy to assume that the two players will get cracking at the seniors soon enough. But the duo are still teens whose immediate concern was getting the right 'cheese and pouts' for a medal selfie alongside the Japanese bronze medallist.

"My most memorable moments were trading pins, making new friends and playing games in the News 365 athlete house," Tanvi would say.

"We will celebrate at home where my mother will make me some nice food," she would end.

Off-court: Travel fatigue, mosquitos, no AC in rooms

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, November 6

> **"We need to minimise transit times and plan better. Athletes don't function well this way."**
> **RABINARAYAN PATRI**
> TANVI'S FATHER

RABINARAYAN PATRI doesn't subscribe to the sentiment that a good badminton smash — or a Youth Olympics silver — needs to extract struggle or suffering out of his daughter, Tanvi. "Silver was expected, so that's ok," Rabi would say, adding, "Her total travel time to World Juniors in Egypt was 28 hours. For the Youth Olympics, it was 44. Complaining never helps and I can't blame anyone, but if we don't look at comfort of athletes from this generation, they get irritated and it doesn't work," Rabi says, after the 15-year-old played a humdinger of a 82-minute Youth Olympics final at Dakar, Senegal, against 17-year-old Chinese Zang Yi Xin, despite logistical nightmares.

Tanvi returned to Odisha from China, where her father was an IT professional, at age 9 during Covid and trained in her home state for a year. "She would train with temperatures reaching 50 degrees and insane humidity which built her endurance. She won't shy away from hard work. But at Dakar, she called up on Day 1 to say there were mosquitoes and no A/C in the rooms. And the long travel really affects her," the father would add.

When Rabi moved to Bangalore, he chose a residence that was only 10-15 minutes from the Centre of Badminton Excellence academy of Vimal Kumar and earlier Prakash Padukone. "International travel times too can't be this long," he says.

Tanvi had been reeling from 7 days illness ahead of the Dakar Games. This panned out at the October 5-17 Badminton World Juniors, for which funding didn't come through on time, and the squad scrambled with last-minute arrangements. "First the journey from Guwahati to Delhi went 12-15 hours, then 6-7 hours main flight, and then they waited at airport for 4.5 hours for organisers transport without food or water. She got dehydrated, running a fever for 7 days," he recalls.

Better planning

For the junior Olympics from November 1-5, it was worse. "She started from Bangalore at 8 a.m, then at administration offices in Delhi till 10 pm, because documents of someone from Indian contingent were missing. Then the flight took 21 hours to get to Dakar," he recalls. "We need to minimise transit times and plan better. Athletes don't function well this way," he stresses. Despite the mosquitoes, she had settled in when he brought reinforcements of repellants, but her blanket and bedsheet got stolen from the Games Village.

For all the transit-trauma, Rabi has booked Tanvi into a flight to Indonesia Challenge via a long Singapore lay-over. "That airport has good malls. So she can roam around and shop freely."

Her gift for winning silver? "She's been asking for an iPad. I want to wean her away from phones because small letters ruin eyesight, so a big screen is OK. Athletes need good eyes, and she is still a teenager," Rabi says.



Tirthank Pegu (L) and Dhinidhi Desinghu pose with medals. IOA

Dhinidhi brings home another medal; Pegu bags bronze

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 6

WHEN DHINIDHI Desinghu broke new ground by winning India's first-ever global swimming medal — a bronze in 100m freestyle— her coach Nihar Amin had told *The Indian Express* that "she will do better in the 200m freestyle". On Friday, the 16-year-old vindicated her coach by bagging a bronze in the event to complete a double at the Youth Olympic Games in Dakar, Senegal.

She is the first Indian athlete to win multiple medals in individual events at the global youth showpiece. Desinghu clocked a timing of 2:02.28 in the 200m final, ending up behind China's M Chang, who claimed the gold in 1:59.59, and Croatia's Ana Bobanovic who took silver in 2:01.17.

Later in the day, her teammate Tirthank Pegu brought home another swimming medal — a bronze in the men's 200m butterfly event. He clocked 2:01.25 seconds to become the first Indian male swimmer to finish on the podium at the Youth Olympic Games. This was India's sixth medal at the Games. Colombia's Nicolas Kokidko won the gold in 2:04.14 seconds, while Egypt's Zain Ali bagged silver, clocking 2.04:31.

Pegu had qualified by finishing third in the heats, clocking 2:05.30 to confirm his place in the final.

Meanwhile, Gatha Khadake, India's only archery contender at the ongoing Games, finished third in the women's recurve qualification round on Friday. The Maharashtra archer scored 687 points from 72 arrows to secure the third position. Turkey's Dunya Yenihayat topped the standings with 688 points, edging out South Korea's Sumin Kim on the basis of a superior X-count (24-18). Kim also scored 688 points. Gatha will take on Ivory Coast's Sita Sore in the opening round of 32-archer elimination draw.

Gatha Khadake, India's only archery contender at the ongoing Games, finished third in the women's recurve qualification round.

{ GURDIAL SINGH BHANGU • 1941-2026 }

Bhangu, coach of 2002 team that inspired *Chak De!* passes away

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, November 6

ON FRIDAY afternoon, the *WhatsApp* group of players from the Indian women's hockey team that won the 2002 Commonwealth Games title was filled with tributes to chief coach Gurdial Singh Bhangu, who passed away at 85 in Surrey, Canada.

The story of the against-the-odds win in the final made it to the big screen when *Chak De! India* starring Shah Rukh Khan was released in 2007. The Bollywood star played coach Kabir Khan, a fictionalised role, based on Mir Ranjen Negi. Negi was the fall guy of the 1982 Asian Games final loss to Pakistan but redeemed himself by guiding the team to CWG victory as goalkeeping coach. In the movie, India beat Australia in a World Cup final, but in reality the Bhangu-coached squad beat England 3-2, with Mamta Kharab scoring a golden goal in extra time.

On Friday, Negi credited Bhangu for the team's victory.

"The movie was fictional, and they consulted with many Indian coaches, including me. The movie's story was about the Indian team winning the World Cup, after which a former Indian hockey player's reputation was redeemed. Bhangu was the chief coach and the man responsible for the team's victory in 2002. Though I was not in England during the CWG, I worked as an assistant coach with Bhangu sir. One thing that always impressed me was how he brought out the best in each player and how he made the team play as a unit based on their strengths. He was way ahead in terms of tactical knowledge as well as understanding players," Negi told this paper.

Pritam Siwach, a key member of the 2002 team, praised Bhangu for his tactics.

"Bhangu sir was the hero for all of us. His tactical brilliance helped us win the 2002 Commonwealth Games title. The movie did not do justice to Bhangu sir's contribution as the chief coach. For each one of us, Bhangu sir remains the person who made us believe in ourselves. He was the one who taught us the hockey structure.," Siwach said.



Hockey coach Gurdial Singh Bhangu receives the Dronacharya Award from then president KR Narayanan. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Dhyan Chand link

Born in 1941 in pre-independence India's Lyallpur, Bhangu grew up in Ambala. He played university-level hockey before joining the National Institute of Sports (NIS), Patiala, where he was an understudy of hockey legend Dhyan Chand as well as Balkishan Singh, a 1956 Olympics gold medallist and chief coach of the 1980 Moscow Olympics gold-medal-winning Indian hockey team.

Rajinder Singh Sr., a member of the 1980 Moscow Olympics-winning Indian team and a former head coach, remembers how Bhangu's advice stayed with him. "When I did the diploma from NIS, he would tell me that I had the advantage of being a player," Rajinder said.

Bhangu was appointed head coach of the Indian women's team in 1998, following the team's 12th place finish in the World Cup. Months later, the Pritam Siwach-led Indian team won the silver medal in the Bangkok Asian Games.

He did not like the idea of using a whiteboard and markers to discuss team strategy and preferred to discus it during practice sessions when players were in training.

When India took the penalty corner in the 2002 final, the hooter that signaled the end of the first half of extra time went off. But Bhangu had told the Indian players, that in such a scenario, they should continue playing because when a penalty corner is in process play continues even if the hooter goes off. England players thought play had to be stopped, but Kharab's goal, off a rebound during the PC stood, even though umpires initially disallowed it.

"He told us not to stop during a PC even if the hooter goes. When Mamta scored the golden goal, the half-time hooter had sounded and the umpire initially disallowed the goal. But then the rules allowed for the goal as a penalty corner can be completed even if normal time has elapsed," Siwach said.

She recalls Bhangu sir praying after the match. What he said still remains in her memory. '*Sir ka jadoo chal gaya* (Sir's magic has worked)'.

Mbappe's Mao comments: China, La Liga talk

Reuters
Barcelona, November 6

CHINA IS in contact with Real Madrid and LaLiga over the fallout from Kylian Mbappe's remarks about Mao Zedong, China's ambassador to Spain Yao Jing said on Friday.

"There are no negotiations, but there is communication, based on mutual understanding," Yao told Spanish news agency *EFE* before attending a forum at the University of Salamanca. "This unfortunate incident hurt the feelings of many people in China, who now have to come to terms with the current situation," he added.

The dispute began after a video circulated online in which the Real Madrid and France forward discussed a meme showing his face superimposed on an image of Mao.

Mbappe described the figure as "some guy, I think he's a Chinese dictator" but did not name Mao, modern China's founding leader who governed the country from 1949 until his death in 1976.

LaLiga, Real Madrid and the French footballer all subsequently apologised. China's state broadcaster CCTV suspended its coverage of LaLiga and several Chinese brands dropped Mbappe from their marketing campaigns.

Streaming platform Migu omitted Real Madrid's match against Racing Santander last weekend while showing other Spanish league games.

China Media Group said last week that it would listen to what Mbappe had to say after his apology, and "more importantly" watch what he does.

LaLiga president Javier Tebas met Yao last week as Spanish football sought to limit the commercial fallout and said on Monday that the league was continuing its dialogue with Chinese authorities.

LaLiga was "working to resolve it", Tebas said at the World In Progress forum. LaLiga and Migu have an agreement allowing the broadcast of Spain's top division matches until the end of the 2029-30 season. The LaLiga president said league'sbroadcasting contracts with CCTV and Migu totalled around €10 million ($11.20 million) per year, having fallen from €100 million annually at their peak.

• TOUGH CHILDHOOD

Ronaldo and the father who never saw him bloom

Sandip G
New Delhi, November 6

THE BOY from Madeira. Skinny, freckled, spindly-legged, with placid, tiny eyes and untamed hair. This was Cristiano Ronaldo before he became Sporting's wunderkind, Manchester United's prize-horse, Real Madrid's colossus, the Saudi league's identity and one of football's immortals.

In the humble neighbourhood of Quinta do Falcão, he was always the son of Aveiro. His father put in shifts as kit man for the local football club, C.F. Andorinha. He served drinks in the club's small bar. When dusk sank, he shifted to the other side of the table, clinging to his drink. "I always feared my father, so we never had a strong bond. He battled alcoholism and died from cirrhosis, which is why I vowed never to drink alcohol," Ronaldo said in a public function after his father's death at 52.

Ronaldo was 20 then, and his biggest regret was that his father could never watch him become the footballer he became. At the bar, the old man used to tell his friends that his son would be famous. They laughed it off as a drunk man's babble.

His father exists in fragments and nuggets. Ronaldo remembers him in an essay in The Players' Tribune. "He was on the sidelines at every match with his big beard and his work trousers. He loved it. I remember coming home from the matches with him and he'd say, 'Cristiano scored a goal!'"

There are glimpses of Dinis Aveiro in the 2015 documentary Ronaldo. His hollow, sunken eyes peer from the walls of the house, where Ronaldo is shown feeding his son. Those eyes capture a man who waged several wars, real and of the mind. In his late teens he was drafted into the Portuguese Army and sent to guard one of the last remaining outposts of Portugal in Africa, Angola.

The days under the Angolan sun were hard. The heat was so excruciating that instead of water the soldiers began to drink the local beer. "Beer was our best friend," Aveiro's friend José Manuel Coelho tells *ESPN* in a documentary. "It was so hot that the water was always warm and wouldn't kill your thirst," he says.

Sometimes, they starved for days when local rebels demolished the supply vans. Sometimes, they had nothing to do, so they played football until they got tired. But after the 1974 revolution, Portugal gave up its colonies and the soldiers returned home. No one gave them jobs. Some, like Aveiro, took to the bottle.



A young Ronaldo with his mother Maria and father Aveiro. AP/X

Ronaldo's childhood was difficult but, he says, happy. The pillar was his mother. Maria Dolores never took a day off from her work until her son began to earn millions. She worked as a cook and cleaner and largely supported Ronaldo and his three siblings. "My mother reared me up by sacrificing her life for me. She went to bed hungry to feed me. She worked 7 days a week and worked nights as a cleaner to buy me a pair of boots."

Dolores had little interest in football and rarely attended games. She did once, for his Sporting debut, and was so nervous that she fainted.

At first, football was just a pastime with cousins. "As a child, I thought that at 35, I would be a fisherman in Madeira. I never dreamed of playing what I played, winning what I won," he once told the Portuguese daily *A Bola*, half-jokingly.

Fate had different plans. At 12, he landed in Sporting's academy. He cried every day. He was tough outside, but fragile inside. "It was the most difficult time in my life," he wrote. "I was still in Portugal, but it was like moving to another country. The culture and accent were different. I didn't know anybody, and it was extremely lonely," he added.

All the angst translated to goals on the football field. But his heart wilted every time he heard a coach say: 'He is a beast, but it's a shame he's so small.'

"I was skinny. So I made a decision at 11 years old. I was going to work harder than everybody. I was going to stop acting like a kid. I was going to train like I could be the best in the world."

So when the lights in the dormitory went out, he slipped out to train. He was always late for classes, but it didn't matter. He once told his friend José Semedo: "Stay here. We'll be footballers anyway, we don't need school!" So it turned out. He had so much self-belief that he told Semedo one day he would become the greatest player on the planet. It was the dream of a child, he told him. Later, he had the words printed on the heel of his boots: *El sueño del niño*. The dream of a child.

That dream sprouted in Quinta do Falcão, where he would always be the son of Aveiro, the son of a broken soldier who broke records.

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